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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Tuesday, 9th December, 2025

The House met at the Chamber, Parliament House, at 12:34 p.m.

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 6— Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report.*

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members I have in my hands the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 4th December, 2025, under correction.

Page 1…5—Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much.

On the page numbered 14, the item numbered 12, under the titled item "MOTION", on the very first line, may we delete the word "the" after the word "House", so that it reads, "That this Honourable House adopts…"

On the last paragraph, the name of the Hon Member for Tema East is Mr Isaac Ashai Odamtten which is spelt with a double "t". If they could delete this and replace it with the correct one.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note.

Page 15…29—

Mr Afriyie: This is just a minor error. On the item numbered (lxi), "Ag Director, Corporate strateg" so if they could delete what is there and insert the word "Strategy".

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, kindly take note.

Page 29…40—

Mr Afriyie: On the page numbered 39 (xvii), the name should be "Mr Kofi Kyei-Duodu" and again (xvii), the name of the Auditor-General presently known is, Asiedu. So, what is there should be deleted, so we insert "Asiedu".

Again, the item numbered (xxiii), the word should be "Bernard Kwabena Adjei", so if we could delete what is there and insert the word "Bernard"

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note.

Page 40…41.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 4th December, 2025, as presented and corrected is hereby accepted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, the *Official Report* of 25th November, 2025. Thereafter, we shall consider that of 26th November, 2025.

Hon Members, any correction on the *Official Report* of 25th November, 2025?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Tuesday, 25th November, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, *Official Report* of 26th November, 2025 is under correction. Hon Members, any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Wednesday, 26th November, 2025]

12:44 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, as mentioned at conclave, may I come under Order 7 (2), for us to vary the order of Business and proceed to take the item numbered 10, with your leave.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Second Deputy Majority Whip?

Second Deput Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I have no difficulty.

STATEMENT

Declaration of Kpandai Seat

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, I am further fortified under Standing Order 93(1) to make this Statement for and on behalf of the Minority Caucus.

Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to make this Statement on a matter that strikes at the core of our constitutional order and the integrity of parliamentary democracy. Yesterday, the 8th of December, 2025, you declared the Kpandai Parliamentary seat vacant. Respectfully, this decision has generated a profound concern not only among Members of this House –– *[Uproar]*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, are you coming under a matter of urgent public importance?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it is so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You did not say so.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I did. I said I am fortified under Order 93(1).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, can we all look at Order 93(1)? I read;

> “By the indulgence of the House and leave of the Speaker, a Member may explain a matter of personal nature or make a Statement on a matter of urgent

public importance, at the time appointed for Statements under Order 67"

So, Hon Member, if it is not a normal Statement, you said you want to vary the Order of Business to take Statement, and you are coming under Order 93, you need the leave of the House and the leave of the Speaker.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we have precedence in this House — *[Uproar]—*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members of the Minority, when I give the floor to your leader, and your Leader is speaking, and I have not granted the floor to any other person, it does not lie in your mouth to shout, sit down, sit down. So, your Leader is on the floor, and he must be respected to speak.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, yesterday, the 8th of December, 2025, you declared the Kpandai parliamentary seat vacant. Respectfully, this decision has generated profound concern, not only among Members of this House, but across the nation because of its apparent inconsistency with binding procedural rules governing the effects of application for stay of execution.

Mr Speaker, it is trite that where an application for stay of execution is pending for determination, any proceeding for execution of the judgement shall be stayed for the period. This is why the events of 24th November, 2025 are so important. On that day, you delivered a ruling in response to an application from the Majority Chief Whip, requesting that the Kpandai seat be declared vacant.

Mr Speaker, in your own reasoning, you recorded clearly and publicly relaying on these very procedural rules, and affirmed this binding nature. This same inconsistency was seen in the Hon James Gyakye Quayson matter during the 8th Parliament, where you strongly maintained that Parliament must not act while a stay of application is pending.

Mr Speaker, with respect, the question that naturally arises is, why has the principle changed? What explains the abrupt departure from the binding reasoning you articulated on 24th November, 2025? Why does the stay rule apply in one circumstance, but not the other, particularly when the factual and procedural posture is virtually identical? Ghanaians are asking, and we in this House must also ask. Is this because the Hon Matthew Nyindam is a member of the New Patriotic Party (NPP)?

Mr Speaker, the law does not discriminate. The law does not bind or stiffen binding on whether an NPP or National Democratic Congress (NDC) member stands before it. The impartial and consistent application of procedural rules is a bedrock of the rule of law and the credibility of this House. If Parliament begins to act as though legal rules are optional, binding on some days, and dispensable on other days, then we risk sliding into a dangerous culture of political tit-for-tat, where each Majority and Minority merely waits for its turn to get even.

Mr Speaker, such a path fractures confidence in this institution and threatens the stability of our democratic order. Today, it may appear expedient for one Side, tomorrow the rules may reverse. If we abandon principle today, we leave the future Parliament with a trail of inconsistency that invites retaliation, weakens the authority of Speaker's Chair, and erodes public trust.

Mr Speaker, we must do better, this House must do better, and we must act better. Let us commit ourselves to principled leadership, to procedural fidelity, and to the understanding that this House is a guardian, not a manipulator, of the law. Legitimacy of Parliament depends on our consistency, and we cannot do otherwise. Consistency depends on our willingness to obey, not our political impulses, but the clear dictates of the law.

Mr Speaker, we strongly submit that the letter that was forwarded to the Electoral Commission was out of place, was unfortunate, and flies in the face of law and procedural justice. We submit strongly to this House that that letter must be withdrawn by Parliament forthwith, and we must act and stay consistent with the pronouncements of the Chair, for that matter, the Speaker on this same matter.

We in the Minority do not agree to the writing of this letter. We take a strong position that that letter must be withdrawn forthwith, and as a cradle of democracy, we must be seen to be setting a very good example for the populace of this country to follow suit.

Mr Speaker, I submit to you that that letter must be recalled. That letter declaring the Kpandai seat vacant must be recalled immediately — *[Uproar]*— It cannot be. It cannot be. The situation cannot, and we, on this side of the House, cannot support that decision. Ghana is a fledgling democracy, and the least we can do is to support procedure, is to support the provisions of our law, and to stay away from decisions that fly in the face of logic and procedural justice. We are totally against it. In this House, we have worked in collaboration and in cooperation with our colleagues in the Majority. Even when you do not have your numbers, we have allowed you to lay papers and do all manner of things. This decision will not stay. This decision will not stay. As Speaker, I will humbly call upon you to instruct the Clerk. The Clerk must be instructed forthwith to withdraw that letter and act according to law. I so submit.

Mr Speaker, I thank you — *[Hear! Hear!]*.

[Members of the Minority rose and sang part of the National Anthem]

[Hon Members from the Minority Side chanted and displayed placards]

12:54 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Order! Order!

[Mr Speaker rises to be heard in silence pursuant to Standing Order 126(2)]

Hon Members, I would suspend Sitting for five minutes, and I expect to see the Hon Leaders of the House at the Lobby.

1:00 p.m. — *Sitting suspended.*

3:50 p.m. — *Sitting resumed*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, you may resume your seats. Hon Members, welcome back. Before the suspension, the Minority Chief Whip raised a matter of urgent public importance. There has been a lot of deliberations on the issue regarding the way forward. This is a House of records and the Hon Minority Chief Whip has placed certain issues on record. I may want to give him an opportunity to rehash the issues. *[Uproar]* Hon Members, in the event he has taken a decision not to rehash the issues, it can be summarised, then I will give the opportunity to the Majority Side to also place on record—*[Uproar]* Hon Members, the rule of this House in line with natural justice is that both Sides must be heard. **[Members of the Minority:** No! No! No!**]**

Hon Members, some of you have been in this House for a very long time. Speakers do not give direction without listening to both Sides. **[Members of the Minority:** No! No! No!**]** So, any issue that is raised on the floor of Parliament, the rules of natural justice will demand that both Sides must be heard. That is why we have minority and we have majority.

Hon Minority Chief Whip, will you exercise the option or not? *[Uproar]*

Yes, Hon Majority Leader, let me hear from you.

Hon Members, I am surprised that an issue is raised and you do not want a response to it.

Hon Members, kindly resume your seats.

[Members of the Minority chanted]

4:07 p.m. —

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN THE CHAIR]

[Members of the Minority sang the national anthem.]

4:10 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please let there be order.

Before I enquire to know the state of affairs, it is important I, on your behalf, acknowledge the presence of some visitors. We have students from the Mozano Senior High School, led by the patron of the school, Mr Samuel Kojo Essuman. They are 65 in number, coming from the Gomoa West constituency. On your behalf, I warmly welcome them to the House of Parliament, which is the House of the people. As of now, we are occupying these seats on their behalf. So please, you are welcome, and do not be surprised; these are your products. It is Ghanaians who vote for us to be here, therefore, we should truly represent the people who vote for us. We are here for nothing but their interests, that is why we are here to further— Please, you are welcome, resume your seats. We have a few things to do today, and just please, keenly watch what is happening. Learn the good ones, not the bad ones.

[Students of Mozano Senior High School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: Hon Members, may I listen to the Leaders to give me a brief of the current situation in the House before I proceed? Yes, Majority Leader and Leader of the House?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Minority Members — *rose* —

[Members of the Minority Caucus chant.]

[The Speaker rises to be heard in silence pursuant to Standing Order 126(2)]

4:20 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, I want to humbly draw your attention to our Standing Orders. Hon Members, "Order in the House", on page 73 of the Standing Orders.

"Chair to be heard in silence.

1) The Speaker is responsible for the maintenance of order and observance of the rules of debate in the House.

2) Whenever the Speaker addresses the House, any Member standing shall immediately resume the Member's seat, and the Speaker shall be heard in silence.

3) Whenever the Speaker rises in situations of disorder, any Member standing shall immediately resume the Member's seat.

4) A Member shall not leave the Member's seat while the Speaker is addressing the House."

Hon Members, this is just to refresh your memory. Just on Sunday, I had the honour of hosting the First-timers at the residence of the Speaker, which I happen to occupy now. [**An Hon Member:** It was a trojan horse]

Mr Philip Fiifi Buckman: If you are a man remove your nose mask. *[Uproar]*

The Speaker: Hon Members, this is the House of representatives, not the Ghana Armed Forces. The Ghana Armed Forces has only men, but in this House, we have men and women. So please, if you are directing questions, use a language that is gender compliant.

Hon Members, I keenly observed all that took place this morning and afternoon. But the Order permits me, on resuming the seat, to at least enquire to know the state of affairs. Usually, we start with the Leader of the House. If for any good reason you think that we should listen to somebody else, we will do so. But for Business, it must continue. Hon Members, we are in a democratic state. Once again, I call the House to order.

I want the sense of the House on where to start from. If you want to vary the order of Business, we are always applying, which is a convention now. Usually, the Leader of the House is given the opportunity to start. I will definitely listen to other views, but this is a House of Order.

Yes, Leader of the House? *[Uproar]*

Hon Members, clearly, we have a problem; we have to find a solution. I cannot guide the House to find a solution without listening to the House. *[Uproar]*

Hon Members, please, I know we cannot resolve the problem without a Conclave, but I must first know the problem before we— *[Uproar]* [**Some Minority Members:** Djietror leave Speaker!]

The Speaker: Hon Members, please, the gentleman on my right Side is the Clerk to Parliament.

Hon Members, we need to position ourselves by preparing to have a Conclave. Please, both Sides will have to come to an understanding that there is a need for us to have a Conclave where the Speaker will preside over the discussions and then mediate for us to come to a consensus. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Please, I cannot, after resuming the seat, suspend sitting again.

[Uproar]

[The Speaker rises to be heard in silence pursuant to Standing Order 126(2)].

4:40 p.m.

Hon Members, please let peace prevail. The alternative to peace is something that none of you will treasure. So please, let there be peace. We have the Orders, and I am bound to follow them. I cannot do anything other than follow these Orders, unless you change the Standing Orders. As of now, what I have before me are the Standing Orders as presently constituted, and that is what I am going by.

Please, we have to listen to the Leader of the House. *[Uproar]*

Hon Members, because of the nature of the Business before the House, the alternative is, in fact, a no-go area, and Business must go on today, for the interest of the country, the public, the people we represent, and in your own interest. We have to continue with the Business of the day.

Please, for the last time, let Business go on; peace must prevail.

Thank you. *[Uproar]*

4:50 p.m.

[Pause]

Hon Members, after consultation, I will suspend Sitting for five minutes. We will resume after five minutes.

Sitting is accordingly suspended.

4:54 p.m. — *Sitting suspended.*

5:57 p.m. —*Sitting resumed*.

The Speaker: I apologise profusely for taking more than a five-minute suspension. I decided it was important to listen to your Leaders; I have done so. We are back after more than—how many minutes? You are right, it has been more than one hour. I think it is proper and the law, that the Majority Leader is heard. Then I, as the Presiding Officer, will have my say by giving a ruling on the matter. That is the situation. I cannot do anything apart from that.

Please, Leader of the House.

[Members of the Minority chant]

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the issues before this House have to do with a letter written by the Clerk to Parliament to the Electoral Commission dated 4th December 2025. In the letter, the Clerk, Ebenezer Ahumah Djietror, had written to the Chairperson of the Electoral Commission, and it reads:

> "Occurrence of Vacancy in the Membership of Parliament.
>
> In exercise of the powers conferred and the duty imposed on the Clerk to Parliament by Article 112(5), as amended, of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, I, Ebenezer Ahumah Djietror, the Clerk to Parliament, do hereby formally notify you of the occurrence of a vacancy in the membership of Parliament occasioned by the order of the High Court, Tamale, for a rerun of the Kpandai Parliamentary Elections given on the 24th day of November 2025. This notification is pursuant to the service of a court order on the Clerk to Parliament as the fourth respondent in the suit numbered NR/TL/HC/E13/22/25.
>
> Accordingly, notice is hereby given."

Mr Speaker, on the strength of this communication from the Clerk to the Chairperson of the Electoral Commission, the Minority, this morning, made a Statement pursuant to the provisions on Statements on urgent public matters.

Mr Speaker, when the Minority Chief Whip made the Statement, he demanded that the Clerk be made to withdraw the letter he had written to the Electoral Commission. I was not in the Chamber at the time that the Statement was made by the Minority Chief Whip. I came in, and I saw that the Majority Chief Whip was on his feet and the Members of the Minority were on their feet behaving the very way that they are behaving now. So, I urged the Minority to allow for comments to be made, but they persisted in behaving the way that they are behaving right now.

Mr Speaker, they continued behaving this way until the First Deputy Speaker, who was presiding, decided to rise on his feet to try to bring order to the House. He stood for a very long time, and they did not. They continued conducting themselves in the manner that they are conducting themselves now. And so, the First Deputy Speaker took a short suspension and invited the Leadership to Conclave. When we went into the Conclave, the Minority Leadership refused to show up. They refused to show up, and subsequently, Hon Habib came and said he had been mandated by the Leadership to represent them in the Conclave. So, we tried to discuss the situation and find out exactly what the problem was.

It turned out, Mr Speaker, that they said on Thursday, 27th November 2025, you had given a ruling regarding the re-run of the Kpandai parliamentary elections. And in your ruling, according to them, you had indicated that if the Member for Kpandai exercised his right to appeal, then that exercise of the right to appeal against the High Court's decision would act as a stay on the execution of the orders or the judgment of the court. The Member for Kpandai went to file an appeal and an application for stay. And so, according to them, having acted on your indications in the Chamber, they felt that the decision to allow the Clerk to write to the Chairperson of the Electoral Commission was not in good faith, and that was the basis of their objection.

I listened to them and called for the records; I was given the *Hansard* which captures exactly what you said on Thursday, 27th November 2025.

And Mr Speaker, I want to read excerpts of your ruling, the basis for their claims, and my responses to them.

6:07 p.m.

Mr Speaker, you indicated on that day that:

> "Hon Members, on Tuesday 25th November 2025, the Legal Services Office of the House was served with an order from the Tamale High Court, directed at the Clerk-to-Parliament. Per the order, the court had ordered the second respondent, that is the Electoral Commission, to re-run the Kpandai Parliamentary Election within 30 days. Hon Members, this order arises out of the election petition filed by Daniel Nsala Wakpal, challenging the declaration of the Electoral Commission of Matthew Nyindam as Member of Parliament-Elect for the Kpandai Constituency, pursuant to the Kpandai Parliamentary Elections held on 7th December, 2025. The effect of the order, to my understanding, is that the Electoral Commission is to conduct a re-run election within 30 days, implying that the original declaration of Mr Matthew Nyindam as the winner of the Parliamentary Election is invalid and

the Member is no longer a Member of Parliament.

I, however, bring to the attention of the House the provisions of the Court of Appeal Rules 1997 (C.I. 19) as amended in the Court of Appeal Rules of 2020 (C.I. 132) Rule 27(3). It provides as follows and I quote:

> ‘There shall be a stay of execution of the judgement or decision appealed against for a period of seven days immediately following the giving of notice of the judgement or decision.’

This rule appears mandatory in its terms and applies in every High Court decision capable of appeal. The Supreme Court in *Mensah v. Ghana Commercial Bank* ([2005 – 2006] SCGLR 288) held that any execution commenced before the expiry of this seven-day period is premature and void. The Court of Appeal reaffirmed this position in *Klenam Construction Ltd vs Falcon Crest Investment Ltd & Others,* 7th April 2022, emphasising that the purpose of the statutory stay is to allow the losing party the opportunity to consider the judgement and determine whether to appeal or seek further relief. Justice Baah (J.A.) explained that the position of the law does and I quote him.

> ‘The plain meaning, scope and effect of rule 27 (3)(b) of C.I. 19 is that in respect of any ruling, judgement or decision of the High Court of whatever description in respect of which an appeal can be and further in respect of which an application for a state of execution or proceedings could be filed, there shall operate a statutory state of execution or proceedings for a period of seven days. The apparent intent of the law is to enable the vanquished to ponder over and scrutinise the *bona fides* of the ruling, decision or judgement in order to decide on whether or not to appeal. It is when a decision is made to appeal that an application can be made to the High Court under rule 27 (1)(a) of C.I. 19 or to this court under rule 27(1)(b) of C.I. 19…’

In this instance the ruling of the Tamale High Court was delivered on 24th November, 2025. The statutory seven-day stay therefore remains in force until 1st December, 2025. During this period, the ruling of the High Court cannot form the basis for the Speaker to instruct the Clerk to Parliament to notify the Electoral Commission that the Kpandai seat is vacant.”

Mr Speaker, you then added:

> “In addition to the above, should Mr Nyindam exercise his right of appeal such as an application under rule 27(1)(b) of C.I. 19, it may impose a further suspension on the enforcement of the judgement until the application is determined by the appropriate court. This rule appears to prevent the subject matter of the appeal from being altered or prejudiced while the appeal processes are pending. Therefore, before the initial seven-day statutory stay, the filing of a stay application may yet introduce an additional layer that may prevent

changes to the status of the Hon Member within the meaning of Article 97 and Article 99 of the 1992 Constitution. The attention of the House is also brought to Article 105 of the 1992 Constitution which provides that a person who sits or votes in Parliament knowing or having reasonable grounds for knowing that he is not entitled to do so commits an offence. It is crucial to emphasise that Article 105 is penal in nature should the Hon Member know that he ought not to be in the Chamber and he participates in the activities in the Chamber.

Hon Members, it is therefore premature to say that Mr Matthew Nyindam is disqualified from entering and participating in the proceedings of the House, because this period still falls within the seven-day mandatory stay of execution of the order. Hon Members, this is not a declaratory order; it is an executive order that was delivered by the High Court and so the Hon Member is right to have been in the House yesterday, and to have participated in the proceedings."

Mr Speaker, this is what you delivered, and the Minority are basing their arguments on the part of your ruling where you said in a quote:

"In addition to the above, should Mr Nyindam exercise his right of appeal such as an application under rule 27(1)(b) of C.I. 19, it may impose a further suspension on the enforcement of the judgement until the application is determined by the appropriate court. This rule appears to prevent the subject matter of the appeal from being altered or prejudiced while the appeal processes are pending."

Mr Speaker, their argument is that you appeared to have given a ruling that the Member is entitled to stay as a member of this House and also that if the Member did file any process in the courts by virtue of having filed the process, then the Member's right to remain is further fortified until the matters are disposed of by the court where the application for stay of execution or even the appeal has been lodged. So, I called for C.I. 19 and as amended by C.I. 132.

Mr Speaker, I read C.I. 132(1) to them. C.I. 132 says that the Court of Appeal Rules 1997, C.I. 19, referred to in this enactment as the principal enactment is amended in Rule 27 by (a) the substitution for sub-rule one of quote:

"(1) An appeal shall not operate as a stay of execution under the judgement or decision appealed against unless the court otherwise orders on an application made to the court by motion on notice".

6.17 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I referred my friends on the other side to this provision of C.I. 132 and tried to indicate to them that filing an appeal or even filing a motion on notice will not automatically serve as a stay of the execution of an order of a court. So, in the absence of a substantive order by the court, the Clerk to Parliament is not estopped from communicating that to the

Chairperson of the Electoral Commission under the Constitution. This is because the Chairperson is also obliged under the Constitution to communicate within a certain time period.

Mr Speaker, I then urged on our Colleagues on other Side that we should come back to the Chamber and they can restate their position and I will also state this position as I have stated it. Then on the basis of our positions, we can invite you as Speaker, to come and give a ruling whether it was appropriate or keeping with the law for the Clerk to Parliament to write the letter that he wrote to the Chairperson of the Electoral Commission which I have already read in the Chamber.

I think that it will be appropriate to read Article 112 of the Constitution so that we can see what informed the action of the Clerk to Parliament and whether he is in error or also acting pursuant to a constitutional obligation. So, Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, let me read Article 112(5) of the Constitution.

> "Whenever a vacancy occurs in Parliament, the Clerk to Parliament shall notify the Electoral Commission in writing within seven days after becoming aware that the vacancy occurred, and a by-election shall be held within thirty days after the vacancy has occurred.
>
> (6) Notwithstanding clause (5) of this article, a by-election shall not be held within three months before the holding of a general election."

So, Mr Speaker, clearly, the Constitution injuncts the Clerk to Parliament, whenever a vacancy occurs in Parliament, to notify the Electoral Commission in writing within seven days after the vacancy occurred, and a by-election shall be held within 30 days after the vacancy occurred.

If we take the records, we notice that on 24th November, 2025, you had indicated in your ruling that the statutory seven-day stay, therefore remains in force until 1st December, 2025. So once the statutory seven days was enforced till 1st December, 2025, it means that the obligation of the Clerk to Parliament will start counting on the 1st of December, 2025. So, within seven days of December, the Clerk was obliged constitutionally, pursuant to Article 112(5) of the Constitution to notify the Clerk. So, on the 4th of December, the Clerk wrote to the Electoral Commission indicating that there was a vacancy. This was because the Clerk had been served by the order emanating from the High Court indicating that the court had ruled that there should be a re-run of the election in the Kpandai constituency.

Mr Speaker, I think that what you are being invited to rule on here today is whether the Clerk erred in communicating to the Electoral Commission that a vacancy has occurred, and that once a vacancy has occurred there should be a by-election in the Kpandai constituency. Mr Speaker, your indication, especially in your ruling that filing an appeal may elongate the period during which the Member may be allowed to remain in the Chamber—

That is basically what it is; that is all. It is nothing really earth-shattering. Since morning we have had negotiations and discussions, and we said that we should come into the Chamber and since they have indicated their position, we should also indicate our position.

Now, in a normal democracy with normal democrats—people who actually believe in democracy—one would imagine that they would have no issue with us having this discussion in an open Parliament. But I am not surprised that we have this character of parliamentarians representing the Minority side.

They are insisting that they do not want the discussions held in an open Parliament, that we should not be transparent about our arguments, and that this Side of the House should not be heard on this matter. I have said that it is not possible; no matter how much they chant, no matter how much noise they make, in fact, even if they come and stand on my seat here, I will still state my position so that the Speaker can give his ruling.

So, Mr Speaker, the issue before you is not to challenge your ruling, because your ruling was not even about what happens when one files an appeal. Your ruling was whether or not within the seven days you could be called upon to remove the Member of Parliament from the Chamber, if you can recall. You ruled accordingly that by our C.I. 19, there is an automatic stay for seven days. Within that seven days the judgement could not be executed, the Member would have a right to be in the Chamber. But after the seven days, then execution will be triggered automatically.

You gave that ruling, but you engaged in a general discussion of some legal matters and you said that if he triggers his appeal right it "may"— I think that the contention is around your use of the word "may". Having used the word "may", their position is that once he had filed his appeal and filed his motion on notice, trying to secure an interim injunction, then we should not have allowed the Clerk to write the letter to the Electoral Commission.

But my contention is that that was not the gravamen of your ruling. The gravamen of your ruling was basically to decide whether on that day, the Hon Member should stay in the Chamber, and you did rule that he could stay in the Chamber.

Now, the issue of whether when he files an appeal and when he files a motion or notice for interim injunction, whether that serves as an injunction, is a completely different matter. I drew attention to C.I. 132 which amended C.I. 19 and which in its terms is very clear that, once judgement is given when a person files an appeal or a motion on notice for a stay of execution, it does not automatically stay proceedings in the execution of that judgement.

6.27 p.m.

Mr Speaker, this is what you are being called upon to decide. Unfortunately, I am surprised that our Friends on the other Side will not want this fact to be stated, so that Ghanaians will know why they are in black, and why they are wearing face masks. They do not want Ghanaians to identify them individually. They are wearing face masks. If they are not ashamed of what they are doing, they should remove their face masks. If they are ashamed of what they are doing, then they should not do it. If they have the courage to do them, they should not wear a face mask to do them.

I am not wearing a face mask. I am very confident, and I can assure them that I will not be distracted. They can say anything about Bawku; I will not respond to them. They can say anything, but I will not mind them. I will remain focused and let Ghanaians know that they are only pretending to be democrats; they are not democrats. If they were democrats, they would allow Ghanaians to hear what it is that they are fighting. They do not want Ghanaians to hear the facts because they know that the facts are not on their side. They are fighting for justice, but they do not want Ghanaians to know the facts on the basis that their fight

How would the Speaker rule if the Speaker has not heard both Sides on this matter? The Speaker cannot rule then. That is why, since morning, my Side has insisted that we will speak to the facts so that the Speaker can rule on the matter. And I am insisting that we will not allow this matter to be treated in secrecy. It must be treated in the full glare of the media. I want them to capture the facts based on which they are mounting their protests, so that Ghanaians would be the judges as to who is actually right in this matter.

Mr Speaker, basically, those are the facts. And I hear them talking about Bawku. I will restrain myself today, because His Royal Majesty Otumfuo Osei Tutu II has indicated that he will bring the report on Bawku on the 17th to present to His Excellency the President. When he presents his report to His Excellency the President, we will see where the matter will end.

Mr Speaker, on that note, I thank you very much. *[Hear! Hear!]*

[Members of the Minority continued chanting]

The Speaker: Hon Members, I believe the office of the *Official Report* would have captured what the Majority Leader commented upon — *[Hear! Hear!]* Hon Members, I will have to, in the circumstances that we are in today, have access to what has been captured by the *Official Report*, and I will come to the House to give a ruling in this matter.

Hon Members, in the circumstances, I want to urge the House to await my ruling and to allow us to proceed with the Business of the House. *[Hear! Hear!]*

I am reliably informed that this was an urgent Statement that was made by the Minority Chief Whip, and so I think this matter would have come under the item numbered 8. Being an urgent Statement of Public concern, the First Deputy Speaker granted leave after the indulgence of the House, and so the rules were properly applied. It means after the item numbered 8, subject to the convenience of the House, I want us to take the item numbered 9; which is at the commencement of public business. Hon Members, the item numbered 9: Presentation of Papers.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 9 (a) is a request for tax waivers to be laid by the Minister for Finance. Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is not immediately available, and so I want to crave your indulgence for his Deputy, who is here to lay the item numbered 9(a).

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — *rose*—

Hon Members, the Minority Chief Whip was on his feet, so I have to listen to him.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

6:37 p.m.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, my Colleagues should bear me out. On all the occasions that it mattered, we had cooperated —*[Interruption]*—

Mr Speaker, they may speak into the microphone, and we will give them a reply. They can say whatever they want to say. They cannot scare me; I would say whatever I want to say. If they want to speak, they should rise and catch the eye of the Speaker.

Mr Speaker, since we started the consideration of the estimate, we have largely cooperated with our Colleagues, even where Hon Ministers are absent, and where Chairpersons of Committees are absent, we have cooperated and staged the needed compromise.

Mr Speaker, we have had enough for the day hence, we will call for an adjournment; and a deserving one of course. For the record, we want to make it very clear to them that they cannot scare anybody here, until the issue on Kpandai is resolved, the Business of Government will suffer; they should get it clear. Mr Speaker, they keep telling us they have 183, and then four Independent Members; they should go and marshal up their numbers, and come and do their Business, but until the issue of Kpandai is resolved, we, on this Side, will not cooperate; we are saying it again, we will not cooperate with them.

[Uproar]

Nobody is going anywhere; we are not moving.

Mr Speaker, we have made that point, and we will continue to make this point; we are not obstructing Government Business. We believe that governance is a continuum, and we must continue with Government Business; however, to the extent that they have conspired to twist our hands, I put it to them that Government Business will suffer.

So, Mr Speaker, we are not doing any Business; we are not going to cooperate with you until the issue of Kpandai is resolved. Government Business will suffer; they are going to suffer. If they think that we would be going home, nobody is stepping out of this Chamber; nobody is moving out.

So, Mr Speaker, we have had enough for the day; we must deservedly adjourn, and then when we come tomorrow, we will consider whether we will do Business with you or not.

Question put and Motion negatived.

The Speaker: Yes, Deputy Minority Chief Whip?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I rise under Order 151(3).

Mr Speaker, with your permission, I read Standing Order 151(3), and it states:

> "A Member may challenge the decision of the Speaker on the voice vote and the Speaker shall determine whether to call for a headcount or electronic vote.

Mr Speaker, in this case, we call for a headcount.

The Speaker: Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I am sure my Colleague, Hon Habib, is aware of the provisions of Order 154, which says that one cannot unnecessarily call for a division.

Mr Speaker, it is obvious that this Side has the numbers, and we can continue to conduct business. I can understand that our friends on the other Side have an issue that they want to bring to the attention of the nation, and they have brought their issue to the attention of the nation.

I have, in my presentation to you, been fair to both sides. I have really, in fact, made their case better than they would have made it themselves. I am sure Ghanaians know the basis of their protest, and I am not running away from the basis of their protest; I do not easily run away.

Mr Speaker, the issue is that we have been prevented from conducting Business the whole day as a result of the protests that they mounted. We indulged them, and we engaged them. I presided over a meeting that lasted several hours, trying to find an amicable way out of it. Because of that, we have not been able to touch any of the items under Government Business, and so, I urge you, that we proceed to deal with the items.

The Speaker: Hon Members, it is clear that the Hon Deputy Minority Whip has challenged my decision on the voice vote. What is now left is for me to determine whether to call for a headcount or electronic vote. That decision lies in my bosom, and I will exercise it in favour of us continuing with the Business, because I believe that the voice vote was very clear, and there was nothing wrong with my decision. Therefore, we will proceed with the Business of the House.

[Hear! Hear!]

[Uproar]

The Speaker: We move to take the item numbered 9(a), by the Minister for Finance.

6:47 p.m.

PAPERS

By the Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) on behalf of the Minister for Finance—

Request for the Waiver of Import Duties, Import NHIL, Special Import Levy, Value Added Tax, GETFund Levy, ECOWAS Levy, AU Levy and EXIM Levy on the importation of Vehicles with Engine Capacities of up to 2.70cc for Foreign Service Officers returning from postings at Ghana Missions abroad.

Referred to the Finance Committee.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker the item numbered 9 (b) is brought to this House by the Minister for Foreign Affairs. The Deputy Minister for Foreign Affairs is in the Chamber so I want to crave your indulgence for the Deputy Minister for Foreign Affairs to lay the item numbered 9(b)

The Speaker: Hon Members, item numbered 9(b) by the Minister for Foreign Affairs.

By the Deputy Minister for Foreign Affairs (Mr James Gyakye Quayson) on behalf of the Minister for Foreign Affairs—

Agreement under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) on the conservation and sustainable use of marine biological diversity of areas beyond national jurisdiction.

Referred to the Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 9(c) is by the Minister for Energy and Green Transition. The Minister for Energy and Green Transition is unavoidably absent and so I crave your indulgence for the Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources who is in the Chamber to lay the Paper on behalf the Minister for Energy and Green Transition.

By the Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Alhaji Yusif Sulemana) on behalf of the Minister for Energy and Green Transition

Work Programme of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) for the year 2026.

Referred to the Committee on Energy.

The Speaker: Hon Members we now move to the item numbered 25.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I crave your indulgence so that the Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources moves the Motion

ANNUAL ESTIMATES, 2026

MINISTRY OF LANDS AND NATURAL RESOURCES

Chairman of the Committee (Alhaji Collins Dauda): Mr Speaker, I would like to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the allocation of the sum of GH₵2,108,555,490.00 for the services of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Alhaji Yusif Sulemana: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion ably moved by the Chairperson of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources, and in so doing, present the Report of the Committee. I want to call on this House to adopt and approve the amount of GH₵2,108,555,490.00 for the services of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year was presented to Parliament by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson, on 13th November, 2026, in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution.

Pursuant to Orders 195 and 240 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Annual Budget Estimates were referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee held a meeting with the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah, together with officials of the Ministry and its Agencies, to consider the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates. Representatives from the Ministry of Finance were also present to support the Committee's deliberations.

The Committee is grateful to the Hon Minister and the Officials for their attendance and for clarifying issues raised at the meeting.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992;

ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament, 2024;

iii. The Land Act, 2020 (Act 1036);

iv. The Ghana Integrated Aluminium Development Corporation Act, 2018 (Act 976);

v. The Ghana Integrated Iron and Steel Development Corporation Act, 2019 (Act 988);

vi. The Ghana Geological Survey Authority Act, 2016 (Act 298);

vii. The Ghana Boundary Commission Act, 2024 (Act 1123);

viii. The Lands Commission Act, 2008 (Act 767);

ix. The Minerals Commission Act, 1993 (Act 450);

x. The Forestry Commission Act, 1999 (Act 571)

xi. The Minerals Development Fund Act, 2016 (Act 912);

xii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year; and

xiii. The Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources Medium Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2026-2029.

Mission and Core Functions of the Ministry Mission of the Ministry

The Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources exists to ensure the sustainable management and utilisation of lands, forests, wildlife, and mineral resources through policies, programmes, legislation, and research for socio-economic growth and development.

Core Functions of the Ministry

The Ministry is responsible for the following:

i. Ensuring the efficient formulation, implementation, coordination, monitoring, and evaluation of policies and programmes;

ii. Ensuring efficient and equitable land delivery services;

iii. Facilitating the promotion of sustainable forest and wildlife resource management and utilisation;

iv. Ensuring efficient management of mineral resources to catalyse sustainable development;

v. Facilitating the promotion of effective inter-agency and cross-sectoral linkages; and

vi. Protecting the country's boundaries in collaboration with other State agencies.

Policy Objectives of the Ministry Under the Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2026 — 2029

The following are the policy objectives of the Ministry under the Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2026-2029:

i. Ensure sustainable extraction of mineral resources;

ii. Ensure effective linkage of the extractive industry to the rest of the economy;

iii. Develop an efficient land administration and management system;

iv. Expand forest conservation areas;

v. Protect forest reserves;

vi. Combat deforestation, desertification, and soil erosion;

vii. Enhance climate change resilience;

viii. Reduce greenhouse gases;

ix. Promote proactive planning for disaster prevention and mitigation; and

x. Promote sustainable groundwater resources development and management

Agencies Under the Ministry

The Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources comprises the following:

i. Headquarters of the Ministry;

ii. Forestry Commission;

iii. Lands Commission;

iv. Minerals Commission;

v. Office of the Administrator of Stool Lands (OASL);

vi. Ghana Boundary Commission;

vii. Ghana Integrated Aluminium Development Corporation (GIADEC); and

viii. Ghana Integrated Iron and Steel Development Corporation (GIISDEC).

Financial Performance of the Ministry in 2025 Performance of approved budget

The sum of One Billion, Eight Hundred and Seventeen Million, Four Hundred and Forty-Nine Thousand, Six Hundred and Thirty-Nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵1,817,449,639.00) was approved for the implementation of programmes and activities of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the 2025 financial year. Of this amount, only One Billion, Two Hundred and Forty-Six Million, Seven Hundred and Ninety Thousand, Eight Hundred and Twenty-Eight Ghana Cedis, Ninety Pesewas (GH₵1,246,790,828.90) was actually released. This left an unreleased balance of Five Hundred and Seventy Million, Six Hundred and Fifty-Eight Thousand, Eight Hundred and Ten Ghana Cedis, Ten Pesewas (GH₵570,658,810.10), representing roughly thirty-one percent of the approved budget.

From the funds released, One Billion, One Hundred and Fifty-Two Million, Five Hundred and Forty-Two Thousand, Seven Hundred and Thirty-Five Ghana Cedis, Forty-Five Pesewas (GH₵1,152,542,735.45) was actually paid out, leaving Ninety-Four Million, Two Hundred and Forty-Eight Thousand, Ninety-Three Ghana Cedis, Forty-Five Pesewas (GH₵94,248,093.45), or about seven-point-six percent of releases, still undisbursed as at October, 2025.

The details of the Ministry's expenditure for the 2025 Financial Year are shown in Table 1

Table 1: Summary of Financial Performance of the Ministry as at October, 2025

Item	**Approved Budget (GH₵) - A**	**Actual Releases (GH₵)- B**	**Actual Payment (GH₵) - C**	**Variance (GH₵) (A-B)**	**Variance (GH₵) (B-C)**
GoG					
Compensation	469,698,051.00	381,947,464.75	381,947,464.75	87,750,586.25	-
Goods & Services	110,943,501.00	95,230,000.00	40,774,190.68	15,713,501.00	54,455,809.32
Capex	65,140,060.00	-		65,140,060.00	-
Sub-Total	645,781,612.00	477,177,464.75	422,721,655.43	168,604,147.25	54,455,809.32
IGF					
Compensation	266,414,326.00	197,250,655.00	197,250,655.00	69,163,671.00	-
Goods & Services	468,309,702.00	416,645,606.00	392,339,617.00	51,664,096.00	24,305,989.00
Capex	151,693,999.00	94,417,333.28	93,224,732.63	57,276,665.72	1,192,600.65
Sub-Total	886,418,027.00	708,313,594.28	682,815,004.63	178,104,432.72	25,498,589.65
DP					
Goods & Services	105,950,000.00	57,037,699.80	42,744,005.32	48,912,300.20	14,293,694.48
Capex	179,300,000.00	4,262,070.07	4,262,070.07	175,037,929.93	-
Sub-Total	285,250,000.00	61,299,769.87	47,006,075.39	223,950,230.13	14,293,694.48
Grand Total	**1,817,449,639.00**	**1,246,790,828.90**	**1,152,542,735.45**	**570,658,810.10**	**94,248,093.45**

Source: 2026 Budget Estimate Presentations to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources

Operational Performance of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources in 2025

The operational performance of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources is summarised as follows:

Headquarters of the Ministry

The Headquarters of the Ministry achieved the following in 2025:

i. Established National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations (NAIMOS) through a collaboration between the Ministry, the Ministry of Defence, and the Ministry of the Interior, specifically to support the fight against illegal mining;

ii. Supported NAIMOS operations with the Ministry's taskforce and the procurement of essential equipment, including operational vehicles, computers, and communication equipment;

iii. Seized various equipment, including 44 excavators, 11 bulldozers, 36 pump action guns, 24 motorbikes, 14 cars, 1,200 water pumps, 26 LXG cylinders, and washing boards;

iv. Arrested 1,466 illegal miners, and successfully repossessed forest reserves of illegal miners; and

v. Initiated the process of developing a Legislative Instrument to operationalise the Wildlife Resources Management Act 2023, (Act 1115).

Forestry Sub-Sector

The following are the achievements of the Forestry Sub-sector in 2025:

i. Exported a total of 184,350 m^3 of timber and timber products valued at €83.5 million, representing 62 per cent of the annual target of 300,000 m^3;

ii. Recorded a total of 450,776 visitors across various forest and wildlife ecotourism sites managed under the Forestry Commission against the annual target of 500,000;

iii. Restored a total of 10,320ha degraded forest plantation (6,715ha-Public and 3,605ha-Private);

iv. Harvested a total area of 1.51 million cubic meters of natural forest timber, representing 76 per cent of the annual target of 2 million cubic meters;

v. Implemented the Tree for Life Initiative and achieved the following targets under various components: MTS-5,206ha, Direct Planting (YFC) -694ha, Enrichment Planting-1,311ha, Module Plantation-391ha, Tress-on-Farm-911,206 seedlings, Amenity Planting-1,374,214 seedlings; and

vi. Embarked on a joint FC/Military operation to flush out illegal miners from Forest Reserves, resulting in the arrest of 347 suspects, destruction of 123 changfang machines, the seizure of 194 excavators, 16 vehicles, 4 bulldozers, 217 pumping machines, 69 motorbikes, 7 tricycles, 15 gold detector machines, and 10 heavy-duty generators.

Land Sub-Sector

Lands Commission

The Lands Commission achieved the following in 2025:

i. Modernised its records management system in the Ashanti and Greater Regional Offices.

ii. Established digitised files and Attribute data.

iii. Improved the Ground Rent Management module in the ELIS management of government leases and rent collection;

iv. Completed 98 per cent of the construction of GARO complex, which is expected to be handed over at the end of December 2025.

v. Collaborated with the Licensed Surveyors Association of Ghana (LiSAG) and a private sector partner to operationalise fifty-two (52) Continuously Operating Reference Stations (CORS) across the country.

Office of the Administrator of Stool Lands (OASL)

The OASL achieved the following in 2024:

i. Commenced the distribution of rent demand notes using the App, in addition to data collection and rent demand notes generation.

ii. Constructed a Borehole using stool land revenue at Nkrankrom (Sunyani Municipal).

iii. Collected revenue to the tune of One Hundred and One Million, Seven Hundred and Thirty-Five and Sixteen Ghana Cedis, Sixty Pesewas (GH₵101,735,016,60) as at the end of September, 2025 as stool land revenue out of a target of two hundred and fifty-nine million, seven hundred and seventy-four thousand and seven hundred and eighty-nine Ghana Cedis Ninety Pesewas (GH₵259,774,789.90), representing 39 per cent of the target;

iv. Established two (2) Customary Land Secretariats (CLSs) at Gomoa Fetteh and Atebubu traditional areas in Central and Bono East Regions, respectively; and

v. Engaged six hundred and sixteen (616) communities, fifty-seven (57) traditional authorities, and two hundred and fifty-one (251) Stools and families to foster collaboration and cooperation in the sustainable use of land resources in the country.

Ghana Boundary Commission

The Ghana Boundary Commission achieved the following in 2025;

i. Conducted of a finalisation of the field research and survey of Phase 1 of the joint reaffirmation exercise from BP55 to BP45 in March 2025 by the Ghana Boundary Commission, in collaboration with Côte d'Ivoire's National Boundary Commission;

ii. Conducted preliminary orthophoto mapping of the international boundary at Newtown in the Western Region, specifically from Boundary Pillar (BP) 55 to BP 45. (7.80km);

iii. Carried out Phase I of Land Boundary Reaffirmation Exercise in March 2025 to finalise surveys of boundary pillars along the international Boundary Line (IBL) BETWEEN bp 55 and BP 45;

iv. Collaborated with the GIZ/M-TOC project to hold workshops in Tamale, Northern Region, and developed actionable plans to mitigate the destabilising effects of Transnational Organised Crime (TOC) in the border communities of Ghana; and

v. Undertook Joint Operational Assessment with GISSDEC in the Oti Region from 10th – 14 November 2025 to confirm Pillars and ensure operations are within the territorial borders of Ghana.

Mining Sub-Sector

Minerals Commission

The Minerals Commission achieved the following in 2025:

i. Trained and deployed 1,671 Blue Water Initiative personnel, exceeding the planned target of 1,000 in response to the illegal mining threat.

ii. Distributed 1,257,324 hybrid oil palm seedlings compared to a target of 4,000,000 as part of the Forest Restoration Policy;

iii. Drafted the regulatory framework for medium-scale mining;

iv. Conducted 4,454 monitoring visits, exceeding the planned 4,000 to ensure compliance with mining laws;

v. Installed 868 GPS trackers on mining equipment and registered 1,559 mining equipment under the Importation Policy to strengthen oversight and enhance compliance;

vi. Issued 4,815 certifications of competency as part of ensuring safe operation at mine sites.

Ghana Geological Survey Authority

GGSA achieved the following in 2025:

i. Produced ten (10) bulletins for monthly seismicity and earthquake monitoring activity;

ii. Conducted geohazard mapping at Appolonia in the Shai Osudoku District in the Greater Accra;

iii. Conducted geological mapping on the Akwapim range to identify possible geothermal energy sources in the country and

iv. Conducted one hundred (100) line kilometres geophysical survey at Appolonia, Adeiso, Nyanyano, and surrounding areas in the Greater Accra and Eastern Regions;

v. Conducted clay investigation at Prampram, Ada, Adidome, Oyibi, and Apam areas;

vi. The Authority drafted seven (7) technical instructions for the development of regulations to operationalise the GGSA Act 2016 (Act 928);

Ghana Integrated Iron and Steel Development Corporation (GIISDEC)

Among others, GIISDEC achieved the following in 2025:

i. Conducted transaction reviews, prepared solicitation documents, and initiated negotiations with strategic partners to attract investment across the iron and steel value chain;

ii. Undertook drilling campaigns and geological surveys with 13 MOUs signed with partners to undertake MREs at their own cost and risk;

iii. Supported water infrastructure projects in Asato and Djamurome communities, restoring clean water access to over 500 households;

iv. Organised townhalls, durbars, and parliamentary engagements to deepen public awareness;

v. Strengthened corporate development, branding, and capacity building initiatives

vi. Successfully secured and relocated to a more cost-efficient office space, reducing overhead expenditure while maintaining a conducive working environment.

Ghana Integrated Aluminium Development Corporation (GIADEC)

In 2025, GIADEC achieved the following:

i. Successfully secured six (6) bauxite mining leases in June 2025, which are awaiting parliamentary ratification of the mining leases, thereby paving the way for the commencement of mining development.;

ii. Held a series of investor engagement meetings with high-profile players such as RUSAL, KAMARA Group, Aluminium Corporation of China (Chinalco), African Selection Group, HN Industry Group Ltd, Quebec Mines, Neo Group, Madison Alumina, JSG Saudi, etc to explore strategic partnerships, offtake agreements, and other areas of possible collaboration for the development of the IA;

iii. Completed the initial draft of the Biodiversity Action Plan for the Tano Offin Forest Reserve, incorporating insights from comprehensive baseline studies; and

iv. Successfully launched a compelling documentary which traces the history of the IAI, showcases GIADEC's journey since its establishment, and presents key findings from an independent Economic and Social Impact Analysis (ESIA).

Outlook for 2026 Financial Year

The Headquarters of the Ministry

The Headquarters of the Ministry plans to undertake the following activities in 2026 in furtherance of its mandate:

i. Plant 30million seedlings under the Tree for Life Reforestation Initiative;

ii. Continue with the implementation the Cooperative Mining Schemes and Skills Development Programmes to provide alternative livelihoods for the youth in mining Communities;

iii. Procure additional Vehicles and other logistics for NAIMOS;

iv. Establish the Geological and Minerals Information System for GGSA

v. Complete the renovation of Minerals Commission District Offices at Dunkwa and Prestea; and

vi. Implement the Ghana Women and Youth Social Cohesion Project (GWYESCO).

Lands Commission

In 2026, the Lands Commission shall undertake the following activities:

i. Embark on digital transformation of business processes across the country;

ii. Facilitate the development of legislative instruments for the full implementation of the Land Act, 2020 (Act 1036) and the Lands Commission Act, 2008 (Act 767);

iii. Establish and equip new Land Commission District Offices to decentralise land service delivery

iv. Undertake public sensitisation activities on services provided by the Commission;

v. Build capacity to improve work culture and corporate governance; and

vi. Construct and renovate District and Regional Offices.

Ghana Boundary Commission

The Ghana Boundary Commission shall undertake several projects in 2026, including the following:

i. Commence construction of the boundary pillars of the newly reaffirmed boundary with Cote d'Ivoire;

ii. Procure and set up GIS Geo-Database Software for the management of Ghana's land boundaries;

iii. Plant boundary pillars and teak along Ghana's international border line;

iv. Undertake capacity building training for staff in their respective areas of operation;

v. Undertake community sensitisation programmes and media engagement; and

vi. Conduct field research on border security risk, vulnerability assessment, and other border-related issues.

Office of the Administrator of Stool Lands (OASL)

OASL plans to undertake the following activities in 2026:

i. Mobilise the stool land revenue to the tune of 351,877,147.

ii. Extend the operation of the office by establishing 5 new districts or collection points;

iii. Monitor its operations in 10 regions and 120 district offices;

iv. Deploy OASLRevApp to 90 districts (cumulative);

v. Continue to collaborate with the Ministry, Parliament, and other key stakeholders to review OASL Act (Act 481);

vi. Undertake stakeholder validation of Guidelines for the use of stool land revenue by MMDAs;

vii. Facilitate the establishment of 50 self-initiated customary land secretariats; and

viii. Monitor or strengthen activities of 90 existing customary land secretariats across the country.

Forestry Commission

The Forestry Commission plans to undertake the following activities in 2026:

i. Embark on activities to enforce the Governance & Trade (FLEGT)/ Voluntary Partnership Agreement (VPA)

ii. Augment the implementation of a Robust Afforestation/ Reforestation Programme (RAP) to achieve national landscape restoration targets under the Ghana Forest Plantation Strategy (GFPS) through the establishment of 25,000ha of forest plantations;

iii. Expand ecotourism infrastructure especially those at Mole and Shai Hills;

iv. Scale up the implementation of Reducing Emission from Forest Degradation and Deforestation (REDD+) Projects to tackle climate change, especially in the Bono region;

v. Continue to implement sustainable management and protection of Wildlife Resources; and

vi. Develop the timber trade industry.

Minerals Commission

The Minerals Commission has committed to undertake the following activities in 2026:

i. Recruit and train Blue Water Guards to help the fight against illegal mining;

ii. Continue to implement the Make Ghana Green Project (T4L Policy);

iii. Facilitate the adoption of a revised Mining Policy, and amendment of the Minerals and Mining Act to improve mining regulatory regime;

iv. Continue the construction of office complexes at strategic locations in mining areas

v. Train small-scale miners in sustainable mining practices;

vi. Train technical and non-technical staff in various fields; and

vii. Procure operational vehicles and equipment to inspection visits to operating mines, including industrial mineral operation sites.

Ghana Geological Survey Authority

The Authority shall undertake the following activities in 2026:

i. Collaborating with both local and international partners in the execution of the Authority’s mandate;

ii. Implementing measures to improve on IGF generation to enable the Authority to become self-reliant;

iii. Renovation and rehabilitation of dilapidated office facilities and bungalows;

iv. Conducting geophysical and geochemical surveys on the Senyon Small-Scale Mining blocked-out area to delineate a prospective target for gold mineralisation and;

v. Continuous monitoring of seismicity and or earthquakes, carry out geo-hazard mapping and public education on geo-hazards of the country to reduce and mitigate the impact of natural disasters and risks.

Ghana Integrated Iron and Steel Development Corporation

In 2026, GIISDEC plans to undertake the following activities:

i. Commence the establishment of a Steel Processing Plant Project at Opon Manse;

ii. Undertake mineral resource estimation at Bodada and the Pudo Blocks to diversify and improve mineral value for investment; and

iii. Develop the legislative Instrument (L.I.) to provide a comprehensive legal and regulatory framework for the operationalisation of the Ghana Integrated Iron and Steel Development Corporation Act, 2019 (Act 988)

Ghana Integrated Aluminium Development Corporation

GIADEC intends to undertake the following activities in 2026:

i. Secure ratification of mining leases for GIADEC concessions;

ii. Develop and commence full-scale bauxite extraction at Nyinamhin Block A;

iii. Complete alumina refinery pre-feasibility study;

iv. Execute Agreement with strategic partner for alumina refinery, and Valco modernisation;

v. Collaborate with Ministry of Trade and Industry and Ghana Railway Development Authority to award railway contract from Huni valley to Nyinahin; and

vi. Implement mandatory certification and licensing of downstream sector players.

2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry

The sum of Two Billion, One Hundred and Eight Million, Five Hundred and Fifty-Five Thousand, Four Hundred and Ninety Ghana Cedis (GH₵2,108,555,490) has been allocated to the Ministry for its activities in the 2026 Financial Year. This figure comprises the amount of Eight Hundred and Ninety Million, Six Hundred and Four-Three Thousand, Four Hundred and Fifty-Eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵890,643,458.00) for Compensation of Employees, Eight Hundred and Sixty Million, One Hundred and Forty-Six Thousand, Nine Hundred and Fourteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵860,146,914.00) for Goods and Services, and CAPEX of Three Hundred and Fifty-Seven Million, Seven Hundred and Sixty-Five Thousand, One Hundred and Eighteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵357,765,118). The details are presented in Tables 2 and 3.

Table 2: 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources by Economic Classification

Item	GOG (GH₵)	IGF (GH₵)	DP FUNDS (GH₵)	Sub-Total (GH₵)
Compensation of Employees	511,851,802.00	378,791,656.00	-	890,643,458.00
Goods and Services	280,943,501.00	507,926,413.00	71,277,000.00	860,146,914.00
Capital Expenditure	15,140,060.00	342,625,058.00	-	357,765,118.00
Total	**807,935,363.00**	**1,229,343,127.00**	**71,277,000.00**	**2,108,555,490.00**

Table 3: 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources by Programme Classification

Item	GOG (GH₵)	IGF (GH₵)	DP FUNDS (GH₵)	Total (GH₵)
Management and Administration	27,722,485.00		71,277,000.00	298,999,485.00
Land Administration and Management	154,543,546.00	324,863,960.00		479,407,506.00
Forest and Wildlife Development and Management	295,059,315.00	183,853,737.00		478,913,052.00
Mineral Resource Development and Management	118,566,498.00	720,625,430.00		839,191,928.00

Boundary Administration	12,043,519.00			12,043,519.00
Total	**807,935,363.00**	**1,229,343,127.00**	**71,277,000.00**	**2,108,555,490.00**

Observations

The Committee made the following observations during the deliberations:

Implementation of Responsible Cooperative Mining and Skills Development Programme (rCOMSDEP)

The Committee noted that, as at October 2025, an amount of GH₵30 million had been released for the implementation of targeted interventions to promote responsible and inclusive mining under the Responsible Cooperative Mining and Skills Development Programme (rCOMSDEP). Under the programme, the Ministry negotiated the release of portions of mining concessions from AngloGold Ashanti, Newmont Ghana and Adamus Mines to enable communities in Obuasi, Bibiani, Anwia Teleku-Bokaso and Nkaseim to establish Cooperative Mining Schemes.

The Ministry also collaborated with the Department of Cooperatives to register six cooperative mining groups in the Western Region and engaged 51 communities across the country on responsible mining and compliance with health, safety and environmental standards. In partnership with GIZ International and AngloGold Ashanti, rCOMSDEP further provided start-up kits valued at €200,000 to 127 trained youth in Obuasi.

In 2026, the Ministry plans to implement a GH₵24 million package of interventions under the Responsible Cooperative Mining and Skills Development Programme (rCOMSDEP). The largest component is Vocational, Technical and Digital Skills training for 200 beneficiaries, at least half of whom will be women and youth, at a cost of GH₵15,732,500. A further GH₵1,396,000 is earmarked to support 80 viable MSMEs, while GH₵3,076,000 will benefit 80 participants engaged in agriculture and agro-processing. In addition, GH₵3,795,500 has been allocated to support four responsible cooperative mining groups, with a focus on formalisation and compliance with environmental and safety standards.

NAIMOS Budget Shortfall and Urgent Funding Needs

The Committee observed that the National Anti-Illegal Mining Operations Secretariat (NAIMOS) has been given an allocation of GH₵150.36 million for executing its core mandate in 2026.

The Committee further observed that for optimal effectiveness, the Secretariat urgently requires state-of-the-art equipment, such as multi-terrain 4x4 vehicles, motorcycles, body cameras, and advanced surveillance tools, to counter the intelligence and sophistication increasingly demonstrated by *galamsey* operators. The Coordinator also outlined the Secretariat's adoption of a robust multi-sectoral strategy, drawing on specialised expertise from the Minerals Commission, Ghana Armed Forces, Ghana Immigration Service, Ghana Police Service, National Intelligence Bureau, and Blue Water Guards to ensure coordinated and impactful interventions.

In recognition of the important role expected of the NAIMOS personnel as well as the national security implications of their anti-illegal mining efforts., the Committee strongly urges the Ministry of Finance to accord top priority to supplemental funding for the Secretariat during the 2026 Mid-Year Budget Review.

Disbursement of the Ghana Geological Survey Authority's Share of Minerals Development Fund

The Committee observed with deep concern the persistent failure to disburse the Ghana Geological Survey Authority's rightful share of funds from the Minerals Development Fund (MDF), which is critical to supporting the implementation of its key capital projects. Notably, in 2025, the Authority did not receive any portion of the GH₵66.3 million earmarked as its share from the MDF. This chronic underfunding has severely constrained the Authority's capacity to procure essential geological equipment, conduct vital geological investigations, and develop the necessary infrastructure to monitor seismic and earthquake activities, thereby limiting its ability to provide timely and accurate information to the public.

Recognising the gravity of this situation, the Committee strongly urges the Authority to proactively engage with the sector Minister and the Minister for Finance to address and resolve the challenges hindering the timely release of its allocated MDF share. Furthermore, the Committee calls on the Authority to develop and implement robust strategies aimed at generating internal revenue streams, thereby supplementing government funding to sustainably finance its mandate and enhance its operational effectiveness.

Delayed Compensation Budget Releases for GIADEC and GIISDEC

The Committee expressed concern about the irregular release of compensation budget allocations to the Ghana Integrated Aluminium Development Corporation (GIADEC) and the Ghana Integrated Iron and Steel Development Corporation (GIISDEC). As at the end of October 2025, the Corporations had received only five months of their approved compensation budget, with an additional three months still being processed. Ministry of Finance officials explained that, because the staff of the Corporations had not yet been fully placed on the government's mechanised payroll, each payment required prior validation by the Audit Service before release.

The officials further indicated that consultations were ongoing among the Ministry of Finance, the two Corporations, the Fair Wages and Salaries Commission, and the Controller and Accountant-General's Department to address this challenge and to complete the mechanisation of the Corporations' staff on the payroll system.

Capital Expenditure Requirement of GIADEC and GIISDEC

The Committee expressed concern about the capital expenditure ceilings approved for the operations of GIADEC and GIISDEC. For the 2026 financial year, GIADEC received an approved capital budget ceiling of GH₵ 1.70 million against a stated requirement of GH₵23.846 million, while GIISDEC was allocated GH₵1.80 million out of a required GH₵17.116 million. Given that both Corporations operate in a highly capital-intensive industry, the Committee regards these allocations as severely inadequate and likely to disrupt critical planned activities for 2026, including mineral resource estimation, verification drilling, and the broader national objective of value addition to natural resources and job creation.

In light of this, the Committee urges the Ministry of Finance to grant both Corporations full (100 percent) retention of their internally generated funds and to consider providing additional capital resources during the 2026 Mid-Year Budget Review. The Committee further encourages the Corporations to intensify the execution of their mandates and proactively seek strategic partnerships to develop the sector, with the ultimate aim of reducing their reliance on direct government subventions.

Collection and Disbursement of Mineral Royalties and Related Payments

The Committee noted instances of non-compliance with the legal framework governing the collection and disbursement of mineral royalties to beneficiaries, as set out in Article 267(2) of the 1992 Constitution. The existing arrangement, under which the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA), Minerals Development Fund (MDF) and other Agencies oversee the collection and disbursement of these revenues, not only contravenes the constitutional prescription but also negatively affects the effective coordination and timely disbursement of rents, dues, royalties, revenues and other related payments.

Accordingly, the Committee urges the Hon Minister for Lands and Natural Resources to urgently initiate consultative engagements with MIIF, Office of the Administrator of Stool Lands (OASL), MDF and GRA to agree on clear mechanisms that will ensure the efficient collection and equitable disbursement of mineral royalty revenues in full compliance with the law.

Underfunding of Activities of the Ghana Boundary Commission

The Committee registered its strong concern over the persistent underfunding of the Ghana Boundary Commission's programmes and activities since its establishment. In both 2024 and 2025, the Ministry of Finance failed to release any funds for the Commission's capital projects. As at October 2025, only GH₵650,000.00, representing 43.3 percent of the approved Goods and Services budget of GH₵1,500,000.00, had been released, while only GH₵3,718,962.37, representing 61.4 percent of the approved GH₵6,054,640.17 for compensation of officers, had been disbursed. This chronic underfunding has hampered the Commission's recruitment efforts, payment of office accommodation rent, acquisition of essential equipment and logistics, procurement of orthophotos of Ghana's border corridors, and the construction of boundary pillars.

Accordingly, the Committee urges the Ministry of Finance to enhance both the level and timeliness of budgetary allocations and releases to the Commission, with particular attention to capital expenditure. The Committee further encourages the Ministry of Finance to support the Commission in identifying and developing viable internal revenue-generating mechanisms to supplement government funding and ensure the sustainability of its operations.

Improving Turnaround time for Land service Delivery

The Committee observed that despite sustained investment allocations aimed at enhancing the Lands Commission's service delivery, the turnaround time for key land-related services has shown minimal improvement. For example, the Commission achieved an average turnaround time of 10 days for official searches, falling short of the target of 5 days. Similarly, the preparation of land plans currently takes approximately three weeks. Officials attributed these delays primarily to insufficient investment resources necessary to establish the required infrastructure and systems for efficient service delivery.

Furthermore, the Committee noted that the Commission currently retains only 33 percent of its internally generated funds (IGF), a situation that hampers its capacity to invest meaningfully in infrastructure upgrades and operational reforms. Improving this retention rate could provide the Commission with greater financial autonomy, enabling it to accelerate modernisation efforts and enhance service efficiency.

In light of these findings, the Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance review and increase the retention rate of the Commission's internally generated funds to at least 70 percent. Additionally, the Committee urges the Commission to prioritise investments in technology-driven solutions such as digital land records management and automated processing systems to reduce turnaround times.

Utilisation of 2025 Budgetary Allocations to Minerals Commission

The Committee noted that the Minerals Commission exceeded its approved budget allocations for Goods and Services and Capital Expenditure

(Capex) by GH₵9,567,924.00 and GH₵1,572,276.00, respectively.

Officials of the Commission explained that this overspending resulted from urgent operational support extended to the National Inter-Ministerial Committee on Illegal Mining (NAIMOS), which was established after the approval of the Commission's budget estimates in response to the escalating illegal mining crisis, commonly referred to as galamsey. The effects of galamsey were profound, including severe pollution of water bodies, deprivation of potable water for indigenous communities, and associated public health risks.

In responding to this threat, the Commission expanded its planned deployment under the Blue Water Initiative, exceeding its original target of 1,000 personnel by training and deploying 1,671 personnel to support anti-illegal mining operations. The sector Minister further intimated that the Minister for Finance had assured the Commission that parliamentary authorisation for the excess expenditure would be sought at the Mid-Year Budget Review; however, owing to exigencies at the time, this did not materialise.

While recognising the urgency and national importance of NAIMOS's operations, the Committee strongly admonishes the Commission to ensure that, in all future instances, any expenditure beyond approved budget ceilings is undertaken only after obtaining prior parliamentary approval through the sector Minister, irrespective of the circumstances.

Grant of Commitment Authorisation

The Committee observed that the underperformance of the 2025 capital expenditure (CAPEX) budget for Agencies under the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources adversely impacted the timely execution of planned projects. By October 2025, the Ministry had not received any disbursements from its approved Capex allocation of GH₵62,020,000.00. Officials of the Ministry explained that this situation resulted from delays associated with a newly introduced financial management control requiring Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs) to obtain commitment authorisation from the Ministry of Finance before implementing capital projects.

While appreciating the role of such controls in promoting sound public financial management, the Committee was of the opinion that these measures should not cause delays that undermine efficient implementation of approved budgets. The Committee therefore urges the Ministry of Finance to review the current arrangement to avert undue delays in the utilisation of capital expenditure.

Outstanding Allowances for Forestry Initiative Beneficiaries

The Committee expressed concern over the prolonged delays in the payment of allowances owed to personnel engaged under the Youth in Afforestation and Tree for Life Restoration initiatives. Officials of the Forestry Commission indicated that beneficiaries under the Youth in Afforestation initiative were owed seventeen (17) months of arrears, while those under the Tree for Life Restoration initiative were owed four (4) months of arrears. The delays were attributed to an ongoing audit and validation exercise being conducted by the Ministry of Finance. The Officials, however, disclosed that a substantial portion of the validation had been completed and that some beneficiaries were expected to be paid before the end of the year.

The Committee urges the Ministry of Finance to release funds for the settlement of all validated outstanding arrears and to expedite the completion of the remaining validation exercise in order to alleviate the financial hardship faced by the beneficiaries. To ensure sustainable funding for commendable job-creation initiatives such as these, the Committee also calls for a review of the capping policy on the internally generated funds of the Forestry Commission.

Conclusion and Recommendation

The Committee, having examined and scrutinised the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources in the light of the sector's monumental prospects to support the country's developmental efforts, as well as the myriad of challenges bedevilling the sector. Key challenges include low budgetary allocation, delayed releases of approved budgets, and the galamsey menace. The Committee, however, observed that the 2026 budgetary allocations to the Ministry and its Agencies are inadequate to unlock the sector's prospects and address the challenges therein. Additional funds will be required to address the financial shortfalls, especially the amount of Nineteen Million Ghana Cedis (GH₵19,000,000) required by GGSA to rehabilitate the National Seismic Observatory Centre.

In this regard, the Committee recommends to the House to adopt this Report and approve the sum of Two Billion, One Hundred and Eight Million, Five Hundred and Fifty-Five Thousand and Four Hundred and Ninety Ghana Cedis (GH₵2,108,555,490) for the implementation of the programmes and activities of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the 2026 Financial Year in accordance with Article 179 of the Constitution.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources on the allocation of the sum of GH¢2,108,555,490.00 for the services of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 18, which is the

Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment.

6:57 p.m.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Motion numbered 18. Chairman of the Committee.

MINISTRY OF LABOUR, JOBS AND EMPLOYMENT

Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment (Dr Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

> That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions on the allocation of the sum of GH₵100,103,498.00 for the services of the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment for the year ending 31st December 2026.

[Members of the Minority moved to the middle of the aisle]

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Joseph Appiah Boateng): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion, and in so doing, present your Committee's Report. I urge *Hansard* to capture the entire report as having been read, while I read the conclusion.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 financial year was presented to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with article 179 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana and section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Pursuant to Orders 195(4) and 246 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment to the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations, and Pensions for consideration and report to the House.

Deliberations

The Committee met on Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025, to review the Annual Estimates of the Ministry. In attendance were the Hon Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment, Dr Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo; the Chief Director of the Ministry; the Technical Team; Heads of Agencies under the Ministry; and Officials from the Ministry of Finance.

Mr Austin Gamey, a former Hon Member of Parliament and labour consultant, and representatives from Gamey and Gamey Group also honoured the invitation of the Committee.

The Committee is grateful to the Hon Minister, his team from the Ministry, officials from the Ministry of Finance and representatives from Gamey and Gamey Group for their cooperation and support.

Reference Documents

The Committee made reference to the following documents during its deliberations:

1. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992;
2. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana, 2024;
3. The 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana;
4. The 2026 Programme-Based Budget (PBB) Estimates of the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment;
5. The 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana;
6. The 2025 Programme-Based Budget (PBB) Estimates of the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment;
7. The Report of the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions on the 2025 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment; and
8. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Policy Objectives for the Medium-Term 2026-2029

The policy objectives of the Ministry for the Medium-Term 2026 to 2029 are as follows:

i. Promote decent employment creation and skills development;

ii. Strengthen labour administration and industrial relations;

iii. Enhance national productivity and enterprise competitiveness;

iv. Establish effective occupational safety and health regulatory and administrative systems;

v. Expand social protection to cover vulnerable and informal sector workers;

vi. Develop reliable labour market information and research system;

vii. Strengthen the sustainability and inclusiveness of the pension system for all workers;

viii. Improve the co-operatives regulatory and administrative systems in all sectors;

ix. Ensure fair, equitable and sustainable public sector pay systems;

x. Protection of children against all forms of child labour, forced labour and exploitation; and

xi. Mainstream cross-cutting issues to ensure decent work outcomes (gender, disability, green jobs, digitalisation and climate resilience).

Core Functions of the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment

The Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment, in line with its Sector Medium-Term Goal (2026-2029) to achieve a strong regulatory and administrative system for the promotion of decent work in Ghana, performs the following core functions:

a. Initiate, formulate and coordinate sector policies and programmes as well as schemes to ensure sustainable, accelerated employment-generation and human capital development;

b. Develop strategies and mechanisms to ensure and promote industrial peace and harmony;

c. Develop and periodically review all legal and policy instruments for the Sector;

d. Ensure the development and review of labour market information management systems to facilitate the availability of timely, relevant and accurate national employment and labour statistics;

e. Coordinate all national employment initiatives with the collaboration of relevant stakeholders of the economy;

f. Ensure the monitoring and evaluation of sector policies, programmes and projects in relation to gainful employment-generation and the promotion of industrial harmony;

g. Promote best management practices, systems and procedures in all sectors of the economy to enhance labour productivity;

h. Ensure fair and equitable wages and salaries for employees in all sectors of the economy;

i. Ensure the provision of employable skills and apprenticeships, particularly to the youth, through vocational and technical training at all levels to promote decent and sustainable jobs;

j. Ensure occupational safety and health for all workers in both the formal and informal sectors;

k. Ensure all workplaces conform to labour laws through labour inspections; and

l. Facilitate the development of vibrant cooperatives and small-scale enterprises for employment generation and poverty reduction.

Departments and Agencies Under the Ministry

The Ministry executes its functions through the following Departments and Agencies:

i. The Ministry (Head Office)

ii. Labour Department

iii. Fair Wages and Salaries Commission

iv. Department of Factories Inspectorate

v. Management Development and Productivity Institute

vi. National Labour Commission

vii. Department of Co-operatives

viii. Ghana Co-operative Council

ix. Ghana Co-operative College

Review of 2025 Financial Performance
Total Approved Budget for 2025

In 2025, the Ministry was appropriated a total budget of Four Hundred and Eleven Million, Seven Hundred and Ninety Thousand, Four Hundred and Ninety-five Ghana Cedis (GH₵411,790,495.00), out of which Two Hundred and Thirty-nine Million, Seven Hundred and Seventy-nine Thousand, Five Hundred and Sixty-five Ghana Cedis (GH₵239,779,565.00) was allocated to the National Pensions Regulatory Authority (NPRA). In the course of the year, however, the NPRA was re-aligned to the Ministry of Finance. The implementation report of the budget of the NPRA was, therefore, undertaken through the Ministry of Finance.

The expenditure analysis accordingly covers the remaining One Hundred and Seventy-two Million, Ten Thousand, Nine Hundred and Twenty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵172,010,929) for the Head Office of the Ministry and the other Departments and Agencies from three (3) sources. These sources are the Consolidated Fund (GoG), Internally Generated Fund (IGF) and Development Partners (DPs). Out of the total remaining appropriated amount, seventy-seven million, three hundred and thirty-five thousand, seven hundred and seventeen Ghana Cedis (GH₵77,335,717) was for Compensation of Employees (CoE); ninety-three million, seven hundred and sixty-two thousand, eight hundred and twenty Ghana Cedis (GH₵93,762,820) for Goods and Services (G&S); and Nine Hundred and Twelve Thousand, Three Hundred and Ninety-two Ghana Cedis (GH₵912,392) for Capital Expenditure (CAPEX).

The summary of the 2025 Approved Budget for the Ministry is indicated in Table 1 as follows:

Table 1: Summary of 2025 Approved Budget

ECONOMIC CLASSIFICATION	SOURCE OF FUNDING			TOTAL (GH₵)
	GoG	IGF	DP	
CoE	77,335,717			**77,335,717**
G&S	17,629,751	7,624,169	68,508,900	**93,762,820**
CAPEX		912,392		**912,392**
TOTAL	**94,965,468**	**8,536,561**	**68,508,900**	**172,010,929**

Source: 2026 Budget Hearing Presentation to Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions

Budget Expenditure for 2025

As of October 2025, a total amount of Ninety Million, Three Hundred and Forty-seven Thousand, Seven Hundred and Sixty-one Thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵90,347,761.00) of the appropriated amount of One Hundred and Seventy-two Million, Ten Thousand, Nine Hundred and Twenty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵172,010,929) was released. In terms of economic classification, Sixty-one Million, Four Hundred and Thirty-four Thousand, Eight Hundred and Five Ghana Cedis (GH₵61,434,805.00) out of the Compensation allocation was released and expended. Nineteen Million, eight hundred and seventy-nine thousand, two hundred and sixteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵19,879,216.00) of the Goods and Services allocation was released, and sixteen million, three hundred and twenty thousand, two hundred and sixty-five Ghana Cedis (GH₵16,320,265.00) was expended; while three hundred and forty-nine thousand, one hundred and forty-seven Ghana Cedis (GH₵349,147.00) of the allocation for CAPEX was released and expended.

The expenditure returns of the Ministry for the year 2025 is provided in Table 2.

Table 2: Summary of 2025 Budget Performance

Funding Source & Economic Classification	2025 (APPROPRIATION)	2025 RELEASED BUDGET (Jan - Oct.)	ACTUAL PAYMENT (Jan -Oct 2025)	VARIANCE 1		VARIANCE 2	
	A	B	C	D=A-B	%	E=B-C	%
Com. of Employees	**77,335,717**	**61,434,805**	**61,434,805**	**15,900,912**	**21%**	**0**	**0%**
GoG	77,335,717	61,434,805	61,434,805	15,900,912	21%	0	0%
Goods and Services	**93,762,820**	**19,879,216**	**16,320,265**	**73,883,604**	**79%**	**3,558,951**	**18%**
GoG	17,629,751	12,188,231	9,066,795	5,441,520	31%	3,121,436	26%
IGF	7,624,169	5,449,840	5,012,324	2,174,329	29%	437,515	8%
DP	68,508,900	2,241,145	2,241,145	66,267,755	97%	0	0%
CAPEX	**912,392**	**349,147**	**349,147**	**563,245**	**62%**	**-**	**0%**
GoG							
IGF	912,392	349,147	349,147	563,245	62%	0	0%
Total	**172,010,929**	**81,663,168**	**78,104,217**	**90,347,761**	**53%**	**3,558,951**	**4%**

Source: 2026 Budget Hearing Presentation to Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions

Key Achievements for the 2025 Fiscal Year

In the year 2025, the Ministry recorded the following key achievements under its programmes:

Management and Administration

During the period under review, the Ministry concluded the 2025 National Daily Minimum Wage (NDMW) negotiation and commenced negotiation of the 2026 NDMW; validated the draft revised Labour Bill, 2025; launched and commenced implementation of the Work Abroad Programme with the Youth Employment Authority; and participated in the 113th International Labour Conference and Governing Board Meeting.

The Ministry also reviewed the National Employment Policy (2015) and the National Labour Migration Policy (2020-2024); developed eight (8) bilateral Labour Agreements and Memoranda of Understanding with partner countries; and collaborated with development partners to implement the National Green Jobs Strategy (2021-2025), among others.

Job Creation and Development

The Ministry registered 1,717 cooperative societies; 783 inspections were conducted on cooperative societies; and 13,144 cooperative society farmers were trained.

Skills Development

The Ministry provided training for 825 individuals in management and development, and built the capacities of 106 Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) on the Sustaining Competitive and Responsible Enterprises (SCORE) Project.

Labour Administration

In 2025, the Ministry conducted 1,085 workplace inspections and 16,817 job seekers were placed in job vacancies by Public Employment Centres and Private Employment Agencies. Additionally, 989 workmen compensation claims were registered, and 621 victims received compensation. A total of 3,652 shops, offices and factories were inspected, and 682 establishments were registered. The Ministry also held 616 advocacy sessions on safety, while the 2025 and 2026 base pay negotiations were concluded on 20th February, 2025 and 9th November, 2025, respectively. The Ministry also engaged 72 Trade Unions and Associations to ensure industrial harmony.

Budgetary Outlook for the Year 2026

The Ministry intends to undertake the following projects and programmes within the 2026 fiscal year in furtherance of its objectives:

Engage Social Partners

The Ministry aims to collaborate with social partners to maintain a harmonious labour environment, ensuring that workers' rights are protected and their interests are represented. This partnership would foster a positive and productive workplace culture.

Intensify Labour and Workplace Inspections

The Ministry aims to ensure compliance with labour standards and protect the rights of workers. Accordingly, the Ministry would intensify labour and workplace inspections to help identify and address any violations or gaps in labour practices.

Establish and Operationalise the Independent Emolument Commission

The Ministry seeks to strengthen wage and salary administration through the establishment and operationalisation of the Independent Emolument Commission. The Commission is expected to play a crucial role in promoting fairness and transparency in public sector pay management, which would signify a significant step towards reforming the public sector.

Operationalise the Labour Market Information System

The Ministry also intends to improve its processes for formulating impactful policies and development outcomes through the operationalisation of the Ghana Labour Market Information System. The System is essential for improving and modernising the collection, processing, systematisation and harmonisation of information on labour from internal and external sources.

Complete Nationwide Qualifications and Skills Mismatch Survey

The Ministry plans to complete the Nationwide Qualification and Skills Mismatch Survey to gather comprehensive data on qualifications and skills mismatches in Ghana's labour market to guide policy direction and enhance workforce productivity.

Strengthen Labour Migration Governance

The Ministry seeks to strengthen labour migration governance in order to facilitate safe and regular migration, protect the rights of people seeking job opportunities outside the borders of the country, as well as promote labour mobility to reduce unemployment and improve career prospects.

Revamp the Co-operative Regulatory and Administrative System

The Ministry intends to revamp the Co-operative Regulatory and Administrative System to enhance the environment for co-operative development in the country and boost member participation and productivity.

Strengthen Occupational Safety and Health Administration

As part of efforts to prevent work-related injuries, illnesses and deaths, the Ministry would strengthen the enforcement of workplace safety and health standards by providing training and education, and promoting cooperation between employers and employees to improve workplace safety and health.

Expand Employment Creation Opportunities

The Ministry seeks to expand employment creation opportunities, thereby promoting economic growth and development. This would involve implementing policies and programmes to support entrepreneurship, innovation, and job creation.

Provide Managerial and Productivity Enhancement Skills

The Ministry would also focus on skills training for managerial and productivity enhancement in order to equip the workforce with relevant skills, ensure efficient resource utilisation and facilitate the attainment of organisational objectives.

Budgetary Allocation for the Year 2026

Variation in Figures for the Total Budgetary Allocation for 2026

The presentation by the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment indicates that the Ministry, its Departments and Agencies have been allocated a total amount of One Hundred and Forty-two Million, Three Hundred and Seven thousand and Sixty-three Ghana Cedis (GH₵142,307,063) to implement its programmes and activities for the year 2026.

The amount varies from the total budgetary allocation to the Ministry, as provided in the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, which is in the sum of one hundred million, one hundred and three thousand, four hundred and ninety-eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵100,103,498).

The Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment referred, however, to a correspondence from the Ministry of Finance in respect of correction of a transposition error, thereby revising the expenditure ceilings for the Compensation of Employees from Forty Million, One Hundred and Twenty-one Thousand, Eight Hundred and Forty-three Ghana Cedis (GH₵40,121,843) to Eighty-two Million, Three Hundred and Twenty-five Thousand, Four Hundred and Eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵82,325,408).

Accordingly, a breakdown of the revised 2026 allocation to the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment in terms of cost centres and funding sources is provided in Table 3 as follows:

Table 3: 2026 Budgetary Allocations

ECONOMIC CLASSIFICATION	SOURCE OF FUNDING			TOTAL (GH₵)
	GoG	IGF	DP	
Compensation	82,325,408	-	-	**82,325,408**
Goods & Services	35,629,751	8,283,250	-	**43,913,001**
CAPEX	15,000,000	1,068,654	-	**16,068,654**
TOTAL	**132,955,159**	**9,351,904**	-	**142,307,063**

Source: 2026 Budget Hearing Presentation to Committee on Employment

Table 4: Allocation of 2026 Ceiling by Programme

	Budget Prog.	GoG (GH₵)				IGF (GH₵)				DP			TOTAL
		COE	G&S	CAPEX	TOTAL	COE	G&S	CAPEX	TOTAL	G&S	CAPEX	TOTAL	(GH₵)
.1	**Mgt & Adm.**	13,701,423	18,017,944	3,000,000	***34,719,367***								**34,719,367**
.2	**Job Crt & Dev**	19,888,719	4,496,429	1,000,000	***25,385,148***		502,350		***502,350***			***0***	**25,887,498**
.3	**Skills Dev't**	4,201,379	437,383	8,000,000	***12,638,762***		4,690,385	827,715	***5,518,100***			***0***	**18,156,862**
.4	**Lab Admin.**	44,533,887	12,677,995	3,000,000	***60,211,882***		3,090,515	240,939	***3,331,454***			***0***	**63,543,336**
GRAND TOTAL		**82,325,408**	**35,629,751**	**15,000,000**	***132,955,159***		**8,283,250**	**1,068,654**	***9,351,904***				**142,307,063**

Source: 2026 Budget Hearing Presentation to Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions

Observations and Recommendations

Capacity of the 24-Hour Economy Policy to Generate Employment

Mr Austin Gamey of Gamey and Gamey Group emphasised that through the exercise of appreciative leadership, the 24-Hour Economy Policy could be implemented as a transformative tool that is capable of generating massive employment opportunities for Ghanaians. Mr Gamey highlighted employment opportunities in the tourism, hospitality, agriculture and freight sectors of the country, which could increase job creation prospects under the 24-Hour Economy Policy. He advised the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment to fully operationalise the Ghana Labour Market Information System as required under section 6 of the Labour Act, 2003 (Act 651) to facilitate the attainment of accurate labour statistics that would inform policy decisions to improve productivity, enhance accountability and promote fair and equitable working conditions.

The Committee commended the depth of the presentation and recognised the need to harness national efforts towards creating an enabling environment for the creation of more job opportunities, particularly for the teeming youth.

Operationalisation of Ghana Labour Market Information System (GLMIS)

The Committee raised concerns in respect of the status of releases and utilisation of donor funds for completion of the Ghana Labour Market Information System, which is funded by the World Bank. The Committee noted that out of the 2025 appropriation of Sixty-eight Million, Five Hundred and Eight Thousand, Nine Hundred Ghana Cedis (GH₵68,508,900) of earmarked funds from donor partners for the GLMIS, only Two Million, Two Hundred and Forty-one Thousand, One Hundred and Forty-five Ghana Cedis (GH₵2,241,145) had been released for the project. The Ministry indicated that although regional offices for implementation of the project have been constructed and some equipment has been procured for operationalisation of the GLMIS, a significant number of logistics were outstanding and were required for full implementation of the

System. The Ministry indicated further that it was indebted to suppliers under the project to the tune of over GH₵16 million, and therefore required funds to settle its debts and fully operationalise the GLMIS.

Noting the critical gap created by the lack of a comprehensive workforce data management system in the Ministry's operations, the Committee strongly recommends the provision of adequate resources for the operationalisation of GLMIS. The system should be fully deployed to collect and analyse labour market data regularly, providing insights into employment trends, skills shortages, and workforce distribution. By establishing a robust data infrastructure, the Ministry will be better equipped to develop evidence-based policies that align with Ghana's evolving labour market needs.

Underfunding of Key Agencies of the Ministry

The Committee observed, with grave concern, the underfunding of key Agencies under the Ministry. The budgetary allocations to the Labour Department, Fair Wages and Salaries Commission, Department of Factories Inspectorate and the Cooperatives Department are far below their operational requirements. Apart from allotments to the Headquarters of the

Ministry for management and administration, the cumulative allocations for Goods and Services as well as Capital Expenditure to the respective Departments and Agencies under the Ministry amount to Seventeen Million, Six Hundred and Eleven Thousand, Eight Hundred and Six Ghana Cedis (GH₵17,611,806) and Twelve Million Ghana Cedis (GH₵12,000,000) respectively. The Committee noted that labour sector underfunding results in inadequate inspections and enforcement, thereby undermining national economic stability, stifling productivity, and weakening the ability of relevant institutions to ensure compliance with applicable policies and enactments.

The Committee, therefore, intends to convene a meeting with key representatives from the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment, as well as the Ministry of Finance, to consider an upward adjustment of the budget ceilings for relevant Agencies during the Mid-Year Review of the National Budget Statement and Economic Policy. This meeting is critical in light of the national security implications of inadequate resourcing of critical Departments and Agencies, which may impede service delivery in the labour sector.

Inadequate Staffing of the Ministry

The Ministry bemoaned the inadequacy of staffing, particularly at the district levels where some offices are manned by only one (1) officer. This situation impedes effective service delivery and adversely affects productivity. Having regard to the funds appropriated for the compensation of employees for the 2026 fiscal year, the Ministry is unable to undertake a major recruitment exercise to augment its personnel strength.

Accordingly, the Committee advocates strongly for improvement in allocations to the Ministry to facilitate recruitment of critical staff in furtherance of retooling relevant Agencies for effective service delivery. This recommendation is in view of the critical role the Ministry plays in ensuring industrial harmony and compliance with employment policies and applicable statutes.

Recruitment of Skilled Labour for the Department of Factories Inspectorate

The Committee, based on observations during its monitoring visit to the Department of Factories Inspectorate, admonished the Ministry to ensure the recruitment of qualified personnel to discharge duties and responsibilities in line with the mandate of the Department. The Ministry was advised to liaise with the Office of the Head of Civil Service for the appointment of personnel with requisite qualifications to conduct periodic technical safety, health and welfare inspections in order to ascertain compliance with regulatory standards in workplaces nationwide.

The Committee, therefore, supports the plans of the Ministry to complete the Nationwide Qualification and Skills Mismatch Survey to gather comprehensive data on qualifications and skills mismatches in Ghana's labour market to guide policy direction and enhance workforce productivity.

National Pensions Regulatory Authority

Notwithstanding the realignment of the National Pensions Regulatory Authority (NPRA) under the Ministry of Finance, the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions considered the 2025 performance and 2026 estimates of the NPRA.

The Committee took particular notice of the impact of the retention of nine per cent of the annual internally generated funds of the Authority. The only source of funding for the NPRA for the 2026 fiscal year is the projected internally generated fund amount of Two Hundred and Ninety-nine Million, Eight Hundred and Ninety-two Thousand, Four Hundred and Ninety-seven Ghana Cedis (GH₵299,892,497), which would accrue from fees and charges on pension assets under management as well as the cost of renewals and penalties for infringement of relevant laws. Accordingly, capping nine per cent of the internally generated funds of the Authority would reduce its operational capacity for effective education and awareness creation on pensions and statutory contributions.

The NPRA seeks approval for 100 per cent retention of its internally general funds to support the expansion of operations to all regional capitals and selected districts across Ghana. This initiative is in line with section 14 of the National Pensions Act, 2008 (Act 766), which empowers the Board to establish regional and district offices as deemed necessary.

Full retention of internally generated funds will enable the Authority to establish and operationalise additional offices to increase pension penetration, particularly within the informal sector where the majority of Ghanaians are engaged, as well as improve the monitoring and enforcement of mandatory pension contributions nationwide. The Authority would also effectively and promptly facilitate the resolution of all pension-related complaints to enhance public trust and promote regulatory efficiency.

The Committee, therefore, entreats the Ministry of Finance to uncap the internally generated funds of the NPRA in order that the Authority could retain 100 per cent of the funds, which is essential to expanding the Authority's footprint, improving regulatory compliance and ensuring greater pension security for all workers.

Conclusion

The Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment is instrumental in shaping the nation's labour landscape by formulating and implementing polices that promote job creation, safeguard workers' rights, and ensure a conducive and harmonious working environment. The effective execution of its mandate is, however, dependent on the availability of adequate financial resources to support its programmes and activities. The current budgetary ceilings for the Ministry and its Agencies do not support the full implementation of policies that would ensure the effective discharge of approved mandates. The Committee is optimistic that an upward adjustment of allocations to the Ministry during the Mid-Year Review of the National Budget would adequately resource the various Agencies for effective service delivery.

The Committee accordingly recommends that the House adopt its Report and approve the total sum of One Hundred and Forty-two Million, Three Hundred and Seven Thousand, and Sixty-three Ghana Cedis (GH₵142,307,063) for the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment for the discharge of its mandate.

Respectfully submitted.

The Speaker: Hon Members, please resume your seats.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions on the allocation of the sum of GH₵100,103,498.00 for the services of the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the Motion numbered 19, which will be moved by the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment.

NATIONAL LABOUR COMMISSION

Dr Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo: Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions on the allocation of the sum of GH₵26,648,670.00 for the services of the National Labour Commission for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Ashai Odamtten): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion—

The Speaker: Hon Members, I heard the Motion being moved. I do not know who seconded the Motion; you have not disclosed your identity.

7:07 p.m.

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Isaac Ashai Odamtten): Mr Speaker, I am the Vice Chairperson of the Committee. I second the Motion and present your Committee’s Report. I ask the *Hansard* to capture it as having been read in its entirety.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 financial year was presented to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with article 179 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana and section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Pursuant to Orders 195(4) and 246 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the National Labour Commission to the Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions for consideration and report to the House.

Deliberations

The Committee met on Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025 to review the Annual Estimates of the Commission. In attendance were:

i. The Hon Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment, Dr Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo

ii. The Chief Director of the Ministry

iii. The Ag. Executive Secretary of the National Labour Commission

iv. The Technical Team

v. Officials from the Ministry of Finance

The Committee is grateful to the Hon Minister, his team from the Ministry, the Ag. Executive Secretary and staff of the National Labour Commission, and officials from the Ministry of Finance for their cooperation and support.

Reference Documents

The Committee made reference to the following documents during its deliberations:

9. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992;

10. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana, 2024;

11. The 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana;

12. The 2026 Programme-Based Budget (PBB) Estimates of the National Labour Commission;

13. The 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana;

14. The 2025 Programme-Based Budget (PBB) Estimates of the National Labour Commission;

15. The Appropriation Acts of 2024 and 2025; and

16. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Policy Objective for the Medium-Term 2026-2029, Goal, and Core Values of the Commission

The policy objective of the National Labour Commission is to develop effective mechanisms for managing and handling workplace differences for timely resolution of labour disputes.

The overarching goal of the Commission is to promote the establishment of judicious enterprise-based dispute settlement mechanisms that effectively address internal grievances and facilitate external dispute resolution to bring timely closure to industrial disputes, in order to create and maintain a peaceful industrial relational ambiance for enhanced productivity, job creation and economic growth.

The vision of the Commission is to have a harmonious industrial relations environment borne out of the firm understanding and committed compliance with the Labour Laws by all stakeholders to make the Ghanaian economy competitive to attract investment. The Commission's mission is to develop and sustain a peaceful and harmonious industrial relations environment through the use of effective dispute resolution practices within the context of the law, promotion of cooperation among the labour market players and mutual respect for their rights and responsibilities.

Core Functions of the National Labour Commission

The National Labour Commission, in line with its mandate and Medium-Term Goal, performs the following core functions:

m. Facilitate the settlement of industrial disputes;

n. Settle industrial disputes;

o. Investigate labour related complaints, particularly unfair labour practices, and take such steps as it considers necessary to prevent labour disputes;

p. Maintain a database of qualified persons to serve as mediators and arbitrators; and

q. Promote effective labour cooperation between labour and management.

Review of 2025 Financial Performance

Total Approved Budget, Releases and Expenditure for 2025

In the year 2025, the National Labour Commission was allocated a total budget of Sixteen Million, Six Hundred and Forty-eight Thousand, Four Hundred and Sixty Ghana Cedis (GH₵16,648,460.00). As of September, 2025, a total of six million, four hundred and seventy-eight thousand, three hundred and thirty-one Ghana Cedis and Twenty-four Pesewas (GH₵6,478,331.24) was released and expended, leaving a budget variance of ten Million, one hundred and seventy thousand, one hundred and twenty-six Ghana Cedis and Seventy-six Pesewas (GH₵10,170,126.76).

The breakdown of the allocation, releases and expenditure for the year 2025 in terms of cost centres is provided in Table 1.

Table 1: 2025 Budgetary Allocations, Releases and Expenditure by Cost Centres

ITEM	APPROVED BUDGET (GH₵)	RELEASES (GH₵)	ACTUAL EXPENDITURE (GH₵)	% RELEASED	VARIANCE (GH₵)
Compensation	11,271,732.00	4,853,467.49	4,853,467.49	43.06	6,418,265.51
Goods & Services	2,749,728.00	1,624,863.75	1,624,863.75	59.09	1,124,864.25
Capex	2,627,000.00	-	-	0.00	2,627,000.00
Total	**16,648,460.00**	**6,478,331.24**	**6,478,331.24**	**38.91**	**10,170,126.76**

Source: 2026 Programme Based Budget of the National Labour Commission

The total expenditure for Compensation of Employees for the period under reporting is Four Million, Eight Hundred and Fifty-three Thousand, Four Hundred and Sixty-seven Ghana Cedis and Forty-nine Pesewas (GH₵4,853,467.49), out of the Eleven Million, Two Hundred and Seventy-one Thousand, Seven Hundred and Thirty-two Ghana Cedis (GH₵11,271,732.00) approved for the fiscal year. The variance relates to third and fourth quarter non-salary allowances, funds covering late swearing in of members of the Commission, recruitments, replacements, promotions and funeral grants.

For the period under consideration, One Million, Six Hundred and Twenty-four Thousand, Eight Hundred and Sixty-three Ghana Cedis and Seventy-five Pesewas (GH₵1,624,863.75) was released for Goods and Services, while there were no actual releases for Capital Expenditure. The Commission has, however, indicated that expenditure authorisation has been obtained for the purchase of some motor vehicles and bikes.

Key Achievements for the 2025 Fiscal Year

In the year 2025, the Commission recorded the following key achievements under its programmes:

Complaints Management

In pursuance of its mandate, the Commission handled a total of five hundred and fifteen (515) complaints filed by individual workers, workers' groups, workers' associations, trade unions and employers from both public and private sectors of the country. The total number of complaints comprise three hundred and Thirty-eight (338) cases for the current year and one hundred and seventy-seven (177) rolled over cases from previous years. A total of three hundred and nineteen (319) cases were resolved by the end of

October, 2025, representing an approximate 62 per cent rate of complaints settlement.

Industrial Disputes

During the reporting period, majority of industrial disputes, notices of strikes, strikes and work stoppages were recorded from both teaching and non-teaching (administrative) personnel of the tertiary education sector. The issues bordered mainly on terms and conditions of employment. The Commission rendered fifty-seven (57) decisions, directives, orders and rulings for compliance in order to rectify anomalies by defaulting parties.

Facilitation Sessions

The Commission recorded two hundred and eighty-eight (288) facilitation sessions for the settlement of industrial disputes. The Commission conducted seventy-four (74) hearing sessions to adjudicate labour and industrial disputes. As indicated above, majority of industrial disputes, notices of strikes, strikes and work stoppages for the year 2025 were recorded from the tertiary education sector.

Budgetary Outlook for The Year 2026

The Commission intends to undertake the following projects and programmes within the year under review in furtherance of its objectives:

Media Relations, Information, Education and Communication

The National Labour Commission plans to strengthen its media relations and education drive through briefing sessions, seminars and partnerships to disseminate information on the rights and responsibilities of actors within the legal framework to foster a harmonious labour environment.

Personnel and Staff Management

The Commission also aims to improve the management and retention of staff through the alignment of human resource policies to organisational outcomes, as well as institutionalising structures for career development.

Manpower Skills Development

In 2026, the Commission intends to organise periodic capacity building programmes to develop the skills of its employees, and introduce new resources and systems to equip staff for the effective and efficient discharge of responsibilities.

Software Acquisition and Development

In line with emerging trends and the introduction of modern information communication technology tools, the Commission seeks to digitalise a number of its processes and systems to improve accessibility to its services.

Prosecution, Enforcement and Compliance with Labour Laws

The Commission would prioritise the enforcement of relevant laws, and ensure compliance with applicable policies and statutes.

The Commission would continue to prosecute industry players who breach the provisions of labour laws to ensure that rights are respected and responsibilities are discharged.

Industrial Dispute Resolution and Education

As part of efforts to safeguard the security of the labour sector and ensure industrial harmony, the Commission would continue to settle disputes and educate the public on sound labour practices and alternative dispute resolution mechanisms.

Maintenance, Rehabilitation, Refurbishment and Upgrade of Existing Assets

The Commission would commit a portion of its allocation for the 2026 fiscal year to the maintenance and rehabilitation of its existing assets in order to improve operational efficiency and enhance overall performance.

Budgetary Allocation for the Year 2026

The National Labour Commission is allocated a total amount of Twenty-six Million, Six Hundred and Forty-eight Thousand, Six Hundred and Seventy Ghana Cedis (GH₵26,648,670.00) to implement its programmes and activities for the year 2026. The Government of Ghana is the sole funding source for the Commission.

The breakdown of the allocation in terms of cost centres and funding source is provided in Table 2 as follows:

Table 2: 2026 Budgetary Allocations and Funding Sources

Economic Classification	Sources of Funding				
	GOG (GH¢)	IGF (GH¢)	Donor (GH¢)	Total (GH¢)	%
Compensation	11,271,942.00	-	-	11,271,942.00	42.30
Goods and services	12,749,728.00	-	-	12,749,728.00	47.84
Capex	2,627,000.00	-	-	2,627,000.00	9.86
Total	26,648,670.00			26,648,670.00	100.00
%	100	0	0		

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana

Comparison of Budgetary Allocation by Cost Centres (2024-2026)

The budgetary allocation for the Commission for the 2026 fiscal year has significantly increased by 60.07 per cent as compared to the 2025 allocation. The allocation for compensation of employees has increased marginally from eleven million, two hundred and seventy-one thousand, seven hundred and thirty-two Ghana Cedis (GH₵11,271,732) in 2025 to Eleven Million, Two Hundred and Seventy-one Thousand, Nine Hundred and Forty-two Ghana Cedis (GH₵11,271,942) in 2026.

The Goods and Services allocation for the year 2026, on the other hand, has significantly increased by 363.67 per cent from Two Million, Seven Hundred and forty-nine thousand, seven hundred and twenty-eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵2,749,728) in 2025 to Twelve Million, Seven Hundred and Forty-nine Thousand, Seven Hundred and Twenty-eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵12,749,728) in 2026.

The allocation for Capital Expenditure, however, dropped from Two Million, Nine Hundred and Thirty-two Thousand, Eight Hundred and Eighty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵2,932,889) in 2024 to two million, six hundred and twenty-seven thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵2,627,000) in 2025, representing a -10.43 per cent change. The amount for Capital Expenditure for 2025 remains the same for the 2026 fiscal year.

The breakdown of allocations for the Commission by economic classification from 2024 to 2026 is shown in Table 3 below:

Table 3: Economic Classification from 2024 to 2026

Item	**2024**	**2025**		**2026**	
	Amount (GH¢)	Amount (GH¢)	% Change	Amount (GH¢)	% Change
Compensation	9,100,960	11,271,732	23.85	11,271,942	0.00
Goods & Services	8,987,819	2,749,728	-69.41	12,749,728	363.67
Capex	2,932,889	2,627,000	-10.43	2,627,000	0.00
Total	**21,021,668**	**16,648,460**	**-20.80**	**26,648,670**	**60.07**

Source: Appropriation Act, 2024 & 2025, and 2026 Budget Statement & Economic Policy

Budgetary Allocation by Programmes (2025 and 2026)

In 2026, 47.83 per cent of the budget of the National Labour Commission is allocated for Management and Administration, while 52.17 per cent is allotted for Labour Dispute Resolution.

Table 4 below indicates the breakdown of allocations for the Commission by Programmes.

Table 4: Budget Allocations by Programmes

Programme	**2025**		**2026**	
	Budgeted Amount (GH₵)	**%**	**Budgeted Amount (GH₵)**	**%**
Management and Administration	8,199,086	49.25	12,745,248	47.83
Labour Dispute Resolution	8,449,374	50.75	13,903,422	52.17
Total	**16,648,460**	**100**	**26,648,670**	**100**

Source: 2025 & 2026 Programme Based Budget of the National Labour Commission

Observations and Recommendations

Inadequate Financial Resources for the National Labour Commission

The Committee acknowledged the critical role of the National Labour Commission in maintaining industrial harmony, noting that labour unrest poses a serious threat to national security. The Committee observed that although the 2026 budget allocation for the Commission has increased by 60.07 per cent as compared to its 2025 appropriation, the amount was insufficient and could hinder the ability of the Commission to function optimally. The Commission indicated its inability to organise capacity-building programmes for its mediators and arbitrators as well as honour its obligations to facility managers for the year 2026 due to inadequate financial resources. Awareness creation and sensitisation efforts on industrial relations and fair work practices would also be impeded given the limited resources of the Commission.

The Committee, therefore, entreats the Ministry of Finance to increase the Commission’s resource allocation during the 2026 Mid-Year Budget Review, to ensure that the Commission has adequate funding to fulfil its mandate effectively.

High Staff Attrition

The Committee noted that high employee attrition has resulted in inadequate staffing of the Commission, and this situation negatively impacts the Commission’s ability to effectively mediate labour disputes and enforce compliance with labour laws. The Committee was informed that the Commission’s inability to retain a significant number of its employees was as a result of the unattractive working conditions and remuneration of its officers, which is comparatively inadequate within the dispute resolution space.

To address the challenge, the Committee recommends the harmonisation of salary scales of employees of the Commission with specialised skills and professional qualifications, with that of officers who perform cognate roles in other public service institutions. The recommendation is in view of the fact that the National Labour Commission, in the performance of its adjudicatory role, is deemed to be clothed with the powers of a High Court. Accordingly, the salaries of qualified officers of the Commission may be reviewed to reflect the nature of the duties they perform.

Legislative Reform

The Committee, recognising the need for a review of the Labour Act, 2003 (Act 651) to reflect emerging trends in industrial relations and the world of work, is advocating for the finalisation of processes to facilitate the presentation of the reviewed law to Parliament for consideration and enactment. The legislative reform would address new working arrangements, promote fair labour practices and strengthen the protection of workers' rights. Following the final validation of the draft Bill, the Attorney-General's Department is requested to expedite action on the relevant processes to ensure the presentation of the Bill to the House during the First Meeting of the Second Session of the Ninth Parliament.

Presence of the National Labour Commission in Regions of the Country

The National Labour Commission entreated the Committee to support advocacy for the expansion of the Commission in the sixteen (16) regions of the country. Currently, the Commission has four (4) regional offices, with two (2) of them operating below capacity due to inadequate staffing and resources. The situation adversely affects accessibility of the Ghanaian populace to the services offered by the Commission. The Committee, therefore, requests that resources for expansion of the number of regional offices of the Commission be factored into the Mid-Year Review of the National Budget to facilitate timely dispute resolution, equity in service delivery as well as strengthen decentralisation efforts, particularly in the wake of rising challenges on the labour front.

Conclusion

The National Labour Commission is pivotal in the settlement of labour disputes in Ghana, given its statutory mandate of ensuring compliance with labour laws and standards, facilitating the settlement of industrial disputes and investigating complaints relating to unfair labour practices in order to promote harmony in the world of work.

Having carefully examined the Commission's budgetary needs for the 2026 financial year, the Committee recommends that the House adopts its

Report and approves the total sum of Twenty-six Million, Six Hundred and Forty-eight Thousand, Six Hundred and Seventy Ghana Cedis (GH₵26,648,670) for the National Labour Commission to enable them carry out their operations successfully.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker you may put the Question.

Question put and Motion agreed to

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Employment, Labour Relation and Pensions on the allocation of the sum of GH₵26,648,670.00 for the services of the National Labour Commission for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Majority Leader: Mr Speaker, we can take Motion numbered 30.

MINISTRY OF DEFENCE

Deputy Minister for the Interior (Mr Ebenezer Okletey Terlabi): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Defence and Interior on the allocation of the sum of GH₵10,772,441,661.00 for the services of the Ministry of Defence for the year ending 31st December 2026.

[Uproar!]

Mr Peter Lanchene Toobu: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion, and in doing so, I present your Committee's Report. I want the *Hansard* to capture it as having been read.

Introduction

The Hon Minister responsible for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, presented the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2026 Financial Year to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2026 in accordance with articles 179 and of the 1992 Constitution, and Sections 21 and 23 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Following the presentation, the 2026 Annual Estimates of the Ministry of Defence (MoD) was referred to the Parliamentary Select Committee on Defence and Interior for consideration and report to the House in accordance with Orders 195(4) and 247(2) of the Standing Orders House

Deliberations

The Committee met with the Acting Minister for Defence, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, the Hon Deputy Minister responsible for Defence, Hon Ernest Brogya Genfi, the Chief of Defence Staff, Lt Gen William Agyapong, the Chief Director of the Ministry of

Defence, officials of the Ministries of Defence and Finance and the Military High Command to consider the Estimates and hereby presents this report in accordance with Order 215 of the Standing Orders of the House.

The Committee expresses its sincere gratitude to the Acting Minister and the Deputy Minister, Service chiefs and officials for their valuable assistance.

Reference Documents

The Committee was guided by the following documents during the consideration of the 2026 Estimates of the Ministry of Defence:

a. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

b. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;

c. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);

d. Armed Forces Act, 1962 (Act 105)

e. Medium Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2026 – 2028

f. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 financial year;

g. The Report of the Committee on Defence and Interior on the Annual Estimates of the Ministry of Defence for the 2025 financial year; and

h. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 financial year.

Background of the Ministry of Defence

The Ministry of Defence (MoD) is a key security service delivery institution of the Government of the Republic of Ghana under the Office of the Head of Civil Service (OHCS). The Ministry is tasked with the responsibility of formulating and managing the implementation of policies that directly impact the defence and security operations of the country.

Primarily, the Ministry of Defence has the mandate to safeguard the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Ghana. In executing this mandate, the Ministry ensures that national defence mechanisms are effectively structured to protect the nation from both internal and external threats that may undermine the stability and security of the State.

Additionally, the Ministry is committed to ensuring the protection of life, property and rights of all nationals, especially the vulnerable, within a democratic environment.

Goal

The goal of the Ministry of Defence is to safeguard Ghana's territorial integrity, maintain internal security as well as enhance institutional capacity for sustainable defence, veterans' welfare, and national development.

Core Functions of the Ministry

The Core Functions of the Ministry are as follows:

a. Formulate and implement policies to protect the state against external aggression and total defence of the Nation in collaboration with the National Security Council and the Armed Forces Council.

b. Ensure the state of combat readiness of the Ghana Armed Forces for rapid response to any security threat.

c. Improve the logistical and infrastructural needs of the Ghana Armed Forces.

d. Facilitate the Capacity building of the Ministry and the Ghana Armed Forces.

e. Formulate, implement, monitor and evaluate policies in relation to the operations of MoD and GAF especially in areas of remuneration, provision of logistics and resources to enable them function efficiently.

f. Facilitate the provision of social infrastructure such as roads/bridges, health and educational facilities.

g. Formulate and implement policies for international peace support operations in collaboration with the National Security Council and the Armed Forces Council.

h. Support Ghana's foreign policy on international peace and security.

Policy Objectives

There are fifteen (15) Policy Objectives in the 2026-2028 Medium-Term National Development Policy Framework (MTNDPF) that are relevant to the Ministry, and these are as follows:

a. Ensure improved fiscal performance and sustainability.

b. Enhance public safety and security.

c. Strengthen the effectiveness, accountability, and efficiency of public institutions.

d. Deepen transparency and public accountability.

e. Enhance the wellbeing and inclusion of the aged in national development.

f. Improve human capital development and management.

g. Promote job creation and decent work.

h. promote efficient and effective land administration.

i. Expand the digital technology landscape.

j. Enhance the application of ICT in national development.

k. Mainstream science, technology, research, and innovation in all socio-economic activities.

l. Promote Ghana's economic interests.

m. Enhance Ghana's international image and influence.

Implementing Agencies

The Ministry of Defence operates to achieve its mandate through the following agencies:

a. Ministry of Defence Headquarters;

b. General Headquarters of the Ghana Armed Forces;

c. Ghana Army;

d. Ghana Navy;

e. Ghana Air Force;

f. Ghana Armed Forces Command and Staff College;

g. Military Academy & Training School;

h. Kofi Annan International Peacekeeping Training Centre;

i. Veterans Association of Ghana;

j. 37 Military Hospital; and

k. Defence Advisors.

2025 Performance Review

The Ministry of Defence, in the year under review, undertook the following activities in pursuit of its mandate under Article 210 of the Constitution and the Armed Forces Act, 1962 (Act 105).

Internal Security Operations

1. The Ghana Armed Forces (GAF) continues to support internal security efforts in collaboration with sister security agencies through the following operations:

Joint Operations - Under operations such as CALM LIFE, HALT II, MAIDA BUURI, COWLEG, and GONGGONG, the GAF has played a pivotal role in maintaining law and order, combating illegal activities, and preventing environmental degradation.

2. The GAF through "Operation HALT II - Combating Illegal Mining (*Galamsey*)" intensified its anti-*galamsey* operations during the year, focused on protecting key forest reserves and water bodies across four regions. They are the Ashanti Region; (Jimira and Offin Shelter) Western & Western North: (Subri River banks, Cape Three Points, and Abrewa Nni Nkran Forest Reserves) Northern Region: (Bole, Banda Nkwanta, Bamboi, Bui, Wakawaka, and Black Volta Basin). This operation successfully reclaimed all targeted forest reserves which had previously been under the control of armed illegal miners. The forest reserves

have since been restored to the Forest Commission (FC).

Bawku Conflict - Through operation MAIDA BUURI: The Ghana Armed Forces escalated its operation in Bawku from peace support to peace enforcement in response to the persistent security challenges in the area. GAF continues to maintain a strong presence in Bawku, where tensions remain high due to recurring violent clashes and targeted attacks.

International Peace Support Operations

In 2025, Ghana sustained its commitment to global peacekeeping efforts under the auspices of the United Nations and other international bodies. During the period, the Ghana Armed Forces deployed 2,199 troops with equipment to various peacekeeping missions globally. These deployments bolster Ghana's diplomatic presence and reaffirm its status as a credible contributor to international peace and security.

Defence Infrastructure Development

The Ministry continued work on the Forward Operating Base (FOB) at Ezinlibo, located near Ghana's western maritime border. The base is strategically situated to enhance maritime surveillance and protect vital offshore oil and gas infrastructure.

As at the end of September 2025, the project had achieved a completion rate of 83 per cent. When completed, it will significantly improve the Ghana Armed Forces' capacity to respond to maritime threats and secure Ghana's Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).

To counter the increasing threats of terrorism and transnational crime along Ghana's northern borders, the Ministry continued the implementation of the Northern Border Security Project, which commenced in 2021. The project involves Construction of 12 Forward Operating Bases (FOBs), 2 Forward Logistics Bases (FLBs) in Wa and Bolgatanga, 1 Main Logistics Base (MLB) and a Central Command Centre in Tamale.

The project has achieved overall completion rate of 64.9 per cent as at September, 2025 serving as a strategic buffer against external threats and enhancing troop deployment in vulnerable areas.

Military Health System Strengthening

Installation of Oxygen Plant at 37 Military Hospital: In 2025, the Ministry installed a new oxygen generation system at the 37 Military Hospital to replace aging infrastructure. This intervention ensures uninterrupted oxygen supply for critical care services.

To further improve health service delivery, a new containerised laboratory equipped with modern diagnostic tools was established at Duala Barracks. This upgrade has decongested the 37 Military Hospital and improved access to diagnostic services for troops.

Enlistment, Training, and Capacity Building

In April 2025, 163 Officer Cadets from Regular Career Course Intake were commissioned into the Army, Navy, and Air Force. 384 Officer Cadets are currently under training at the Ghana Military Academy and will pass out in 2026. The Ghana Armed Forces Command and Staff College (GAFSC) successfully graduated 76 junior officers from its Junior Staff Course and 97 officers from the Senior Staff Course, including participants from allied countries.

Financial Performance for 2025

The Ministry of Defence was allocated an amount of Six Billion, Three Hundred and seventy-one million, four hundred and sixty-seven thousand, five hundred and ninety-eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵6,371,467,598.00) for its planned programmes and activities for the 2025 financial year. Out of this, GH₵6,330,917,035.00 representing 99.36 per cent of the total appropriation was from the Government of Ghana and GH₵40,550,563.00 representing 0.64 per cent of the total appropriation was from Internally Generated Funds. The allocation was distributed among the various cost centers as follow:

Compensation of Employees	—	GH₵5,691,168,726
Goods and Services	—	GH₵420,298,872
CAPEX	—	GH₵260,000,000
Total	—	GH₵6,371,467,598

During the year, an additional amount of GH₵205,779,868.19 was released from GoG to the Ministry for the maintenance of critical equipment and payment for some arrears bringing the total appropriations to GH₵6,577,247,466.99 representing 3.23 per cent increase. Out of this amount, Compensation of Employees is GH₵5,691,168,726.00 representing 86.5 per cent, Goods and Services is GH₵626,078,740.19 representing 13.5 per cent and Capital Expenditure is GH₵260,000,000.00.

As at October 2025 a total amount of GH₵5,889,225,306 was released to the Ministry for its operations. The 2025 releases are from two main sources namely:

Government of Ghana (GoG)	—	GH₵5,851,401,827.69
Internally Generated Funds (IGF)	—	GH₵37,823,478.31
Total	—	GH₵5,889,225,306

Out of the released an amount of GH₵5,697,285,670 representing 96.70 per cent was expended leaving an amount of GH₵191,939,636 or 3.3 per cent unexpended. The detailed breakdown of the total release and expenditure for the Ministry as at 31st October, 2025 is presented in table 1.

Table 1: 2025 Budget Performance as at October for the Ministry of Defence

Expenditure Item	Approved Budget (GH₵) (A)	Releases (GH₵) (B)	Actual Expenditure 2025 (GH₵) (C)	Variance (GH₵) (A-B)	% Released
Compensation of Employees	5,691,168,726	5,117,581,797	5,117,581,797	573,586,929	90
Goods and Services	626,078,740	638,863,522	522,915,548	(12,784,782)	102
Capital Expenditure	260,000,000	132,779,987	56,788,325	127,220,013	51
GRAND TOTAL	**6,577,247,467**	**5,889,225,306**	**5,697,285,670**	**688,022,160**	**90**

During the 2025 financial year, the Ministry projected to mobilise an amount of GH₵40,550,563 as internally generated Funds. As at October, 2025 the sum of GH₵37,823,478.31 representing 93.27 per cent has been collected leaving a variance of GH₵2,727,084.69 or 6.73 per cent.

Outlook for 2026

For the 2026 financial year the Ministry of Defence (MoD), through the Ghana Armed Forces (GAF), intend to implement a number of activities in pursuit of its core mandate of safeguarding the territorial integrity of Ghana, maintaining internal security as well as enhancing institutional capacity for sustainable defence, veteran's welfare and national development. In this regard, the Ministry and the Ghana Armed Forces would among others:

a. Strengthen national Defence capabilities;

b. Enhance peacekeeping contributions;

c. Retool the armed forces to counter emerging threats; and

d. Address capacity gaps in infrastructure, logistics, and training.

In this regard, the Ministry of Defence and the Ghana Armed Forces will continue with the implementation of activities in pursuit of its core mandate of safeguarding the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Ghana and ensuring the protection of life, property and rights of all nationals, especially the vulnerable within the democratic environment in accordance with the 1992 Constitution and the Armed Forces Act, 1962 (Act105). To this end, the following operations and projects, among others, will be pursued:

a. Coordinate all Public Private Partnership (PPP) projects for the Ministry to ensure value for money;

b. Facilitate four Memoranda on Defence Cooperation between the Ministry and Bi-lateral and multi-lateral Agencies;

c. Modernise and expand the ICT and Security Infrastructure of the Ministry;

d. Ensure efficient ration supplies to troops in all Garrisons;

e. Conduct Company/Battalion (COY/BN) exercises in Northern, Central and Southern Commands;

f. Complete and operationalise Forward Operating Bases (FOBs);

g. Improve supply of medicines and other medical-related items to military hospitals;

h. Conduct Peace Support Training Programmes for Military, Police and Civilians;

i. Organise Conflict Prevention and Resolution Programmes;

j. Continue works on the 500-bed Afari Military Hospital, which will provide specialised healthcare services to both military and civilian populations;

k. Improve self-reliance through DIHOC projects to strengthen food security, improve housing for personnel, and reduce external dependence for military supplies;

l. Continue the reconstruction of Phase II of the Ministry of Defence Bungalows, renovation of barracks accommodation in Bawah Barracks, Michel Camp, Myohung Barracks, Liberation Barracks, Uaddara and Volta Barracks, facilities at the Recruit Training Centre and the training camps at Bundase and Daboya;

m. Facilitate acquisition of immovable and movable assets, specialist vehicles, surveillance and special forces equipment, and Tentage;

n. Retool the Ghana Air force with four helicopters and two fixed wing aircrafts; and

o. Improve airstrips in four selected regions.

2026 Budgetary Allocation

To implement the above programs, an amount of Ten Billion, Seven Hundred and Seventy-Two Million, Four Hundred and Forty-One Thousand, Six Hundred and Sixty-One Ghana Cedis (GH₵10,772,441,661.00) has been allocated to the Ministry for the implementation of its activities in the 2026 financial year. Out of this allocation, Ten Billion, Seven Hundred and Twenty-Eight Million, One Hundred and Fifteen Thousand, and Nine Hundred and Eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵10,728,115,908.00) is from GoG sources and Forty-Four Million, Three Hundred and Twenty-Five Thousand, Seven Hundred and Fifty-Three Ghana Cedis (GH₵44,325,753.00) is expected to be received from IGF sources. The 2026 allocation will be disbursed among the three main economic classifications as follows:

Table 4: 2026 Budgetary Allocation by Economic Classification

No	Expenditure item	GoG Allocation (GH₵)	IGF (GH₵)	Total (GH₵)
1.	Compensation of Employees	6,564,367,599.00	-	6,564,367,599.00
2.	Goods and Services	876,074,062.00	44,325,753.00	876,074,062
3.	Capital Expenditure (CAPEX)	3,332,000,000.00	-	3,332,000,000.00
	Total	**10,772,441,661.00**	**44,325,753.00**	**10,772,441,661.00**

Observations and Recommendations of the Committee

The Committee, after thorough consideration of the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Defence, has made the following observations and recommendations:

Afari Military Hospital Project

The Ministry of Defense in an attempt to extend health services to officers and the general public in the middle belt of the country commenced the construction of a second military Hospital at Afari in the Ashanti Region. The Committee noted with deep regret that completion of work on the 500 bed facility intended to serve as a major referral and treatment center for military personnel and civilians has faced prolong delays. The project which commenced in 2014 and is about 60 per cent complete faced significant delays due to financial constraints and some contractual issues between government and the contractor. The Committee however observed that although the project has an unpaid claim of GH₵91,222,313.72, the 2026 estimates of the Ministry of Defense failed to make specific budgetary allocation for the completion of work on the Afari Military Hospital.

The Deputy Minister while expressing dissatisfaction at the delays informed the Committee that the civil works on the project is about 91 per cent complete, while the supply and installation of medical equipment and logistics component is only about 5 per cent complete, resulting in an overall project completion rate of approximately 60 per cent. The Committee was also informed that significant quantity of medical equipment are in the country, some stored in bonded warehouses and others at the port attracting high demurrage, with the risks of deterioration.

The Acting Minister for Defence informed the Committee that a reconciliation of the payments made under both the Supplier's Credit Agreement and Government of Ghana components indicates that total expenditure on the project has already exceeded the contract sum originally approved by Parliament. The Minister indicated that, in the circumstances, he is legally constrained from making any further payments to the contractor unless an amended contract sum is approved by Parliament.

The Committee noted that the Afari Military Hospital is a major health and military infrastructure which if completed will serve as a major referral facility for the Military in the middle and northern parts of Ghana and also extend health services to the general public. The Committee therefore urges the Ministry to engage the contractor to resolve all contractual issues and secure the necessary parliamentary approvals to pave way for the completion of work on the Hospital.

Retooling of the Ghana Air Force and Armed Forces

The Committee observed that the recent increase in Capital Expenditure (CAPEX) for the Ministry of Defence is primarily aimed at retooling to address significant infrastructural deficiencies that impede its operational effectiveness. Notably, the Ghana Air Force currently needs functional helicopters, which are essential for a range of military operations and support missions.

In response to this critical shortfall, the MoD has been allocated an amount of GH₵2,532,000,000.00 for the procurement of four (4) helicopters and two (2) fixed-wing aircraft from France, with expectations set for delivery within the years 2026, 2027, and 2028. This acquisition is crucial for enhancing the aerial capabilities of the Ghana Air Force, thereby ensuring it can fulfil its mandate more effectively. The Committee was also informed that beyond aerial assets, the Ghana Armed Forces is also to enhance ground mobility and protection for military personnel in various operational contexts. In response to this, an additional amount of GH₵600,000,000 has been allocated for the procurement of, nineteen (19) Armored Personnel Carriers for the Armed Forces.

The Committee, having regards to the urgent need to improve the ground and aerial capability of the Ghana Armed Forces to deal with armed threat, recommends to the Ministry of Finance to make resources available to the Military for the procurement of fighter jets to argument its aerial capabilities.

Forward Operating Bases (FOBs)

The Committee noted that in an effort to enhance troop deployment to protect the countries vital resources and protect the country from threat of armed terrorist groups from the Sahel, the Ghana Armed Forces commenced construction work on a number of Forward Operating Bases along the country's borders.

The Committee observed that, the establishment of Forward Operating Bases (FOBs) along the country's borders is a key plank of Ghana's national security strategy. However, implementation has been hampered by funding and contracting constraints. The Ministry reported that the development of operational and logistics bases, are at various completion levels with outstanding certified works amounting to GH₵741,974,258.79, which have remained unpaid for over a year.

The Committee however noted that, an amount of GH₵150 million has been allocated in the 2026 budget for the construction of FOBs, Northern Border and New Barracks. The amount is not sufficient to meet the arrears payment under the FOBs contract.

The Committee therefore urged the Minister of Finance and Acting Minister of Defence to commit additional resources for the completion of the Operating bases in view of their strategic importance to the security of the country.

The Acting Minister informed the Committee that the GH₵741,974,258.79 is part of total government arrears that has been validated by the Auditor-General. Consequently, he is committed to pay about GH₵400 million of the arrears to the contractors. An additional amount of GH₵150 million has been allocated in the 2026 allocation for further works, bringing the indicative support for FOBs to about GH₵550 million.

The Hon Minister for Finance assured the Committee that, the Ministry of Defence will be considered in the 2026 supplementary appropriation to support further payments for the FOBs.

Accommodation and Welfare

The Committee observed that the Ghana Armed Forces continues to face a significant accommodation deficit, with the Ministry reporting that about 14,000 personnel currently live outside military barracks due to inadequate housing facilities. Although the Ministry outlined several ongoing interventions such as the construction of 10,000 housing units through a partnership, plans to add an additional 2,000 units next year, the completion of stalled military quarters, and a self-help scheme to mobilise resources with suppliers and private partners, the Committee noted that these efforts remain insufficient compared to the scale of the deficit.

The Committee further observed that inadequate accommodation at some Forward Operating Bases and logistics bases presents operational and welfare risks, particularly for troops deployed in high-risk border areas.

While acknowledging the Ministry's initiatives, the Committee is of the view that the accommodation challenge remains critical and requires a more comprehensive and sustained financing strategy to improve troop welfare, retention, morale, and overall operational readiness.

Use of Domestically Made Drones for Military Surveillance

Addressing the Committee on the steps being taken to sustain peace in conflict zones in Ghana, the Chief of Defence Staff informed the Committee that the Ghana Armed Forces is developing and producing its own drones for surveillance activities in selected conflict zones in the country. The drones made by the Ghana Armed Forces have a significantly improved operational capability compared to other models currently in use. Specifically, these domestically manufactured drones boast of an endurance of up to three hours' continuous flight, which is a considerable enhancement when contrasted with the commercially procured drones that typically have an operational duration of only 45 minutes.

These self-produced drones are presently deployed on peacekeeping operations in the Bawku area, where they play a crucial role in various military operations and surveillance activities. By utilising drones with extended flight times, the Ghana Armed Forces can conduct more comprehensive reconnaissance missions, gather intelligence over larger areas, and respond more effectively to dynamic situations on the ground. This advancement not only highlights the innovative capabilities of the military but also underscores a significant step towards increased self-sufficiency in defence technology.

Delay Commencement of Works on Dollar Power FOB

The Committee noted that the Minister for Defence intends to establish an operating base at "Dollar Power" to facilitate troop deployment. However, the implementation of the project faced numerous set-backs delaying project implementation. The Ministry attributed the delay to the difficulty in accessing the site.

The project is located in a rough terrain which is difficult to access by commercial contractors who are reluctant to work there due to difficulty in moving materials and equipment through the terrain.

The Committee is of the view that Dollar Power had become a security concern, requiring a different operational approach. The Committee therefore urges the Ghana Armed Forces to rely and use, its personnel and engineering expertise and capabilities to undertake the project.

Conclusion

Article 210 of the 1992 Constitution and Armed Forces Act, 1962 (Act 105) assign responsibility for the protection of the territorial integrity of Ghana to the Ghana Armed Forces. The forces have over the years performed creditably by implementing policies aimed at safeguarding the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Ghana and ensuring the protection of life, property and rights of all nationals, especially the vulnerable within the democratic environment.

To further empower the Armed Forces to effectively execute their constitutionally mandated role, and in view of the realities of violent extremism, cybersecurity breaches, illegal mining and maritime piracy necessitate increased investment in infrastructure, equipment, and personnel readiness.

In view of the above, the Committee recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the sum of Ten Billion, Seven Hundred and Seventy-Two Million, Four Hundred and Forty-One Thousand, Six Hundred and Sixty-One Ghana Cedis (GH₵10,772,441,661.00) for the implementation of the programs of the Ministry of Defence and its Agencies for the 2026 Financial Year.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, you may put the question on Motion numbered 30.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Defence and Interior on the allocation of the sum of GH₵10,772,441,661.00 for the services of the Ministry of Defence for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, let us take Motion numbered 31.

NATIONAL COMMISSION FOR CIVIC EDUCATION

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the allocation of the sum of GH₵144,580,479.00 for the services of the National Commission for Civic Education for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Isaac Ashai Odamtten (NDC — Tema East): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion, and in doing so, I present your Committee's Report and call on the *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as though it has been read in its entirety.

Introduction

The Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, on Thursday, 13th November 2025, presented to Parliament the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2026 Financial Year. This presentation was in full compliance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), which mandate the submission of annual fiscal policy proposals to the Legislature for approval.

Pursuant to Order 254(2)(d) of the Standing Orders of the House, the Rt. Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) to the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies for consideration and report. The referral forms part of Parliament's constitutional obligation to scrutinise budget proposals of governance institutions, particularly those established under Chapter 18 of the 1992 Constitution, to ensure the effective discharge of their mandates.

Deliberations

In the discharge of its oversight responsibilities, the Committee engaged extensively with the Chairperson of the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE), Ms Kathleen Addy, supported by senior officials of the Commission and technical officers from the Ministry of Finance. Their submissions provided the Committee with essential clarifications on the Commission's budgetary needs, programme priorities, and the broader policy context within which the 2026 Estimates were prepared.

The Committee expresses its appreciation to the Chairperson and her team for their cooperation, frank responses, and the technical guidance offered during the deliberations, all of which greatly facilitated the Committee's assessment of the Estimates.

Reference Documents

In the course of its work, the Committee relied on a range of authoritative documents to guide its scrutiny and ensure consistency with the national legal and policy framework. The key reference materials consulted include:

i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, which establishes the National Commission for Civic Education and outlines its constitutional mandate;

ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana, which provide procedural guidance for the consideration of budget estimates;

iii. The National Commission for Civic Education Act, 1993 (Act 452), which specifies the functions, powers, and operational responsibilities of the Commission;

iv. The 2025 Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the National Commission for Civic Education

(NCCE), serving as the immediate baseline for assessing the Commission's performance and financial needs;

v. The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), particularly those relating to governance, inclusion, education, and institutional strengthening; and

vi. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year, which provides the macroeconomic context and fiscal outlook within which the Commission's estimates were prepared.

These documents collectively formed the legal, policy, and operational basis for the Committee's deliberations.

Mission and Vision

The National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) is mandated to promote and sustain constitutional democracy by fostering nationwide awareness of the rights, responsibilities, and civic duties of citizens. Its mission emphasises the delivery of comprehensive civic education aimed at deepening democratic culture, strengthening participatory governance, and enhancing national cohesion.

The Commission's vision is to evolve into a highly effective, credible, and independent governance institution that provides accessible, impactful civic education to all Ghanaians. This vision underscores the NCCE's commitment to contributing meaningfully to the sustainability of Ghana's democracy and the continuous growth of an informed and responsible citizenry.

Functions of the Commission

Pursuant to the National Commission for Civic Education Act, 1993 (Act 452), the Commission is mandated to perform a range of core constitutional and civic responsibilities essential to deepening Ghana's democratic governance architecture. Act 452 specifically requires the Commission to:

a) Create and sustain public awareness of the principles, values, and objectives of the 1992 Constitution, recognising it as the fundamental law governing the Republic of Ghana;

b) Educate and encourage citizens to defend the Constitution at all times against abuse, violation, or any conduct that undermines constitutional order;

c) Formulate programmes, for submission to Government, at the national, regional, and district levels aimed at advancing the objectives of the Constitution and strengthening democratic practice across governance structures;

d) Design, implement, and supervise civic education programmes that promote in citizens an understanding of their civic responsibilities, as well as an appreciation of their rights, freedoms, and obligations as members of a democratic society;

e) Assess and advise Government on structural or social inequalities that constrain the realisation of true democracy, and provide recommendations for addressing such disparities to ensure equitable participation and inclusion.

These functions collectively place the NCCE at the centre of Ghana's democratic consolidation efforts, with a statutory mandate to build an informed, responsible, and constitutionally conscious citizenry.

Achievements in 2025

During the 2025 Financial Year, the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) implemented a range of programmes and interventions aimed at strengthening democratic consciousness, enhancing national cohesion, and broadening civic participation across the country. Key achievements recorded within the period include:

a) The Commission played a pivotal role in ensuring post-election peaceful coexistence, reinforcing stability and harmony as essential pillars of national development.

b) It established and deepened strategic relationships with key stakeholders across the governance framework, thereby enhancing coordination, policy alignment, and collaborative civic engagements.

c) The Commission advanced its mandate of promoting inclusive governance, ensuring that marginalised groups, community actors, and the general citizenry had access to democratic education and participation platforms.

d) It sustained the raising of civic awareness on citizens' active participation in national development, particularly within the post-election environment, emphasising unity, tolerance, and responsible citizenship.

e) The NCCE engaged diverse audiences on critical national issues, including tax education to support Government's revenue mobilisation drive, environmental sustainability, and child protection, thereby contributing to broader national policy objectives.

f) It continued to deepen democratic values, foster institutional trust, and encourage citizen involvement in local and national governance processes.

g) The Commission significantly expanded its outreach through mass and social media channels such as television, radio, Community Information Centres, and digital platforms including Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, and its official website, thereby reaching a wider and more diverse population.

These achievements underscore the Commission's sustained commitment to strengthening Ghana's democracy through effective civic education and public engagement.

2025 Budget Performance

For the 2025 Financial Year, the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) was allocated a total of one hundred and thirty-six million, one hundred and fifty-one thousand, one hundred and four Ghana Cedis (GH₵136,151,104.00) to implement its programmes and operations. The allocation was distributed across the Commission's three principal expenditure items as follows:

- Compensation of Employees — GH₵118,907,015.00
- Goods and Services — GH₵17,244,089.00
- Capital Expenditure (Capex) — 0

This allocation was intended to support the Commission's statutory activities nationwide.

Out of the approved appropriation, the Commission received GH₵112,520,904.93, representing 82.64 per cent of the total allocation. As at October 2025, actual expenditure amounted to GH₵109,811,571.92, reflecting the Commission's utilisation of available resources to execute its mandate within the constraints of reduced releases. The details of the releases and actual expenditure for the period January to October 2025 are presented in Table 1 below

Table 1: 2025 Releases and Actual Utilisation

Classification	2025 Appropriation (GH₵) (A)	2025 Released Budget (Jan–Oct) (GH₵) (B)	Actual Expenditure (Jan–Oct) (GH₵) (C)	Variance 1 (GH₵) (D = A – B)	Variance 2 (GH₵) (E = B – C)
Compensation for Employees (GoG)	118,907,015.00	102,102,753.01	102,102,753.01	16,804,261.99	0

Goods & Services (GoG)	3,636,649.00	3,118,324.45	2,418,324.44	518,324.55	700,000.01
Goods & Services (Other Potential Partners)	13,607,440.00	5,290,494.47	5,290,494.47	8,316,945.53	0
Capex (GoG)	–	2,009,333.00	0	(2,009,333.00)	2,009,333.00
Total	**136,151,104.00**	**112,520,904.93**	**109,811,571.92**	**23,630,199.07**	**2,709,333.01**
Source: 2026 Budget Estimates Presentation					

The performance analysis reveals notable funding gaps, particularly in Goods and Services and Capital Expenditure, which affected the Commission's ability to execute critical activities. Despite these constraints, the NCCE demonstrated prudent financial management, ensuring that essential civic education and governance sensitisation activities were carried out across the country.

Outlook for 2026

In advancing its constitutional mandate and strategic objectives, the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) has outlined a comprehensive set of programmes and activities for implementation during the 2026 Financial Year. These interventions are designed to deepen civic consciousness, promote democratic participation, and strengthen national cohesion across all levels of society. The planned activities include:

i. Organising regional and district-level consultative and validation forums to support the ongoing Constitutional Review process, ensuring broad citizen participation in national constitutional reforms.

ii. Engaging youth, Civic Education Committees, and identifiable community groups at the head office, regional, and district levels on the functions and structures of District Assemblies, in order to enhance local governance participation.

iii. Conducting mobile information van operations across district, zonal, and sub-metro levels to promote broader citizens' involvement in the Constitutional Review process.

iv. Celebrating Citizenship Week, with a thematic focus on the "Good Society" campaign, promoting values such as patriotism, discipline, attitudinal change, national trust, responsibility, and the pursuit of excellence.

v. Observing Constitution Week nationwide, reinforcing public understanding of the Constitution and democratic governance.

vi. Hosting dialogue platforms between the Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA) and occupational groups at the district level to enhance tax compliance and revenue mobilisation.

vii. Utilising local radio and Community Information Centres (CICs) across all administrative levels to disseminate civic education messages.

viii. Conducting awareness campaigns on economic empowerment, particularly focusing on the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) to improve citizens' knowledge of economic integration opportunities.

ix. Intensifying public engagements on child protection, addressing emerging vulnerabilities, especially in the digital environment.

x. Sensitising communities on environmental governance, including issues of climate change, pollution, and natural resource protection.

xi. Implementing the Anti-Corruption Action Plan and promoting public accountability through civic education programmes.

xii. Delivering capacity-building and refresher training for NCCE staff to strengthen institutional effectiveness and service delivery.

xiii. Procuring, maintaining, and rehabilitating essential logistics and assets, including office furniture, computers, motorbikes, and vehicles to support field operations.

These activities collectively position the Commission to contribute meaningfully to national development and democratic consolidation.

2026 Budgetary Allocation

To support the implementation of its planned programmes for the 2026 Financial Year, the NCCE has been allocated One Hundred and Forty-Four Million, Five Hundred and Eighty Thousand, Four Hundred and Seventy-Nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵144,580,479.00). This allocation is to be disbursed across the Commission's three main expenditure items as follows:

- Compensation of Employees – GH₵136,943,830.00
- Goods and Services – GH₵5,636,649.00

Capital Expenditure (Capex) – GH₵2, 000,000.00

The allocation will finance two main programmes and seven sub-programmes, as detailed in Table 2 below.

Table 2: 2026 Budget Allocation by Programme and Sub-Programme

S/N	Programme (GH₵)	Sub-Programmes	2026 Allocation (GH₵)
1	Management and Administration – 52,822,305.00	General Administration & Human Resource	50,922,103.00
		Finance	664,303.00
		Research, Gender and Equality	569,541.00
		Communication and Corporate Affairs	666,358.00
2	Civic Education – 91,758,174.00	Constitutional Awareness Creation	38,148,539.00
		Deepening & Sustaining Civic Awareness	32,202,435.00
		Patriotism & Good Governance	21,407,200.00
Total			144,580,479.00

Observations

After a thorough examination of the 2026 Budget Estimates of the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE), the Committee made the following observations:

Budget Ceiling and Funding Gap Analysis

The Committee observed a significant disparity between the Commission's actual financial requirements and the budget ceilings approved by the Ministry of Finance. For the 2026 Financial Year, the Commission requested GH₵56,257,875.00 for Goods and Services; however, the Ministry approved only GH₵5,636,649.00, resulting in a profound funding gap.

The Committee expected the Commission to clearly outline the critical activities that cannot be executed under the reduced ceiling and to indicate the extent of anticipated donor support to help bridge this shortfall.

In its submission, the Commission stated that the limited allocation is inadequate to support essential nationwide programmes, including:

- Intensive tax compliance sensitisation, which is crucial for enhancing national revenue mobilisation;

- Environmental governance campaigns, including climate change awareness, sanitation education, and advocacy against illegal mining; and

- Public engagements on the Constitution Review process, local governance participation, and broader national cohesion efforts.

The Committee notes that such drastic funding limitations risk undermining the Commission's ability to fulfil its constitutional mandate.

Shortfall in Compensation Allocation for 2026

The Committee observed that the Commission's request of GH₵146,101,438.00 for Compensation of Employees exceeded the Ministry of Finance's ceiling of GH₵136,943,830.00, yielding a shortfall of GH₵9,157,608.00. Upon inquiry, the Commission clarified that the additional request relates primarily to existing staff, as outstanding commitments from the previous year have increased compensation obligations.

Furthermore, the Commission highlighted a human resource deficit across 99 districts, necessitating the recruitment of 200 additional staff to operationalise at least 25 district offices, at a projected cost of GH₵9,157,614.46. The Committee recognises the urgency of addressing these staffing gaps to ensure the Commission's effective presence across the country.

Goods and Services Budget Shortfall for 2026

The Committee expressed concern regarding the severe shortfall in the Commission's Goods and Services allocation. While the Commission requires GH₵56,257,875.00, the approved ceiling stands at GH₵5,636,649.00 a level insufficient to support the Commission's extensive operational needs.

Key nationwide activities that require substantial funding include:

- Tax education and compliance campaigns;

- Environmental governance and climate change sensitisation;

- Public education on the Constitutional Review process;

- Child protection advocacy and digital safety campaigns; and

- Anti-corruption and accountability initiatives.

These programmes are resource-intensive and are critical to the Commission's constitutional obligations. As such, the Commission has appealed for a review of the ceiling to enable effective fulfilment of its mandate.

Financial Arrears and Pending Legal Risks

The Committee noted with grave concern that the Commission is burdened with outstanding arrears amounting to GH₵15,212,150.62, initially released in 2024 but subsequently withdrawn by the Ministry of Finance in 2025. This reversal left the Commission unable to settle its financial commitments.

Consequently, the Commission faces legal threats, particularly from CFAO, the supplier of procured vehicles, due to unpaid liabilities. Procurement processes had been duly completed, but the clawback of funds resulted in an unresolved debt. The Committee considers this a serious financial and reputational risk for the Commission and therefore recommends that the Minister for Finance urgently releases the withheld funds to enable the Commission to settle its obligations without further delay.

Operational and Institutional Challenges

The Committee observed a number of operational constraints negatively affecting the Commission's effectiveness. These include:

- Persistent illegal mining despite sustained sensitisation campaigns, indicating the need for better-resourced and more targeted interventions;
- Widespread tax non-compliance, especially among informal sector workers, self-employed persons, and digital commerce operators, which continues to undermine Government revenue mobilisation efforts;
- Increasing child-protection concerns, including children's heightened exposure to online abuse and digital risks;
- Damage to institutional credibility, as delays in settling 2024 arrears have strained relations with suppliers, some of whom have threatened legal action.

These challenges underscore the necessity for enhanced funding, improved logistical support, and strengthened institutional capacity to enable the Commission to effectively discharge its constitutional mandate.

Strengthening Staff Capacity for Affirmative Action Implementation

The Committee notes that the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) proposes to undertake capacity-building training for 400 selected staff to equip them with the requisite knowledge and skills to effectively sensitise the public on the Affirmative Action Law. The Commission explained that many of its officers have not received recent refresher training, resulting in gaps in understanding of key policy, legal, and administrative frameworks, including the 1992 Constitution, the Commission's training manual, collective agreements, and emerging gender-related legislation.

Given the introduction of the Affirmative Action Law, the Committee recognises that specialised training is necessary to ensure that civic educators—particularly at the regional and district levels are able to accurately interpret, communicate, and advocate the provisions of the law. Strengthening staff capacity will enable the Commission to undertake nationwide sensitisation with greater clarity and consistency.

Resource Mobilisation and Partnerships

Despite the Commission's persistent funding challenges, the Committee observed that the NCCE has numerous untapped opportunities for external support. The Commission identified potential partnerships with:

- Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA) particularly for tax compliance education;
- UNICEF for child protection engagements;
- UNDP and UNFPA for civic, social, and community empowerment programmes;
- Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) and Minerals Commission for environmental governance activities; and
- Various embassies and UN agencies – for human rights and governance initiatives.

The Committee further emphasised the importance of strengthening collaboration with the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF). District Assemblies receive significant allocations for social protection, including disability support and child welfare interventions, which align with the NCCE's child protection and community engagement efforts.

The Committee therefore urges the Commission to actively pursue resource mobilisation opportunities with these partners.

Engagement with the Constitutional Review Process

The Committee acknowledges the NCCE's support to the Constitutional Review Committee through regional stakeholder engagements. However, it was noted that the Review Committee lacks a budget for public education, and the NCCE has not contributed to the budgeting process for the implementation phase.

This oversight risks the exclusion of essential civic education components from the implementation of the constitutional review roadmap. The Committee therefore advised that the NCCE establish closer collaboration with the Review Committee to ensure its role is fully integrated into future planning and budgeting activities.

The Committee further stressed the importance of public sensitisation on both entrenched and non-entrenched constitutional clauses, particularly as citizens often express confusion about amendment procedures. Public misunderstanding also persists regarding roles and boundaries between Members of Parliament (MPs) and Metropolitan, Municipal and District Chief Executives (MMDCEs) issues that can be more effectively addressed through robust civic education in support of the review process.

The Commission was strongly encouraged to actively participate in the implementation planning process to ensure that its constitutional mandate is reflected in subsequent review activities.

Public Sensitisation on Climate Change and Greenness

The Committee underscored the importance of integrating climate change education and green transition awareness into national civic engagement efforts. With the global shift towards environmental stewardship, Ghana must empower citizens especially young learners to adopt sustainable lifestyles.

The Committee noted that such civic awareness should begin at the basic school level, where early education can instil values of environmental preservation, responsible resource use, and adaptation to climate change.

The Committee therefore recommended that the NCCE incorporate environmental governance and green education into its public sensitisation campaigns. Strategic collaboration with the Ministry of Education and the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) was strongly encouraged to ensure comprehensive and consistent delivery of green education programmes.

Integration of Ethical Behaviour Education in Civic Learning

The Committee emphasised the necessity of introducing ethical behaviour education at the kindergarten and primary school levels, recognising that the formation of ethical citizens begins early in life. Values such as honesty, patriotism, responsibility, and self-value must be intentionally cultivated to shape future adults who contribute positively to national development.

The Committee urged the Commission to integrate ethical conduct training into both:

- its school-based civic education programmes, and

- its staff refresher training modules.

Embedding ethical values in civic learning will help foster a more responsible, disciplined, and patriotic citizenry capable of upholding democratic and national principles throughout their lives.

Inability to Engage Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) as a Result of Late Directive

The Committee noted that, due to the late directive regarding the invitation of Civil Society Organisations (CSOs), it was unable to engage any CSOs during budget hearing. The Committee acknowledged the importance of CSO participation in enriching the deliberative process.

The Committee further observed that, going forward, it will take the necessary steps to ensure that relevant CSOs are duly invited and adequately engaged in its subsequent meetings and budget hearings to enhance transparency, inclusiveness, and stakeholder input.

Conclusion and Recommendation

The Committee, having carefully examined the 2026 Budget Estimates of the National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE), reaffirms the indispensable role of the Commission in promoting civic consciousness, deepening democratic values, and creating sustained public awareness of the principles and objectives of the 1992 Constitution, which remains the fundamental law of the Republic.

In recognition of the NCCE's constitutional mandate and its contribution to national cohesion, good governance, and citizen empowerment, the Committee recommends that the House adopt this Report and approve the sum of one hundred and forty-four million, five hundred and eighty thousand, four hundred and seventy-nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵144,580,479.00) for the effective implementation of the Commission's programmes and activities for the Financial Year ending 31st December 2026.

The Committee trusts that the timely approval and release of the Commission's budget will enable it to fulfil its obligations to the nation and continue to strengthen the democratic fabric of Ghana.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the allocation of the sum of GH₵144,580,479.00 for the services of the National Commission for Civic Education for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, let us go to item numbered 27.

NATIONAL MEDIA COMMISSION

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the allocation of the sum of GH₵12,527,863.00 for the services of the National Media Commission for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Isaac Ashai Odamtten (NDC — Tema East): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion. In seconding the

Motion, I present the Committee's Report and ask the *Hansard* to capture the Report as read.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year was presented to Parliament by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson**,** on 13th November 2025**,** in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921)**.**

Following the presentation, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the National Media Commission (NMC) to the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies, pursuant to Order 254(2) of the Standing Orders of Parliament, for consideration and report.

In fulfilment of this mandate, the Committee held deliberative meetings with the Executive Secretary of the Commission, Mr George Sarpong**,** officials of the Commission, and key stakeholders including the Ghana Journalists Association (GJA)**,** the Ghana Independent Broadcasters Association (GIBA)**,** and technical officers from the Ministry of Finance**.** The Committee's engagements focused on the Commission's policy priorities, operational needs, and funding requirements for the 2026 Financial Year.

The Committee conveys its sincere appreciation to all officials and stakeholder representatives for their valuable submissions, insights, and cooperation, which greatly enriched its deliberations.

Reference

In the course of its deliberations, the Committee referenced the following key documents:

a) The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

b) The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;

c) National Media Commission Act, 1993 (Act 449);

d) Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);

e) The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year;

f) National Medium-Term Development Policy Framework (NMTDPF), 2025–2028, in support of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs); and

g) Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF), 2025–2028.

Overview of National Media Commission

The National Media Commission (NMC) was established in July 1993 pursuant to the National Media Commission Act, 1993 (Act 449), in fulfilment of the constitutional mandate under Chapter 12 of the 1992 Constitution. The Commission is entrusted with ensuring the establishment and maintenance of the highest journalistic standards across the mass media landscape.

Its functions include the investigation, mediation, and resolution of complaints lodged by or against the media, thereby promoting accountability and ethical conduct within the media ecosystem. The Commission also bears a constitutional obligation to promote and protect the freedom and independence of the mass media, fostering an environment conducive to the free flow of information and communication in support of Ghana's democratic development.

Core Functions

The National Media Commission (NMC) performs a constitutionally mandated set of core functions aimed at safeguarding media freedom, promoting high journalistic standards, and strengthening Ghana's democratic communication landscape. The principal functions of the Commission are as follows:

1. To promote and ensure the freedom and independence of the media for mass communication and information dissemination, thereby fostering an environment that facilitates the free flow of ideas, opinions, and information essential for democratic governance.

2. To take all necessary measures to establish and maintain the highest journalistic standards within the mass media. This includes the investigation, mediation, and resolution of complaints lodged by or against the press and other media institutions, with the objective of promoting ethical and responsible journalism.

3. To insulate state-owned media from governmental control, thereby safeguarding their editorial independence, operational autonomy, and professional integrity in line with constitutional provisions.

4. To make regulations by constitutional instrument for the registration of newspapers and other publications, provided that such regulations shall not in any way direct or control the professional functions of individuals engaged in the production of newspapers or other media content.

Achievements in 2025

During the year under review, the National Media Commission, in fulfilment of its mandate under Article 168 of the 1992 Constitution and Section 2(1)(e) of the National Media Commission Act, 1993 (Act 449), undertook several key initiatives aimed at strengthening media regulation, safeguarding media independence, and enhancing journalistic standards nationwide. The Committee notes the following achievements:

I. Complaints Handling and Dispute Resolution

II. The Commission received ten (10) complaints during the reporting period. Out of these, seven (7) were resolved through its Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) Mechanism. Two (2) complaints fell outside the Commission's mandate, while one (1) remains pending due to the submission of additional offensive broadcast material by the media outlet concerned.

III. Enhancement of Media Monitoring Systems

IV. The Commission improved its media monitoring capacity through the deployment of the Ghana Media Watch App, a digital platform designed to detect and address hate speech, incitement, and disinformation in the media ecosystem.

V. Safety of Journalists

VI. The Commission intensified efforts to track incidents relating to the safety of journalists, collaborating closely with the Ghana Police Service. As at the end of the reporting period, three (3) such incidents were under active investigation by the Police.

VII. Strengthened Inter-Agency Regulatory Collaboration

VIII. A Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was executed with the Bank of Ghana, the National Communications Authority, and other relevant regulatory bodies to strengthen oversight and apply regulatory sanctions against undesirable media practices, including "juju" performances, money doubling schemes, and fake miracles by televangelists. This collaborative initiative has significantly contributed to the sanitisation of the media space.

IX. Mediation of Conflicts Between Radio Stations and Traditional Authorities

X. The Commission continued its spot monitoring of grievances arising between radio stations and traditional authorities across various regions. By facilitating dialogue between chiefs and radio station management, the Commission helped manage tensions, safeguard cultural sensitivities, and protect vulnerable audiences from exploitation.

XI. Visits to State-Owned Media Houses

XII. As part of ongoing efforts to uphold media standards, members of the Commission conducted familiarisation visits to state-owned media organisations to assess their operations, achievements, and challenges. This continuous engagement is designed to reinforce adherence to professional and ethical standards and prevent institutional lapses.

Budget Performance in 2025

For the 2025 Financial Year, the National Media Commission was allocated a total budget of GH₵15,668,348.00, distributed across three expenditure items; Compensation, Goods and Services, and Capital Expenditure. Table 1 below presents the Commission's budget performance as of 24th November 2025.

Table 1: NMC Budget Performance as at 24th November 2025

Item	2025 Approved Budget (GH₵) (A)	2025 Releases as at 24-11-2025 (GH₵) (B)	Actual Expenditure (GH₵) (C)	Variance (GH₵) D = A – B	% Released (E = B/A × 100)
Compensation	7,668,348.00	1,415,926.53	5,358,868.53	6,252,421.47	18.46
Goods and Services	3,000,000.00	2,127,500.00	2,017,401.79	872,500.00	70.92
Capital Expenditure	5,000,000.00	3,000,000.00	2,944,327.95	2,000,000.00	60.00
Total	**15,668,348.00**	**6,543,426.53**	**10,320,598.27**	**9,124,921.47**	**41.76**

The Committee's review of the 2025 budget performance of the National Media Commission (NMC) reveals a mixed pattern of expenditure execution, characterised by significant under-releases in critical budget lines. Overall, only 41.76 per cent of the approved budget of GH₵15,668,348.00 had been released to the Commission as at 24th November 2025, resulting in a substantial funding gap of GH₵9,124,921.47.

The most concerning shortfall occurred under Compensation, where only 18.46 per cent of the approved amount was released. This severe underfunding adversely affected the Commission's ability to meet its statutory personnel obligations. Conversely, Goods and Services recorded a relatively higher release rate of 70.92 per cent, enabling the Commission to undertake critical activities such as media monitoring, complaints resolution, and inter-agency regulatory interventions.

Under Capital Expenditure, 60 per cent of the approved funds was released, supporting limited investments in infrastructure and technological upgrades. However, the outstanding balance of GH₵2,000,000.00 indicates that essential capital projects remain either partially implemented or deferred.

The Committee concludes that the overall resource constraints significantly limited the Commission's capacity to fully execute its mandate in 2025, particularly in relation to staffing needs, operational expansion, and the modernisation of regulatory tools. Strengthening budget releases in future fiscal years will therefore be essential to sustaining the Commission's constitutional role in safeguarding media freedom and upholding professional standards.

Outlook for 2026

For the 2026 Financial Year, the National Media Commission (NMC) has outlined a comprehensive programme of activities aimed at strengthening media regulation, safeguarding democratic communication, and enhancing national stability. The key initiatives are summarised below:

(a) Media and Peace Building Initiatives

The Commission intends to build on the gains made in previous years by intensifying its media and peace-building interventions. Efforts will focus on restoring integrity within the information ecosystem through enhanced measures to combat hate speech, incitement, fake news, and disinformation.

To deepen its contribution to national stability, the Commission will:

- scale up media monitoring and regulatory enforcement to ensure adherence to professional standards;

- convene a national dialogue on media, governance, and peace building to foster stakeholder collaboration; and

- implement targeted interventions to address violent extremism and terrorism threats in Ghana and the wider West African sub-region.

(b) Improving Regulation of Electronic Communication

In 2026, the Commission will operationalise a Memorandum of Cooperation with key regulatory and security stakeholders to develop innovative regulatory tools for addressing hate speech, incitement, harmful online content, and the escalating challenge of disinformation.

Core partner institutions include:

- the National Communications Authority,

- the Ghana Police Service,

- the Ghana Armed Forces,

- the Ghana Independent Broadcasters Association, and

- Private Newspaper Publishers.

Through this collaboration, the Commission seeks to strengthen its regulatory framework by leveraging multi-agency expertise to promote responsible electronic communication and protect the public space from abuse.

(c) Development of New Guidelines

The Commission will develop a new set of Guidelines for Investigative Journalism to enhance professionalism, accountability, and ethical conduct in this critical field. The guidelines will be developed in consultation with media practitioners, industry stakeholders, and subject-matter experts to ensure relevance, practicality, and impact. This initiative underscores the Commission's commitment to promoting high-quality, fact-based journalism in the public interest.

(d) Broadcast Monitoring Centre (BMC)

Through the Broadcast Monitoring Centre, the Commission will continue its oversight of the broadcast space with the objective of:

- minimising ethical violations,
- identifying and addressing content concerns, and
- promoting responsible broadcasting.

These efforts are intended to strengthen Ghana's democratic development by ensuring that the media operates within professional and ethical boundaries while serving the public interest.

(e) Broadcasting Bill

The Commission will pursue stakeholder engagement and support toward the passage of the Broadcasting Bill, a critical legislative instrument necessary for establishing a comprehensive and modern regulatory framework for Ghana's broadcast sector.

(f) Recruitment of Professional Staff

To reinforce its regulatory and administrative capacity, the Commission plans to recruit additional qualified and experienced professionals to support its expanding mandate and operational needs.

(g) Office Building

The Commission is seeking to acquire a suitable office building to provide a conducive working environment, improve institutional efficiency, and enhance the delivery of regulatory and administrative services.

(h) Decentralisation

In pursuit of national reach and stakeholder accessibility, the Commission intends to decentralise its operations, extending its presence to regions across the country. This initiative will enable improved engagement with local media actors and enhance responsiveness to regional concerns.

Review of the NMC Act and Related Legislative Instruments

Recognising the evolving media landscape, the Commission will undertake a comprehensive review of the NMC Act (Act 449) and related Legislative Instruments to ensure that the regulatory framework remains robust, relevant, and fit for purpose in addressing emerging trends, digital communication challenges, and sectoral developments.

2026 Budget Allocation

To facilitate the implementation of its planned programmes and activities for the 2026 Financial Year, the National Media Commission (NMC) has been allocated a total amount of GH₵12,937,678.18. However, based on the detailed cost-centre breakdown submitted to the Committee, the effective allocation for operational expenditure amounts to GH₵12,527,863.00, distributed across the Commission's three expenditure items as follows:

Table 1: 2026 Budget Allocation by Cost Centre

Cost Centre	**2026 Allocation (GH₵)**
Employee Compensation	6,527,863.00
Goods and Services	3,000,000.00
Capital Expenditure	3,000,000.00
Total	**12,527,863.00**

The Committee notes that the 2026 allocation represents a reduction of GH₵3,140,485.00 compared to the Commission's 2025 allocation of GH₵15,668,348.00, amounting to a 20.04 per cent decrease. This downward adjustment has implications for the Commission's ability to pursue planned reforms, scale its regulatory activities, and respond to emerging challenges within the media ecosystem.

A comparative analysis of allocations for 2025 and 2026 is presented below.

Table 2: Comparative Allocations for 2025 and 2026

SN	Cost Centre	2025 Allocation (GH₵) (A)	2026 Allocation (GH₵) (B)	Variance (GH₵) (C = A – B)
1	Compensation of Employees	7,668,348.00	6,527,863.00	1,140,485.00
2	Goods and Services	3,000,000.00	3,000,000.00	–
3	Capital Expenditure	5,000,000.00	3,000,000.00	2,000,000.00
Total		**15,668,348.00**	**12,527,863.00**	**3,140,485.00**

The Committee observes that:

The most significant reduction occurred under Capital Expenditure, which declined by GH₵2,000,000.00.

Employee Compensation also saw a reduction of GH₵1,140,485.00, potentially affecting staffing and operational capacity.

The allocation for Goods and Services remained unchanged.

The Committee emphasises that these budget cuts may constrain the Commission’s ability to execute its expanded mandate, particularly in areas such as digital monitoring, peace-building interventions, investigative journalism guidelines development, and decentralised operations.

2026 Allocation by Programme and Sub-Programme

The 2026 allocation will be applied to the Commission’s two main programmes and four sub-programmes as shown below:

Table 3: 2026 Budget Allocation by Programme

Budget Programme	Budget Sub-Programme	2026 Allocation (GH₵)
Management and Administration	General Administration and Finance	7,164,363.00
	Policy Planning, Monitoring and Evaluation	1,500,000.00
Media Regulation and Management	Media Affairs	488,750.00
	Media Complaints Settlement	3,374,750.00
Total		**12,527,863.00**

The Committee notes that:

Management and Administration receives the largest share of the allocation, reflecting the substantial administrative and institutional support required for national media regulation.

Media Regulation and Management, which directly supports monitoring activities, complaints resolution, and sectoral guideline development, receives a combined allocation of GH₵3,863,500.00.

Observations

After a thorough examination of the 2026 Budget Estimates of the National Media Commission (NMC), the Committee made the following observations:

Decrease in Budgetary Allocation

The Committee notes with concern the 20.04 per cent reduction in the NMC's allocation for the 2026 Financial Year, representing a nominal decrease of GH₵3,140,485.00 from GH₵15,668,348.00 in 2025 to GH₵12,937,678.18 in 2026.

The Committee is of the considered view that this reduction runs contrary to Parliament's long-standing advocacy for the strengthening of independent constitutional bodies, including the NMC. It further observes that, despite Ghana's democratic maturation and the rapid expansion of the national media ecosystem, independent constitutional bodies have not experienced corresponding growth in resource allocation.

The Committee identifies a systemic misalignment between constitutional expectations and actual budgetary provision, which directly undermines the NMC's mandate. The Committee therefore expresses its willingness to collaborate with all independent constitutional bodies to review and reform the budgetary framework governing their operations, with a view to ensuring that these institutions receive adequate resources to discharge their mandates effectively.

Human Resource Deficit

The Committee expresses grave concern regarding the severe human resource deficit confronting the NMC, which is constitutionally tasked with regulating a vast and rapidly expanding media environment comprising:

- over 500 radio stations,
- more than 100 television channels,
- numerous newspapers, and
- a rapidly growing digital and online media space.

The NMC informed the Committee that international monitoring standards require one monitor for every four broadcast hours, implying a minimum requirement of approximately 1,000 monitors for radio regulation alone. However, the NMC currently has only three professional staff nationwide; the Executive Secretary, one officer nearing retirement (providing temporary support), and one additional officer.

The Committee further notes that the NMC has no regional offices or personnel, thereby creating serious regulatory and national security vulnerabilities, particularly in border communities where media activity is high.

The Committee agrees that this acute personnel deficit poses existential risks to the country's media regulatory system, especially in an era marked by misinformation, digital content proliferation, and conflict-sensitive reporting. The Committee therefore recognises the urgent need for significant staffing reinforcement.

Compensation Projections

The Committee examined the NMC's compensation projections, which show an increase from approximately GH₵6 million (2025 actual) to a proposed GH₵12.9 million for 2026, despite expenditure levels below GH₵1 million at the time of the 2025 budget.

The NMC clarified that this increase is attributable to:

1. Accumulated arrears owed to previous Commission members, whose allowances remain unpaid six months after the end of their tenure.
2. Delayed disbursement of allowances for current Commission members, appointed in May 2025.
3. Constitutional provisions under Article 71, which govern the

remuneration and allowances of Commissioners.

The NMC emphasised that the low expenditure levels do not indicate diminished need, but reflect systemic delays in releases. The increased projections also account for the Commission's request for approval to recruit essential professional staff to meet regulatory demands.

The Committee acknowledges these explanations and finds the projections to be justifiable in light of the Commission's operational realities and constitutional obligations.

Constitutional Issues Regarding Budget Allocations

The Committee raised significant constitutional and institutional concerns regarding the budgeting framework for independent constitutional bodies. Under Chapter 12 and Article 172 of the 1992 Constitution, the NMC is not subject to the direction or control of any person or authority in the performance of its functions.

However, in practice, the NMC is:

- required to negotiate its budget with the Ministry of Finance,
- bound by the Public Financial Management Act, and
- required to compete with executive agencies for fiscal space.

The Committee views this arrangement as inconsistent with the constitutional independence envisioned for the NMC and similar bodies such as CHRAJ. It further notes that reliance on the Executive for funding may inadvertently compromise institutional autonomy.

The Committee therefore highlights the need for a review and realignment of the budgeting system to ensure adherence to constitutional provisions guaranteeing independence.

Establishment of a Legal Framework for Budget Processing

The Committee observes a marked disparity between the budget-processing mechanisms of the Executive, Parliament, and the Judiciary, all of which enjoy constitutionally defined protection, and those of independent constitutional bodies, which do not.

To address this institutional gap, the Committee advocates for the establishment of a special budget mechanism—either through legislative amendment or constitutional instrument—to shield independent bodies from undue executive control.

Such a mechanism should enable the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies to transmit budget proposals directly to the Ministry of Finance, thereby strengthening the financial independence and institutional autonomy of entities such as the NMC.

Impact of Technological and Media Evolution

The Committee recognises that the constitutional framework governing the media was designed for a traditional media ecosystem consisting of radio, television, and print. However, the contemporary media space has evolved dramatically and now includes:

- social media,
- digital content creation,
- online broadcasting, and
- complex algorithm-driven communication systems.

The Committee notes that this transformation requires a far more sophisticated regulatory infrastructure than currently exists. The resource allocation and institutional design of the NMC are insufficient to respond to these challenges, thereby posing risks to national information integrity.

The Committee therefore expresses its readiness to collaborate with independent constitutional bodies to review and modernise the budgetary and regulatory framework, ensuring that institutions such as the NMC are equipped to effectively regulate Ghana's evolving media landscape.

Observations from Stakeholders

During its deliberations, the Committee received submissions from key stakeholders in the media ecosystem. Their observations are summarised below:

Weak Enforcement Capacity

The President of the Ghana Journalists Association (GJA) drew the Committee's attention to a critical institutional challenge: the inability of the National Media Commission (NMC) to enforce its decisions. He noted that, although the NMC is constitutionally mandated to promote high journalistic standards, it lacks a strong legal framework to compel compliance with its rulings.

He further referenced Article 162 of the 1992 Constitution, arguing that its provisions limit the Commission's authority to impose sanctions for media misconduct. This constitutional constraint, he submitted, undermines the Commission's regulatory effectiveness and weakens its ability to ensure adherence to ethical and professional standards within the media landscape.

Overburdening of Other Agencies

The GJA President also expressed concern that other institutions such as the Digital Journalism Ethics (DJE) platform and the GJA are increasingly performing responsibilities that should rightly fall under the jurisdiction of the NMC. This, he explained, is the result of both legislative gaps and resource limitations, which have severely hampered the NMC's capacity to discharge its mandate.

To address this challenge, the GJA issued a call to action, urging Parliament to:

- amend the relevant legislation;
- strengthen the NMC's institutional autonomy; and
- provide the Commission with the necessary enforcement powers to perform its regulatory functions effectively.

The Association emphasised that a strong and well-resourced NMC is indispensable (*sine qua non*) to promoting ethical journalism, ensuring media accountability, and preventing abuses within the increasingly complex media environment.

Increase in Budgetary Allocation

The Ghana Independent Broadcasters Association (GIBA) underscored the urgent need to increase the NMC's budgetary allocation. GIBA argued that without adequate funding, the Commission cannot effectively regulate an expanding and technologically diverse media sector. GIBA also stressed the importance of timely disbursement of approved funds, noting that consistent delays hinder the NMC's operational efficiency and compromise its ability to undertake essential monitoring, standard-setting, and complaints resolution activities.

Conclusion

The Committee, having carefully scrutinised the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the National Media Commission and considered the submissions of stakeholders, is satisfied that the proposed allocation is essential for the Commission to execute its constitutional mandate in safeguarding media freedom, professional standards, and public accountability.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this Report and to approve the sum of twelve million, nine hundred and thirty-seven thousand, six hundred and seventy-eight Ghana Cedis, Eighteen Pesewas (GH₵12,937,678.18) for the implementation of the programmes and activities of the National Media Commission for the 2026 Financial Year.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the allocation of the sum of GH₵12,937,678.18 for the services of the National Media Commission for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take item numbered 23.

7:17 p.m.

MINISTRY OF TRADE
AGRIBUSINESS AND INDUSTRY

Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry (Mrs Elizabeth Ofosu-Adjare) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism on the allocation of the sum of GH₵844,541,243.00 for the services of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

I thank you Mr Speaker for the opportunity.

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Alexander Roosevelt Hottordze): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion as the Chairman of the Committee. In doing so, I present the Committee's Report and I urge the *Hansard* Department to capture the Report in its entirety.

Mr Speaker, I urge the House to adopt this Report and approve the sum of GH₵844,541,243.00 for the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry to carry out its activities for the 2026 financial year. Thank you so much.

Introduction

On Thursday, 13th November 2025, the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, presented to Parliament the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Order 195(2) of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Subsequently, the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry was referred to the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism for consideration and report pursuant to Standing Order 248(2).

Deliberations

The Committee met on Wednesday, 3rd December, 2025, with the Hon Deputy Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry, Mr Sampson Ahi, the Chief Director of the Ministry, Mr Noah Tumfo, the technical team and other officials of the Ministry as well as the stakeholders of the Ministry and considered the Estimates of the Ministry. The Committee is grateful to all who honoured its invitation and assisted in its consideration of the Budget Estimates for the Year 2026.

Reference Documents

The Committee, in its consideration of the Estimates, referred to the following documents:

i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;

iii. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);

iv. Public Management Regulations, 2019 (L. I. 2378);

v. Ghana Standards Authority Act, 2022 (Act 1078);

vi. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the Year 2026;

vii. The Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the 2026 Financial Year; and

viii. Report of the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism on the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the 2025 Financial Year

General Background of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry

The Ministry of Trade and Industry has been realigned to Trade, Agribusiness and Industry to focus considerable attention and resources on attracting investments into the local production of high-quality raw materials in high demand; especially, agricultural raw materials that feed into expanding export trade and manufacturing.

This will enable businesses to engage in value addition with adequate high-quality raw materials for maximum utilisation of installed capacities (currently 30-40 per cent in most industries) and roll them unto Government’s 24-hour economy policy.

It is in view of the foregoing that government has highlighted agricultural modernisation and productivity as central to its job creation strategy, particularly, through industrialisation, export development and import substitution for inclusive growth.

DEPTH-driven approach (Diversification, Export competitiveness, Productivity, Technology, and Human well-being) to ensure long-term economic transformation; and

A Private Sector-Led Growth - Unlocking the full potential of Businesses. Furthermore, it is the responsibility of the Ministry to strengthen trade relations with all friendly countries on a most favoured nation basis consistent with Ghana's membership of the World Trade Organisation (WTO). In industry, the Ministry's policy thrust continues primarily to be the development of a more competitive industrial sub-sector with potentials to make in-roads into the international market with value added local products derived from local resources.

Mandate of the Ministry

The Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry is mandated to:

i. To formulate and implement policies and programmes that promote trade, agribusiness, industry, and private sector development.

ii. To regulate and oversee trade, agribusiness and industry practices, including imports, exports and investments.

iii. To support small, medium-sized, large enterprises, and entrepreneurship development.

iv. To promote economic growth and job creation through trade, agribusiness and industry development.

v. To review, monitor, coordinate, and evaluate policies, programmes, and plans of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry, and

vi. Provide technical advice to the government and other stakeholders on issues relating to trade, agribusiness, and industry.

Vision of the Ministry

The Vision of the Ministry is to establish Ghana as a globally competitive manufacturing and trading hub in Africa.

Policy Objectives

Following are the Policy Objectives of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry per the Ghana National Medium-Term Development:

i. Promote trade, agribusiness and industry development;

ii. Support SMEs and Entrepreneurship development;

iii. Enhance Trade Facilitation and Investment Promotion with requisite state agencies;

iv. Develop and implement Trade Agreements and Policies;

v. Improve the Business Environment and reduce regulatory barriers;

vi. Promote economic growth and job creation through Trade, Agribusiness and Industry development;

vii. Enhance public awareness and education on opportunities and threats associated with Trade, Agribusiness and Industry, particularly, those regulated to sub-regional trade; and

viii. Foster partnerships with stakeholders in Trade, Agribusiness and Industry.

Core Functions

Following are the Core Functions of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry:

i. Formulate and implement policies and programmes for industrial transformation and job creation to:

   a. Decentralise industrial development by supporting the private sector to establish manufacturing enterprises;

   b. Establish strategic industries as new growth poles;

c. Revitalise existing industries in key strategic sectors

d. Promote investments in agribusiness

ii. Formulate and implement policies and programmes to enhance export development, import substitution, and internal trade.

ii. Enhance trade and investment through the establishment of Industrial Parks, Special Economic Zones and Agro-Industrial Zones.

iv. Implement policies and programmes, and strengthen the institutional framework to support MSME and entrepreneurship development.

v. Implement and coordinate programme initiatives to enhance the institutional framework and business environment for trade, agribusiness and investment, including internal trade and investment.

vii. Enhance market access for products and services originating from Ghana by participating in multilateral, regional and bilateral trade negotiations and coordinating the implementation of trade agreements.

viii. Develop reliable raw material supply chains with consistent volume, quality and pricing.

ix. Contribute towards the growth of industry, protect consumers and facilitate trade through Standardization, Metrology and Conformity Assessment.

x. Strengthen the capacity and competitiveness of MSMEs to enable competition

xi. Maximise the contribution of MSMEs to the economic and social development of the country.

Key Agencies Under the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry

The Ministry implements its policies, programmes and strategies through the following Agencies:

i. Ghana Standards Authority

ii. Ghana Export Promotion Authority

iii. Ghana Free Zones Authority

iv. GRATIS Foundation

v. Ghana Enterprises Agency

vi. Ghana International Trade Commission

vii. Central Regional Development Commission (CEDECOM)

2025 Budget Performance of the Ministry

An amount of Five Hundred and Forty-Six Million, Four Hundred and Ninety- Four Thousand, Three Hundred and Thirty Cedis (GH₵546,494,330.00) was allocated for the services of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the 2025 Financial Year.

Out of this amount, Three Hundred and Four Million, Four Hundred Thousand, Five Hundred and Eighty-Six Ghana Cedis, fifty-Eight pesewas (GH₵304,400,586.00) was released as at August and actual expenditure as at August was Two Hundred and Ninety-Three Million, One Hundred and Six Thousand, Eight Hundred and Ninety-Nine Cedis, and six pesewas (GH₵293,106,899.06).

A summary of the Budget and Actual Expenditure of the Ministry for the 2025 Financial Year is presented in Table 1 below:

	2025 Budget (A)	**Releases as at August 2025 (B)**	**Actual EXP as at August 2025 (C)**	**Variance (A-B)**	**Variance (B-C)**
Compensation of Employees	188,102,358.00	119,230,423.44	119,230,423.44	68,871,934.56	0.00
Goods and Services	263,866,961	164,735,773.76	158,242,086.24	99,131,187.24	6,493,687.52
CAPEX	94,525,011	20,434,389.38	15,634,389.38	74,090,621.62	4,800,000.00
Total	**546,494,330**	**304,400,586.58**	**293,106,899.06**	**242,093,743.42**	**11,293,687.52**

Achievements for 2025

For the year 2025, the Ministry:

- Obtained over 40,000 acres of land, earmarked by the Yeji Traditional Council, to promote large-scale commercial farming

- Completed the development of policies on Textiles and Garments, Pharmaceutical Manufacturing and Automotive Components.
- Strengthened Ghana's textile and garment industry with support from other institutions and the private sector. The aim is for key Government institutions to source their uniforms locally.

- Submitted the Business Regulatory Reforms Bill to the Office of the Attorney-General

Industrial Park and Special Economic Zones Authority

During the year under review, the Authority:

- Registered 30 new companies under the Free Zones Programme

- Attracted US$165.29million in capital from Free Zone Enterprises

- Created 1600 jobs within the Free Zones enterprises

- Completed payment of the stamp duty for the Afienya SEZ land

- Allocated approximately 205 acres out of the 1,238 acres to six (6) companies

Rural Enterprises Project

During the year under review, the Project:

- Disbursed US$444,000 to 1,246 micro and small enterprises (MSEs) primarily to support working capital needs.

- Equipped 32 Youth factories, procuring and installing equipment for eight (8) of the 26 unequipped factories. The factories are engaged in processing across value chains such as Bamboo, Ginger, Mushroom, Cassava, Banana, Cashew, Citrus, Cocoa Husk, Fish, Groundnut, Leather Tanning, Maize, Mango, Oil Palm, Plantain, Meat (Guinea Fowl), Meat (Poultry), Rice, Salt, Shea and Soya.

The Ghana Export Promotion Authority (GEPA)

During the year under review, the Authority:

- Facilitated the participation of 85 exporters from product associations in various international trade fairs and exhibitions in the first half of the year.

- Supported a number of businesses and exporters to participate and exhibit their products in the Fruit Logistica, MacFruit, and Ambiente Frankfurt Fairs in Germany.

- Organised the Horticulture Expo 2025 in collaboration with FAGE which saw over 200 local exhibitors participating in the expo. Sales worth US$5million was realised.

Ghana International Trade Commission

During the year under review, the Commission:

- Concluded a petition filed by APPEB Company Ltd. alleging price undercutting by Awarrior Ltd. in the domestic gas cylinder market. Both companies are major local manufacturers contributing to Ghana's energy supply chain.

- Submitted its semi-annual notification on dumping measures to the World Trade Organisation (WTO) for the year 2024. The notice was part of Ghana's obligation to provide transparency on its anti-dumping measures, pursuant to WTO Agreement on Antidumping

The National AfCFTA Coordination Office

During the year under review, the Office:

- Launched the Ghana NCO/UNDP Cooperation Project for Women and Youth-Led MSMEs in collaboration with the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). The initiative was to strengthen trade capacity for women and youth-led Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises by addressing regulatory compliance, ensuring adherence to AfCFTA Rules of Origin, and promoting market access through targeted expeditions and fairs.

- Organised two (2) regional dialogues in the Central and Volta regions, providing platforms for stakeholders to address region-specific challenges and devise strategies to enhance MSME participation in AfCFTA.

- Engaged key stakeholders and regulators to sensitise them on the imposition of 10 per cent baseline tariffs on Ghanaian exports to the US and keenly facilitated the Ghana-EU EPA Joint Committee meeting to ensure that Ghana maximises the benefits of the EPA. As part of showcasing Ghanaian products abroad and attract investment, the Ministry is currently participating in the World Expo 2025 in Osaka, Japan

Ghana Enterprises Agency (GEA)

During the year under review, the Agency:

- Generated employment for 250,000 people within the first half year, with 70 per cent being young women and 10 per cent persons with disabilities.

- Provided technical and entrepreneurial training to 79,910 practicing and potential entrepreneurs (mainly youth) nationwide

- Supplied start-up kits to 5,248 youth to establish businesses. Through the Rural Enterprises Programme disbursed US$444,000 to 1,246 Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises under Rural Enterprises Development Fund.

- Disbursed GH₵56,749,600.87 to 4,218 beneficiaries, including 1,950 males and 2,268 females, supporting MSME expansion nationwide.

- Allocated GH₵1,566,496.56 to 26 businesses and facilitated access to GH₵4,928,730.00 for 278 beneficiaries through strategic partnerships with financial institutions.

- Disbursed US$444,000 to 1,246 micro and small enterprises (MSEs), surpassing the target of 500, primarily to support working capital needs

Central Region Development (CEDECOM)

During the year under review, CEDECOM:

- Organised Entrepreneurship and management programs for 100 SMEs.

- Identified Lands for light industrial zones.

- Trained and supported 400 smallholders “Agripreneurs” in best practices for export.

- Established 12,000-seedling nursery.

Ghana Standards Authority

During the year under review, the Authority:

- Hosted the 18th General Assembly of the Intra Africa Metrology System (AFRIMETS) in Ghana under the theme ‘150 years of the Meter Convention: Prospects for Metrology within the African Continental Free Trade Area.

- Held a meeting with stakeholders from the textile and garment industries to discuss standards for the sector.

- Commissioned 300 trading standards inspectors to boost consumer protection

- Undertook inspections, surveillance, tests to Laboratories, Fishing Vessels and Establishments and carried out market surveillance

- Certified a number of locally manufactured products.

- Issued a number of Health and Export Certificates

2026 Budget Allocation to the Ministry

A total amount of eight hundred and forty-four million, five hundred and forty-one thousand, two hundred and forty-three Cedis (GH₵844,541,243.00) has been allocated for the services of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the 2026 Financial Year as shown in Table 2.

Table 2: 2026 Appropriation for the Ministry

Funding Sources	Compensation (GH¢)	Goods and Services (GH¢)	Capex (GH¢)	Total (GH¢)
GOG	148,460,285.00	25,173,606.00	205,000,000,00	378,633,891.00
IGF	69,168,565.00	267,146,281.00	79,332,906.00	415,647,752.00
DP Funds		50,259,600.00		50,259,600.00
Total	**217,628,850**	**342,579,487.00**	**284,332,906.00**	**844,541,243.00**

(Source: MOTI Programme Based Budget Estimates for 2026)

Summary Outlook of the Ministry

The Ministry will vigorously pursue the Rapid Industrialisation for Jobs Initiative aimed at accelerating industrial growth by promoting value addition for both domestic consumption and export. The initiative will focus on establishing strategic industries and reviving defunct ones to create jobs, stimulate economic growth and enhance Ghana’s competitive edge on the global market.

The Government, as part of its agenda to achieve industrial transformation, has identified modern textiles and garments manufacturing as a strategic industry, in terms of its potential to generate export revenue and create jobs on a large scale.

The Government through the Ministry will support the establishment of three (3) garment factories in collaboration with the private sector in the Bono East, Central and Eastern Regions. These are to operate in three shifts with the capacity to generate about 27,000 direct jobs; and improve the incomes and livelihoods of the communities.

The Ministry will develop and implement a five-year Trade Sector Support Programme and help Ghanaian firms to fully leverage opportunities under the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA).

The Ministry will facilitate the passage of Consumer Protection, Competition, and Business Regulatory Reform Bills to create a level playing field for entrepreneurs.

The Ministry will implement the Women in Trade, Agribusiness and Industry Programme to empower women entrepreneurs and provide support for women in cross-border trade among others. In line with this, the Ministry will develop a Policy for women in trade, agribusiness and industry.

The Ministry will structure and institutionalise a platform for sustained government-private sector engagements.

In 2026, large scale contract-commercial activities with high productivity will also be encouraged and supported through the implementation of the following programmes:

i. Feed the Industry Programme;

ii. Accelerated Export Development Programme (AEDP);

iii. National Apprenticeship Programme under GRATIS Foundation;

iv. Agribusiness;

v. Women in Trade, Agribusiness and Industry;

vi. Feed the Industry Programme;

vii. Made-In-Ghana Promotion;

viii. Rapid Industrialisation for Jobs;

ix. Free Apprenticeship Programme; and

x. The 24-Hour Economy policy.

Observations and Recommendations

Uncapping of Internally Generated Funds

The Committee was informed that the Internally Generated Funds (IGFs) of the Ministry and its agencies particularly, Ghana Standards Authority, Ghana Free Zones and Ghana Enterprises Agency had been capped and the capping severely restricts their operational efficiency.

The Ministry indicated that the capping limits the agencies' ability to upgrade their facilities, enforce regulatory compliance and drive innovation in their activities especially in a sector where growth is driven by product quality, market visibility and service improvement. In order to catch up with emerging trends, there was the need for the agencies to invest in modern equipment and technology. The Ministry therefore pleaded with Parliament to uncap their IGFs to enable them perform their functions effectively.

The Committee shared the concern of the Ministry and urged Government to take a second look at the capping of the Internally Generated Funds of the Ministry and its agencies. Where Government is unable to provide more resources to the Ministry, then there is the need to uncap the Ministry and its agencies' IGF to enable them reinvest same into their operations to improve service delivery and expand the scope of their development activities nationwide.

Enforcement & Industry Protection

The Committee was informed of the presence of substandard diapers, detergents, electrical cables etc, on the local market. These substandard imported products had flooded the market especially on rubber products and non-ferrous metals even though there were laws prohibiting their imports into the country. The Committee also noted that local manufacturers had formally notified the Ministry, particularly the Ghana International Trade Commission in a petition, about the presence of these substandard imports and their impact on local industry.

The Ministry admitted that their attention had been drawn to these worrying developments and that steps were being taken to address the situation.

The Committee urged the Ministry particularly the Ghana International Trade Commission to as a matter of urgency address petitions in respect of the influx of the substandard materials and the anti-dumping complaints. In order to protect local manufacturers, the Committee urged the Ministry to put in place stronger mechanisms to prevent these illegal products from finding their way into the country.

Greater Kumasi Industrial City & SEZ Project

The Committee observed that the Ministry was establishing a project at Boankra in the Ashanti Region known as the Greater Kumasi Industrial City (GKIC) and Special Economic Zones (SEZ) Project. The Project is sited on a 5,000-acre land with 3,383 acres earmarked for the GKIC & SEZ Project.

The Ministry informed the Committee that the GKIC & SEZ Project seeks to promote the social and economic development of Ghana, boosting the country's social and economic development. The Project, incorporating the Boankra Inland Port, will provide world class infrastructure for development.

The Committee urged the Ministry to ensure that issues relating to the land acquisition are dealt with including the payment of compensation to ensure timely completion of the project.

Feed-the-Industry Initiative

The Committee observed that the Ministry was implementing the "Feed - the-Industry Initiative" (FTI) and enquired about the object of the programme.

The Ministry informed the Committee that the FTI was an initiative focused on linking farmers to manufacturers for staples like maize, cassava and palm oil, using contract farming to ensure raw material supply and boost to local production. The project also aimed at reducing imports, creating jobs and driving industrial transformation through private sector investment in processing and storage. The goal is to transform Ghana's economy by ensuring food security and supplying industries with reliable raw materials thereby making Ghana a manufacturing hub.

The Committee shared in the vision of the Ministry and was of the view that if successfully implemented, the economy would see a major transformation. The Committee, however, expressed concern that there was the need for deliberate initiatives to support and build the capacity of local companies in order to produce the needed materials to feed industries.

The Committee indicated that in view of the importance of the project for economic development, it would follow up and report to the House the progress of the initiative.

Textile, Garment & Cotton Sector

The Committee observed that the AGOA initiative allowed Ghana to export certain products duty-free. One of such was the garment products. Unfortunately, the initiative had expired and Ghanaian companies that used to export their produce duty-free were no subject to 15 per cent tariffs. This was making exports to the USA unattractive. The impact of these developments was the decline in cotton production in the country.

Management explained that the expiration had adversely affected the textile and garment industry and that Government had started negotiations with the U.S. for renewal. However, in the meantime, Government is exploring other suitable alternatives both locally or internationally to ensure that the Garment Industry survives.

The Committee opined that the Ministry should adopt a value-chain approach to revitalise cotton production so as to integrate it with textiles, garments and being cognisant with the AfCFTA rules-of-origin requirements.

VAT on Vehicle Assembly & Manufacturing

The Committee observed that the Ghana Automobile Industry enjoyed certain incentives focused on boosting local assembly, offering tax breaks, duty rebates and supporting the growth of the use of Electric Vehicles with duty waivers, aiming to make Ghana a regional hub through reduced levies and local content rewards, among others.

The Committee was informed that the Ghana Automobile Industry was, however, not exempt from the payment of Value Added Tax (VAT). The imposition of the VAT tax was gradually crippling the Automobile industry and inhibiting the industry from being competitive and investment-friendly.

The Ministry indicated that it had engaged the Minister for Finance on the issue and that steps are being taken to address same. The Committee resolved that it would also engage the Minister for Finance to understand the issues involved and the way forward.

The 24-Hour Economy

The Committee observed that the 24-Hour Economy and Accelerated Export Development Programme (also called 24H+), was designed to boost productivity, create jobs, and enhance national competitiveness by maximising the use of infrastructure and human resources through multiple work shifts. It was to move Ghana from an import-dependent economy to one focused on value addition and exports.

The Committee expressed the opinion that one of the key agencies to support the realisation of the 24-hr economy was the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry. The Committee enquired whether the Ministry was partnering with the 24-hr Economy Secretariat to achieve its objectives.

The Ministry responded in the affirmative and indicated that it was a partner in respect of the 24-hour economy policy. The Committee called for a broader consultation on the policy in terms of industrial alignment and service availability in order to ensure its success.

Challenges

Accommodation Challenges

The Ministry informed the Committee that it did not have adequate office space to house its staff. The situation was adversely affecting the ability of staff to perform their duties.

The Committee was informed that the Ministry's Headquarters Building also suffer from structural defects which pose danger to occupants and put the Ministry in a bad light.

The Ministry explained that it was unable to address the situation due to inadequate resources and called on the Government to provide additional funding to enable the Ministry to remedy the situation.

Challenge on Regularisation of Appointments

The Ministry, again, informed the Committee that the appointment of some of the Trading Standards Officers of the Ghana Standards Authority was yet to be regularised. This was also impacting the work of the Authority. The Ministry, therefore, called on Parliament to urge the Government to expedite their appointment to enable them to perform their utmost best.

Conclusion

The Committee has examined the 2026 Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry and found the programmes for which the sums have been allocated to be appropriate and in line with the mandate of the Ministry and its Agencies.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this report and approve the sum of eight hundred and forty-four million, five hundred and forty-one thousand, two hundred and forty-three Cedis (GH₵844,541,243.00) for the implementation of the programmes and activities of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the 2026 Financial Year.

[The Speaker rises to be heard in silence pursuant to Standing Order 126 (2)]

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism on the allocation of the sum of GH₵844,541,243.00 for the services of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take item numbered 21. That is the Finance Committee.

The Speaker: Hon Member, item numbered 21 on the *Order Paper,* Motion. Chairman of the Committee.

MINISTRY OF FINANCE

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Finance Committee on the allocation of the sum of GH₵4,671,386,737.00 for the services of the Ministry of Finance for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

The Speaker: Who moved the Motion? I did not get the name of the person who moved the Motion. Please, let us capture it properly.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Deputy Minister for Finance moved the Motion so that the Chairman of the Finance Committee will second and present the report of the Committee.

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion whilst I present your Committee's Report. I call on the *Hansard* Department to capture the entire report as having been read to approve the sum of GH₵4,671,386,737.00.

Introduction

On Thursday, 13th November, 2025, the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson presented to Parliament the Budget Statement and Economic Policy for the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 195(2) of Parliament.

Subsequent to the presentation, the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Finance was referred to the Finance Committee for consideration and report in accordance with Standing Order 195(4) and 226 of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Referral, met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem and the technical team of the Ministry and its agencies. The Committee is grateful to them for honouring the invitation and assisting in its deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during its deliberations:

i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana

ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament

iii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year.

iv. Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (Programme Based Budget Estimates for 2025) of the Ministry of Finance

v. Report of the Finance Committee on the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Finance for the 2025 Financial Year

vi. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921)

Establishment

The Ministry of Finance (MoF) is one of the Central Management Agencies of the Civil Service of Ghana. The Ministry was established under Sections 11 and 13 of the Civil Service Law 1993 (PNDCL 327) and amended by the Civil Service (Ministries) (Amendment) Instrument, 2017 (E.I. 28).

Agencies Under the Ministry

The Ministry has responsibility over the under-listed Departments and Agencies:

i. Controller and Accountant General's Department (CAGD)

ii. Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA)

iii. Ghana Statistical Service (GSS)

iv. Public Procurement Authority (PPA)

v. Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC)

vi. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)

vii. Institute of Accountancy Training (IAT)

viii. Internal Audit Agency (IAA)

ix. State Interest and Governance Authority (SIGA)

x. Independent Tax Appeals Board (ITAB)

The Ministry also exercises oversight over some institutions, including the following:

i. Development Bank Ghana

ii. Minerals Income Investment Fund

iii. Ghana Infrastructure Investment Fund

iv. Ghana Amalgamated Trust PLC

v. GIRSAL

vi. Ghana Commodity Exchange

vii. Ghana Deposit Protection Corporation

Goal and Core Functions

The goal of the Ministry is to ensure efficient and effective management of the economy towards the attainment of upper-middle income status and poverty reduction. The core functions of the Ministry are as follows:

i. Formulate, implement, monitor and evaluate macroeconomic, fiscal and financial policies for sustainable development

ii. Ensure effective mobilisation of domestic and external resources

iii. Ensure efficient and effective allocation and prudent management of resources

iv. Establish and disseminate performance-oriented guidelines and deploy efficient financial management information systems

v. Ensure commitment to transparency, probity and accountability in the management of financial resources

vi. Ensure sustainability of public debt

vii. Develop an efficient financial sector that supports structural transformation of the economy, promotes financial inclusion and is well-integrated into the global financial system

Approved Budget Allocations and Fund Releases to the Ministry for 2025

To ensure the effective implementation of the programmes and objectives of the Ministry, a sum of GH₵3,616,702,370.00 was approved for the Sector for 2025. The breakdown of the total amount approved and actual releases for the year are respectively presented in Tables 1 and 2 below:

Table 1: Analysis of the Approved Budget Allocations of the Ministry for 2025

	SOURCES OF FUNDS									
EXPENDITURE ITEM (X)	**GOG**	**% (X/Y*100)**	**IGF**	**% (X/Y*100)**	**ABFA**	**%**	**DONOR (FGL)**	**% (X/Y*100)**	**TOTAL**	**%**
COMPENSATION	942,102,324	*83.26*	40,612,877	5.17					**982,715,201**	**27.17**
GOODS AND SERVICES	122,011,900	*10.78*	692,912,535	88.17			1,413,536,000	*83.2*	**2,228,460,435**	**61.62**
CAPITAL EXPENDITURE (CAPEX)	67,470,412	*5.96*	52,317,322	6.66			285,739,000	*16.8*	**405,526,734**	**11.21**
TOTAL (Y)	**1,131,584,636**	***100***	**785,842,734**	***100***			**1,699,275,000**	***100***	**3,616,702,370**	***100***
%	***31.29***		***21.73***				***46.98***		***100***	

Source of Absolute figures: Ministry of Finance

Currency: Ghana Cedi (GH₵)

Table 2: Actual Fund Releases to the Ministry from its Approved Budget Allocations for 2025 by Agencies

Agency	**Total Approved Budget**	**Release**	**Actual Expenditure**	**% Released**
Ministry of Finance HQ	2,004,279,030.00	973,189,826.19	895,118,428.42	48.56
Controller and Accountant General's Department	735,542,424.00	632,510,869.35	629,100,895.66	85.99

Ghana Statistical Service	237,581,966.00	160,500,703.20	152,916,184.00	67.56
Public Procurement Authority	22,913,564.00	17,280,754.92	17,280,754.92	75.42
Institute of Accountancy Training	12,519,256.00	7,255,449.58	3,619,214.56	57.95
Securities and Exchange Commission	73,882,240.00	46,887,671.00	46,887,671.00	63.46
Independent Tax Appeals Board (ITAB)	4,835,920.00	1,700,977.66	627,172.62	35.17
Ghana Revenue Authority	462,103,197.00	346,577,397.80	346,577,397.80	75
Financial Intelligence Centre	5,352,220.00	3,409,760.79	3,407,757.59	63.71
State Interest and Governance Authority	30,348,360.00	25,789,870.04	17,516,534.31	84.98
Internal Audit Agency	27,344,194.00	16,558,665.02	16,558,665.02	60.56
TOTAL	**3,616,702,370.00**	**2,231,661,945.55**	**2,129,610,675.90**	61.7

Source of Absolute Figures: Ministry of Finance and all its Agencies
Currency: Ghana Cedi (GH₵)

Key Achievements/Performance of the Ministry for 2025

Management and Administration Programme

In 2025, the Ministry developed its Sector Medium-Term Development Plan (SMTDP) for 2026-2029 in accordance with the Medium-Term National Development Policy Framework (2026-2029). The SMTDP provides the strategic foundation for implementing effective economic policies, focusing on macroeconomic stability, sustainable growth, sound fiscal policies, and efficient public financial management.

Economic Policy Management Programme

The Ministry conducted fiscal impact assessments on key legislations, including amendments to the Cocoa Board, Petroleum Revenue Management, Minerals Income Investment Fund, Energy Sector Levies, Public Procurement Authority, and Public Financial Management Acts. The Ministry also carried out risk analyses on COCOBOD's request for government support and on judgment debt exposures, ensuring that potential fiscal risks were recognised and mitigation strategies proposed.

As part of the Government's Resetting Agenda for the financial sector, a comprehensive restructuring framework was initiated to restore distressed state-owned banks to financial sustainability. In 2025, the Government recapitalised the National Investment Bank (NIB) with about GH₵1.9 billion. The Government also developed an Overall Reform Strategy to recapitalise and strengthen other state-owned and state-interest banks.

The Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC) advanced Ghana's Anti-Money Laundering, Combatting Financing of Terrorism, Counter Proliferation Financing (AML/CFT/CPF) framework in 2025 through key institutional, policy and capacity-building measures. The Inter-Ministerial Committee on AML/CFT was constituted and the National and Sectoral Risk Assessments and the National AML/CFT/CPF Policy and Strategic Plan (2025-2029) were adopted for submission to Le Groupe Intergouvernemental d'Action contre le Blanchiment d'Argent en Afrique de l'Ouest (GIABA) translated as the Inter-Governmental Action Group against Money Laundering in West Africa.

The Ghana Statistical Service completed eight cycles of the Ghana Living Standards Survey Round 8 (GLSS8), data collection for the Accommodation Units Survey, the Informal Cross-Border Trade Survey and the Integrated Business Establishment Survey Phase II. These efforts provide crucial inputs for rebasing Ghana's national accounts and improving the accuracy of the country's economic indicators. The Ghana Statistical Service also published and disseminated a wide range of analytical reports. They include 17 thematic reports from the 2021 Population and Housing Census, three volumes of IBES Phase I reports, the Ghana National Human Development

Report, quarterly labour statistics, and district-level rankings of micro-indicators.

Resource Mobilisation and Management Programme

In 2025, a series of Revenue Bills were presented by the Ministry to Parliament for passage into law. They include amendments to the Income Tax, VAT, Minerals Income Investment Fund, Growth and Sustainability Levy, Energy Sector Levies and Public Procurement Acts.

The Ministry, in collaboration with the IMF, GRA and other key stakeholders initiated a comprehensive review of the Value Added Tax (VAT) regime to propose reforms with a draft Bill submitted to Parliament and passed. The Revenue Assurance, Compliance and Enforcement (RACE) Initiative uncovered discrepancies in shipping line audits, identifying tax liabilities of over GH₵400 million, while assurance exercises on Import Declaration Forms resulted in additional recoveries.

Expenditure Management Programme

The Controller and Accountant General's Department (CAGD) migrated the Appiah Minkah University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurship Development (AMUSTED) onto the National Payroll, covering 674 staff. In addition, CAGD achieved integration between Ghana Integrated Financial Management Information System (GIFMIS) and Ghana Electronic Procurement System (GHANEPS). Furthermore, 549 education and health institutions were migrated onto GIFMIS, marking significant progress toward achieving complete sector coverage.

As part of expenditure control and prevention of arrears accumulation, the GHANEPS was made mandatory for all public entities. Out of a target of 900, the PPA enrolled 891 Procuring Entities on the platform, with 405 actively conducting procurement activities through the platform. By September 2025, 500 entities had published procurement plans, 7,379 tenders were advertised and 11,426 contracts were awarded and published, reflecting a significant improvement in transparency, accountability and record-keeping.

The Public Procurement Authority also completed the 2021-2023 Annual Procurement Assessment for 787 entities, while rigorous value-for-money reviews of Single Source and Restricted Tendering requests delivered savings of over GH₵901 million. Additionally, 455 practitioners received training in procurement audits, contract administration, and tender preparation, further strengthening institutional capacity.

Public Debt Management Programme

In 2025 the Ministry advanced its mandate to enhance transparency and accountability within Ghana's debt management framework. A notable milestone was the preparation and publication of the 2024 Annual Public Debt Report, which provided a comprehensive account of the nation's debt stock, composition and key sustainability indicators.

The Ministry also prepared the 2025 Annual Borrowing and Recovery Plan, aligning financing requirements with repayment obligations and prevailing market conditions. In addition, the timely dissemination of debt statistics through the publication of the 4th Quarter of the 2024 Statistical Bulletin underscored Ghana's commitment to data transparency and further strengthened investor confidence.

Budget Allocation for the Ministry for 2026

To ensure the effective implementation of the programmes and objectives of the Ministry, a sum of GH₵4,671,386,737.00 has been allocated to the Sector for 2026. The breakdown of the total budgetary allocation is presented in Table 3 as follows:

Table 3: Analysis of the Budget Allocation for the Ministry for 2026 by Items and Sources

7	SOURCES OF FUNDS									
EXPENDITURE ITEM (X)	**GOG**	**% (X/Y*100)**	**IGF**	**% (X/Y*100)**	**ABFA**	**% (X/Y*100)**	**DONOR (FGL)**	**% (X/Y*100)**	**TOTAL**	**%**
COMPENSATION	1,224,337,897	*70.00*	174,702,736	*16.13*					**1,399,040,633**	***29.95***
GOODS AND SERVICES	487,374,055	*27.86*	762,514,155	*70.42*			1,721,404,695	*93.58*	**2,971,292,905**	***63.61***
CAPITAL EXPENDITURE (CAPEX)	37,470,412	*2.14*	145,578,638	*13.45*			118,004,149	*6.42*	**301,053,199**	***6.44***
TOTAL (Y)	**1,749,182,364**	***100***	**1,082,795,529**	***100***			**1,839,408,844**	***100***	**4,671,386,737**	***100***
%	***37.44***		***23.18***				***39.38***		***100***	

Source of Absolute figures: Ministry of Finance Currency: Ghana Cedi (GH₵)

Outlook for 2026

To enhance public asset governance, the Ministry will roll-out the Fixed Asset Register Framework nationwide in 2026, paving the way for a National Assets Register. A new Integrated Bank of Projects (IBP) will also be launched to centralise the database of all public investment projects. Together, these systems will improve accountability, reduce duplication and ensure value for money in infrastructure spending.

In 2026, the Ministry, in collaboration with industry stakeholders, will develop a 10-Year Insurance Master Plan (IMP) to transform the insurance industry into a growth catalyst and enhance resilience against systemic shocks.

To protect livelihoods against climate shocks, the Ministry procured a sovereign drought insurance policy under the African Risk Capacity for the 2025/2026 farming season. The policy will provide rapid financial relief for smallholder farmers in northern Ghana during severe droughts. In 2026, Ghana will also adopt a Parametric Flood Insurance Scheme for the Greater Accra Metropolitan Area, protecting 1.2 million vulnerable residents from flood-related disasters.

Domestic revenue mobilisation remained central to Ghana's fiscal turnaround. The Ministry enacted key amendments to the Income Tax, VAT and Energy Sector Levies Acts, and launched the Revenue Assurance, Compliance and Enforcement (RACE) Initiative, which uncovered discrepancies in shipping documentation worth over GH₵400 million. In 2026, Ghana's tax code, including Income Tax, Excise, and Customs Duty Acts, will be reviewed to improve fairness and efficiency.

The integration of GIFMIS and GHANEPS continues to enhance real-time expenditure tracking. By September 2025, 549 education and health institutions had migrated onto GIFMIS. The Controller and Accountant-General's Department (CAGD) will complete the linkage between the National Identification Authority database and the National Payroll System to eliminate ghost names and reduce payroll fraud.

Observations and Recommendations

The Ministry and All Its Agencies

Total and Compensation Budget for the Ministry and all its Agencies

The Committee noted that the total budget of the Ministry and its agencies increased from GH₵3,616,702,370 for 2025 to GH₵4,671,386,737 for 2026 and the difference which is GH₵1,054,684,367 translates into 29.16 % of the amount for 2025 (the percentage increment). The Committee was informed that the increase is partly attributable to an increase in the Compensation budget which also resulted from the inclusion of the 9% salary increment announced by the Government and also allowances to be paid to the staff of some of the agencies under the Ministry. The Compensation budget for the Ministry and all its agencies has increased from GH₵982,715,201 for 2025 to GH₵1,399,040,633 for 2026 and that is a 42.36% increase over the amount for 2025.

Macro-Fiscal Performance of the Ministry

The Committee noted the macro-fiscal performance of the Ministry indicated in Table 4 below:

Table 4: Some Economic Performance Indicatiors as at October 2025 relative to the same period in 2024

Some Economic Indicators	**2024 Actual**	**2025 Actual**
Economic Growth	5.7	4.0
Inflation	23.8	8.0
Food Inflation	*27.8*	*9.7*
Non-Food Inflation	*20.3*	*6.9*
Overall Real GDP Growth	4.8	6.3
Primary Balance (on commitment basis)	-3.0	1.6
Non-Tax Oil Revenue (as a percentage of GDP)	7.8	8.7
Public Debt to GDP ratio	68.9	45.0
GSE Composite Index Year-on-Year Return	22.3	27.8
Exchange Rate	17	11.3
Cedi Appreciation	-27.1	42.6

Source: Ministry of Finance Units of Measurement: Percentages

The Committee noted that the Bank of Ghana, in response to the sound economic policies being undertaken by the Ministry, also reduced the Monetary Policy Rate from 28 per cent in 2024 to 21.5 per cent in 2025. The Committee observed that due to effective oversight by the Ministry of Finance, Ghana's capital market demonstrated resilience in 2025, with total funds under management rising to GHS85.53 billion, a 10 per cent quarter-on-quarter increase.

According to the Ministry, the achievements shown on Table 4 afore, were as a result of deliberate choices anchored in sound economic management, institutional discipline and unyielding commitment to the people of Ghana.

Ministry of Finance – Headquarters

Submission of Performance Report on Budget Implementation by the Ministry to Parliament

The Committee observed that the Ministry of Finance occasionally did not comply with Section 27 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2019 (Act 921) which requires Principal Account Holders and for that matter covered entities, to submit Performance Reports on Budget Implementation for the preceding year within the first quarter of the ensuing year. The submission of such reports enables Parliament to have a better view of actual releases and expenditures for the fourth quarter of the covered entities and for that matter, the full one-year period which could not be made available to the House for consideration by the Committee during the budget hearing.

The Committee therefore recommends that the Ministry submits the Performance Reports on Budget Implementation as required by the Law.

Internal Audit Agency

Inability to Embark on Field Visits

It came to the attention of the Committee that, the Internal Audit Agency (IAA) was unable to embark on field visits to monitor and evaluate the Internal Audit Units (IAU) of MDAs and MMDAs due to inadequate funds. In total, an amount of GH₵9,403,400.00 was appropriated to IAA to cater for Goods and Services but it was only able to receive GH₵4,243,504.19 which constitutes 45.13 per cent. Monitoring and evaluation forms part of the mandate of IAA and it helps in risk management and in the identification of lapses in our financial controls systems in order to devise remedies for improvement.

In 2026, the Agency has identified some key activities in line with its strategic plan to support in ensuring efficient and effective management of public resources and compliance with Act 921 and other relevant legislations.

It is also seeking to strengthen internal audit practices, enhancing accountability and improving public financial management across covered entities. The activities are structured quarterly and it includes the following:

i. Nationwide monitoring and follow-up on the implementation of audit recommendations

ii. Capacity-building for IAUs and Audit Committees

iii. Rollout of the Enterprise Risk Management

iv. Training on Commitment Control Compliance

v. Onsite technical support and periodic stakeholder engagements

vi. Visibility and communication activities

vii. Maintenance of the IAA website

Significant budget provisions would be needed to carry out the activities outlined afore; and also enable IAA support to the audit committees and assist in the investigation of financial impropriety and special audits. Allocations to the Agency for 2026 in respect of Goods and Services is GH₵10 million and it says part of the money would be used to engage internal auditors on the field in order to finalise a draft Bill for reforms to enhance its role

The Committee recommends that more funds be release to IAA to enable it execute its mandate effective since the Agency forms an integral part of our financial management system.

GHANA REVENUE AUTHORITY
(GRA)

Summary of Tax Revenue Performance for 2025

The Committee observed that as at October 2025, the Domestic Tax Revenue Division (DTRD) of the Ghana Revenue Authority had collected a non-oil tax revenue of GH₵102 billion as against a target of GH₵100.5 billion for the period. In the same period, the Customs Division (CD) collected a non-oil tax revenue of GH₵42.7 billion as against a target of GH₵45.3 billion and that was partly as a result of the reduction in the exchange rate.

The Commissioner-General however opined that with the reduction in the exchange rate, cost of doing business is expected to also reduce and when that happens, businesses will earn more and pay more taxes. The Committee shares his view.

The Committee further observed that total collection of non-oil tax revenue for the period amounted to GH₵144.7 billion as against a target of GH₵145.8 billion. Non-oil tax revenue collected by DTRD grew by 22.5 per cent which is beyond its target of 20.8 per cent and collection of same by CD grew by 17.5 per cent which is below its target of 24.8 per cent.

Overall non-oil tax revenue collected by the two Divisions of GRA, grew by 21 per cent as against a target of 22 per cent. The Commissioner-General was however of the strong conviction that the Authority will be able to meet its target at the end of 2025. Out of the total non-oil tax revenue collected during the period, the portion collected by DTRD constituted 70.5 per cent and the portion collected by CD contributed 29.5 per cent.

Tax to GDP Ratio

The Committee was informed that even though our tax to GDP ratio is currently hovering around 14 per cent, it is expected to improve to about 18 to 20 per cent with the introduction of the modified taxation system expected to address the challenges in the collection of taxes in the informal sector. According to the Commissioner-General, GRA is dealing with some structural issues to improve efficiency in the collection of taxes to address issues including the gap between filing of tax returns and payment of tax.

He also informed the Committee that the Authority is intensifying measures including its collaboration with the Registrar of Companies and the Social Security and National Insurance Trust to flash out new entrants in business who would not want to pay tax. The Committee was further informed that the Authority is carrying out extensive sensitisation and education with the use of our local dialects where it is deemed fit.

The Committee recommends that GRA continues to execute its mandate effectively to raise more revenue to government for national development.

CONTROLLER AND ACCOUNTANT-GENERAL'S DEPARTMENT (CAGD)

Non-usage of GIFMIS

Non-usage of GIFMIS by some institutions pose a challenge to government. As the House is aware, the System among other merits, promotes transparency and efficiency in the public sector, improves procurement management and cracks down on financial malpractices and wasteful public spending.

The Committee recommends that government put in place the needed infrastructure to enable all governance institutions use GIFMIS to achieve the benefits of the System.

Ghana Statistical Service (GSS)

Staffing and Funding Challenges

The Committee observed that GSS has a staff strength of 258, one-half of the number it requires and for that matter, made provision for recruitment and that was accepted by the Ministry of Finance in the 2026 Budget. As a result, an amount of GH₵32,133,500.00 has been budgeted for Compensation in 2026 which is a 64 per cent increase over the 2025 amount of GH₵19,594,426.00. The Committee was informed that GSS relied heavily on National Service Persons because it does not have the needed staff strength.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance provides GSS with more resources to enable it execute its mandate effectively.

Public Procurement Authority

Visibility and Annual Procurement Assessment

The Committee observed that out of the 16 Regions of the Country, PPA has offices in only three (3) of them. It was however indicated that in 2026, as part of its efforts to expand its operations and also improve visibility, the Authority intends opening 2 new zonal offices – one in Tamale and another in Ho. The Committee also observed that PPA will conduct the 2025 Annual Procurement Assessment and promote Sustainable Public Procurement (SPP) through legislative updates and awareness campaigns.

The Committee was informed that PPA experiences high attrition due to poor conditions of service and for that matter has low staff strength.

Despite the bottlenecks, PPA's interventions including Annual Procurement Assessments, training programmes and issuance of guidelines led to a savings of about GH₵900 million.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance find ways of resourcing PPA to help maintain its staff, get needed logistics and set-up more offices to enable the Authority execute its mandate effectively including value-for-money audits.

Institute of Accountancy Training

Legal Backing and Capacity

The Committee was informed that the Institute of Accountancy Training (IAT) depends highly on part-time and small number of seconded staff and that adversely affects institutional continuity and loyalty and hampers meaningful academic contributions. The Committee was also informed that absence of institutional and programme accreditation has resulted in limited public visibility and low student enrolment.

The Committee is aware that IAT lacks formal legal mandate and that constraints its institutional authority, autonomy and long-term stability and that to some extent, explains the reason it is experiencing other challenges, some mentioned afore.

The Committee has time and again recommended that the Institute should be given legal backing to enable it overcome its challenges and operate in full capacity to make more revenue for government.

Financial Intelligence Centre (Fic)

Anti-Money Laundering and Counter Financing of Terrorism

The Committee noted that the Financial Intelligence Centre's collaboration with the Ghana Revenue Authority led to the recovery of GH₵2.06 million from tax-related financial crimes.

In 2026, Ghana will undergo its third FATF/GIABA Mutual Evaluation, with FIC leading implementation of the National AML/CFT Policy to improve compliance, supervision and enforcement. The evaluation is to conduct national risk assessment among other objectives.

Recommendations by FATF is crucial in assessing the international capital markets and the consequences of being grey-listed or black-listed as a country is dire. It includes lack of investor confidence and other severe economic consequences. it was therefore gratifying to get an assurance that, through the relentless efforts of FIC, the Country is ready for the mutual evaluation and will not be grey-listed or black-listed. The Committee recommends that FIC collaborates with the Bank of Ghana and Securities and Exchange Commission in the area of virtual assets to get easy access to data in that respect to enhance its operations.

Securities and Exchange Commission

Regulatory Gaps

The Committee was informed that in addition to the Virtual Assets Bill, 2025 currently before Parliament, a new Securities Industry Bill will also be introduced for passage to replace the Securities Industry Act, 2016 (Act 929) to deal with regulatory gaps of the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC). The two Bills when passed into law, will enhance the work of SEC to cover particularly, the virtual space.

Revenue Generation

The Committee was informed that in 2025, the Commission, with the expectation of getting legal backing to collect fees on pension funds under management, projected to collect an amount of GH₵25 million. With the passage of the Fees and Charges (Miscellaneous Provisions) (Amendment) Regulations, 2025 by Parliament now, it envisages to collect an amount of GH₵50 million in 2026 from that source.

Independent Tax Appeals Board

Delay in the Execution of Mandate

It would be recalled that a body named Independent Tax Appeals Board (ITAB) was established by the enactment of the Revenue Administration (Amendment) Act 2020 (Act 1029) with the mandate to hear and determine appeals against decisions of the Commissioner-General of GRA on tax assessments and related matters within 30 days. The Board is supposed to serve as an impartial platform for tax dispute resolution.

The Committee was informed that even though ITAB was inaugurated in January 2023, is yet to become fully operational due to staffing and logistical challenges. The Board informed the Committee that it did not have the full complement of staff to commence work and the few available were on secondment.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance assists ITAB to deal with its staffing and logistical challenges to become fully operational since cases have already been referred to it and rulings were pending.

STATE INTERESTS AND GOVERNANCE AUTHORITY

Staffing and Logistical Challenges

The Committee observed that the State Interests and Governance Authority (SIGA) has staffing, logistical as well as office accommodation challenges and is also unable to invest in technology such as Real Time Monitoring and Document Management Systems due to inadequacy of funds. The Authority suffers high attrition and therefore does not have the required number of staff to work with, particularly professionals. It also operates in a building which needs extensive renovation or redevelopment.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance make more resources available to SIGA to enable it deal with its staffing and logistical challenges and deliver on its mandate.

Conclusion

The Committee has examined the 2026 Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Finance and its agencies and found the programmes for which the sums have been allocated, to be appropriate and in line with its mandate.

The Committee, after thorough deliberations, recommends that the House adopts its report and approve the sum of GH₵4,671,386,737.00 for the implementation of the programmes and activities of the Ministry of Finance and its Agencies for the 2026 Financial Year.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the report of the Finance Committee on the allocation of the sum of GH₵4,671,386,737.00 for the services of the Ministry of Finance for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take item numbered 17.

MINISTRY OF FOOD AND AGRICULTURE

Chairperson of the Committee (Dr Godfred Seidu Jasaw): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity. I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the allocation of the sum of GH₵3,037,594, 607.00 for the services of the Ministry of Finance for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Speaker, allow me to present your Committee's Report. I invite with your leave, Mr Speaker for Hansard to capture the full content of this report as if it was read in its entirety. A lot has been done and so the Committee accordingly recommends that the House accordingly adopts its report to approve a sum of GH₵3,037,594,607.00.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial year was presented to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution of Ghana.

Pursuant to Orders 195(4) and 239 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Estimates which relate to the Ministry of Food and Agriculture (MOFA) to the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs for consideration and report to the House.

Deliberations

The Committee convened on Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025, and considered the 2025 Budget Estimates for the Ministry of Food and Agriculture. Attendees included the Minister in charge of Food and Agriculture, Hon Eric Opoku, and technical officers from the Ministry as well as officials from the Ministry of Finance.

The Committee offers its profound appreciation to the Honourable Minister and his technical team, as well as the Ministry of Finance, for their enriching insights and professional clarifications.

In furtherance of the principles of the Open Parliament initiative, the Committee also extended an invitation to some Civil Society Organisations (CSOs), including the Association of Ghana Rice Producers and Processors, the Vegetable Producers and Exporters Association of Ghana (VPEAG), Peasant Farmers Association of Ghana, and the Chamber of Agribusiness, Ghana (CAG).

Reference Materials

The Committee referred to the following documents during the consideration of the Budget Estimates:

i. The 1992 Constitution of Ghana;

ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;

iii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 financial year;

iv. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 financial year;

v. Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs for the 2025 Financial year; and

vi. The Medium-Term Expenditure Framework for 2026-2029 for the Ministry of Food and Agriculture.

Policy Objectives of the Ministry

The National Medium-Term Development Policy Framework (NMTDPF) Policy Objectives for the Agricultural Development are:

i. Create an enabling agribusiness environment;

ii. Improve Public-Private Investments in the Agricultural Sector;

iii. Modernised and enhanced agricultural production systems;

iv. Improve post-harvest management;

v. Promote agriculture as a viable business among the youth; and

vi. Promote livestock and poultry development.

Goal

The Ministry exists to promote sustainable agriculture and a thriving agribusiness through research and technology development, effective extension, and other support services to farmers, processors and traders for improved livelihood.

Core Functions of the Ministry

The core functions of MOFA are to:

i. Plan and advise the Government on agricultural development policies, administration, and management of the agricultural sector of the economy;

ii. Monitor and evaluate the agricultural sector on developments in crops, livestock, irrigation, and mechanisation;

iii. Develop agricultural programmes and projects;

iv. Collaborate in agricultural research; and

v. Ensure compliance with food safety, seed certification and agricultural input standards.

2025 Performance

Financial Performance

During the year under review, a total sum of GH₵2,904,904,981 was allocated to finance the implementation of programmes and projects of the Ministry. An amount of GH₵925,101,495 representing 31.85 per cent out of the approved budget had been released as of November 2025.

Table 1 below provides the detailed performance of the budgetary allocations to the Ministry during the year under review:

Table 1: Summary of Expenditure by Economic Classification (2025)

Financial Performance (January to November 2025)						
	Item	**2025 Approved Budget**	**2025 Adjusted Budget**	**Releases**	**Actual Expenditure**	**Variance**
		(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E=B-C)
1	**Compensation**	226,613,456	226,613,455	157,400,722	157,400,722	69,212,733
2	**Goods and Services**	1,451,152,897	1,291,152,897	713,991,143	297,503,106	577,161,754
	o/w GoG	844,776,265	684,776,265	551,506,863	140,773,983	734,082,282
	ABFA	-	-	-	-	-
	IGF	22,694,442	22,694,442	5,432,461	4,157,972	17,261,981
	DP Funds	*583,682,190*	*583,682,190*	*157,051,819*	*152,571,151*	*426,630,371*
3	**CAPEX**	1,227,138,629	1,387,138,629	53,709,630	53,320,788	1,333,428,999
	o/w GoG	505,000,000	665,000,000			
	ABFA	-	-	-	-	-
	IGF	6,962,956	6,962,956	388,842	-	6,574,114
	DP Funds	715,175,673	715,175,673	53,320,788	53,320,788	661,854,884
	TOTAL	**2,904,904,982**	**2,904,904,981**	**925,101,495**	**508,224,616**	**1,979,803,486**

Programme Performance for 2025

The Ministry of Food and Agriculture implements four (4) main programmes under the Programmed Based Budgeting of the country. The programmes are further categorised into sub-programmes. The expected outcomes and achievements under the various programmes and their corresponding sub-programmes are provided below.

Management and Administration

The Programme seeks to improve institutional coordination within the Ministry of Food and Agriculture and other relevant ministries, departments and agencies (MDAs), strengthen institutions within the Ministry, and strengthen policy, planning, monitoring and evaluation in the agricultural sector.

Some of the successes recorded in 2025 under the Management and Human Resource Programme include the following:

i. A state-of-the-art soil testing equipment was procured with support from the Food and Agriculture Organisation of the United Nations for rehabilitation of the Kumasi Soil Laboratory to meet international standards;

ii. 150 motorbikes were procured and delivered to facilitate the mobility of Agricultural Extension Agents (AEAs);

iii. 400 AEA's are being recruited as Feed Ghana District Coordinators;

iv. 10,000 youth are being enrolled on the National Service Scheme under a four-year programme to augment the depleting number of AEA's;

v. 70,000+ Community Commodity Farmer Cooperatives were registered;

vi. The Ministry organised two agriculture-related national and international shows;

vii. Trained a total of 959 staff in both in-service training and local courses, and 20 staff had foreign training;

viii. Trained a total of 1,031 value chain actors;

ix. Conducted 11 monitoring on projects and programmes;

x. Organised 2 internal budget hearings;

xi. Registered 15,756 farmers on the GHAAP;

xii. Disseminated 200 agricultural facts and figures;

xiii. Published the Annual Agriculture in Ghana Facts and Figures;

xiv. Disseminated 39 weekly Market prices report;

xv. Produced 39 weekly agricultural commodity price analyses;

xvi. Produced one quarterly food situation report;

xvii. Initiated the procurement of works, machinery, and equipment for the construction of 50 Farmer Services Centres in 50 districts to improve access to mechanisation services;

xviii. Completed the procurement process for the construction of poultry processing factory at Bechem; and

xix. Achieved 20 per cent completion in respect of the drilling of 642 solar powered mechanised boreholes to irrigate 285ha of land for vegetable production across the country.

Crops and Livestock Development

The priorities of the Ministry in the area of Crops and Livestock development are to reduce food and nutrition insecurity through modernised agriculture, maintain national strategic stock for emergencies, provide job opportunities for the teeming youth in agriculture, and introduce productivity in the agricultural sector through the adoption of improved technology.

In this regard, the Ministry recorded some remarkable achievements during the year under review, as indicated in the following sub-programmes:

Production and Productivity Improvement

In pursuit of enhanced food security, economic resilience, and sustainable agricultural development, the production and productivity sub-program focused on empowering farmers, strengthening value chains, and promoting climate-smart practices. The following milestones were achieved:

i. The Korea Programme on International Agriculture (KOPIA) supported the production and distribution of 300 tons of Agyapa Rice seed developed by the Council for Scientific and Industrial Research;

ii. Developed and deployed a modern platform (Event Mobile Application Plus (EMA-i+)) to strengthen early detection and rapid response to livestock diseases;

iii. Procured and distributed 133mt of tomato seeds;

iv. Procured and distributed 150,000 kg of fertilizers;

v. Distributed 50,000 mt of fertilisers to farmers;

vi. Distributed 3,133 mt of improved seeds;

vii. Procured 2 million broilers and 1 million layers to be distributed to 60,000 farmers;

viii. Launched the Nkoko nketenkete programme and procured 500,000 kruoilers for delivery to 10,000 households;

ix. Locally produced 2.7 million veterinary vaccines;

x. Promoted food safety through public health by conducting 316 public education campaigns and educating 27,829 school children on animal health and zootonic diseases;

xi. Inspected and certified 48,945 quantities of meat for human and animal consumption;

xii. Administered 17.7 million doses to animals excluding poultry and aquaculture;

xiii. Conducted a total number of 382,975 visits to farms and homes;

xiv. Visited 5,203,277 farms and other agricultural value chain actors;

xv. Established 6,456 field demonstrations;

xvi. Established 60,101 cooperatives /FBOs;

xvii. Organised training sessions for 5,788 farmer groups and FBOs;

xviii. Trained 610 cooperatives on new technologies;

xix. Organised 902 AEA trainings on market-oriented approach;

xx. Disseminated 510 improved technologies;

xxi. Disseminated 468 Climate Smart Agricultural Practices;

xxii. Got 503,110 farmers to use climate-smart agricultural practices;

xxiii. 382,975 farmers benefited from assessing extension services;

xxiv. 2,487 farmers participated in RELC planning sessions;

xxv. Recorded 324 private seed companies which supply certified seeds;

xxvi. Produced 31,350 mt of certified seeds;

xxvii. Recorded 13,180 ha under certified seed cultivation;

xxviii. Produced 640.56 mt quantity of foundation seeds;

xxix. Produced 58 mt of breeder seeds;

xxx. 24 feeds were sampled and tested;

xxxi. Technically supported 225 farmers; and

xxxii. Gave 266 waivers on livestock input.

Mechanisation, Irrigation, and Water Management

To modernise agriculture and enhance resilience, the Ministry focused on expanding irrigation infrastructure, promoting mechanisation services, and building technical capacity. Key achievements recorded included the following:

i. Developed 17,995.85 ha of land under formal irrigation;

ii. Cultivated 3.27 per cent of land under irrigation;

iii. Supported 120 individuals and enterprises with mechanisation services; and

iv. Trained 726 operators, mechanics, and AMSEC Managers on the proper use of farm machinery and equipment.

Postharvest Management and Marketing

To reduce postharvest losses and stabilise commodity supply, the Ministry significantly bolstered national storage infrastructure by constructing 69 warehouses to enhance grain and input storage capacity.

Nutrition-Sensitive Agriculture

This sub-programme made significant strides in enhancing food quality and building community capacity to improve nutritional outcomes. Key achievements in the year under review include the following:

i. Underwent 41 nutrient-specific fortification;

ii. Developed 15 recipes; and

iii. Trained 16 women's groups in capacity-building courses.

Early Warning Systems and Emergency Preparedness

To enhance agricultural resilience, the programme successfully responded to immediate threats while building long-term emergency preparedness capacity. The Ministry under this sub-programme:

i. Controlled an area of 348,418 Ha of land that was infested with Fall Army Worm and recovered 100 per cent of the infested lands; and

ii. Trained 68 staff to respond to plant pest and disease emergencies.

Agribusiness Development

The Agribusiness initiative is intended to broaden agricultural activities by incorporating cash crops and livestock as profitable enterprises, while increasing the worth of existing goods, identifying outlets for current offerings, and developing diverse new products. The Ministry recorded the following achievements during the 2025 financial year:

Promotion of Private Sector Investment in Agriculture

This sub-programme seeks to improve private sector investment in agriculture. In furtherance of this, the Strategic Business Investment briefs covering five (5) priority commodities were developed.

Promotion of Appropriate Agricultural Financing

Under this sub-programme, the Ministry seeks to enhance access to affordable credit, strengthen financial inclusion for farmers, and foster sustainable investment across the agricultural sector. The following key achievements were recorded:

i. One (1) financial institution was signed onto the Ghana Incentive-Risk Sharing System for Agricultural Lending (GIRLSAL) Agriculture Credit Guarantee Scheme;

ii. 359,320,000 value of Agriculture Loans was issued to Financial Institutions;

iii. 177,200,000 value of Agriculture Credit Guarantee was provided to financial institutions by GIRSAL;

iv. 17 Financial Institutions benefited from GIRSAL Agriculture and Agribusiness Training Program; and

v. 50 actors were trained to improve the capacity of value chain actors in contracting and contract agreement.

Sustainable Management of Land and Environment

The objective of the Sustainable Management of Land and Environment Programme is to foster effective land management that supports sustainable agricultural practices while enhancing the adaptability and resilience of production systems in agriculture. The Ministry recorded the following outputs during the year under review:

Conservation of Natural Resources/ Management of Environment and Natural Resources

The objective of this sub-programme is to promote sustainable management of the environment and natural resources. The Ministry achieved the following successes under the sub-programme in the year 2025;

Achieved 17 per cent of rehabilitation works in Aveyime irrigation project;

i. Achieved 54 per cent of the development of 100,000 irrigable land under irrigation development;

ii. Achieved 50 per cent of the rehabilitation of 850 ha of Vea Irrigation Scheme;

iii. Trained 32 staff and 182 farmers on Sustainable Land and Water Management (SLWM);

iv. 2,000 farmers were supported to adopt SLWM technologies; and

v. 199 Natural Resources Management (NRM) related demonstrations were established.

Climate Change Resilience and Mitigation

To enhance institutional capacity and advance climate-resilient agricultural production systems, the Ministry achieved the following:

i. 32 agriculture staff were trained on climate change adaptation and mitigation;

ii. 20,000 farmers adopted a diversified cropping system; and

iii. 172 farmers were introduced to alternative livelihoods.

Outlook For 2026

Financial Requirement

The budgetary allocation for the Ministry of Food and Agriculture for the year 2026 is the sum of GH₵3,037,594,607 made up of GH₵2,239,683,723 representing 73.7 per cent from the GoG, GH₵32,072,271 representing 1.05 per cent from IGF, GH₵369,150,000 representing 12.2 per cent from foreign loans, and GH₵396,688,613 representing 13 per cent from foreign grants.

Total allocation for Compensation of employees is GH¢268,997,117, representing 8.9 per cent, Goods and Services is GH₵1,413,209,073 (46.5 per cent) and CAPEX is GH₵1,355,388,417 (44.6 per cent).

The detailed breakdown by economic classification is shown in Table 2 below:

Table 2: 2026 Budget Ceilings by Economic Classification and Funding Source

2026 Sources of Funding and Economic Classification					
Sources Of Funding	**Compensation**	**Goods And Services**	**CAPEX**	**Total**	**% of Total Allocation**
GoG	268,997,117	1,025,686,606	945,000,000	2,239,683,723	**73.7**
IGF	-	21,883,854	10,188,417	32,072,271	**1.05**
Foreign Loans	-	37,950,000	331,200,000	369,150,000	**12.2**
Foreign Grants	-	327,688,613	69,000,000	396,688,613	**13.05**
Total	268,997,117	1,413,209,073	1,355,388,417	**3,037,594,607**	
%	8.9	46.5	44.6		**100**

Source: Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for 2026 financial year

Table 3: 2026 Budgetary Allocation by Programme

Programme	**Sources of Funding**				
	GOG(GH₵)	**IGF(GH₵)**	**Donors (GH₵)**	**Total (GH₵)**	**Percent Allocation (%)**
Management and Administration	97,105,884	9,073,770	-	106,179,654	**3.5**
Food Security and Emergency Preparedness	46,300,000	574,200	-	46,874,200	**1.5**
Agricultural Land Management	20,000,000	-	-	20,000,000	**0.7**
Farmer Managed Irrigation	690,000,000	-	-	690,000,000	**22.7**
Crop and Livestock Development	1,385,777,839	22,424,301	665,788,613	2,073,990,753	**68.3**

Agribusiness Development	400,000	-	-	400,000	**0.01**
Sustainable Management of Land Environment	100,000	-	100,050,000	100,150,000	**3.3**
Total	**2,239,683,723**	**32,072,271**	**765,838,613**	**3,037,594,607**	**100**

Source: Programme Based Budget of the Ministry of Food and Agriculture.

Management and Administration

To enhance collaboration among the Ministry and relevant ministries, departments and agencies (MDAs), the Ministry has planned to implement the following initiatives:

i. Procure vehicles for the Ministry;

ii. Subscribe to local and international affiliations;

iii. Review legal and administrative frameworks;

iv. Fulfil contractual obligations and commitments;

v. Conduct internal audit operations;

vi. Undertake treasury and accounting activities;

vii. Procure office supplies and consumables;

viii. Update the HR database;

ix. Coordinate and collaborate with external agencies of the Ministry;

x. Create a National operational and geodata database like the National Farmer Database; and

xi. Develop an assessment of food outlook (production prospects, demand and supply).

Crops and Livestock Development

The outcome expected under the crops and livestock development programme is to improve agricultural productivity and contribute to sustainable economic growth while promoting improved nutrition. To achieve this, the following interventions have been planned for the 2026 financial year under the various sub-programmes of this programme.

Production and Productivity Improvement

Under this initiative, the following activities are planned to be implemented:

i. Promote the utilisation of locally produced vaccines;

ii. Undertake knowledge dissemination measures and training of farmers on antimicrobial use and resistance;

iii. Promote seed and grazing reserves and storage facilities;

iv. Undertake knowledge dissemination measures and training of farmers in disaster preparedness methods; and

v. Enhance early warning systems for natural disasters and promote mass vaccination of small ruminants to eradicate PPR and achieve zero rabies by 2030.

Mechanisation, Irrigation and Water Management

In line with the vision to streamline agricultural activities for greater productivity and better returns on investments, the Ministry plans to promote agricultural mechanisation and rehabilitate irrigation infrastructures.

Postharvest Management and Marketing

The Ministry plans to undertake the following activities under this sub-programme:

i. Promote varieties that have a good shelf life;

ii. Produce and acquire improved planting materials;

iii. Implement food fortification measures;

iv. Promote measures to strengthen dietary diversity; and

v. Construct warehouses and provide drying facilities.

Nutrition-Sensitive Agriculture

For this sub-programme, the Ministry plans to champion measures to boost dietary diversity and will also renovate and fence its office facility.

Early Warning Systems and Emergency

This sub-programme seeks to promote the following initiatives:

i. Surveillance and prevention of plant pests and diseases;

ii. Surveillance and prevention of animal pests and diseases;

iii. Promotion of seed and grazing reserves, and storage facilities;

iv. Knowledge dissemination measures and training of farmers in disaster preparedness methods; and

v. Procurement of insecticides.

Agribusiness Development

In an effort to reduce heavy dependence on food imports, the Ministry plans to undertake the following under the agribusiness development programme:

i. The Agence Francaise de Developpement (AFD) has earmarked 8 million Euros for the development of the shea industry under the Boost Ecological Transition Towards Enhanced Revenue (BETTER) Project;

ii. The African Development Bank (AFDB), through the Savannah Agriculture Value Chain Development Project (SADEP) will partner with the private sector to establish a 40mt per day soya processing plant in Northern Ghana at a total cost of $370,000;

iii. An allocation of GH¢100m has been made to the National Buffer Stock Company (NAFCO) to mop up produce of about 6,000mt of maize, 3,000 mt of rice, and 2,000 mt of Gari;

iv. Provide agribusiness information and expertise to the private sector;

v. Facilitate investment into the agricultural sector;

vi. Facilitate the Ghana Agribusiness Competitiveness Advisory Project;

vii. Facilitate the Capital Market Instruments for Agriculture;

viii. Promote specific market and production contracts; and

ix. Promote the warehouse receipts system.

Sustainable Management of Land and Environment

During the 2026 financial year, the Ministry plans to launch the following initiatives. These efforts are central to promoting responsible land use and green agricultural techniques essential for robust productivity and food security:

i. Ensure Sustainable Land and Water Management;

ii. Support sound environmental management of the agriculture sector activities;

iii. Ghana Land Restoration and Small-Scale Mining (GLRSSMP);

iv. Improve on Human resource capacity;

v. Enhance institutional support systems and mechanisms; and

vi. Promote risk reduction, transfer, and alternative livelihoods.

Observations

After an extensive engagement with Officials of the Ministry of Food and Agriculture, the Committee made the following observations:

Delay in Releases of Approved Budget

The Committee observed with concern that the 2025 budget execution of the Ministry was severely hindered by delays in the release of approved budgets. The Committee noted that as of November 2025, an amount of GhȻ925,101,495 representing 31.8 per cent of the approved budget of GHȻ2,904,904,982 had been released.

Consequently, many planned interventions, particularly capital-intensive projects under the Feed Ghana Programme, could not be fully executed within the fiscal year. This resulted in reduced programme impact and diminished capacity to address urgent agricultural challenges.

The Minister attributed the low financial performance partly to delays in the submission and subsequent approval of the 2025 Budget as late as March of the same year owing the transition arrangement of a new Government. The Minister further noted that the financial management controls introduced by the Ministry of Finance, including the requirement for mandatory commitment authorisations prior to the commencement of capital projects, also contributed to the underperformance.

Given the catalytic role of the agriculture sector in driving broader economic growth, the Committee urges the Ministry of Finance to ensure the timely release of funds to enable the Ministry to implement its planned programmes and activities for the 2026 financial year.

Improvement in Soil Testing and Fertilizer Quality Assurance

The Committee commended the Ministry’s renewed shift towards science-led agricultural transformation through increased investment in soil diagnostics. The procurement of a modern soil analysis technology and the rehabilitation of the Kumasi Soil Laboratory to international standards establishes the foundation for accurate and timely soil health assessments nationwide. These improvements will empower farmers, extension officers, and input suppliers to apply fertilisers based on precise nutrient requirements, thereby reducing waste, minimising soil degradation, and improving crop yield.

The Committee noted that the Food and Agriculture Organization is supporting this initiative aimed at strengthening fertiliser quality assurance and enabling targeted, soil-specific blends that boost productivity, lower environmental harm, and advance national goals of increased yields, reduced production costs, and enhanced food security.

The Committee recommends scaling up these services to the district level to ensure comprehensive benefits for smallholder farmers.

Promotion of School and Home Gardening

The Committee noted with appreciation the Ministry’s efforts in promoting home and school gardening initiatives under the Feed Ghana Programme to enhance household nutrition, reduce food expenditures, and position agriculture as an accessible livelihood for urban and peri-urban populations while fostering behavioural shifts toward sustainable food systems. It was noted that over 413 schools have been enrolled in expanded school gardening programmes supported by structured incentives and annual awards, providing youth with hands-on exposure to modern farming technologies, agribusiness, and research-driven practices. Through these initiatives, the Ministry is cultivating interest in agriculture among young people and building a foundation for a skilled workforce capable of sustaining national food security and advancing Ghana's agricultural transformation.

Irrigation Infrastructure Deficits and Outstanding Claims on Ongoing Projects

Irrigation remains essential for ensuring year-round agricultural production, increasing crop yields, and ultimately achieving national food security. The Committee, however, observed that the Ministry's efforts to develop irrigation infrastructure over the years have been constrained by inadequate budgetary allocations, delays in the release of funds, and persistent procurement challenges. The Minister informed the Committee that outstanding claims owed to contractors for completed works currently exceed GH₵1 billion.

The Committee is concerned that the accumulation and rollover of such significant debts may crowd out new investments, delay the implementation of critical projects, and undermine contractor confidence in the sector. Consequently, the Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance make a special allocation outside the Ministry's 2026 budget to settle the outstanding debts. Furthermore, the Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance establish dedicated and sustainable funding mechanisms to support the continuous development of irrigation facilities across the country.

Need for strengthening Extension Services

Extension services are vital to agricultural development as they bridge the gap between research and farmers, providing critical knowledge, skills, and innovations to improve productivity and sustainability.

It was, however, noted that the extension officer-to-farmer ratio in Ghana is 1:1,700, far exceeding the Food and Agriculture Organisation recommended ratio of 1:500. The insufficient number adversely affected the Ministry's capacity to provide technical support and address field challenges under the Feed Ghana Programme. While the Ministry has implemented interim measures such as recruiting temporary officers and equipping, sustainable improvements require long-term civil service recruitment, adequate budgetary allocations, and stronger private-sector collaboration. The Committee is of the view that strengthening extension services is indispensable to achieving Ghana's agricultural transformation goals, as effective farmer engagement is fundamental to scaling modern practices and enhancing productivity.

Collaboration with Universities and Research Institutions

The Committee commended the Ministry for its efforts in strengthening collaboration with universities and research institutions. The initiative demonstrates a clear commitment to recognizing the pivotal role of science, technology, and innovation in driving agricultural transformation. This enhanced engagement, exemplified by the invitation of eight leading universities and research institutions to present their research breakthroughs at the recent 41st National Farmers' Day celebration, promoted the wider adoption and commercialisation of innovations by facilitating direct interactions between researchers, policymakers, farmers, and private sector stakeholders.

The Committee further noted that sustained support through adequate funding, policy alignment, and structured national research exhibitions will be critical to ensuring that Ghana's agricultural sector follows a competitive, technology-driven growth trajectory.

Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) Perspectives

In line with Parliament's commitment to the Open Parliament initiatives, the Committee invited civil society organisations (CSOs) engaged in the agricultural sector to participate in its deliberations.

The CSOs welcomed the Ministry's planned programmes for 2026, viewing them as a positive step toward recognising agriculture as a key driver of economic growth, job creation, and transformation. They noted that initiatives such as the Feed Ghana Programme, increased allocations to the National Food Buffer Stock Company, investments in Farmer Service Centres, and the directive for schools to source food locally, if effectively implemented, have the potential to enhance productivity, reduce post-harvest losses, and improve market access for smallholder farmers.

However, the CSOs expressed concern that the allocation of only 2.18 per cent of total government expenditure to agriculture remains substantially below the 10 per cent target set under the Maputo Declaration, which is necessary to achieve the desired sectoral transformation.

They recommended the establishment of an Agricultural Development Fund to finance critical interventions, including irrigation and mechanisation, and proposed the enactment of legislation granting tax exemptions on agricultural inputs and equipment to reduce production costs.

Allocation of GH₵100 Million to the National Buffer Stock Company Limited (NAFCO)

The timely release of the GHS 100 million allocation to the National Food Buffer Stock Company marked a significant policy shift and a positive departure from previous years, during which no substantial budgetary provisions were made to build national food reserves. During the engagement, the CEO confirmed that although the Company had not originally budgeted for this amount, the funds were nonetheless released following urgent consultations with the sector Minister to address emerging challenges, particularly the need to mop up excess produce from farmers to keep them in business.

The Committee further noted that, although the amount was relatively modest in comparison to the estimated requirement of GH₵750 million, the timely intervention constituted a significant step towards enhancing national food security initiatives and stabilising agricultural markets. The GH₵200 million budgeted for in the 2026 allocation is timely and should be released in good time as well.

The Committee recommends that additional budgetary allocations be made to facilitate the completion of several government-initiated warehouses, which are currently at various stages of construction, in order to provide adequate storage facilities to support the strategic food reserves initiative by the National Food Buffer Stock.

Oil Palm Expansion Programme and Dedicated Funding Structure

The Committee noted the Authority's readiness to implement the proposed national oil palm development programme, targeting 100,000 hectares of new plantations and the creation of over 250,000 direct and indirect jobs. The Authority indicated that a US$500 million long-term financing mechanism is being established through public and private investments, concessional financing, and development partners.

The Committee further observed significant potential for industrial development through value addition initiatives, including industrial mills, vegetable oil refining, biofuel production, and other manufacturing such as soaps, lubricants, pharmaceuticals, and specialty oils.

The Committee welcomed this initiative and acknowledged the critical role of financing in ensuring the long-term sustainability and the success of the programme.

The essential role of the West African Food Systems Resilience Programme (FSRP) in strengthening the national food system

The Committee recognised the essential role of the West African Food Systems Resilience Programme (FSRP) in strengthening Ghana's food security by aligning its interventions with national priorities for a more robust and climate-resilient agricultural sector, particularly through support for local production of rice, maize, soya and tomato, improved irrigation, and climate-smart practices.

It noted that the Programme's promotion of improved seed varieties, climate-resilient fertiliser blends, and the strengthening of meteorological and early-warning systems is already yielding measurable gains in productivity, farmer uptake of improved technologies, and reduced climate-related risks. The Committee further observed that FSRP's support for youth agricultural entrepreneurship and agricultural value chains is enhancing job creation and economic resilience and therefore considers the Programme a strategic partner whose continued support is vital to reducing dependence on food imports and ensuring long-term national food system resilience.

Conclusion and Recommendations

The Committee has carefully examined the budget estimates of the Ministry of Food and Agriculture for the 2026 financial year and is satisfied that the policies and programmes outlined for the year will go a long way to position agriculture as an anchor for the sustainable growth and development of the country.

The Committee accordingly recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the total sum of Three Billion, Thirty-Seven Million, Five Hundred and Ninety-Four Thousand, Six Hundred and Seven Ghana Cedis (GH₵3,037,594,607) to implement planned programmes and activities of the Ministry of Food and Agriculture for the 2026 financial year.

Deputy Minister for Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs (Mr John Setor Dumelo) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question proposed

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the allocation of the sum of GH₵3,037,594,607.00 for the services of the Ministry of Food and Agriculture for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take item numbered 15, the estimate for the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts.

MINISTRY OF TOURISM, CULTURE AND CREATIVE ARTS

Chairman of Committee (Mr Alexander Roosevelt Hottordze): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Joint Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism and Culture, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs on the allocation of the sum of GH₵255,127,941.00 for the services of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

In moving this Motion, I present the Report of the Committee and I urge the *Hansard* Department to capture the Report in its entirety as if it was read word by word.

Introduction

On Thursday, 13th November, 2025, the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson presented to Parliament the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year in accordance with article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Order 195(2) of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Subsequent to the presentation, the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts was referred to the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism for consideration and report in accordance with Orders 195(4) and 248 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee met on Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025, with the Hon Deputy Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, Mr Yussif Issaka Jajah, the Chief Director, Agencies of the Ministry, the technical team and stakeholders of the Ministry and considered the Estimates.

The Committee was joined by the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs to consider the Estimates.

The Committee is grateful to all for honouring the invitation and assisting in its consideration of the Estimates.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during its deliberations:

i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana,

ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana,

iii. The Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts for the 2025 Financial Year,

iv. Joint Report of the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism and Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs on the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts for the 2025 Financial Year,

v. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921); and

vi. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the Year 2026.

Background

The Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts facilitates the interface between government, implementing bodies in tourism, culture, and the creative industries as well as international civil society partners. The Ministry is to develop sustainable tourism pivoted on Ghanaian culture and creative arts as a key to accelerated national development. The Ministry executes its mandate through implementing agencies and currently has thirteen (13) institutions as its main frontline and key implementing agencies.

Policy Direction

Strategic Overview

The 2026-2029 Medium-term Work plan and Budget of the Ministry is aimed at creating an enabling and conducive policy environment within which the private sector would thrive to propel the development and growth of the Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts Sector for the creation of employment and generating income opportunities, especially for women and the youth;

Goal of Ministry

To provide a firm, stable policy environment for effective mainstreaming of Ghanaian culture into all aspects of national life and to ensure the strong emergence of a vibrant creative economy to improve and advance the tourism industry.

Policy Objectives

The following have been identified as the Policy Objectives of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts from the 2026-2029 Framework:

i. Diversify and expand the tourism industry for economic development;

ii. Develop a competitive creative arts industry;

iii. Promote culture in the development process;

iv. Enhance Ghana's international image and influence;

v. Promote Ghana's political and economic interests abroad; and

vi. Integrate Ghanaian diaspora in national development

Core Functions

The core functions of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts are:

vii Formulation of policy, planning and programming for development;

viii Promotion of domestic, regional and international Tourism, Arts and Culture;

ix. Promulgation of legislation and regulations on Tourism, Arts and Culture development, including investment policies and incentives;

x. Conducting research into regional and global trends in Tourism, Arts and Culture;

xi Development of human resources within the private and public sectors to effectively promote Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts;

xii Co-ordination and collaboration with other Government Agencies, Development Partners, the Private Sector and Non-Governmental Organisations on matters concerning Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts;

xiii Development of policies and programmes, to link up with Africans including Ghanaians in the Diaspora for Tourism, Arts and Culture and investment promotion for the country; and xiv Monitoring and Evaluation of the sector's performance.

Agencies of the Ministry

The Ministry has Thirteen (13) Agencies that assist it in implementing its programmes and activities. They are:

1. Ghana Tourism Authority (GTA)
2. Ghana Tourism Development Company (GTDC)
3. Hotel, Catering and Tourism Training Institute (HOTCATT)
4. National Commission on Culture (NCC)
5. National Theatre of Ghana (NTG)
   - i. Ghana Drama Company (Abibigromma)
   - ii National Symphony Orchestra (NSO)
   - iii. National Dance Ensemble (NDE)
6. Creative Arts Agency (CAA)
7. Bureau of Ghanaian Languages (BGL)
8. Kwame Nkrumah Memorial Park (KNMP)
9. W.E.B. Dubois Center
10. Ghana Museums and Monuments Board (GMMB)
11. National Folklore Board (NFB)
12. Pan-African Writers Association (PAWA)
13. National Film Authority (NFA)

2025 Financial Performance

An amount of two hundred and four million, five hundred and ninety- seven thousand, eight hundred and forty Ghana Cedis, Thirty-Nine Pesewas (GH₵204,597,840.39) was allocated for the services of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts. Out of this, GH₵135.3931 million was released for the 2025 Financial Year as at September. Actual expenditure of the amount released stood at GH₵133.5448 million as captured in Tables (1) and (2) below:

Table 1. 2025 Financial Performance (Expenditure) By Economic Classification and Sources of Funds

Expenditure Item	2025 Approved Budget /Appropriation(000')	Amount Released for Jan-September, 2025 (000')	Actual Expenditure for Jan-Sep, 2025(000')	%UTILISATION (%C/A)
Compensation of Employees	**108,363.74**	**76,194.70**	**76,194.70**	**70.31**
o/w GoG	108,363.74	76,194.70	76,194.70	70.31
IGF	-	-	-	-
Use of Goods and Services	**36,579.85**	**24,314.80**	**23,227.40**	**63.50**
o/w GoG	7,500.00	3,125.00	3,125.00	41.67
IGF	29,079.85	21,189.80	20,102.40	69.13
Capital Expenditure (CAPEX)	**59,654.247**	**34,883.60**	**34,122.80**	**57.20**
o/w GoG	51,030.17	30,618.10	30,618.10	60.00
IGF	8,624.07	4,265.50	3,504.70	40.64
TOTAL	**204,598.00**	**135,393.10**	**133,544.80**	**65.27**

2025 Non-Financial Performance

Management and Administration

In 2025 and under management and Administration Division, the Ministry:

i. Effectively organised the 2025 National Heritage Photo Competition which was launched on 28th March, 2025, to engage Ghanaians under the age 25 to showcase the nation's rich cultural heritage through photography, visual arts, digital art and design.

ii. Continued with remedial and restoration works on six of Ghana's Forts and Castles across the country to prevent delisting of some Ghanaian heritage sites from the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation World Heritage List. When completed, visitation to these sites are expected to increase considerably thereby improving revenue generation for the state.

iii. Undertook a familiarisation visit to the Volta Region to abreast themselves with the state of activities in the Sector. The tour formed part of the Ministry's commitment to promoting Ghana's cultural heritage and advancing tourism development across the country.

iv. Celebrated Drama Performance in the country in collaboration with the Design and Technology Institute to inspire stakeholders within the industry to improve skills development and patronage,

v. Inaugurated a five-member Committee mandated to plan national events aimed at honouring distinguished legends in Ghana's creative and cultural industry.

vi. Organised the Afro-Castro Festival which serve a vibrant celebration of the shared culinary heritage and cultural roots of African-descended communities across the globe. The event brought together participating countries from Africa, the Caribbean, South America, North America and beyond. The objective of the festival was to reconnect with and celebrate Africa's culinary legacy through a fusion of flavours, music, art and performance.

vii. Commemorated Nkrumah's Day with a holistic pilgrimage titled "Journey to Nkroful" The even formed part of this year's Nkrumahfest and sought to honour the life and legacy of Ghana's first Prime Minister and President, Osagyefo Dr Kwame Nkrumah.

viii. Built capacity of staff in Top Management, Middle Management and Junior officers in Conflict Resolution and Negotiation Skills, in effective Leadership and Management skills, Negotiation and Conflict Resolution skills and other relevant Civil Service Policy documents were imperative for effective service delivery.

Tourism Product Development Programme

In 2025, under its Tourism Product Development programme, the Ministry:

i. Continued the construction of Ashanti Regional office building project which started in 2024 is ongoing. The project is scheduled for completion in the 3rd Quarter of the Year.

ii. Organised the "Taste 68@68" Food Fair, in recognition of the 2025 Heritage Month. The celebration of Ghana's culinary heritage, showcased 68 traditional and contemporary Ghanaian dishes as part of the Black Star Experience initiative.

iii. Celebrated the 2025 PANAFEST/ Emancipation Day

iv. Organised the 2025 Kwahu Paragliding event from 18th – 21st April, 2025.

v. Continued with the rehabilitation of some Tourist Sites to give them a facelift across the country in the first half of the year. They include the

Tano Boase Sacred Grove, Denkyira Eco–Park, and Pikworo Slave Camp and Heritage Site.

vi. Launched the 'Accra by Night' programme which aimed at showcasing the capital city's rich cultural heritage and vibrant nightlife. The programme will be customized to fit the other 15 regions in the country.

vii. Launched the Fleet Pool Management Services Car Rental

viii. Launched the Eco-chest Science Tour

ix. Launched the Ghana Tourism Marketplace

x. Ghana Tourism Investment Platform

xi. Launched the Destination Marketing Awards

Tourism, Research and Marketing Programme

Under this programme, the Ministry promoted Ghana as a preferred Tourism destination through the following fairs and exhibitions:

i. Vakantiebeurs, Utrecht – Holland – 12th January, 2025

ii. FITUR – Madrid, Spain-22th – 26th January, 2025

iii. Meetings Africa 24th – 26th Feb, 2025

iv. ITB – Berlin, Germany 4th – 6th March, 2025

v. Investment Forum, Osaka Expo March, 2025

vi. Seatrade Cruise Global Fair & Exhibition 7th – 10th April, 2025

vii. WTM AFRICA, South Africa 9th - 11th April, 2025

Ghana Tourism Authority

The Ghana Tourism Authority, issued Six Thousand, and Forty-One (6,041) Operational Licenses to Tourism and Hospitality Establishments nationwide after inspection as of 25th August, 2025.

Culture, Creative Arts and Heritage Management

For the period under review, the management:

i. Successfully submitted a comprehensive nomination dossier for Ghana's Highlife Music and Dance to UNESCO, following two years of dedicated research and stakeholder engagement.

ii. Collaborated with Adesa Productions Limited in the production of the ongoing Ghana's Most Beautiful pageant.

iii. Celebrated the birthday of Dr. Du Bois with a wreath-laying ceremony and Photo exhibitions as part of the observation of the "Black History

Month", the W.E.B. Du Bois Memorial Centre.

iv. Implemented a new marketing strategy to improve visitation to the Park by Ghanaians and non-Ghanaians increasing visitation from 62,345 to 89,288 by August, 2025.

v. Successfully staged drama in eighteen (18) schools, creating awareness and educating students about their culture and heritage within the periods of January to August, 2025.

vi. In collaboration with the Ministry of Finance, undertook the translation of the 2025 Citizens' Budget from English into seven (7) Ghanaian languages to foster linguistic inclusivity in Ghana.

vii. Translated and voiced driver testing questions in Asante Twi and uploaded them onto the DVLA website, improving accessibility for semi-literate and illiterate drivers.

viii. Implemented the Sankofa Black Star Experience to promote Ghana's cultural heritage among school learners at Essikado St. Mark Basic School and Essikado STMA Basic School, reaching 201 learners, introducing traditional Ghanaian textiles and their cultural meanings and demonstrating conventional dances of the Ahanta and Nzema people.

ix. Successfully organised the National Film Dialogue in Ghana on the 18th September, 2025, creating a platform for stakeholders to engage, share ideas, and develop strategies aimed at promoting growth and sustainability of the film industry.

x. Recorded a single tract audio and video song for social media as a means of improving its visibility and connections to the tourism world.

xi. Submitted the Highlife Music and Dance Dossier to UNESCO For Enlisting on The Representative List In 2025.

Outlook for 2026

Priorities of the Ministry

Management and Administration

In 2026, the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, together with its implementing Agencies will undertake the following programmes and activities:

i. Facilitate the payment of salaries and other emoluments

ii. Capacity building for all staff will be conducted

iii. Coordinate programmes and projects of the Sector Ministry

iv. Upgrade several sites to increase visitation and participation

v. Undertake research to inform policy work

vi. Facilitate the implementation of the Tourism and Culture Policies

vii. Payment of subscriptions

viii. Coordinate regional and international cooperation programmes on tourism related issues

ix. Participate in international tourism programmes

Tourism and Product Development

The Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, together with its implementing Agencies will undertake the following programmes and activities during the year:

i. Construct and upgrade facilities at tourist sites and regional offices

ii. International tourism arrivals arrivals will be compiled

iii. Improve on tourism product development activities within the sector

iv. Tourism Research and Marketing

v. The Ministry together with its implementing Agencies will perform the following programmes and activities:

vi. Participate in four (4) local fairs

vii. Participate in four (4) international fairs

viii. Organise seven (7) major events

ix. Conduct surveys on the tourism sector

x. Procure promotional materials

xi. Promote domestic and regional tourism

xii. Increase research activities within the sector

xiii. Consolidate existing markets and raise awareness about Ghana as a tourist destination and create desire action to make repeat visit to Ghana

Tourism Quality Assurance

The Ministry, through its Agencies will undertake:

i. Inspection and licensing of tourist sites and attractions

ii. Registration and licensing of Tour Guides

iii. Organise variety of activities to enhance quality assurance within the tourism industry

iv. Registration of tourism plant

Culture Creative and Heritage Management

The Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, together with its implementing Agencies will undertake the following programmes and activities during the year:

i. Organise the re-enactment of the declaration of Independence Day

ii. Organise African Union Week by the end of May, 2026

iii. Organise a reading festival expected to be held in at least eight Regions in the country

iv. Organise the Emancipation Day/Wreath Laying Ceremony

v. Renovate Forts and Castles in the country

vi. Enhance musical performance in the country

vii. Intensify links with the Regional Centres for national culture for performances

2026 Budget Allocation for the Ministry

A total of Two Hundred and Fifty-Five Million, One Hundred and Twenty-Seven Thousand, Nine Hundred and Forty-One Cedis (GH₵255,127,941.00) has been allocated for the services of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts for the 2025 Financial Year as shown in the Table below.

Table 2: 2026 Appropriation for the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts

Source of Funds	**Expenditure Item**			**Totals**	**% of Total**
	Compensation	**Goods & Services**	**Capex**		
GoG	118,457,608.00	57,500,000.00	31,030,173.00	206,987,781.00	81.1
IGF	0.00	33,276,916.00	14,863,244.00	48,140,160.00	18.9
DP Fund	0	0	0	0	0.00
TOTAL	**118,457,608.00**	**90,776,916.00**	**45,893,417.00**	**255,127,941.00**	**100.00**

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy Document

Observations And Recommendations

The Committee having carefully considered the 2026 Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts (MoTCCA), presents the following observations and recommendations.

Absence of sustained investment in tourism

The Committee received submission from the Ghana Tourism Federation (GHATOF), in which the Federation emphasised the importance of sustained investment in destination marketing, product development and service quality enhancement.

The Federation highlighted the enormous potential to be derived from some Government initiatives such as the Black Star Experience, domestic tourism campaigns, and diaspora-focused programmes, if implemented successfully. In order to do this, there was the need for Government to make the relevant investment in the sector in order for the country to reap the benefits like in other countries. The Federation indicated that with the right investment, tourism could be one of the top five foreign exchange earner for the country.

The Federation expressed the opinion that there was the need for the Ministry to include experts from the private sector in policy formulation and other regulatory reforms. This would help bring on board new innovations to help improve standards across the tourism and hospitality value chain. It also called for more collaboration between the Ministry and the private sector.

The Committee identified the Federation as one of the major stakeholders in the sector and urged the Ministry to collaborate more with these stakeholders in order to accelerate tourism growth and improve the competitiveness of Ghana’s tourism brand on the global stage.

Operational challenges confronting the Ghana Hotels Association

The Ghana Hotels Association (GHA) highlighted concerns facing the Association including high operational costs, infrastructure deficits and regulatory compliance difficulties. The Association indicated that these challenges were adversely affecting their businesses and called on Government to intervene.

The Association indicated that despite these challenges, the Association will continue to play its role in the sector by providing jobs, services, professional development and also continue to collaborate with the Ghana Tourism Authority in pursuit of their mandate.

The Committee recognised the Hotel Association as an important player in the hospitality industry and opined that for them to operate efficiently, these issues as indicated have to be resolved. The Committee called for engagement between the Ministry, the Ghana Tourism Authority and hotel operators to address regulatory bottlenecks, standardisation gaps and the declining maintenance of hospitality infrastructure in some regions.

Uncapping of Internally Generated Funds

The Committee noted with concern that the continued capping of Internally Generated Funds of the Ministry and its agencies is severely restricting their operational efficiency. Agencies such as the Ghana Tourism Authority, the Ghana Museums and Monuments Board, the National Film Authority, the National Theatre, the Bureau of Ghanaian Languages and the National Commission on Culture rely heavily on Internally Generated Funds to sustain their programmes, maintain heritage sites and execute destination marketing initiatives.

The Committee therefore recommends to the Minister for Finance to make additional allocation to the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts to enable it invest same into their operations to improve service delivery and expand the scope of tourism and cultural development nationwide. In the alternative, the Minister may review the Earmarked capping law to enable the Ministry and its Agencies have 100 per cent retention of their IGF.

Partnerships and International Positioning of Ghana's Tourism Brand

The Committee observed that the recent activities of the Ministry's initiatives, including the "Home Coming Programme", "December in GH," and the "celebration of March as Tourism Month", have helped to consolidate Ghana's visibility as a preferred destination for both diasporans and international visitors.

The Committee noted that Ghana's most frequent visitor markets — particularly the United States, the United Kingdom, and Nigeria—offer strong diaspora and regional tourism potential, which the Ministry is positioning itself to harness.

The Committee also noted that most of these successes had come about due to partnerships the Ministry had gone into with the private sector.

The Committee recommended that the Ministry scale up public–private partnerships, deepen collaboration with development partners and secure dedicated financing for global tourism marketing to enhance Ghana's international brand and strengthen the contribution of tourism to the national economy.

Dollarisation of Hotel Services

The Committee expressed concern about the persistent practice of quoting hotel accommodation and hospitality services in foreign currency, particularly in U.S. dollars, despite clear directives from the Bank of Ghana prohibiting dollarisation.

The Committee noted that this practice has adverse effects on the strength and perception of the Ghana Cedi and creates barriers for domestic tourists who cannot afford foreign currency-based pricing. It also creates inconsistencies within the industry and weakens the financial regulatory framework governing tourism operations.

The Committee believes that strict compliance with anti-dollarisation directives is essential for maintaining monetary stability and ensuring fairness across the hospitality industry.

The Committee therefore urges the Bank of Ghana, working closely with the Ghana Tourism Authority, to intensify enforcement of the regulations and ensure full compliance across the hospitality sector.

Lack of Film Villages and the Decline of Local Creative Content

The Committee noted with concern the absence of Film Villages which continues to undermine the local film industry. Although Ghana has diverse cultural landscapes suitable for film production, lack of dedicated filming environments force actors and producers, particularly within the Kumawood (Kumasi) industry, to travel to remote locations in search of traditional scenes. This raises production costs and reduces the volume of locally produced films.

The Committee expressed worry that the absence of local movies had led to the screening on Ghanaian Television Asian translated movies at the expense of indigenous content. This trend poses a threat to the preservation and promotion of Ghana's cultural values and creative identity. Establishing Film Villages would not only preserve the local film eco-system but also attract investment, create jobs and strengthen national cultural pride.

The Committee therefore recommends that the Ministry prioritizes the establishment of Film Villages in selected regions and collaborate with private investors to support the growth of indigenous film production and the broader creative economy.

Tourism Infrastructure and Site Development

The Committee noted that while the Ministry has made progress in rehabilitating several tourist sites and initiating new tourism products, many heritage and cultural sites remain in urgent need of development. Key cultural institutions such as Forts and Castles, Regional Centres for National Culture, Museums and Historical Monuments continue to suffer from inadequate maintenance and outdated visitor facilities.

The Committee acknowledged ongoing works including the rehabilitation of the Tano Boase Sacred Grove, Denkyira Eco-Park and the Pikworo Slave Camp, as well as the construction of the Ashanti Regional Office and the launch of innovative tourism products such as "Accra by Night." Nevertheless, the sector still requires significant investment to modernise infrastructure and preserve historical sites.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry speeds up the completion of major capital projects, particularly the restoration of forts and castles, the completion of regional cultural centres and the upgrading of museums and monuments as strategic assets for cultural preservation and tourism growth.

Commitment Authorisation

The Committee observed that the delays in the issuance of commitment authorization from the Ministry of Finance, significantly hamper the timely execution of the Ministry's programmes.

The Committee recognised that tourism activities are often seasonal and time- sensitive, particularly during periods such as December, Easter, and the summer months, and any disruption affects revenue generation and visitor satisfaction. Such delays disrupt the implementation of annual tourism events, impede the continuity of capital projects and frustrate the operational timelines of sub-vented agencies whose work is heavily dependent on scheduled releases.

The Committee therefore urges the Ministry of Finance to ensure timely commitment authorisations and regular quarterly releases to enable the Ministry carry out its mandate effectively for the benefit of the state.

Challenges of the Ministry

The Committee was informed that key challenges confronting the Ministry and its agencies include limited office space for staff, insufficient and obsolete office equipment and Inadequate logistics within the Ministry and its agencies, limited fleet of vehicles for use, inadequate staffing for the Agencies and inadequate budgetary allocation for goods and services as well as Capex.

The Committee therefore urges that urgent steps are taken to address the challenges to enable the Ministry deliver its mandate.

Conclusion

The Committee has examined the 2026 Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts and found the programmes for which the sums have been allocated to be appropriate and in line with the mandate of the Ministry and its Agencies.

The Committee therefore recommends to the House to adopt this report and approve the sum of two hundred and fifty-five million, one hundred and twenty-seven thousand, nine hundred and forty-one Cedis (GH₵255,127,941.00) for the implementation of the programmes and activities of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts and its Agencies for the 2026 Financial Year.

7:27 p.m.

Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts (Ms Dzifa A. Gomashie) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved
:

That this honourable House adopted the sum of GH₵255,127,941.00 for the services of the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 16, the Estimates for the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology for the year ending 31st December 2026.

The Speaker: The Motion numbered 16, Chairman of the Committee.

MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT, SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Ranking Member of the Committee (Prof Hamza Adam): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Environment, Science and Technology on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,349,588,593.00 for the services of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Introduction

On Thursday, 13th November, 2025, the Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, presented the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the year 2026 to Parliament in accordance with article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Order 193 of the Standing Orders of Parliament. Subsequently, the Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Environment, Science, and Technology for year the 2026 was referred to the Committee on Environment, Science and Technology in accordance with Order 195(4) and Order 249 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee met with the Acting Minister for Environment, Science and Technology, Mr Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah, the Chief Director, Mrs Suweiba Adam and the technical team of the Ministry to consider the referral. Officials of the Ministry of Finance as well as Agency Heads including Council for Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR), Ghana Atomic Energy Commission

(GAEC), Environmental Protection Authority (EPA), National Biosafety Authority (NBA), Nuclear Regulatory Authority (NRA) and Electrical and Electronic Waste Management (E-Waste) were in attendance to assist in the deliberations. The Committee is grateful to the Chief Director and her officials for their cooperation and support.

Reference Documents

i. The 1992 Constitution;

ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;

iii. Medium-term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for the

Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology for 2024-2027;

iv. The 2024 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana;

v. The 2024 Programme-based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology;

vi. The 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana;

vii. The 2025 Programme-based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology; and

viii. The 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana; and

ix. The 2026 Programme-based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology.

Policy Objectives of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology.

The Ministry has adopted fourteen (14) policy objectives contained in the Medium-term National Development Policy Framework (MTNDPF) for the period 2026-2029. The objectives are as follows:

- Enhance environmental protection services;
- Improve forest and protected areas;
- Enhance institutional capacity and coordination for effective climate action;
- Enhance climate change resilience;
- Reduce greenhouse gases;
- Reduce environmental pollution;
- Reduce coastal and marine erosion;
- Minimise potential environmental impact of the oil and gas industry;
- Promote sustainable extraction of mineral resources;
- Combat deforestation, desertification, and soil erosion;
- Mainstream science, technology, and innovation in all socio-economic activities;
- Ensure availability of clean, affordable and accessible energy
- Improve research and development (R&D), innovation, and sustainable financing for industrial development
- Enhance the application of science, technology and innovation.

Goal

The Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology (MEST) seeks to ensure accelerated socio-economic development of the nation through the formulation of sound policies and a regulatory framework to promote the use of appropriate environmentally friendly, scientific and technological practices.

Core Functions

The core functions of the Environment, Science and Technology Sector are:

- Provide leadership and guidance for Environment, Science and Technology within the broad sector of the economy through sound policy formulation and implementation;

- Ensure the establishment of the regulatory framework and setting of standards to govern the activities of science and technology and the management of the environment for sustainable development;

- Promote activities needed to underpin the standards and policies required for planning and implementation of sound scientific and technological development activities;

- Ensure the coordination, supervision, monitoring and evaluation of activities of Environment, Science and Technology while fulfilling national benefits-sharing commitments;

- Set out the parameters required for programmes on environment, science and technology and human settlement in consultation with the National Development Planning Commission (NDPC) in guiding the District Assemblies as the planning authorities at the local level;

- Analyse and coordinate all planned programmes as well as budgets in the Environment, Science and Technology, and innovation sector of the economy for purposes of achieving a single integrated management system;

- Initiate, simulate, and coordinate research including the continuous development and review of policies, laws, rules and regulations in the environment, science, technology and innovation sector of the economy; and

- Ensure effective environmental management and governance, in line with the functions of the Act 1124, 2025 with the EPA as the main implementing agency and the MEST playing an oversight, coordination and facilitating role.

Agencies under the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology

The Agencies under the Ministry are as follows:

i. Environmental Protection Authority (EPA);

ii. Ghana Atomic Energy Commission (GAEC);

iii. Council for Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR);

iv. E-Waste Fund Management (E-Waste);

v. Nuclear Regulatory Authority (NRA); and

vi. National Biosafety Authority (NBA

Budget Allocation of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology for 2025

Table 1: Details of Total Budget Allocation for 2025

ITEM	GOG	IGF	DONOR	TOTAL
Compensation for Employees	452,445,220.00	139,050,786		591,496,006
Goods and Services	12,822,745.00	149,991,171	25,102,000	187,915,916
Capital Expenditure (Capex)	110,000,000.00	71,388,484	24,450,000	205,838,484
TOTAL	**575,267,965.00**	**360,430,441.00**	**49,552,000.00**	**985,250,406**

Source: Ministry of Finance

Expenditure Trends for the Medium-Term

Table: Expenditure Trend (2024–2025)

Economic Classification	2024 Approved Budget (GH¢)	2024 Releases (GH¢)	2024 Release (%)	2024 Expenditure (GH¢)	2024 Utilisation (%)	2025 Approved Budget (GH¢)	2025 Releases (GH¢)	2025 Release (%)	2025 Expenditure (GH¢)	2025 Utilisation (%)
Compensation of Employees	403,586,615.34	399,083,606.00	**98.90%**	399,083,606.00	**100.00%**	591,496,006.00	385,365,185.92	**65.10%**	385,365,185.92	**100.00%**
Goods and Services	21,789,114.00	20,497,143.96	**94.10%**	11,869,989.05	**57.90%**	212,365,916.00	187,634,857.61	**88.40%**	173,093,840.96	**92.20%**
Capital Expenditure (CAPEX)	152,339,971.00	97,229,246.08	**63.80%**	25,780,363.39	**26.50%**	181,388,484.00	95,222,035.98	**52.50%**	13,123,053.43	**13.80%**
TOTAL	**1,173,985,818.34**	**1,153,632,842.34**	98.30%	**1,020,425,477.32**	88.50%	**985,250,406.00**	**668,222,079.51**	67.80%	**571,582,080.31**	85.50%

Interpretative Summary

In 2024, the Ministry experienced strong release performance, with over 98 per cent of the approved budget released, yet utilisation lagged, particularly in Goods and Services and Capital Expenditure, indicating implementation and absorption challenges rather than cash-flow limitations. Compensation of Employees remained fully executed once released.

In 2025, the constraint shifted decisively to limited releases, with only 67.8 per cent of the approved budget made available as at the reporting period. Notwithstanding this, utilisation efficiency improved markedly for Goods and Services and remained perfect for Compensation of Employees, suggesting stronger expenditure discipline once funds were available. CAPEX performance deteriorated further, with low release rates compounded by exceptionally weak utilisation, reinforcing concerns about persistent project execution delays and systemic weaknesses in capital budget delivery.

Performance/Key Achievements for 2025 Management and Administration

The Ministry, with support from the World Bank's Problue initiative, has developed a draft Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) scheme for the plastic sector, laying the policy groundwork for a sustainable plastic value chain. Furthermore, to stimulate market solutions, eight (8) out of eleven (11) selected small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) have been awarded technical and financial support totalling USD331,606.00.

These pilots focus on innovative areas such as producing biodegradable plastics and advancing food-grade and construction material-grade recycling.

Additionally, the Ministry's efforts in managing electronic waste have yielded significant results. A total of 172.41 tonnes of e-waste was collected in the first half of 2025, bringing the cumulative collection since the programme's inception to 927.56 tonnes.

Again, capacity building remains a priority with 194 staff from 59 Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs) were trained on sound e-waste management practices to enhance compliance and enforcement at the local level.

Under the Environment and Climate Change, the Ministry launched the "One Child, One Tree" initiative nationwide as part of the "Tree for Life" programme. In addition, a total of 24 million metric tonnes of CO_2 has been allocated for carbon trading under Article 6 of the Paris Agreement, and the national carbon trading framework has been developed. Furthermore, three bilateral agreements have been concluded with Switzerland, Sweden, and Singapore to operationalise the programme. Also, three (3) projects were authorised, with the potential to reduce carbon emissions by up to 5.2 million tonnes.

On Science and Technology, the Ministry successfully organised the African Research Initiative for Scientific Excellence (ARISE) Conference and launched the Biennial Environment, Science and Technology (BEST) Forum. Cabinet approval has been granted for the development of a Bill to establish a Space Agency. Additionally, an Intellectual Property (IP) Framework has been developed and Cabinet approvals have been secured for both the Science, Technology and Innovation (STI) Policy and the Nuclear Radiation Safety Policy.

The establishment of the Foundry and Machine Tooling Centre is progressing steadily. Phase I, which covers the foundry construction, is 95 per cent complete, with most of the required equipment already procured and delivered. Phase II, comprising the Machine Tooling Centre, Patterns Development Shop, and Staff Canteen, is 76 per cent complete. Equipment for Phase II has been ordered and is awaiting delivery.

Research and Development Programme

In 2025, the Ministry through the Council for Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) delivered significant results across its mandate. To strengthen food security, CSIR collected and conserved 814 plant accessions, distributed 172 nationwide, and produced substantial quantities of foundation seeds, including 20 metric tonnes of rice and 5.7 metric tonnes of maize.

Research and development activities led to the introduction of two new postharvest technologies and the development of innovative food products such as millet-based cookies and noodles.

In the area of manufacturing and materials science, CSIR, in collaboration with the Association of Ghana Industries (AGI), fabricated and deployed high-quality agro-processing equipment and also developed a 6-horsepower petrol engine mower. In the energy sector, the Council promoted clean cooking by training 35 manufacturers of improved cookstoves, with ten (10) selected for advanced training as trainer of trainers.

Budget Allocation for 2026

Table 2: Details of Total Budget Allocation for 2026

ITEM	GOG	IGF	DONOR	TOTAL
Compensation for Employees	495,900,671.00	324,017,459.00	-	819,918,130
Goods and Services	27,822,745.00	175,368,846.00	97,824,750.00	301,016,341
Capital Expenditure (Capex)	60,000,000.00	106,554,122.00	62,100,000.00	228,654,122
TOTAL	**583,723,416.00**	**605,940,427.00**	**159,924,750.00**	**1,349,588,593**

Source: Ministry of Finance

Outlook for 2026

The Ministry, through its agencies and departments plans to undertake the following programmes and activities in the year 2026:

- To contribute to the government's **Tree for Life Restoration Programme,** the '**One Child, One Tree**' initiative will seek to achieve the planting of 1 million trees in collaboration with the EPA and MLNR to get many more children to plant and nurture a tree as their contribution towards the government's tree for life programme.

- To promote government's climate change agenda, the implementation of bilateral cooperation agreements under Article 6 of the Paris Agreement, a new carbon budget for carbon market projects will be published as part of resource mobilisation to achieve the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs).

- In line with government's climate change adaptation and resilience policy, the Ministry as part of its resource mobilisation drive towards achieving the NDCs will engage with the Adaptation Fund to mobilise US$15million towards resilience building in the Eastern Region of Ghana.

- To support government's blue economy strategy, the Ministry will continue the implementation of the West Africa Coastal Areas Resilience Investment Project (WACA RESIP 2) through investments in physical, social and nature-based solutions to enhance protection against coastal erosion and flooding in selected sites in the Densu Delta and Keta Lagoon Complex Area.

- In fulfilment of government's agenda of leveraging private sector expertise and investments for job creation through the set-up of plastic recycling plants to create pellets for other products and exports, under the World Bank Problue initiative, the Ministry will work to finalise the draft Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) scheme (L.I) for submission to Cabinet for approval and Parliament for ratification.

- To achieve government's agenda for ensuring institutional development and regulatory framework, the EPA will ensure the enforcement of the regulations on effluent, air quality, ozone, petroleum, and the certification of air conditioners to support sustainable development.

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee made the following observations during the deliberations:

Increase in Budgetary Allocation

The Committee noted that the total budgetary allocation to the Ministry for the 2026 financial year stands at one Billion, three hundred and forty-nine million, five hundred and eighty-eight thousand, five hundred and ninety-three Ghana Cedis (GH₵1,349,588,593.00), compared to nine hundred and eighty-five million, two hundred and fifty thousand, four hundred and six Ghana Cedis (GH₵985,250,406.00) approved for 2025. This reflects a significant increase of three hundred and sixty-four million, three hundred and thirty-eight thousand, one hundred and eighty-seven Ghana Cedis (GH₵364,338,187.00), representing 37.0 per cent year-on-year growth.

The Ministry attributed this upward adjustment primarily to the provision made for the recruitment of 500 scientists across five (5) of its agencies, estimated at Forty-five Million Ghana Cedis (GH₵45,000,000.00). Further upward pressure on Compensation of Employees resulted from the additional recruitment of staff of the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) in line with its new status as an authority, amounting to one hundred and eighty million, nine hundred and sixty-six thousand, six hundred and seventy-three Ghana Cedis (GH₵180,966,673.00). The allocation also incorporates provision for foreign inflows totalling one hundred and fifty-nine million, nine hundred and twenty-four thousand, seven hundred and fifty Ghana Cedis (GH₵159,924,750.00).

The Committee commended the increased allocation to the Ministry as a positive step towards strengthening its human resource base and operational capacity. The Committee, however, reiterated its commitment to robust oversight to ensure that the allocated funds are utilised effectively and exclusively for the purposes for which they have been approved.

Ministry – Headquarters

The Committee observed that a total amount of one hundred and sixty-seven million, eight hundred and twenty-four thousand, five hundred and sixteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵167,824,516.00) has been allocated to the Ministry Headquarters to implement its programmes and activities in the 2026 financial year.

It was further noted with concern that fifty-one million, two hundred and fifty thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵51,250,000.00) from the Headquarters' allocation is earmarked specifically for the completion of the Foundry and Machine Tooling Centre Projects.

While the Committee recognises the importance of these strategic industrial initiatives, it expressed surprise that the remaining balance of one hundred and sixteen million, five hundred and seventy-four thousand, five hundred and sixteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵116,574,516.00), representing approximately 69% of the total Headquarters allocation, may be insufficient to sustain the Ministry's core administrative and operational functions throughout the year.

The Committee further noted persistent discrepancies between approved budgets and actual releases, particularly under Goods and Services, estimated at fifty-five million, forty-six thousand, nine hundred and fifteen cedis, sixty-five pesewas (GH₵55,046,915.65). The Ministry explained that a significant portion of the Capital Expenditure (CAPEX) allocation of Seventy-Seven Million Ghana Cedis (GH₵77,000,000.00) remains unutilised due to delayed reflection of payments in the Ministry's accounts as of October 2025. These delays in releases continue to hinder the timely implementation of planned programmes and weaken operational effectiveness.

The Committee, therefore, strongly recommends that the Ministry of Finance prioritise the release of the outstanding seventy-seven Million Ghana Cedis (GH₵77,000,000.00) to enable the Ministry Headquarters to fully execute its programmed activities and deliver on its mandate for the 2026 fiscal year.

Expenditure on Compensation

The Committee observed with concern that some agencies under the Ministry exceeded their approved allocations for Compensation of Employees during the 2025 financial year.

Specifically, the Council for Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) was approved an amount of two hundred and eighty-eight million, seven hundred and seventy-two thousand and eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵288,772,008.00) for Compensation, yet actual expenditure amounted to Three Hundred and Seven Million, Four Hundred and Forty-Three Thousand, Three Hundred and Sixty-Six Cedis, Forty-Six Pesewas (GH₵307,443,366.46), resulting in an overrun.

Similarly, the National Biosafety Authority (NBA) received an approved budgetary allocation of nine hundred and seventy-eight thousand, three hundred and ninety Ghana Cedis (GH₵978,390.00) but expended One Million, three hundred and thirty-five thousand, nine hundred and twenty-one cedis, twenty-three Pesewas (GH₵1,335,921.23). This translated into a negative variance of three hundred and fifty-seven thousand, five hundred and thirty-one Ghana Cedis, Twenty-Three Pesewas (GH₵357,531.23).

These overruns indicate weaknesses in payroll management, establishment control, and expenditure forecasting within the affected agencies. Such excess expenditure on Compensation places pressure on the overall budget execution of the Ministry and risks diverting resources from critical operational and programme activities.

The Ministry explained that expenditure overruns were a result of transfers, promotions and recruitment that come as amended salaries paid by Controller and Accountant General's Department.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry be exhaustive in anticipating its human resource activities when budgeting in subsequent years.

Electrical and Electronic Waste Management Fund (E-Waste)

The Committee observed that an amount of Eight Hundred and sixty-six thousand, three hundred and eighty-nine Ghana Cedis, Eighty-Five Pesewas (GH₵866,389.85) was approved in 2025 under Compensation for staff engaged in the management of the Electrical and Electronic Waste Fund. However, the Committee was concerned to note that no release was effected during the period under review, despite the approval.

The Committee stressed that effective E-waste management is critical to environmental protection, public health, and the safe handling of hazardous electronic materials. The absence of compensation releases risks undermining the operational continuity of the programme and its capacity to deliver on its mandate.

The Committee, therefore, urges the Ministry of Finance to urgently release the outstanding compensation for the 2024–2025 period to ensure staffing stability. Furthermore, the Committee recommends enhanced financial support for the E-Waste programme going forward, to strengthen its sustainability and improve national environmental safeguarding efforts.

National Biosafety Authority (NBA)

The Committee noted that in the 2025 financial year, the National Biosafety Authority (NBA) received an approved allocation of three million, two hundred and thirty-six thousand, five hundred and eighty-nine Ghana Cedis, Seventy-One Pesewas (GH₵3,236,589.71). Out of this amount, actual expenditure stood at Two Million, two hundred and thirty-eight thousand, eight hundred and forty-nine Cedis, sixty-eight Pesewas (GH₵2,238,849.68), indicating underutilisation of resources made available to the Authority.

During its deliberations, the Committee was informed of the pressing need to review the Biosafety Act, 2011 (Act 831) to address staffing challenges and operational constraints. The Authority's office infrastructure was said to be in a dilapidated state, adversely affecting service delivery and staff performance.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance urgently release the necessary funds to facilitate renovation of the Authority's office building to ensure a conducive and safe working environment.

Additionally, the Committee emphasises the importance of prioritising recruitment to fill existing staffing gaps and urges the timely review of the Biosafety Act, 2011 (Act 831), with the aim of enhancing regulatory effectiveness, ensuring biosafety compliance, and strengthening revenue generation to support national development.

Nuclear Regulatory Authority (NRA)

The Committee observed that a total amount of Twenty-Six Million, Three Hundred and Nineteen Thousand, Eight

Hundred and Eighty-Three Cedis, Forty Pesewas (GH₵26,319,883.40) was allocated to the Nuclear Regulatory Authority (NRA) for the 2025 fiscal year. As at October 2025, Eighteen Million, Nine Hundred and Seventy Thousand, Seven Hundred and Twenty Cedis, One Pesewa (GH₵18,970,720.01) had been released, representing 72 per cent of the approved allocation.

The Committee noted that the Authority remains heavily dependent on donor support for staff training, which poses a sustainability risk to its regulatory mandate. Inadequate Capital Expenditure (CAPEX) continues to constrain the acquisition of critical regulatory tools, infrastructure and safety-related equipment. Nonetheless, the Committee commended the NRA for its prudent and efficient utilisation of the limited resources made available.

The Committee was further informed that significant logistics gaps persist, particularly in relation to vehicles, office accommodation, and essential equipment. These operational deficiencies hinder effective field monitoring, inspections and staff productivity.

The Committee accordingly urges the Ministry of Finance to prioritise and enhance budgetary support to the Authority, with emphasis on CAPEX and capacity-building investments, in order to strengthen its operational efficiency and regulatory credibility. In light of the current fiscal constraints, the Committee also recommends that the Authority consider the use of Public-Private Partnership (PPP) arrangements as an innovative approach to address its office accommodation and related infrastructural challenges.

Environmental Protection Authority (EPA)

The Committee noted that the Environmental Protection Authority (EPA) was allocated a total amount of Two Hundred and Fifty-Nine Million, Five Hundred and Sixty-One Thousand, Three Hundred and Ten Cedis (GH₵259,561,310.00) for its operations in 2025. Out of this allocation, the Authority expended Two Hundred and Thirty-Seven Million, Five Hundred and Twenty-Eight Thousand, Four Hundred and Thirty-Three Cedis (GH₵237,528,433.00), representing 91.5 per cent budget execution.

Despite the overall positive outturn, the Committee observed a significant over-expenditure under Goods and Services. An approved allocation of Seventy-Four Million, One Hundred and Sixty Thousand, Two Hundred and Sixty-Two Cedis (GH₵74,160,262.00) was exceeded by actual spending amounting to ninety-three million, two hundred and five thousand, one hundred and ninety-five Cedis (GH₵93,205,195.00). This resulted in a variance of Nineteen Million, Forty-Four Thousand, Nine Hundred and Thirty-Three Cedis (GH₵19,044,933.00), representing approximately a 25 per cent overrun. The Authority explained that this was driven by the intensification of illegal mining activities (galamsey), which substantially increased enforcement and monitoring requirements.

The Committee also noted that the Authority does not currently have the financial capacity to undertake new office construction, and therefore requires support to rehabilitate and upgrade existing facilities to ensure a functional working environment.

In light of these concerns, the Committee recommends that Government strengthen financial oversight mechanisms to ensure strict adherence to approved budgetary limits. Any additional expenditure requirements should be justified and approved in advance to avoid fiscal slippages, while ensuring that the Authority remains adequately resourced to respond effectively to escalating environmental threats.

Council for Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)

The Committee observed that the total budgetary allocation for the Council for Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) in 2025 was three hundred and eighty million, one hundred and sixty-three thousand, four hundred and twenty-eight Cedis (GH₵ 380,163,428.00). However, actual expenditure amounted to four hundred and three million, eight hundred and twenty-seven thousand, four hundred and sixty-seven cedis, twenty-three pesewas (GH₵ 403,827,467.23), reflecting an overspending of twenty-three million, six hundred and sixty-four thousand, thirty-nine cedis and twenty-three pesewas (GH₵23,664,039.23), representing approximately a 6 per cent increase over the approved budget.

The Committee noted that this excess was primarily due to unforeseen government salary increments of 10 per cent, promotions for staff who obtained higher qualifications, and arrears related to the upgrade of 200 staff members.

The Committee recommends that the Council improves its budget planning by anticipating internal promotions and aligning projected costs more accurately to prevent future budget overruns.

Ghana Atomic Energy Commission (GAEC)

The Committee noted that the Ghana Atomic Energy Commission (GAEC) was allocated One Hundred and Forty-two million, eight hundred and ten thousand, two hundred and four Ghana Cedis, ninety-seven Pesewas (GH₵142,810,204.97) for 2025. As of October 2025, one hundred and seventeen million, four hundred and nineteen thousand, one hundred and seventy-nine Ghana Cedis and Two Pesewas (GH₵117,419,179.02) had been expended.

The Committee observed that high utility costs are adversely affecting the smooth operations of GAEC laboratories, and that inadequate logistics have constrained the implementation of some national programmes.

Additionally, insufficient funding has delayed the completion of the fencing project intended to protect GAEC lands from encroachment.

The Committee recommends that GAEC explores innovative energy solutions to reduce utility costs and that the Ministry of Finance allocates sufficient funds to enable the timely completion of the land fencing project.

Nuclear Power Institute (NPI)

The Committee noted that the Nuclear Power Institute (NPI) serves as a technical advisory body responsible for enhancing national understanding of nuclear science, promoting the peaceful use of nuclear energy, undertaking technical studies, developing policies and strategies, and informing government decisions on nuclear power.

The Committee observed that the Institute’s budgetary requirement for the year 2026 was Five Million, Five Hundred Thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵5,500,000.00), yet only One Hundred Thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵100,000.00), representing 1.8 per cent of the requested amount, was granted, which is woefully inadequate to support its critical functions.

In view of the Institute’s pivotal role in the establishment of Ghana’s first nuclear power plant, the Committee recommends that NPI be adequately funded, particularly through consideration during the supplementary budget, to ensure the effective execution of its mandate.

Conclusion

The Committee, having reviewed and examined the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology, is satisfied that the proposed policies and programmes are well-aligned with Government’s industrialisation agenda and are likely to contribute significantly to national economic growth.

Accordingly, the Committee recommends to the House the adoption of this report and the approval of the total sum of One Billion, Three Hundred and Forty-Nine Million, Five Hundred and Eighty-Eight Thousand, Five Hundred and Ninety-Three Ghana Cedis (GH₵1,349,588,593) to enable the Ministry to effectively undertake its planned activities for the 2026 Financial Year.

Mr Henry Godfred Bentil (NDC — Mpohor): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the sum of GH₵1,349,588,593.00 for the services of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the estimates for the Ministry of Sports and Recreation. Item numbered

29. The Chairman of the Committee is here.

MINISTRY OF SPORTS AND RECREATION

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Ernest Norgbe): Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the allocation of the sum of GH₵622,627,978.00 for the services of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Introduction

On Thursday, 13th November 2025, the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson, in accordance with Article 179(1) of the 1992 Constitution and Section 28 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), presented to Parliament the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the financial year ending 31st December 2026.

Pursuant to Order 251 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the 2026 Annual Estimates of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation to the Select Committee on Youth and Sports for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee met on Thursday, 27th November 2025 with the Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation, Mr Kofi Adams, and other officials of the Ministry, who assisted the Committee in deliberating on the estimates allocated to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation for the 2025 financial year.

Also in attendance were Mr Yaw Ampofo-Ankrah, Director-General of the National Sports Authority (NSA); Mr Bawah Fuseini, Acting Director of the National Sports College–Winneba; Mrs Wilhelmina Asamoah, Chief Director of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation; and an official from the Ministry of Finance (MoF).

The Committee expresses its gratitude to the Hon Minister and all the officials for their cooperation.

Reference Documents

The following documents were used as reference guide during the Committee's deliberations:

1. The 1992 Constitution;

2. The Standing Orders;

3. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year;

4. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year;

5. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Youth

and Sports for the 2025 Financial Year; and

6. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation for the 2026 Financial Year.

Vision, Mission, Mandate and Strategic Overview of the Ministry

The Ministry of Sports and Recreation is one of the newly created Ministries, established from the former Ministry of Youth and Sports during the previous administration. It is constituted under Executive Instrument (E.I.) of January 2025 (Civil Service (Ministries) Instrument, 2025) and operates pursuant to Sections 11 and 13 of the Civil Service Law (PNDCL 327).

The Ministry's overarching goal is to promote national integration, sustained macroeconomic stability, peace, a healthy population, and the attainment of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) through the advancement of sports for development and recreation.

The mandate of the Ministry is to formulate, coordinate, and implement Government policies for the sports and recreation sector. Its vision is to create an enabling sports and recreation environment that enhances personal wellbeing, strengthens international competitiveness, and supports national development.

The Ministry's mission is to develop, promote, and sustain accessible and inclusive sports and recreational opportunities and partnerships through strategic policies and programmes that enhance individual wellbeing, foster national cohesion, and drive excellence at the local and international levels.

Financial Performance for 2025
Table 1:

2025 Budget Allocation to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation (Economic Classification)		
ITEM	**AMOUNT**	**%**
COMPENSATION	36,989,566	56
GOODS AND SERVICES	28,909,890	44
CAPEX		
TOTAL	**65,899,456**	**100**

SOURCE: Program-Based Budget Estimates for Ministry of Sports and Recreation, 2025

Table 2:

2025 Budget Allocation to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation (Funding Sources)		
ITEM	**AMOUNT**	**%**
GOG	**61,769,566**	**94**
IGF	**4,129,890**	**6**
DONOR		
TOTAL	**65,899,456**	**100**

SOURCE: Program-Based Budget Estimates for Ministry of Sports and Recreation, 2025

For the 2025 fiscal year, the Ministry of Sports and Recreation and its Agencies were allocated a total amount of Sixty-Five Million, Eight Hundred and Ninety-Nine Thousand, Four Hundred and Fifty-Six Ghana Cedis (GH₵65,899,456) to implement planned programmes and activities.

Compensation of Employees amounted to thirty-six million, nine hundred and eighty-nine thousand, five hundred and sixty-six Ghana Cedis (GH₵36,989,566). An allocation of twenty-eight million, nine hundred and nine thousand, eight hundred and ninety Ghana Cedis (GH₵28,909,890) was approved for Goods and Services. No provision was made for Capital Expenditure (CAPEX) for the 2025 financial year.

Additionally, a sum of four million, one hundred and twenty-nine thousand, eight hundred and ninety Ghana Cedis (GH₵4,129,890) was approved as Internally Generated Funds (IGF) for the Ministry of Sports and Recreation.

Table 3:

2025 Budget Financial Performance of the Ministry as at September 2025					
Expenditure Item/ Funding Source	**2025 Approved Budget**	**Releases (End Sept 2025)**	**% Released**	**Actual Expenditure**	**% Actual Expendit ure**
	A	B		C	
Compensation Of Employees (GOG)	36,989,566.00	30,053,097.52	81.25	30,053,097.52	81.25
Goods And Services (GOG)	24,780,000.00	19,199,643.00	77.48	19,052,470.85	76.89
Igf	4,129,890.00	2,231,973.49	54.04	1,528,082.91	37.00

Capex (Gog)	0.00	0.00		0.00	
Total	**65,899,456.00**	**51,484,714.01**	**78.13**	**50,633,651.28**	**76.83**

SOURCE: Program-Based Budget Estimates for Ministry of Sports and Recreation, 2025

With respect to the 2025 financial performance of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation, an amount of Fifty-One Million, Four Hundred and Eighty-Four Thousand, Seven Hundred and Fourteen Ghana Cedis and One Pesewa (GH₵51,484,714.01), representing 78.13 per cent of the approved budget, had been released to the Ministry as of September 2025. Of this, Fifty Million, Six Hundred and Thirty-Three Thousand, Six Hundred and Fifty-One Ghana Cedis and Twenty-Eight Pesewas (GH₵50,633,651.28), constituting 76.83 per cent of the total budget allocation, was actually expended as at September 2025.

Key Achievements of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation in Year 2025

In 2025, the Ministry achieved the following under its three (3) development programmes: Management and Administration, Sports Development, and Promotion of Recreation.

Management and Administration

The Ministry of Sports and Recreation advanced several key initiatives in 2025, including securing Cabinet approval for the establishment of the Ghana Sports Fund to provide sustainable financing for the sector. A bill to operationalize the Fund is currently underway. The Ministry also strengthened national team support by facilitating the Black Stars' 2026 FIFA World Cup qualifying campaign—covering travel, accommodation, and per diem—which culminated in Ghana topping CAF Group I with 25 points from eight wins, one draw, and one loss.

In women's sports, the Black Queens represented Ghana at the 2025 TotalEnergies Women's AFCON in Morocco, held from 5th to 26th July 2025. With adequate resourcing from the Ministry, the team secured a bronze medal after a strong performance against South Africa, signalling a resurgence in women's football and reaffirming government commitment to advancing women's participation in sports.

The Ministry also made progress in anti-doping efforts through the work of the Anti-Doping Secretariat. Under the African Zone VI RADO framework, the Secretariat developed a comprehensive Education Plan to enhance awareness among athletes and stakeholders. It further conducted a sensitisation programme with the Ghana Boxing Federation on key anti-doping procedures and compliance requirements. To maintain global standards, the Secretariat completed and submitted the World Anti-Doping Agency Code Compliance Questionnaire on 6th May 2025, ensuring Ghana's continued adherence to international anti-doping regulations.

Sports Development

In early 2025, significant capacity-building initiatives were undertaken to strengthen technical expertise within Ghana's sports sector. From 4th to 7th February, the French Embassy, in partnership with the National Sports Authority, organised a high-performance training programme at the Accra Sports Stadium for 35 technical officers from various Olympic sports associations. Delivered by the Institute of Sports and Exercise Performance (INSEP), the programme introduced globally researched sports training modules, enhanced high-performance skills, and included practical fitness sessions.

Further training initiatives followed, including a Sports Psychology Course organised by the National Sports College and the NSA from 23rd to 26th March 2025, which equipped 70 administrators, coaches, and athletes with essential psychological principles that affect coaching and performance.

Additionally, from 9th to 13th April 2025, the NSA and the National Sports for All Ghana (NASFAG) held an Intermediate and Advanced Fitness Instructors Course at the National Sports College in Winneba, upgrading the skills of 32 instructors to support improved service delivery in fitness and sports programmes.

Promotion of Recreation

In 2025, Ghana hosted several major sporting events across multiple disciplines. The Ghana Athletics Association held its first Open Championship on 15th February at the Baba Yara Sports Stadium, showcasing top athletic talent nationwide. Tennis development also received a boost as the Tennis Foundation Ghana and the Ghana Tennis Federation organised the ITF Juniors J30 Tournament at the Borteyman Sports Complex from 31st March to 12th April, attracting young athletes from six countries.

Additionally, the Ghana Bodybuilding and Fitness Association hosted the IFBB West African Championship from 25th to 28th April at the Bukom Boxing Arena, featuring competitors from ten nations. Ghana's Dogbe Samson Selorm emerged victorious in the Men's Physique category, earning a prestigious Pro Card.

Ghana's youth football also made notable progress as the Black Starlets impressed at the 2025 WAFU B U17 Boys Championship. Although they lost 4–3 on penalties to Ivory Coast after a goalless draw, their strong performance secured qualification for the 2025 U17 Africa Cup of Nations in Morocco. This achievement highlights the potential of the young squad and strengthens Ghana's prospects in upcoming continental youth competitions.

BUDGETARY ALLOCATIONS FOR 2026

For the 2026 financial year, the Ministry of Sports and Recreation has been allocated a total amount of five hundred and eighty million, four hundred and twenty-four thousand, four hundred and thirteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵580,424,413). Of this allocation, Forty Million, One Hundred and Twenty-One Thousand, Eight Hundred and Forty-Three Ghana Cedis (GH₵ 40,121,843), representing 7 per cent of the total budget, is earmarked for Compensation of Employees. An amount of two hundred and seventy million, three hundred and two thousand, five hundred and seventy Ghana Cedis (GH₵270,302,570), constituting 47 per cent of the allocation, is designated for Goods and Services. For Capital Expenditure, the Ministry has been allocated Two Hundred and Seventy Million Ghana Cedis (GH₵270,000,000), also representing 47 per cent of the total budget.

Table 5:

2026 Budget Allocation to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation (Economic Classification)		
ITEM	**AMOUNT**	**%**
COMPENSATION	40,121,843	6.9
GOODS AND SERVICES	270,302,570	46.6
CAPEX	270,000,000	46.5
TOTAL	**580,424,413**	**100.0**

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy

Table 6:

2026 Budget Allocation to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation (Sources of Funds)		
ITEM	AMOUNT	%
GOG	575,679,043	99.2
IGF	4,745,370	0.8
DONOR		
TOTAL	580,424,413	100.0

Source: 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy

Of the Ministry's funding sources, allocations from the Government of Ghana, amounting to Five Hundred and Seventy-Five Million, Six Hundred and Seventy-Nine Thousand, Forty-Three Ghana Cedis (GH₵575,679,043), constitute 99 per cent of the total budget, while Internally Generated Funds, totalling four million, seven hundred and forty-five thousand, three hundred and seventy Ghana Cedis (GH₵ 4,745,370), account for only 1 per cent.

Table 7: Budget Allocations to Agencies Under the Ministry of Sports and Recreation

2026 BUDGET ESTIMATES BY COST CENTRES					
COST CENTRE	COMPENSATION	GOODS & SERVICES	CAPEX	IGF	TOTAL
GENERAL ADMINISTRATION	10,707,491	250,267,604	253,071,786		514,046,881
NATIONAL SPORTS COLLEGE	2,014,593	7,111,440	8,500,000		17,626,033
NATIONAL SPORTS AUTHORITY	27,399,759	3,555,720	3,328,214	4,745,370	39,029,063
RECREATION PROMOTION		4,622,436	5,100,000		9,722,436
TOTAL	40,121,843	265,557,200	270,000,000	4,745,370	580,424,413

Source: 2026 Budget Hearing Presentation to Committee on Youth and Sports

Outlook for 2026

i. In 2026, the Ministry intends to develop strategic national documents and policies to guide the operations and development of sports and recreation in the country.

ii. The Ministry has received Cabinet approval to establish a centralised fund, the “Ghana Sports Fund,” aimed at providing sustainable financing for all aspects of the sports and recreation ecosystem and reducing dependence on central government support. In 2026, the Bill and accompanying Regulations, which have already been initiated, will be finalised to enable the Ministry to mobilise funds effectively.

iii. The Ministry also plans to finalise the Ghana National Sports Policy, which is intended to align the country’s sports framework with international standards.

iv. The Ministry plans to review the Sports Act, 2016 (Act 934), to ensure that Ghana’s legislative and regulatory frameworks governing sports are robust and effective, thereby laying a solid foundation for the long-term growth and development of the sector.

v. Further, the Ministry plans to develop a Sports Bill to convert the National Sports College into a University.

vi. The Ministry plans to create and establish a National Recreation and Wellness Agency.

vii. Sensitisation on the Legislative Instrument (L.I.) for the Sports Act, 2016 (Act 934) will be undertaken to educate the youth and sports enthusiasts on the regulatory framework governing sports in Ghana.

viii. After establishing the Anti-Doping Agency in 2025, the Ministry plans to develop anti-doping regulations in 2026 to guide sportsmen in Ghana. It also intends to enforce and implement the Anti-Doping Act, 2024.

ix. The Ministry intends to develop strategic documents for national sports and recreation development, including a policy on tax exemptions for sports.

x. The Ministry intends to facilitate the participation of the Senior national team, the Black Stars in the 2026 FIFA world cup tournament.

xi. The Ministry will facilitate the participation of all national teams in local and international competitions, support Ghana's involvement in the 2026 Commonwealth Games, 2026 Youth Olympic Games and organise district and regional sports competitions, as well as sports competitions for schools and colleges.

xii. To promote sports development, the Ministry will continue the rehabilitation of the following stadia, Baba Yara Sports Stadium, phase II, Accra Sports Stadium, Essipong Sports Stadium, phases I and II, and the completion of the Abiriw Sports Stadium, phase II.

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee made the following observations and recommendations:

Increased Budget Allocation for the 2026 Financial Year

The Committee observed that the Ministry's budget allocation for 2026 increased substantially, rising from GH₵65,899,456.00 in 2025 to GH₵580,424,413 in 2026. This represents a 780 per cent increase over the 2025 allocation. The Committee was also pleased to note that provisions were made for capital expenditure in 2026, which was absent in 2025. Both Goods & Services and CAPEX saw significant increases, with CAPEX receiving GH₵270 million and Goods & Services GH₵265.5 million. The Ministry explained that the majority of the

CAPEX allocation is earmarked for the construction of three mini stadia.

Refurbishment of Sports Infrastructure stalled

The Committee was informed that, due to the absence of capital expenditure allocation in 2025, the Ministry was unable to undertake planned refurbishments of designated stadiums. Several ongoing stadium rehabilitation projects have stalled because of unpaid contractor arrears, including Essipong Stadium (Phases 1 & 2), Baba Yara Stadium, New Edubiase Stadium, and Bekwai Sports Facility. The Committee therefore recommends that the Ministry to prioritise the completion of these stalled sports infrastructure projects. It further recommends that the Ministry leverage on the increased budget allocation to prepare clear timelines and financing plans for the completion of these facilities and settle outstanding payments owed to contractors to prevent further cost escalations.

Ghana Sports Fund Bill

The Committee was informed that the Ministry has obtained Cabinet approval to establish the "Ghana Sports Fund," designed to provide sustainable financing for all aspects of the sports and recreation ecosystem and reduce reliance on central government support. The Ministry indicates that the draft Bill outlines multiple revenue sources for the Fund, including: an amendment to the Gaming Commission Act to allocate part of its revenue; the introduction of a sports lottery; a percentage of revenue from various sporting events; and a share of income from national games. The Committee is also of the view that a review of the ban on adverts on alcoholic beverages would attract sponsorship and shore up funds for the Sports fund. Currently, the Bill is with the Attorney General's office and, once finalised, will be presented to Parliament for legislation under a certificate of urgency.

He explained that this approach is necessary to leverage the upcoming 2026 World Cup to mobilise funds for the Sports Fund.

Weak Transparency and Monitoring Systems in Sports

The Committee expressed concern over the lack of structured monitoring of most sporting federations under the National Sports Authority. It noted weak reporting and audit trails, which often contribute to corruption and malfeasance. Reference was made to a report by the Ghana Integrity Initiative citing the sports sector as a high-risk area for corruption. In response, the Minister stated that he has mandated the submission of annual development plans by all sports federations.

He further intends to enhance monitoring to detect misreporting, non-performance, and financial irregularities, while promoting transparency through increased public disclosure of budgets and sponsorship arrangements for national teams. The Committee urges the Ministry to strengthen monitoring and accountability mechanisms.

Ghana's Preparation for FIFA 2026 World Cup Tournament

The Committee was informed that preparations for Ghana's participation in the 2026 World Cup have commenced. These preparations include the establishment of two committees—one of which is an inter-ministerial committee—to oversee all programmes and activities related to the tournament. The Minister further indicated that a lottery scheme is being introduced to raise funds to support logistics and other essential needs.

In response to the Committee's enquiry regarding the GH₵150 million allocation for the 2026 World Cup in the national budget, the Minister explained that the amount is based on estimates submitted by the Ghana Football Association (GFA). These estimates cover appearance fees, winning bonuses, and other commitments for players and technical staff. He clarified that the allocation does not include 50 per cent of the outstanding winning bonuses owed to the national team. The Minister also explained that the allocation excludes costs related to airlifting supporters, in line with the Government White Paper on the Dzamefe Report, which prohibits such expenditures.

Nonetheless, he assured the Committee that the Government will facilitate the mobilisation of funds from corporate institutions, both public and private to support interested supporters who wish to attend the tournament. He committed to providing periodic briefings to the House on the programmes undertaken and expenditures made from the World Cup budget. The Committee urges the Ministry to collaborate with the Ministry of Finance to settle all outstanding obligations.

Review on Ban on Alcohol Advertisements

The Committee observed that the ban on alcohol advertisements on television during soccer tournaments has had a significant negative impact on revenue inflows for funding sports activities in the country. The Ministry noted that the FDA's restriction on alcohol advertising during sporting events has reduced sponsorship opportunities and diminished the vibrancy of the local league, ultimately affecting the financing of national teams. It was further noted that such advertisements continue to appear during foreign tournaments, and many young people regularly watch the Premier League on DSTV. The Committee concurs that a review of the existing law is necessary to enhance sponsorship opportunities for both local and national teams.

Safety Concerns in Boxing and Other Sporting Events

The Committee expressed serious concern regarding the recent deaths of two boxers who sustained fatal injuries during their bouts. It questioned the absence of medical personnel at these events, noting that immediate first aid intervention might have prevented the tragic outcomes. The Committee also notes that the recommendations of the

Government White Paper on the Amarteifio Committee—particularly the establishment of an Interim Committee on Boxing—have been implemented. The Committee therefore recommends that the Ministry should adequately resource both the Interim Committee and the National Sports Authority to ensure that qualified medical personnel and appropriate medical facilities are present at all sporting venues. This, the Committee emphasises, is essential to safeguarding athletes' welfare and preventing similar incidents in the future.

Conclusion

The Committee recognises the increased budget allocation to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation for 2026 fiscal year as a significant and commendable effort toward strengthening sports and recreation in Ghana. The Committee believes that this enhanced allocation will enable the Ministry to address existing structural, financial, and policy shortcomings, thereby improving its overall effectiveness. It will also promote greater transparency, reinforce both emerging and established sports institutions, and support improved sports development outcomes across the country.

In light of the above, the Committee recommends that this Honourable House approve an allocation of Five Hundred and eighty million, four hundred and twenty-four thousand, four hundred and thirteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵580,424,413) for the Ministry of Sports and Recreation for the 2026 financial year.

Respectfully Submitted.

Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi I. Adams) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the sum of GH₵580,424,413.00 for the services of the Ministry of Sports and Recreation.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let us take item numbered 20 for the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment for the year ending 31st December 2026. The Chairman of the Committee is here. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

MINISTRY OF YOUTH DEVELOPMENT AND EMPOWERMENT

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Ernest Norgbe): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,621,252,519.00 for the services of the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Introduction

The Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson, on Thursday, 13th

November 2025, in accordance with Article 179(1) of the 1992 Constitution and Section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), presented to Parliament the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the financial year ending 31st December 2026.

In line with Order 251 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Annual Estimates of the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment for the 2026 fiscal year to the Select Committee on Youth and Sports for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee held a meeting on Monday, 1st December 2025 with the Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment, Hon George Opare-Addo, accompanied by technical officers from the Ministry, to deliberate on the budget estimates. Also in attendance were Mrs Emma Ofori Agyemang, Chief Director of the Ministry; Mr Eric Agyei, Chief Executive Officer of the National Entrepreneurial and Innovation Programme; Ms Ruth Dela Seddoh, Director-General of the National Service Authority; Mr Osman Ayariga, Chief Executive Officer of the National Youth Authority; Ms Prisca Sedinam Kekeshie, Deputy Chief Executive Officer of the Youth Employment Agency; as well as officials from the Ministry of Finance. Representatives from three youth-focused civil society organizations—Youth Bridge Foundation, Youth Advocates Ghana, and Youth Empowerment for Life—also participated in the meeting.

The Committee expresses its appreciation to the Hon Minister and all officials present for their cooperation and support during the deliberations.

Reference Documents

The following documents were used as reference guide during the Committee's deliberations:

1. The 1992 Constitution;
2. The Standing Orders;
3. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year;
4. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year;
5. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Youth and Sports for the 2025 Financial Year; and
6. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment for the 2026 Financial Year.

Mandate and Policy Framework of the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment

The Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment, formerly part of the Ministry of Youth and Sports under the previous administration, now exists as a standalone Ministry dedicated exclusively to youth-related policy formulation and implementation. The Ministry is established by Executive Instrument (E.I.) 1 of 2025, with the mandate to formulate, coordinate, and monitor policies and programmes that promote youth development and empowerment. According to the National Medium-Term Development Framework, the Ministry's key policy objectives are to:

- enhance coordination mechanisms for youth development;
- promote effective youth participation in socio-economic development; and
- strengthen youth involvement in politics, electoral democracy, and governance.

The overarching goal of the Ministry is to build an inclusive ecosystem in which highly empowered and globally competitive youth play meaningful roles in national development. The vision of the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment is to develop an empowered youth population, capable of contributing to national progress and global competitiveness. The Ministry's mission is to formulate and promote policies that empower the youth, monitor youth development programmes, and coordinate partnerships and opportunities through inclusive approaches for sustainable national development.

Financial Performance for 2025

For the 2025 fiscal year, the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment and its Agencies were allocated a total amount of Six Hundred and forty-four million, eighty thousand, six hundred and fifty-six Ghana Cedis (GH₵644,080,656) to implement planned programmes and activities. Of this amount, thirty-eight million, fourteen thousand, six hundred and fifty-six Ghana Cedis (GH₵38,014,656) was allocated for Compensation of Employees, while five hundred and thirty-eight million, eight hundred and forty-two thousand, four hundred and thirty-nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵538,842,439) was earmarked for Goods and Services. Additionally, sixty-seven million, two hundred and twenty-three thousand, five hundred and sixty-one Ghana Cedis (GH₵67,223,561) was provided for Capital Expenditure (Capex). Furthermore, a sum of eighteen million, seventy-five thousand, four hundred and two Ghana Cedis (GH₵18,075,402) was approved as Internally Generated Funds (IGF) for the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment.

Table 1:

2025 Budget Allocation to the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment				
	GOG	IGF	TOTAL	%
COMPENSATION	38,014,656		38,014,656	6
G&S	527,990,598	10,851,841	538,842,439	84
CAPEX	60,000,000	7,223,561	67,223,561	10
TOTAL	626,005,254	18,075,402	644,080,656	100

SOURCE: *2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, MOF*

Table 2

2025 Budget Allocation to the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment (Sources of Funds)		
ITEM	AMOUNT	%
GOG	626,005,254	98
IGF	18,075,401	2
TOTAL	644,080,655	100

SOURCE: *2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, MOF*

Table 3.

Summary of Expenditure as at September 2025				
ECONOMIC CLASSIFICATION	**2025 APPROVED/REVISED BUDGET (GH₵) -A**	**2025 RELEASED (ALLOTMENT) (GH₵) - C**	**2025 EXPENDITURE (RELEASE) (GH₵) - D**	**% EXPENDITURE**
COM. OF EMPLOYEES	38,014,656	29,293,911	29,293,911	77
GOODS & SERVICES	538,842,439	421,330,598	266,419,597	49
CAPEX	67,223,561	0	0	0
TOTAL	**644,080,656**	**450,624,509**	**295,713,508**	**46**

SOURCE: ***Program-Based Budget Estimates for Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment*, 2026**

With respect to the 2025 financial performance of the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment (MYDE), a total of four hundred and fifty million, six hundred and twenty-four thousand, five hundred and nine Ghana Cedis (GH₵450,624,509) (70 per cent) had been released to the Ministry as of September 2025. of this amount, two hundred and ninety-five million, seven hundred and thirteen thousand, five hundred and eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵ 295,713,508), representing approximately 46 per cent of the total budget allocation, had been expended by the same period.

Table 4:

BUDGET PERFORMANCE AT OCTOBER 2025

COST CENTRE	APPROVED/ REVISED BUDGET	RELEASED BUDGET	% RELE ASED	ACTUAL EXPENDITURE	% EXPENDITURE
HQ	12,565,294	14,341,925	114	10,565,547	84
NEIP	110,000,000	83,300,000	76	34,500,000	31
NSA	39,183,835	26,538,842	68	26,508,842	68
NYA	308,887,364	232,138,607	75	100,682,496	33
SS	178,444,162	177,402,898	99	177,402,898	99
TOTAL	649,080,655	533,722,272	82	349,659,783	54
YEA (STATUTORY FUNDS)	1,771,556,792	582,229,073	33		

SOURCE: MYDE Presentation to the Committee on Youth and Sports

As at October 2025, the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment (MYDE) and its agencies had received 54 per cent of their total Government of Ghana (GoG) budget allocation for the year. Specifically, by the end of October, the MYDE Headquarters had received 84 per cent of its approved allocation, while the National Entrepreneurship and Innovation Programme (NEIP) had received only 31 per cent. The National Service Authority (NSA) had received 68 per cent of its allocation, and the National Youth Authority (NYA) had received 33 per cent.

The Scholarship Secretariat recorded the highest disbursement, receiving 99 per cent of its 2025 allocation. With respect to statutory funds—including the Communication Service Tax (47 per cent), the District Assemblies Common Fund (10 per cent), and the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GET Fund) (5 per cent)—the Youth Employment Agency (YEA) had received only 33 per cent of its total allocation as at October 2025, with no releases recorded from the DACF.

Non-Financial Performance for the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment 2025

Management and Administration

As a new Ministry established in 2025, it collaborated with the Management Services Division, developed an Institutional Framework to guide administrative functions. Functional Directorates were established with appointed Directors and Unit Heads, and all Governing Boards were inaugurated. A stakeholder forum and a Sector Technical Working Group were set up to enhance coordination within the youth ecosystem. The Ministry also prepared a medium-term development plan to provide strategic direction, and the 2025 Budget was approved by Parliament. In partnership with stakeholders, a Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) tracker was developed to monitor youth activities nationwide, scheduled for launch before year-end.

The Adwumawura Programme, aimed at training and providing working capital to 10,000 youth entrepreneurs, was officially launched on 28th April 2025 at the Prempeh Assembly Hall in Kumasi. Similarly, the National Apprenticeship Programme (NAP), designed to provide technical and vocational training to 10,000 young people, was launched on 30th April 2025 at the University for Development Studies (UDS), Tamale Campus. In support of the implementation of these flagship government initiatives, the Ministry developed comprehensive policy guidelines for both the Adwumawura Programme and the National Apprenticeship Programme to guide their effective execution.

The Ministry has implemented key initiatives to promote youth development and empowerment. It launched the “RED MEANS STOP CAMPAIGN” with stakeholders and UNDP to address drug and opioid abuse among young people. In collaboration with the National Youth Authority, the Ministry also commemorated National Youth Month on 1st August 2025, conducting sensitisation, education, and leadership activities at district, regional, and national levels. To guide policy, the Ministry carried out four major research studies on youth health and wellbeing, substance abuse, education, skills development, economic empowerment, and youth aspirations, including civic engagement and volunteerism, strengthening evidence-based decision-making in the youth ecosystem.

Youth Development and Empowerment

The National Apprentices Programme (NAP), launched on 30th April 2025, provided free apprenticeship training for youth, women, persons with disabilities, and rural communities. By September, 250,000 applications were received. 4,057 Mastercraft Persons were trained and placed in a national pool, while the pilot phase onboarded 10,000 trainees and 2,000 trainers, with training tools and PPE distributed to beneficiaries.

A total of 5,910 young people have benefited from the District Skills and Entrepreneurship Roadshow, a collaboration between the NYA and Africa Skills Hub Foundation (ASH). The programme provides practical skills training and entrepreneurship support, particularly for females in the agriculture value chain, while promoting dialogue with stakeholders and delivering health and social awareness campaigns to strengthen youth participation in economic and community development.

To strengthen financial management and ensure value for money, the National Service Authority (NSA) completed a joint audit with the Ministry of Finance on personnel allowances, improved deployment systems, and successfully developed two cohorts from Colleges of Education and Nursing Training Colleges. Additionally, the NSA signed an MoU with the Ministry of Defense to provide military training for 10,000 personnel in the 2025/2026 service year. In collaboration with the Feed Ghana Programme, the Authority cultivated 5,000 acres of maize, rice, and tomatoes, expanded Papao farm poultry capacity to 100,000 birds, and posted 1,500 personnel to acquire skills in agriculture and poultry production under Anchor farmer support.

Job Creation

The Adwumawura Programme onboarded 10,000 youth for entrepreneurship training on 3rd October 2025, with 2,000 expected to receive startup capital by year-end. The National Entrepreneurship and Innovation Programme (NEIP) developed a comprehensive training manual and partnered with 120 innovation hubs, universities, and the British Council to provide structured training, coaching, and mentorship. NEIP also collaborates with UNDP and the Mastercard Foundation under the Young Africa Innovate Programme to support women, persons with disabilities, and atypical innovators. The Youth Employment Agency (YEA) trained 12,000 Community Police Assistants and 5,000 youth in Fire Service, facilitated employment for 10,400 youth, and plans multiple 2026 initiatives including animal farming, fish farming, sustainable charcoal, and Turkey Berry production.

Budgetary Allocations for 2026

For the 2026 financial year, the Ministry has been allocated a total of one billion, six hundred and twenty-one million, two hundred and fifty-two thousand, five hundred and nineteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵1,621,252,519) to execute its programmes and activities. Of this, One Billion, One Hundred and Ten Million, Eighty Thousand, Six Hundred and Fifty-Five Ghana Cedis (GH₵1,110,080,655), representing 68.5 per cent of the total budget, is earmarked for Compensation of Employees. four hundred and seventy-nine million, one hundred and seventy-one thousand, eight hundred and sixty-four Ghana Cedis (GH₵479,171,864), equivalent to 29.6 per cent, is allocated to Goods and Services, while Thirty-Two Million Ghana Cedis (GH₵32,000,000), or 2 per cent, is designated for Capital Expenditure

.

Table 5:

2026 Budget Allocation to the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment					
ITEMS	GOG	IGF	FOREIGN GRANTS	TOTALS	%
COMPENSATION	1,110,080,655			1,110,080,655	68.50%
GOODS AND SERVICES	375,000,000	21,371,864	82,800,000	479,171,864	29.60%
CAPEX	32,000,000			32,000,000	2.00%
TOTALS	1,517,080,655	21,371,864	82,800,000	1,621,252,519	100%
%	93.60%	1.30%	5.10%	100.00%	

Source: 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, MOF

In terms of funding sources, Government of Ghana (GoG) contributions amount to one billion, five hundred and seventeen million, eighty thousand, six hundred and fifty-five Ghana Cedis (GH₵ 1,517,080,655), representing 93.6 per cent of the total budget allocation. Additionally, twenty-one million, three hundred and seventy-one thousand, eight hundred and sixty-four Ghana Cedis (GH₵21,371,864), constituting 1.3 per cent, is expected to be generated internally. A new funding source—foreign grants—amounts to eighty-two million, eight hundred thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵82,800,000).

Table 6:

2026 BUDGET CEILING FOR THE MINSTRY AND AGENCIES(GOG)		
MYDE	GRAND TOTAL	%
HQ	44,149,475	2.7%
NEIP	50,327,736	3.1%
NYA	46,953,549	2.9%
NSA	53,890,184	3.3%
NSP ALLOWANCES	1,040,731,575	64.2 %
NATIONAL APPRENTICESHIP PROGRAMME	170,000,000	10.5 %
ADWUMAWURA	160,000,000	9.9%
YEA	55,200,000	3.4%
TOTAL	1,621,252,519	100%
YEA (STATUTORY FUNDING)	2.3 Billion	

Source: Presentation On Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment for Parliamentary Budget Hearing, December 2025

Outlook for 2026

The Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment will in 2026, prioritise its core mandate of equipping young people to effectively contribute to the socioeconomic development of the country. As part of its 2026 programme, the Ministry plans to undertake research on key labour-related issues affecting the youth. The objective is to generate evidence-based data that will inform the formulation of realistic and responsive policies to address the current needs of young people in Ghana.

Given the comprehensive youth development and job creation initiatives being implemented, the Ministry proposes to strengthen its monitoring systems and conduct regular monitoring and evaluation of all programmes. This will ensure that the interventions are effectively empowering beneficiaries and achieving the intended training outcomes.

In preparation for the implementation of the Medium-Term Development Plan (MYDE 2027 Action Plan), the Ministry will, in 2026, coordinate the development and review of key policies that will guide the national agenda for youth empowerment in Ghana.

In 2026, the Ministry will also develop the Start-Up Bill and initiate processes toward the establishment of the Start-Up Agency. Additionally, the Ministry will develop the Legislative Instruments for the operationalisation of both the National Youth Agency and the National Service Authority.

The Ministry will continue the implementation of the “Red Means Stop Campaign,” a national initiative aimed at raising awareness on the dangers associated with substance abuse.

The Ministry will also sustain the implementation of its flagship programmes—Adwumawura and the National Apprenticeship Programme. In 2026, it aims to train 16,000 beneficiaries under the Adwumawura Programme.

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee made the following observations and recommendations;

Inadequate Funding for Youth Agencies Under the Ministry

The Committee expressed serious concern over the persistent delays and inadequate release of funds to agencies under the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment, resulting in significant underfunding and hindering the implementation of planned programmes. By September 2025, only GH₵ 295,713,508—representing about 46 per cent of the approved GH₵644,080,656 budget—had been spent. In 2026, the budget of the ministry has been increased to GH₵ 1,621,252,519 which is a 151.72 per cent increase as compared with that of 2025. With the current trend of releases, the Committee wonders whether the funds would be released. Given the Ministry’s critical role in providing sustainable employment for the youth, the Committee warned that continued resource gaps pose potential security risks. It therefore recommends that the Minister for Finance ensure timely and sufficient disbursement of funds to enable the Ministry and its agencies to deliver on their mandate.

Statutory Funds for Youth Development Programmes

The Committee observed, with grave concern, the persistent non-release of mandatory statutory allocations intended for agencies under the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment. These allocations—comprising 47 per cent of the Communication Service Tax, 10 per cent of the District Assemblies Common Fund, and 5 per cent of the Ghana Education Trust Fund for the Youth Employment Agency (YEA), as well as the 5 per cent DACF allocation for the National Youth Authority (NYA)—have not been disbursed as required. Civil society organisations highlighted a consistent decline in budget performance from these statutory sources, reflecting diminishing compliance with the YEA Act, 2015 (Act 887) and the NYA Act, 2016 (Act 939). Notably, allocations to YEA and NYA have fallen drastically from their statutory 10 per cent and 5 per cent in 2017 to only 0.6 per cent each in 2025.

The Committee stressed that honouring these statutory obligations would have provided adequate resources for these agencies to deliver sustainable youth employment initiatives. It further underscores that ministerial budget directives cannot supersede Acts of Parliament. Consequently, the Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance uncap and fully release the statutory funds to enable the agencies to effectively carry out their mandates.

Allocations for Government Flagship Programmes

The Committee noted that financial projections for the Government's flagship programmes in 2026—specifically the Adwumawura and National Apprenticeship Programme (NAP)—reflect significant adjustments compared with their 2025 allocations. In 2025, the Adwumawura Programme received GH₵110,000,000, while the NAP was allocated GH₵300,000,000. For 2026, the Adwumawura allocation increases to GH₵160,000,000, representing a 45 per cent rise; however, the NAP allocation declines sharply to GH₵170,000,000, amounting to a 43 per cent reduction.

The Committee expressed concern that, despite the Ministry's plans to scale up beneficiary enrolment in 2026, the reduced funding—particularly for NAP—does not adequately support the intended expansion of programme beneficiaries.

The Committee therefore recommends that funding for future entrepreneurship and youth employment programmes be release-based rather than merely allocation-based, to ensure credible planning, predictable financing, and effective implementation.

Weak Coordination Among Youth Agencies

The Committee also observed a lack of effective coordination among the various agencies under the Ministry, resulting in overlapping programmes and duplication of efforts. This situation has contributed to inefficiencies, administrative friction, and the unnecessary waste of scarce resources. In response, the Ministry indicated that it has initiated coordination meetings among the agencies and is instituting stronger mechanisms to enhance oversight and harmonisation of activities. The Committee urges the Ministry to further streamline the operations of its agencies and to strengthen monitoring and evaluation systems to ensure coherence, efficiency, and successful implementation of all programmes.

State of the Youth Address 2025 (SOYA)

The Committee was informed that the country's first State of the Youth Address was launched by the Ministry in November this year to highlight the current circumstances and needs of young people in Ghana. The Address was based on four commissioned research studies focused on Health and Well-being; Education and Skills Development; Economic Empowerment; and Youth Aspirations. These studies were undertaken to generate baseline data, strengthen policy formulation, and ensure that government interventions are responsive to the real and evolving needs of the Ghanaian youth. The Ministry indicated that, in 2026, it intends to expand the research to district and rural communities in order to capture a more comprehensive understanding of youth realities across the country.

Conclusion

The Committee concludes that the agencies under the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment operate under severe fiscal and operational constraints, driven largely by the persistent non-release of statutory DACF funds, delays in Government of Ghana disbursements, and budget allocations that do not reflect actual programme demands. If these challenges remain unresolved, they risk undermining youth development efforts, exacerbating unemployment, and creating broader social and security vulnerabilities.

The Committee is confident that full and timely disbursement of the approved funds will significantly improve the Ministry's capacity to deliver meaningful opportunities for the nation's youth and address the critical challenge of unemployment. In light of this, the Committee unreservedly recommends that this August House approve a total budget allocation of one billion, six hundred and twenty-one million, two hundred and fifty-two thousand, five hundred and nineteen Ghana Cedis (GH₵1,621,252,519) for the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment for the 2026 financial year.

Respectfully Submitted.

7:37 p.m.

Any seconder?

Minister for Youth, Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams) (MP) Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion moved on behalf of the Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment.

Question proposed

Question put and Motion agreed to

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,621,252,519.00 for the services of the Ministry of Youth Development and Empowerment for the year ending 31st December 2026

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 24.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 24, by the Chairman of the Committee.

COMMISSION ON HUMAN RIGHTS AND ADMINISTRATIVE JUSTICE

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Mahama Ayariga) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the allocation of the sum of GH₵99,755,648 for the services of the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice for the year ending 31 December 2026.

Introduction

The Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson, on Thursday, 13th November 2025, presented to Parliament the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 financial year. This was in fulfilment of article 179 of the 1992 Constitution of Ghana and section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Pursuant to Order 254 (2) of the Standing Orders of the House, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ) to the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies for consideration and report.

The Committee subsequently met on Tuesday, 2nd November, 2025 and considered the referral. It expresses its appreciation to the Commissioner of CHRAJ, Mr Joseph Akanjolenur Whittal, his team, Mrs. Mary Awelana Addah from Transparency International Ghana, and officials from the Ministry of Finance for their cooperation.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberation on the referral:

i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana.

ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana.

iii. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016, (Act 921).

iv. The Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice Act, 1993 (Act 456).

v. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 and 2026 Financial Years.

vi. Report of the Special Budget Committee on the Annual Estimates of CHRAJ for the 2025 financial year.

vii. The Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2025 - 2028.

Mandate of the Commission

The mandate of the Commission is threefold, namely: Human Rights Protection, Administrative Justice in Public Services, and Anti-Corruption and Enforcement of the Code of Conduct for Public Officers as stipulated under chapter 18 of the 1992 Constitution and the CHRAJ Act, 1993 (Act 456).

Core Functions of the Commission

To achieve its mandate, the Commission carries out the following core functions, among others:

a. Investigates complaints of violations of fundamental human rights and freedoms, injustice, corruption, abuse of power and unfair treatment of any person by a public officer in the exercise of his or her official duties.

b. Investigates complaints regarding the functioning of Public Services, Administrative Services, Regional Coordinating Councils, District Assemblies, the Armed Forces, Police Service, and Prisons Service. These investigations focus on administrative failures affecting balanced structuring and equal access for all citizens.

c. Investigates complaints concerning practices and actions by persons, private enterprises and other institutions, where those complaints allege violations of fundamental rights and freedoms under the Constitution.

d. Investigates all instances of alleged or suspected corruption and misappropriation of public funds by officials and to take appropriate steps, including reports to the Attorney-General and the Auditor-General, resulting from such investigation.

e. Investigates complaints of human rights violations by persons and institutions in both private and public sectors.

f. Investigates complaints and allegations of corruption and misappropriation of public resources.

Review of 2025 Performance

The Commission received a total allocation of GH₵94,106,363.24 for its programmes and activities in 2025. The distribution is as follows: Compensation – GH₵69,436,508.00 (73.785 per cent), Goods and Services – GH₵8,682,759.24 (9.227 per cent), and Capital Expenditure – GH₵15,987,096.00 (16.988 per cent).

The breakdown of the allocation and expenditure is provided in Table I.

Table 1. 2025 Allocation and Releases

ITEM	Appropriation (GH₵) (A)	Released (Jan-Aug) (B)	Actual payment (Jan-Aug) (GH₵) (C)	Variance (GH₵) (A-B)	per cent Released (B/A*100)
Compensation	69,436,508.00	45,258,016.80	45,258,016.80	24,178,491.14	65.18per cent
Goods & Services	8,682,759.24	6,946,207.32	2,418,670.46	1,736,551.92	80per cent
CAPEX	15,987,096.00	1,896,463.90	0.00	14,090,632.10	11.86
TOTAL	94,106,363.24	54,100,688.06	47,676,687.32	40,005,675.16	57.49

Source: The Budget Estimates and Economic Policy for the 2026 Financial Year.

The Committee was informed that the releases to the Commission as at September, 2025 stood at 54,100,688.06, constituting 57.49 per cent of the total approved budget as indicated in Table 1.

Key Achievements in 2025

The following activities, among others, were carried out by the Commission in 2025:

i. Management and Administration

- 82 per cent structural completion and 24.04 per cent financial completion of work on the reconstruction of its Head Office at the Old Parliament House

- Approval process on both the revised Scheme of Service and Conditions of Service underway PSC & FWSC respectively.

ii. Human Rights

- The Commission hosted representatives from the National Commission on Small Arms and Light Weapons and the United Nations to discuss an empirical study on conventional arms and ammunition management, as well as efforts to prevent violent extremism in West Africa.

- Received 4,580 human rights complaints and resolved 4,241 of them. 1,759 public educations and sensitisation programmes on human rights were undertaken.

- Took part in a national forum on migration governance organised by the Coalition of CSOs on Migration Ghana, focused on strengthening coordinated CSO support and reviewing the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration.

- Joined a review meeting on the child marriage information portal, held by the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection and UNFPA, to assess progress and provide input.

- Attended the launch of the MFWA-CFI strategy on advancing gender equality in the media, an initiative aimed at addressing gender gaps and improving women's representation in Ghana and Côte d'Ivoire.

- Participated in a coordination meeting on the legal instrument for the AU Convention on Ending Violence Against Women and Girls, aimed at building consensus to guide Ghana's ratification process.

- Took part in an ECOWAS training workshop on addressing gender-based violence and sexual harassment, designed to strengthen the capacity of judicial, health and social sector actors.

- Joined the 2025 third-quarter Working Group Meeting on Protection and Human Rights, which focused on validating the Mental Health and Psychosocial Support Module and launching the National Referral Mechanism under the ATUU migration governance project.

iii. Administrative Justice

- Continued the partnership with the Public Sector Reform for Results Project (PSRRP) to Strengthen Grievance Redress Mechanism, and CHRAJ's policies, procedures and practices.

- Continued to collaborate with the Ghana Health Service in undertaking a project to conduct a research to "Assess Institutional Compliance with Anti-Fraud and Anti-Corruption procedure under the Primary Health Care Investment Programme for Result (P for R)"

- Received 137 Administrative Justice complaints and resolved 123 of them.

- Carried out a total of 515 public educations and sensitisation activities on administrative justice.

iv. Anti-Corruption

- Represented the Commission as part of Ghana's delegation at the 16 Resumed Session of the Implementation Review Group under the United Nations Convention against Corruption (UNCAC), in Vienna, Austria.

- Coordinated a NACAP High-Level Implementation Committee (HiLIC) meeting to consider and approve the 2023 NACAP Annual Progress Report (APR), and to deliberate on the next steps of the NACAP following its lapse in December 2024;

- Engaged the new government on the state of NACAP and other Anti-Corruption initiatives at the office of the Chief of Staff at the Presidency

- Constituted a Nine (9) member Nucleus Committee to begin the process of development of NACAP II.

- Launched and Disseminated the NACAP final independent end-term evaluation report.

- Received 11 anti-corruption complaints and resolved 153 cases. (150 included previous years' cases concluded in the year 2025). 548 public educations and sensitisation programmes on anti-corruption were undertaken.

Programmes and Activities for the Year 2026

The following programmes and activities, among others, will be undertaken by the Commission in the year 2026:

a. Conduct Corruption Risk Assessment (CRA) for two institutions: Lands Commission and the Ministry of Roads and Highways

b. Development of a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP's) for Whistleblower Protection with Technical Support from UNODC.

c. Organise training on Ethics and Integrity for Management and Staff of ten (10) Public Sector Institutions.

d. Organise sensitisation/public education programmes on Ethics and Integrity for basic schools.

e. Partner Civil Society to advocate for the enactment of the Conduct of Public Officers Bill into law to give effect to Chapter 24 of the Constitution.

f. Investigate 200 Corruption cases and breaches of the Code of Conduct for Public Officers.

g. Commence the development of the National Human Rights Action Plan (NHRAP).

h. Complete the adoption and commence implementation of the National Action Plan on Business and Human Rights (NAP on BHR) on the United Nations Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (UNGPs) in Ghana.

i. Engage Parliament, the Judiciary, NDPC, MDAs, and MMDAs on their role under the NAP-BHR.

j. Investigate about 9000 complaints relative to fundamental human rights and freedoms.

k. Engage resource persons on GBV and Human Rights.

l. Continue the reconstruction work at the Old Parliament House with the objective of achieving 95 per cent physical completion and 70 per cent financial completion.

m. Engage CSOs on Migration in promoting access to justice for migrants.

n. Establish a coordinated Citizen’s Complaint Centre with relevant Ministries for feedback mechanism on public policy and public service delivery.

o. Investigate 150 Administrative Justice complaints and provide remedies at the Head Office.

Budgetary Allocation for the Year 2026

For the year 2026, the Commission has been allocated an amount of Ninety-nine Million, Seven Hundred and Fifty-Five Thousand, Six Hundred and Forty-Eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵99,755,648.00) as against its budgetary requirement of Two Hundred and twenty-three Million, four Hundred and Eighty-Five Thousand, Nine Hundred and Eighty-Seven Ghana Cedis, Seventy-Six pesewas (GH₵223,485,987.76) for its programmes and activities. This leaves a shortfall of GH₵124,481,565.81 constituting 55.7 per cent

As indicated in Table 2 below, GH₵75,085,793.00 has been allocated to the Commission for Compensation, representing 72.27 per cent of the total budget. An amount of GH₵8,682,759.00, making up 8.70 per cent, is for Goods and Services, while GH₵15,987,096.00, representing 16.03per cent, has been designated for Capital Expenditure. The breakdown of the allocation by funding source and expenditure item is presented in Table 2:

Table 2. Breakdown of 2026 Budgetary Allocation by Source of Funding and Expenditure Item

Economic Classification	Funding Sources				
Item	GOG (GH₵)	IGF (GH₵)	Donor (GH₵)	Total (GH₵)	pe
Compensation	75,085,793.00	-	-	75,085,793.00	75.27
Goods and services	8,682,759.00	-	-	8,682,759.00	8.70
Capex	15,987,096.00	-	-	15,987,096.00	16.03
Total	99,755,648.00	-	-	99,755,648.00	100
per cent	100	0	0	100.00	

SOURCE: CHRAJ's 2026 Programme-Based Budget Estimates and Presentation

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee made the following observations and recommendations during its deliberations:

a. Budget Shortfall

The Committee observed that the 2025 allocation for all expenditure items of the Commission fell below the required budget for implementing its programmes and activities. For instance, out of the total budgeted amount of GH₵42,092,769.00 for Goods and Services, only GH₵8,682,759.00 was allocated to the Commission, resulting in a shortfall of GH₵33,410,010.00 (79.37per cent). Similarly, the Commission was allocated an amount of GH₵15,987,096.00 for CAPEX as against its requirement of GH₵53,233,805.00, thus leaving a funding gap of GH₵37,246,709.00 (69.97per cent).

The Committee noted that this funding gap had a significant impact on the implementation of the Commission's planned activities and programmes for the year 2025, such as combatting corruption and human rights abuses nationwide. The Committee therefore urges the Ministry of Finance to reconsider the allocation to the Commission in its mid-year supplementary budget.

b. Delays and Non-Releases of Funds

The Committee observed significant delays and gaps in the release and utilisation of funds allocated to the Commission. The institution's building project had stalled, although GH₵15,987,096 had been allocated for capital expenditure, including GH₵8 million earmarked for completing the Head Office. As of September, the Commission had not received any portion of this allocation. The Committee, therefore, recommends that the Ministry of Finance consider increasing the Commission's budget during the mid-year review to facilitate partial use of the facility.

For Goods and Services, the Commission was allocated GH₵10,543,335.00 for the year under review, out of which GH₵5,227,076.70 had been spent. Despite this, the Committee noted broader concerns with fund utilisation. Less than half of the GH₵8.6 million released for Goods and Services had been recorded as spent, while the GH₵8.1 million released for Capital Expenditure showed zero expenditure. These patterns raised concerns about the institution's ability to execute its programmes within the fiscal year.

The Commission explained that though released funds had been used, payments to vendors had not yet been processed. As a result, the expenditure does not appear in the budget records because the Controller has not completed the payment process. According to the Commission, this is due to challenges in accessing the funds at the Controller and Accountant-General's Department. The Committee urges the Commission to expedite efforts to complete the process.

c. Development Partners Contributions

Although development partners contributed GH₵1,860,576.00 to the Commission in 2025, this amount, which significantly supports Goods and Services, was not reflected in the Commission's annual budget allocation. The Committee was informed that these contributions are often provided as projections and may or may not materialise, which is why they are not included in the budget. The Committee further noted that in 2026, the Commission is expected to receive support totaling GH₵8,435,669.93.

The Committee emphasised that going forward, the Commission should include all contributions from development partners in its annual budget allocation to ensure transparency and accountability to both the government and the partners. Additionally, the Committee highlighted the need for the Commission to strategically engage more development partners by leveraging its mandate and aligning its programmes with donor priorities.

d. Infrastructure Development

The Committee noted that the Commission's 2026 budget allocation includes provisions for additional infrastructural works aimed at improving service delivery. The planned projects include:

- Construction of a fence wall for the Tamale Office
- Roof waterproofing works at the Head Office
- Complete reconstruction of the CHRAJ Head Office
- Commencement of an Office Complex in Tema

The Committee commends the Commission for taking steps to address office space challenges and for securing its land to prevent future litigation. It further advised the Commission to prioritise completing and utilising part of the Head Office while continuing work on the remaining sections. The Committee also urges the Ministry of Finance to review the Commission's allocation, particularly for capital expenditure, during the mid-year budget process.

e. Inadequate Vehicles

The Committee noted that the Commission lacks sufficient vehicles to effectively carry out its mandate as prescribed by Act 456. Many of the existing vehicles are in a poor condition and unfit for monitoring exercises and other operational activities.

The Commissioner informed the Committee that this situation limits the Commission's ability to respond to issues across the regions, undermining efforts to combat corruption, economic crimes, and to protect the rights of citizens. The Commission has budgeted for the purchase of some motor vehicles in the coming year.

The Committee emphasised the need for operational vehicles for the Regional Offices and urged the Ministry of Finance to allocate the necessary resources to enable the Commission to procure additional vehicles for its operations.

f. Civil Society Organisations (CSOs)

As part of effort to involve stakeholders in the Ministry's budget deliberations, and in line with Parliament's commitment to opening its work to the public, the Committee invited Transparency International Ghana, for the first time, to participate in the consideration of the CHRAJ 2026 budget. The representative thanked the Committee for the invitation and noted that such engagements offer a valuable platform to share perspectives on the Commission's performance and budget. She encouraged the Committee to institutionalise this level of stakeholder participation of future hearings.

The Organisation acknowledged CHRAJ's progress and achievements of its 2025 programmes and activities but raised concerns about gaps in financial management and expenditure reporting. It noted that less than half of the allocation for Goods and Services had been used and no payment had been recorded for Capital Expenditure. The Commission explained that the funds had been committed and were awaiting clearance from the Controller and Accountant-General. The organisation cautioned that these delays create a misleading picture of under-spending and weaken public confidence.

The organisation further highlighted broader systemic delays in authorisations and payment processing, which distort budget performance and hinder effective service delivery. During field visits, it observed that many CHRAJ offices lack basic resources and rely on external support. She emphasised that CHRAJ's broad mandate requires stronger and more consistent financial support to operate effectively and called on the Ministry of Finance to provide the necessary support to the Commission. The Committee appreciated the organisation's technical input and indicated that more civil society groups will be invited to future budget engagements.

Conclusion

The Committee has thoroughly reviewed CHRAJ's budget estimates for the 2026 fiscal year and believes that the Commission's proposed policies and programmes will be essential in fulfilling its mandate of promoting human rights, investigating complaints of maladministration, and combating corruption.

In light of this, the Committee recommends that the House adopt its Report and approve the total allocation of Ninety-nine Million, Seven Hundred and Fifty-Five Thousand, Six Hundred and Forty-Eight Ghana Cedis (GH₵99,755,648.00) to enable the Commission implement its planned programmes and activities for the 2026 fiscal year.

Mr Isaac Ashai Odamtten: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion and to present your report on the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies for the House to adopt and to approve the sum. May I urge the *Hansard* department to capture the entire report as if the same was fully read in its entirety.

Question proposed

Question put and Motion agreed to

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies on the allocation of the sum of GH₵99,755,648.00 for the service of the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 34

The Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 34 on page 14 of the *Order Paper,* by the Chairman of the Committee.

MINISTRY OF THE INTERIOR

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Peter Lanchene Toobu): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move* that this honourable House adopts the Report of the Joint Committee on Defence and Interior and Security and Intelligence on the allocation of the sum of GH₵12,577,077,977.00 for the services of the Ministry of the Interior for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Speaker, I present your Committee's report to be captured by *Hansard* as if it has been read entirely.

Introduction

The Hon Minister responsible for Finance, Hon. Dr. Cassiel Ato Baah Forson presented the Annual Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2026 in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution, Section 21 and 213 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act921) and Order 193 of the Standing Orders of the House.

The Annual estimates of the Ministry of the Interior were subsequently referred to the Select Committee on Defence and Interior for consideration and report, in accordance with Orders 195(4) and 247 of the Standing Orders of the House.

To examine the referral, the Committee met with the Hon Minister of the Interior, Alhaji Muntaka Mohammed-Mubarak, Heads of Agencies under the Ministry and officials of Ministries of the Interior and Finance and hereby submit this report.

The Committee expresses its heartfelt gratitude to the Minister and the officials for their assistance.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to and was guided by the following documents during the deliberations:

a. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

b. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;

c. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 926); and

d. Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) for 2026 – 2028;

e. Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) 2026-2028 for The Interior Ministry

f. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year; and

g. The Report of the Defence and Interior Committee on the Annual Estimates of the Interior Ministry for the 2025 fiscal year;

Background

The Ministry of the Interior exists to provide a safe and secure environment where socio-economic activities will thrive within the confines of the law to enable Ghana enhance its status as a middle-income country to achieve higher growth and development. The Ministry executes its mandate through the under-listed agencies:

a. Ghana Police Service (GP);

b. Ghana Prisons Service (PS);

c. Ghana National Fire Service (GNPS);

d. Ghana Immigration Service (GIS);

e. National Disaster Management Organization (NADMO);

f. National Identification Authority (NIA); and

g. Narcotics Control Commission (NACOC).

h. The Ministry also has oversight responsibility over the following institutions:

i. Gaming Commission of Ghana;

j. National Peace Council (NPC);

k. Ghana Refugee Board (GRB); and

l. National Commission on Small Arms and Light Weapons (NACSA).

To ensure the successful execution of its mandate, specific operational functions under the Ministry of the Interior have been assigned to each of the above-listed agencies to undertake.

Goal

The goal of the Ministry is to provide a safe and secure environment, where socio-economic activities will thrive within the confines of the law to enable Ghana enhance her status as a middle-income country to achieve higher growth and development.

Policy Objectives

The Ministry of the Interior intends to execute its mandate in the short to the medium term through the under-listed policy objectives:

a. Enhance public safety and security;

b. Enhance security service delivery;
c. Enhance Ghana's international image and influence;

d. Enhance capacity for policy formulation and coordination;

e. Ensure safety and security for all categories of road users;

f. Harness the benefits of migration for socio-economic development;

g. Promote proactive planning for disaster prevention and mitigation;

h. Ensure the rights and entitlements of children; and

i. Promote the fight against corruption and economic crimes.

2025 Performance Review

In pursuit of its mandate and in an effort to provide a safe and secure environment to promote economic growth and development, the Ministry of the Interior, through its Agencies, implemented activities aimed at controlling crime, prevention and management of disasters, control migration and the proliferation of arms and to control illicit drug trafficking in Ghana. The Ministry carried out among others, the following specific activities and projects in 2025:

Conflict and Disaster Management;

National Commission on Small Arms and Light Weapons

The National Commission for Small Arms and Light Weapons is a government agency of Ghana tasked to control the proliferation of arms and weapons in Ghana. The Commission, which was established in 2007 under the National Commission on Small Arms and Light Weapons Act, 2007 (Act 763), is mandated to prevent and combat the proliferation of small arms, light weapons, and related materials in Ghana. In pursuit of this mandate, the Commission in 2025 continued efforts aimed at controlling arms proliferation in Ghana. Specific activities undertaken during the year include:

a. The Commission, in collaboration with the Ghana Police Service, National Security and Ghana Immigration Service, seized 1,278 illicit weapons;

b. Organised stakeholder consultations and completed work on the proposed National Arms Bill;

c. The Commission destroyed 1,007 seized arms, 11 ammunition and 4 pellets;

d. Conducted a search on civilian possessions, use and celebratory shooting of firearms at Teshie, Nungua, Tema New Town, Nima Mamobi and Amasaman; and

e. As part of its advocacy for gun-violence-free society, the Commission also extended amnesty to illicit arms owners to voluntarily surrender their arms or regularise them.

Ghana National Fire Service

The Ghana National Fire Service (GNFS) is mandated to prevent and manage unwanted fires, protect lives and property, and provide rescue and emergency services. This includes public fire safety education, providing technical advice on building plans and fire extinguishers, and offering technical assistance and humanitarian services in various emergencies. In pursuit of this mandate the Service during the 2025 financial year implemented the following key activities among others:

a) Attended to and controlled 5,103 fire outbreaks;

b) Salvaged properties worth over GH₵5.5 billion;

c) Attended to 559 Road Traffic Collision (2,253 injured and 367 deaths) and 186 Rescue incidents (92 injured and 47 deaths);

d) Undertook 26,953 public fire safety education through one-on-one, communal and mass media approaches;

e) Conducted 21,211 fire audits/inspections at public or residential premises in line with safety standards to ensure the safety of occupants; and

f) Issued 22,364 fire certificates, out of which 16,956 were renewals issued to existing buildings.

National Peace Council

The National Peace Council (NPC) established under the National Peace Council Act, 2011 (Act 818) is mandated to develop and facilitate mechanisms for conflict prevention, management, and resolution, and to build sustainable peace throughout the country. This involves harmonising and coordinating efforts, strengthening capacities for peacebuilding, promoting dialogue, and supervising Regional and District Peace Councils. The NPC acts as an independent institution to foster a culture of peace and stability in Ghana. To achieve its mandate, the Council among others implemented the following activities in 2025:

a. Inaugurated the Savanna and Ahafo Regional Peace Councils in collaboration with the respective regional coordinating councils;

b. Launched a Memorandum of Understanding between the Conference of Managers of Educations Units (COMEU) and Ghana Education Service to guide religious tolerance in second cycle schools;

c. Engaged stakeholder to build local peace Committees in conflict-prone Communities in Upper West, Upper East and North East Regions;

d. Built capacity of 161 security personnel on Responsibility-To-Protect (R2P) in the five regions in the northern part of Ghana;

e. Organised dialogues on the prevention of violent extremism and conflict aimed at building trust among civilian and security agencies in five selected regions; and

f. Completed and handed over Local Peace Committee centers in 20 Communities under Peace Protect Project in northern Ghana.

National Disaster Management Organisation

The National Disaster Management Organization (NADMO) is established by the National Disaster Management Organization Act 2016 (Act 927) to manage as well as develop the capacities of communities to respond to disasters and similar emergencies in the country. NADMO undertook the following activities during the year under review:

a) Carried out 2,978 public educations and sensitisation campaigns on good sanitation practices, floods prevention, earthquake, drowning, fire prevention and other disasters nationwide;

b) Carried out 2,174 community engagements on disaster risk reduction and information sharing on early warning;

c) Undertook 2,268 field trips to assess the extent of damages associated with disasters and gathered data for decision making;

d) Trained 644 staff and stakeholders in Disaster Management;

e) Collaborated with the MMDAs to dredge/desilt 243 drains and other waterways to enable free-flow of water thereby reducing the impact of flooding;

f) Carried out 332 emergency responses and rescue; and

g) Distributed relief items to support 165,524 disaster victims

Crime Management

Ghana Police Service

The Ghana Police Service is established under Police Service Act, 1970 (Act350). The core functions of the Service include the maintenance of law and order, protection of life and property, crime prevention, apprehension and prosecution of offenders. The Service among others, undertook the following activities in 2025:

a) Intensified its operations to combat illegal mining (*galamsey*) across the country;

b) Provided security support for the Akwatia By-Election;

c) Enhanced measures against armed robbery and violent crimes;

d) Undertook nationwide patrols to enhance public safety; and

e) Intensified its efforts in collaboration with national and international partners to combat human trafficking across the country.

Narcotics Control Commission (NACOC)

The Narcotics Control Commission Act, 2020 (Act 1019) established the Narcotics Control Commission (NACOC) to implement legislations and conventions on narcotic drugs and plants, precursor chemicals and psychotropic substances through s motivated workforce and effective collaboration. In 2025, the Commission:

a) conducted 2,727 vessel inspections;

b) intensified its surveillance and intelligence gathering activities (114 individual drug seizures, 112 drug traffickers arrest, and 68 drug related cases); and

c) made 70 arrests, and seized 948kg of narcotics valued at US$3.77 million.

Migration and Refugee Management Ghana Immigration Service

The Ghana Immigration Service (GIS) is mandated to enforce migration laws applicable to both Ghanaians and non-

Ghanaians while safeguarding the territorial integrity of the country by the Immigration Service Act, 2016 (Act 908). The Service undertook the following activities during the year under review:

a) Undertook inspections at 1,958 companies, 2,449 hotels, 460 residential sites and 321 educational institutions to ensure compliance with immigration laws;

b) Conducted 388 investigations into breaches of immigration laws;

c) Prosecuted 24 suspects in criminal cases including human trafficking, illegal entry, harboring criminals and forgery of documents;

d) Arrested 3,236 foreign nationals and Ghanaians for breach of immigration laws;

e) Received 3,658 Ghanaian deportees and refused entry for 1,446 others at their destinations; and

f) Repatriated 2,188 offenders.

Refugee Management (Ghana Refugee Board)

The Ghana Refugee Board is responsible for managing all issues relating to refugees and asylum seekers, in accordance with the Ghana Refugee Law. The activities of the Board are also in line with the UN Convention on Refugees, 1951 as well as AU and ECOWAS protocols. During the year under review, the Ghana Refugee Board (GRB):

a) received, screened and registered 5,274 asylum seekers in Accra and the Upper regions;

b) conducted 187 refugee status determination for applicant;

c) launched GRASP (Ghana Refugee Agri-business and Sustainability Programme) project at the ZINI settlement to provide livelihood for refugees and their host communities in line with Feed Ghana programme;

d) in collaboration with the NIA and Identity Management System issued 821 non-citizen cards to refugees in Accra; and

e) printed and issued 294 Convention Travel Documents and 543 refugee cards.

Gaming Commission

The Ghana Gaming Commission is a body corporate established by the Gaming Act, 2006 (Act 721) with the mandate of regulating, controlling, monitoring and supervising the operations of Games of Chance in the country except lottery. During the year under review, the Gaming Commission:

a) Conducted 67 routine monitoring exercises (17 onsite inspections and 50 offsite monitoring activities);

b) Conducted surveillance leading to the clamp down of 2 illegal casinos at Osu and Tema;

c) Blocked 10 illegal online sports betting operators' payment platforms; and

d) Signed an MoU with National Identification Authority (NIA) for all licensed gaming operators to integrate with NIA's biometric verification platform.

The National Identification Authority

The National Identification Authority, established under the National Identification Authority Act, (Act 707) is a statutory body established to create, maintain, provide and promote the use of national identity cards. The Authority undertook the following activities:

a) Printed 600,000 backlogs, increased public engagement, and increased premium services and offices accepting online applications;

b) Conducted ISO certification training and commenced ISO implementation;

c) Piloted online registration and appointment portal (currently used in 6 premium centers); and

d) Onboarded 16 institutions onto the Verification System Platform to strengthen service delivery, national security, and fiscal accountability (50 million verifications as at November 2025).

2025 Financial Performance

For the implementation of its programmes and activities an amount of ten billion, seven hundred and thirty million, eight hundred and seventy-two thousand, two hundred and fifty-one Ghana cedis (GH₵10,730,872,251.00) was appropriated to the Ministry in 2025 financial year. The amount comprised of GH₵9,961,603,283 for compensation, GH₵659,112,717 for Goods and Services and GH₵110,156,251 for CAPEX.

As at 30th November, 2025 an amount of nine billion, three hundred and ninety million, seven hundred and eighty-five thousand, eight hundred and two Ghana Cedis and eighty-nine Pesewas (GH₵9,390,785,802.89), which represents 87.52 per cent was released to the Ministry of which actual expenditure is nine billion, two hundred and forty-five million, five hundred and sixty thousand, nine hundred and two Ghana cedis and Five Pesewas (GH₵9,245,560,902.05) or 98.45 per cent of total releases. Details of releases and expenditure for the 2025 financial year are presented below:

Table 1: 2025 Budget Performance of the Ministry of Interior as at November, 2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH₵)	2025 Releases as 30/11/2025 (B) (GH₵)	Actual Expenditure 30/11/2025 (C) (GH₵)	Variance (A-B) (GH₵)	% released
Compensation of employees	9,961,603,283.00	8,904,099,786.72	8,904,099,786.72	1,057,503,496.28	89.38
Goods and Services	659,112,717.00	276,091,724.99	197,656,886.74	383,020,992.01	41,89
Capital Expenditure	110,156,251.00	210,594,291.18	143,804,228.59	(100,438,040.18,)	191.18
Total	10,730,872,251.00	9,390,785,802.89	9,245,560,902.05	1,340,086,448.11	87.52

Source: Ministry of Interior Programme-Based Annual estimates for 2025

The GoG appropriation of GH₵10,350,576,581 was disbursed among the three expenditure items of the Ministry as follows:

Compensation of Employees - GH₵9,939,964,121

Goods and Services - GH₵309,487,290

Capital Expenditure - GH₵101,125,170

Total - GH₵10,350,576,581

During the year under consideration, an amount of GH₵9,162,474,602.98 of the GoG allocation was disbursed to finance critical activities in furtherance of the objectives of the Ministry. Details of the releases and actual expenditure of GoG allocation are as follows:

Table 2: 2025 GoG Budget performance as at 30/11/2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH₵)	2025 Releases (B) (GH₵)	Actual Expenditure (GH₵)	Variance (A-B) (GH₵)	per cent released
Compensation	9,939,964,121	8,885,044,074.68	8,885,044,074.68	1,054,920,046.32	89.39

Goods and Services	309,487,290	202,042,909.30	123,867,889.05	107,444,380.70	65.28
Capital Expenditure	101,125,170	75,387,619.00	16,640,385.51	25,737,551.00	74.55
Total	10,350,576,581	9,162,474,602.98	9,025,552,349.24	1,188,101,978.02	88.52

Source: Ministry of the Interior Programme-Based Annual Estimates for 2025

During the period under review, the Ministry also received an additional funding of GH₵39,560,000 from GoG sources to support police operations in Bawku, Walewale and Sawla – Tuna - Kalba.

The IGF appropriation of GH₵380,295,670.00 to the Ministry for 2025 was allocated to the various cost centres as follow:

Compensation of Employees — GH₵21,639,162.00

Goods and Services — GH₵349,625,427.00

Capital Expenditure — GH₵9,031,081.00

Total — **GH₵380,295,670**

As at November, 2025, an amount of GH₵228,311,199.91 had been released, of which actual expenditure stands at GH₵220,008,552.81. Details of the 2025 IGF Budget performance of the Ministry of the Interior are as follows:

Table 3: 2025 IGF Budget performance as at 30/11/2025

Economic Classification	2025 Appropriation (A) (GH₵)	2025 Releases (B) (GH₵)	Actual Expenditure (GH₵)	Variance (A-B) (GH₵)	% released
Compensation	21,639,162.00	19,055,712.04	19,055,712.04	2,583,450.96	88.06
Goods and Services	349,625,427.00	74,048,815.69	73,788,997.69	275,576,611.31	21.18
Capital Expenditure	9,031,081.00	135,206,672.18	127,163,843.08	(126,175,591.18)	1,497.13
Total	380,295,670.00	228,311,199.91	220,008,552.81	151,984,470.09	60.04

Source: Ministry of Interior Programme-Based Annual estimates for 2025

The 2025 released were applied in furtherance of the core mandate and objects of the various agencies under the Ministry of the Interior. The Specific releases to each of the agency is detailed in table 4.

Table 4: 2025 Budget Performance of the various Agencies

ECONOMIC CLASSIFICATION	2025 Appropriation(A) GH₵)	2025 Releases (GH₵) (B)	2025 Expenditure (C) (GH₵)	Variance (A-B)(GH₵)	% Variance
Ministry HQ	78,267,103.76	66,336,001.71	36,108,414.46	11,931,102.05	15.24
Ghana Police Service	5,421,413,056.58	5,297,069,119.75	5,269,069,119.75	124,343,936.83	2.29
Ghana Prison Service	1,045,224,229.53	912,397,293.54	896,756,253.54	132,826,935.99	12.71
Ghana Immigration Service	1,713,158,544.34	1,387,985,093.99	1,370,124,465.72	325,173,450.35	18.98
Ghana National Fire Service	1,404,987,066.41	1,290,578,866.81	1,289,078,866.81	114,408,199.60	8.14
National Disaster Management Organization (NADMO)	266,200,519.58	121,935,907.67	121,935,907.67	144,264,611.91	54.19
National Identification Authority (NIA)	449,323,276.10	90,106,943.88	82,468,964.80	359,216,332.22	79.95
Narcotics Control Commission (NACOC)	262,316,209.65	247,923,806.32	245,223,806.32	14,392,403.33	5.49
National Peace Council (NPC)	13,882,641.74	10,394,581.00	7,925,881.00	3,488,060.74	25.13
Ghana Refugee Board (GRB)	5,494,918.64	2,971,179.08	2,971,179.08	2,523,739.56	45.93
National Commission on Small Arms and Light Weapons (NACSA)	9,269,191.00	7,491,503.08	7,491,503.08	1,777,687.92	19.18
Gaming Commission of Ghana.	61,335,493.69		35,874,110.86		
TOTAL	**10,730,872,251.02**	**9,435,190,296.83**	**9,365,028,473.09**	**1,295,681,954.19**	**12.07**

2026 Programmes and Outlook

For the 2026 financial year, the Ministry will continue to pursue key programmes aimed at achieving its core mandate of promoting law, peace and order, and protection of property and human life and enhancing national security and public safety. In this regard, the following key initiatives will be pursued by the various agencies under the Ministry:

Conflict and Disaster Management

National Commission on Small Arms and Light Weapons

In 2026, the Commission intends to apply its budgetary allocation to finance activities aimed at controlling the proliferation of arms and ammunitions across the country. Specifically, the Commission intends to:

a. Organise weapon and arms destruction program aimed to eradicate seized illicit small arms;

b. Mark state security agencies arms, authorised civilian and traditional authorities for easy identification, tracing and accountability;

c. Conduct arms for Development program for communities with high proliferation of arms;

d. Continue engagement with artisans (blacksmiths) to reduce local manufacture of arms; and

e. Collaborate with the Ministry and the Ghana Police Service to conduct gun amnesty program to curb the proliferation of arms in the country.

Ghana National Fire Service (GNFS)

The Ghana National Fire Service will continue with its fire safety operations through:

a. The recruitment training of additional personnel comprising of Cadets, Recruits and civilian staff to augment its existing workforce;

b. Intensify regular fire prevention and safety education in various local languages through the media;

c. Commence work on the automated Fire Compliance and safety Project;

d. Resource the Rapid Response Squad across the country; and

e. operationalise a new forensic laboratory and launch an Automated Fire Safety Compliance System.

National Peace Council (NPC)

To promote national stability, the National Peace Council will continue its Peace initiatives through:

a. the development of the Peace Index and the Conflict Map;

b. the development of the Peace Building Strategy for Ghana;

c. the compilation of an indigenous mechanism for addressing conflicts in Ghana;

d. strengthening the capacity of political actors, women, youth in conflict-affected areas on the use of non-violent strategies in conflict resolution;

e. the organisation of sensitisation workshops on Peace Building and develop a handbook for Peace education;

f. the resuscitation of the Bawku Inter Ethnic Peace Committee;

g. the reconstitution and inauguration of 10 regional Peace Councils; and

h. the organisation of national-level conference on Chieftaincy to address chieftaincy conflicts in Ghana.

National Disaster Management Organisation (NADMO)

Through the auspices of the Ministry, NADMO will expand early warning systems to all 16 regions and finalise its Legislative Instrument.

Crime Management Programme

Ghana Police Service

The Ghana Police Service will enhance its operational effectiveness in 2026 to ensure the safety and security of Ghanaians. In this regard, the Service will perform its constitutional mandate by maintaining law and order, protection of life and property and preventing and detection of crime. This will be archived through a number of initiatives including:

a. Enhancement of Police Visibility through the deployment of more personnel to major streets and Communities to deter criminal activity and increase public confidence;

b. Established a specialised unit within the Police Service dedicated to investigation and addressing land related offenses to ensure timely resolution of land cases;

c. Intensify Police Patrol Operations along highways, commercial centers and residential suburbs;

d. Expand Police intelligence capability through enhance proactive crime detection, threat analysis and coordinated security interventions; and

e. Collaborate with the private sector to implement automated Traffic Enforcement system to streamline traffic law enforcement and improve compliance.

Ghana Prisons Service

In 2026, the Ghana Prisons Service will continue to prioritise safe custody and welfare of inmates and ensure inmates' rehabilitation by sustaining and expanding vocational and skills development programmes with the ultimate goal of ensuring public safety. The Service will also sustain efforts in staff capacity building through targeted training and development programmes to ensure that officers remain equipped to deliver on their mandate effectively.

Narcotics Control Commission

The Narcotic Control Commission will continue efforts aimed at combatting drug-related crimes, promoting public safety and fostering a drug-free society in accordance with its mandate under The Narcotic Control Commission Act, 2020 (Act1019). To this end, the Commission will:

a. Complete work on the proposed fees and charges associated with the cultivation and management of cannabis and submit same to Parliament for consideration and approval;

b. Reinforce its efforts to reduce drug supply by enhancing land border controls, gathering intelligence on emerging psychoactive substances, and conducting more effective interdictions at airports and seaports; and

c. Employ additional workforce to enhance its capacity to supervise and monitor cannabis cultivation in Ghana.

These measures will help curb the trafficking and misuse of narcotics within the country.

Migration and Refugee Management Programme

Ghana Immigration Service

In 2026 the Ghana Immigration Service (GIS) will continue its mandate to manage and regulate migration for national security and development by controlling the entry, residence, and exit of both foreigners and Ghanaians.

The Service will also enforce immigration and employment laws for non-Ghanaians, managing border security, issuing visas and permits, and cooperating internationally on migration matters.

The ultimate Goal is to secure the nation's borders against unauthorized entry, illicit activities, and other security threats. In 2026, it will deploy border surveillance technology, strengthen inland patrols, and upgrade infrastructure at entry and exit points.

Ghana Refugee Board (GRB)

The Ghana Refugee Board will continue to manage issues related to refugees and asylum seekers in accordance with its mandate. To achieve this, the Board will:

a. Intensify efforts to register all Burkinabe asylum seekers in the country and conduct a verification exercise for Togolese refugees;

b. Continue monitoring exercise to the various refugee camps, settlements, and border towns to promote peaceful coexistence between refugees and host communities; and

c. Accelerate efforts to review refugee laws

Gaming Regulations Programme

Gaming Commission

In the gaming sector, the Commission plans to finalize and implement the Responsible Gaming Policy for the industry in 2026. Furthermore, it will engage stakeholders regarding the draft Gaming Authority Bill to establish a more structured and regulated gaming environment.

National Identification Authority

In pursuit of its mandate to create and promote the use of national identity cards, the NIA intends to commence registration of Ghanaians from age zero and extend its operations to 16 other countries across world. The Authority will also register persons in detention.

Budgetary Allocation for 2026

For the implementation of its activities, the Ministry and its agencies have been allocated the sum of twelve billion, five hundred and seventy-seven million, seventy-seven thousand, nine hundred and seventy-seven Ghana cedis (GH₵12,577,077,977) for the 2026 financial year. to ensure the Ministry successfully undertakes its outlined programs for the year.

Table 6: 2026 Allocations by Economic Classification

ECONOMIC CLASSIFICATION	**2026 GOG ALLOCATION (GH₵)**	**2026 IGF (GH₵)**	**TOTAL ALLOCATION (GH₵)**	**%**
COMPENSATION	11,207,320,989	26,876,412	11,234,197,401	89.32 per cent
GOODS AND SERVICES	641,505,218	335,735,096	977,240,314	7.77 per cent
CAPEX	211,125,170	154,515,092	365,640,262	2.91 per cent
TOTAL	12,059,951,377	517,126,600	12,577,077,977	100 per cent
PERCENTAGE per cent	**95.89 per cent**	**4.11 per cent**		

Source: The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year

The 2026 Budget allocation will be distributed amongst the various agencies of the Ministry of Interior as follows:

Table 7: 2026 Allocation to the various Agencies under the Ministry of Interior

SN	AGENCY	2026 ALLOCATION (GH₵)
1.	Ministry HQ	61,498,323
2.	Ghana Police Service	6,252,498,763
3.	Ghana Prison Service	1,219,029,925
4.	Ghana Immigration Service	1,742,506,807
5.	Ghana National Fire Service	1,901,896,528
6.	National Disaster Management Organisation (NADMO)	409,373,118
7.	National Identification Authority (NIA)	569,183,713
8.	Narcotics Control Commission (NACOC)	313,902,122
9.	National Peace Council (NPC)	24,732,153
10.	Ghana Refugee Board (GRB)	7,653,305
11.	National Commission on Small Arms and Light Weapons (NACSA)	17,740,774
12.	Gaming Commission of Ghana	57,062,446
	Total	**12,577,077,977**

The 2026 allocation to the various institutions under the Ministry of Interior will be further disbursed among the various economic classifications as follows:

Table 8: 2026 Allocations to the various Agencies by Economic Classification

S/N	Economic Classification	Compensation (GH₵)	Goods and Services (GH₵)	Capex (GH₵)	Total (GH₵)	% Of Total Allocation
1.	Ministry HQ	8,414,096	46,084,226	7,000,000	61,498,323	0.49
2.	Ghana Police Service	6,116,427,632	126,071,131	10,000,000	6,252,498,763	49.71
3.	Ghana Prisons Service	1,133,146,009	70,383,916	15,500,000	1,219,029,925	9.69
4.	Ghana National Fire Service	1,685,602,529	66,293,999	150,000,000	1,901,896,528	15.12
5.	Ghana Immigration Service	1,419,013,459	170,746,647	152,746,674	1,742,506,807	13.85
6.	Narcotics Control Commission (NACOC)	284,051,702	24,310,252	5,540,168	303,902,122	2.42
7.	National Commission for Small Arms	11,740,774	5,000,000	1,000,000	17,740,774	0.14
8.	National Disaster Management Organization (NADMO)	395,373,118	13,000,000	1,000,000	409,373,118	3.25

9.	Ghana Refugee Board (GRB)	3,153,305	4,000,000	500,000	7,653,305	0.06
10.	Gaming Commission of Ghana.	26,876,412	29,957,784	228,250	57,062,446	0.45
11.	National Peace Council (NPC)	11,732,153	12,000,000	1,000,000	24,732,153	0.20
12.	National Identification Authority (NIA	138,666,212	409,392,332	21,125,170	569,183,713	4.53
TOTAL		**11,234,197,401**	**977,240,314**	**365,640,262**	**12,577,077,977**	**100**

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee having carefully examined the 2025 estimates of the Ministry of Interior and its Agencies made the following observations:

Allocation for Agricultural Mechanization Programme of the Ghana Prisons Service

The Committee acknowledged the allocation of an amount of GH₵652,885,000 for the agricultural mechanisation activities of the Ghana Prisons Service in the 2026 fiscal year. The amount is to be applied for the procurement of critical input for the Ghana Prisons farming activities aimed at increasing crop and livestock production to reduce reliance on government subvention for food ration. The Committee further expressed satisfaction that, the Prison Service has integrated agricultural mechanisation animal husbandry into its reform programmes.

The Minister of the Interior informed the Committee that, the Programme forms part of a broader agenda to enhance food production, reduce government feeding costs and improve the nutritional needs of inmates. The programme will further provide opportunity for inmates to be trained and equipped with modern agronomic skills to support their rehabilitation and reintegration into society. He further indicated that, the farming initiative, launched under the "Think Prisons 360" programme, has already demonstrated improved welfare outcomes for participating inmates, improved nutritional needs of inmates and equipped inmates with skills for life outside the prisons.

Fumigation of Prison Facilities

The Committee expressed deep concern about the failure of the Ministry of Finance to allocate resources to meet critical needs of the Ghana Prison Service. The Committee is not oblivious of the tight constraints imposed on the budget due to revenue shortfalls and conditionality under the IMF Extended Credit Facility Agreement with the government of Ghana. The Committee, however, believed that some critical needs of the Service, including the routine fumigation, must be met. The Committee was informed that quarterly fumigation of prisons is a requirement under UN Minimum Standards and failure to undertake this exercise could lead to serious public health risks, including the outbreak of communicable disease. The Committee therefore urges the Hon Minister of Finance to release an amount of GH₵6,200,000 funds from the contingency vote for the service to undertake its routine fumigation exercise to forestall the outbreak of communicable diseases in our prisons and to meet its international commitments.

Acquisition of a Helicopter for the Ghana Police Service

The Committee noted that the Ghana Police Service acquired 3 helicopters in 2023 to facilitate its aerial surveillance and crime control operations. However, the helicopters have not been put to use three years after the acquisition. The Hon Minister informed the Committee that the helicopters are indeed 1971 and 1972 models, which have been refurbished for aerial surveillance by the Police. He indicated that the age of the helicopters does not mean they are not airworthy. On why the police have not put the helicopters to use, the Minister explained that the Service presently does not have an air wing to manage the helicopters. He informed the Committee that the policy decision is to reconfigure the 3 helicopters for the use of the Ghana Armed Forces. Additionally, attempts are being made to establish an air wing within the Ghana Police Service for the management of the helicopter fleet before further acquisitions are made. In the interim, the Ghana Police Service will procure a drone for its aerial surveillance activities.

The Committee urged the Minister to take steps to put the helicopters to use to ensure the State derives the desired benefits from the resources invested in these strategic national assets.

National Identification Authority

The Committee observed that the National Identification Authority continues to face significant operational challenges stemming from the incomplete and deteriorating state of its headquarters building. The Committee noted that the works on the head office complex, which was at about 95 per cent completion, have been abandoned for about 10 years, leading further deterioration. The long delays in completing the project have led to serious structural defects, damaged fittings, and occupational safety risks.

In view of the strategic importance of the NIA as the authentication backbone for multiple state institutions and the security associated with the of operations of the NIA, a critical national security role, its physical infrastructure and security systems must not be compromised. The Committee recommends that adequate funding is provided to enable the Authority to complete its accommodation and provide a secured environment for the country’s biometric data system.

National Disaster Management Organisation (NADMO)

The Committee observed that NADMO has been facing persistent funding constraints affecting its ability to manage disasters effectively. The

Committee noted that the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) has failed to pay the statutory 3 per cent DACF allocation to the National Disaster Fund resulting in the accumulation of arrears amounting to of GH₵9,360,234.74. The failure to release funds into the National Disaster Fund has rendered NADMO ineffective, compelling it to rely on ad-hoc borrowing of relief materials from private suppliers during emergencies, resulting in large outstanding liabilities amounting to GH₵150,000,000.

The Committee further observed that NADMO's 2025 allocation for relief items was completely unfunded, and the 2026 budget similarly provides no allocation for relief supplies despite recurrent disasters across the country. The Committee was also informed that NADMO had significant commitments owed to suppliers due to unplanned procurements triggered by urgent disaster response needs. The Committee expressed concern that failure to provide dedicated funding for disaster management exposes communities to prolonged suffering and NADMO to reputational risk. In addition, the Committee also noted that NADMO's vehicle fleet and logistics remain inadequate, impeding its capacity to deploy resources during emergencies.

Ghana National Fire Service

Procurement of Fire Tender

The Committee noted that an amount of GH₵150,000,000.00 has been allocated in the 20216 budget to meet the capital expenditure needs of the Ghana National Fire Service as part of efforts to retool the service and improve its operational capabilities. The official informed the Committee that the amount will be applied to procure additional fire tenders for the Service. The Service explained that the funds will facilitate the repair, maintenance, and upgrading of key assets, including fire tenders, personal protective equipment (PPE), and Rapid Intervention Vehicles. The Ministry explained that the Service has not received significant upgrades in operational equipment for nearly 12 years, resulting in frequent breakdowns that undermine emergency response capacity. The Committee was further informed that the Service is in dire need of new equipment to augment its fleet. The Committee noted that though the allocation may not be sufficient to meet all the requirements of the Fire Service but it is a positive signal and a good starting point in a journey to retool the security services, including the Ghana National Fire Service, so as to position them to meet their constitutional obligations.

Conclusion and Recommendation

In view of the critical role the security services play in promoting peace, enforcement of law and order, the Committee recommends to the House to adopt this report and approve the sum of Twelve Billion, Five Hundred and Seventy-Seven Million, Seventy-Seven Thousand, Nine Hundred and Seventy-Seven Ghana Cedis (GH₵12,577,077,977) for the implementation of the programed activities of the Ministry of Interior and its Agencies for the 2026 Financial Year.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr Ebenezer Okletey Terlabi: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the motion.

Question proposed

Question put and Motion agreed to

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Joint Committee on Defence and Interior and Security and Intelligence on the allocation of sum of GH₵12,577,077,977.00 for the services of the Ministry of the Interior for the year ending 31st December 2026.

The Speaker: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 26.

NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT PLANNING COMMISSION

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Economy and Development on the allocation of the sum of GH₵48,929,740.00 for the services of the National Development Planning Commission for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government for the 2026 Financial Year was presented on Thursday, 13th November 2025, by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution.

Pursuant to Orders 195(4) and 230 (3)(a) of the Standing Orders of Parliament, Rt Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the National Development Planning Commission for the 2026 Financial Year to the Committee on Economy and Development for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee subsequently met on Wednesday, 26th November 2025, and considered the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the National Development Planning Commission (NDPC). Present at the Committee's deliberations were the Acting Director-General of the Commission, Dr Audrey Smock Amoah, a team of technical staff from the Commission, and Officials from the Ministry of Finance.

The Committee is grateful to the Chairman, the Acting Director-General and their officials for their assistance during the deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee availed itself of the following documents during the consideration of the Estimates:

i. The 1992 Constitution

ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament

iii. Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), as amended

iv. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year

v. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year

vi. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the National Development Planning Commission for the 2025 Financial Year

vii. The Programme-Based Budget Estimates of the National Development Planning Commission for the 2026 Financial Year

Background

The National Development Planning Commission (NDPC) was established under Articles 86 and 87 of the 1992 Constitution with a mandate to advise the President on development planning policy and strategy. The National Development Planning Commission Act, 1994 (Act 479) provides a legal framework that formally establishes the NDPC under the Office of the President. Further, the National Development Planning (Systems) Act, 1994 (Act 480) and the Local Government Act, 1993 (Act 462) make the NDPC the national coordinating body of the Decentralised Development Planning Systems in Ghana.

The NDPC exists to advise the President of the Republic of Ghana on development policy and strategy and at the request of the President or Parliament, or on its own initiative, prepare and ensure the effective implementation of approved national development plans and strategies and coordinate economic and social activities country-wide in a manner that will ensure accelerated and sustainable development of the country to enhance continuous improvement in the living standards of Ghanaians.

Medium-Term Strategic Overview of NDPC (2026-2029)

Goal of NDPC

The goal of NDPC for the medium term is to ensure effective coordination of the preparation, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of national policies and plans, as well as to consolidate Ghana's middle-income country status through sustained and accelerated growth.

The core functions of NDPC are:

i. Formulate national development policy frameworks and ensure that the strategies, including consequential policies and programmes, are effectively carried out;

ii. Undertake studies and strategic analysis of macroeconomic and structural reform options and make recommendations on development and socio-economic issues;

iii. Make proposals for the protection of the natural and physical environment to ensure that development strategies and programmes conform with sound environmental principles;

iv. Make proposals for ensuring the even development of the districts of Ghana by the effective utilisation of available resources;

v. Coordinate the decentralised national development planning system by prescribing the format and content of development plans for the Districts, Ministries and Sector Agencies to reflect integration of economic, spatial and environmental principles and ensure their compatibility; and

vi. Monitor and evaluate the implementation of development policies, programmes and projects in the district.

vii. Perform other functions that relate to development planning as the President may direct.

Performance for 2025

Management and Administration

The Commission held seven (7) meetings, including sub-committee sessions, to deliberate on key national development issues and provided strategic advice to His Excellency the President of the Republic. The meetings were on the preparation of the President's Coordinated Programme of Economic and Social Development Policies (CPESDP) and other statutory meetings for the Commission.

The Commission undertook various capacity-building programmes to enhance the effectiveness and efficiency of staff. A total of thirteen (13) staff members participated in specialised training on Gender and Climate Change Indices organised under a GIZ-supported initiative. The training aimed to enhance the understanding of staff on gender-responsive approaches and the integration of climate change indicators into planning, monitoring and decision-making processes.

National Policy Formulation

The Commission strengthened coordination of food and nutrition security issues by preparing Ghana's Nutrition for Growth Summit Commitments, finalising the Food Systems and Nutrition Planning Toolkit, and updating Ghana's Food Systems Transformation Pathways document. These efforts aim to strengthen the integration of nutrition and food systems into national development planning, promote healthier diets, and support sustainable food systems for improved national well-being.

In line with the Public Policy Formulation Guidelines, the Commission supported two (2) MDAs, the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs on the Draft National Urban Policy, and the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition on the Draft National Clean Cooking Policy.

The Commission, in consultation with the Cross-Sectoral Planning Groups (CSPGs), validated the draft Policy Matrix of the 2026-2029 Medium-Term National Development Policy Framework in the first quarter of 2025. The Policy Matrix was subsequently dispatched to all Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs), Regional Coordinating Councils (RCCs), and Metropolitan, Municipal, and District Assemblies (MMDAs) to guide in the preparation of their respective MTDPs for the 2026-2029 planning period.

The Commission's Steering Committee held meetings to provide updates on the Policy and Legislative Almanac System, which has been successfully developed to automate public policy formulation, enhance coordination, and improve the overall quality of public policies. The system is currently awaiting its official launch.

In the advancement of formulating the national human capital development strategy, the Commission conducted a baseline study on skills development in the Country to provide evidence-based insights into the current state of human capital and labour market dynamics.

Building upon the findings of this study, a preliminary outline of the Human Capital Development Strategy has also been prepared. These milestones signify the initial phase of designing a framework that will guide investments in education, skills development, and workforce productivity to support national transformation and inclusive growth.

The Commission coordinated and facilitated Ghana's participation in 2025 High-Level Political Forum (HLPF) which was held in New York, USA, where the country presented its 2025 Voluntary National Review (VNR) and Voluntary Local Reviews (VLRs). The 2025 VNR was officially launched by the President on 8th July 2025, highlighting Ghana's progress in implementing the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and Agenda 2063.

National Plan Preparation

The Commission fulfilled its mandate to coordinate and certify Medium-Term Development Plans (MTDPs) in accordance with the National Development Planning (System) Act, 1994 (Act 480) and the National Development Planning (System) Regulations, 2016 (L.I.2232) during the 2026–2029 planning period. The Commission guided and oversaw the preparation of MTDPs by MDAs, RCCs and MMDAs to ensure compliance with the Planning Guidelines issued by the

Commission and also prepared its own 2026–2029 Medium-Term Development Plan. Additionally, twenty-eight (28) MDAs that requested assistance received direct technical support.

As of 31st October 2025, twenty-four (24) of the thirty-five (35) MDA plans submitted had been approved and certified, while three (3) MDAs had not submitted any draft plans. For the RCCs, two (2) plans had been certified out of the seven (7) submissions received, with nine (9) RCCs yet to submit. At the district level, one hundred and thirty-seven (137) plans had been received across all sixteen (16) regions and were at various stages of review and certification.

The Commission made significant progress on developing the Planning and Budgeting Concepts and Terminologies document, working collaboratively with key institutions such as the Ministry of Finance, Land Use and Spatial Planning Authority (LUSPA), and KNUST. The document is intended to enhance effective planning and coordination by providing a common understanding of key concepts across institutions. After a series of consultations and technical sessions, a third stakeholder engagement was held in October 2025 to validate the draft. The process is now at the completion stage, with stakeholder comments and recommendations being incorporated to finalise the document.

The Commission continued work on the development of the National Coordination Strategy and Guidelines to ensure coherent and results-driven implementation of national development priorities. The Strategy, when completed, will provide a structured framework to enhance collaboration among MDAs, RCCs and MMDAs in planning, implementation, monitoring and reporting of development interventions. Procurement processes to engage a consultant, under a Grant Agreement with the GIZ-PAIReD Programme, are currently underway; however, progress has been temporarily delayed due to locked-up funds arising from Government's financial management checks.

The Commission supported the official launch of the Ghana Infrastructure Plan (2018-2047) by His Excellency the President of the Republic on 22nd October 2025. The Plan provides a long-term framework to guide the development, coordination and management of the country's infrastructure to promote sustainable national development.

National Monitoring and Evaluation

The Commission finalised the 2024 Annual Progress Report (APR) on the implementation of the Medium-Term National Development Policy Framework (2022–2025) on schedule in June 2025. The Report assessed national progress, outlining key achievements, challenges and lessons to inform policy decisions. It was officially launched in October 2025, together with the NDPC's institutional APR, which reviewed the implementation of the Commission's planned activities for the year.

The Commission reviewed the Annual Progress Reports (APRs) submitted by MDAs, RCCs and MMDAs as part of the national monitoring and evaluation process for assessing implementation of the Medium-Term National Development Policy Framework. The review involved a technical assessment of each APR against the indicators and targets in their Annual Action Plans and their conformity to the required reporting templates. In total, 28 out of 43 MDAs, 14 out of 16 RCCs, and all 261 MMDAs submitted their 2024 APRs. All submitted reports have been reviewed and are awaiting dissemination to the respective institutions.

Research and Innovation

The Commission advanced work on the Ghana Macroeconomic Model (GMM), an analytical tool used to assess the impact of policy interventions on key macroeconomic indicators such as growth, employment, inflation and fiscal performance. The model's variables and equations were reviewed and expanded, with updated data incorporated to improve its analytical scope. The consultant has submitted the final revised model together with a draft bi-annual update report, which is scheduled for validation.

The Commission continued to engage key partners and stakeholders to support national development planning through dialogue, collaboration and knowledge sharing aimed at strengthening policy coherence and aligning national, regional and global priorities. By mid-September, ten (10) strategic engagements had been held with partners including ACET, Impact Investing Ghana, UNECA, GIZ, UNCTAD, KOICA and KPMG. Collaboration with KPMG focused on assessing the performance of state-owned and private enterprises, while engagement with KOICA centred on finalising documents and commitments for the NDPC–KOICA Local Economic Development Project: Research for Policy Advocacy in Selected Agricultural Value Chains. Project implementation arrangements, including a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU), are currently being finalised with KOICA.

Financial Performance for 2025

In the 2025 financial year, the Commission was allocated an amount of GH₵30,094,784.01. Out of this approved budget, an amount of GH₵25,676,267.66 was released as at September 2025, representing 85.3 per cent of the total appropriation, for the expenses of the Commission. The Commission however spent GH₵17,045,674.62 of the amount released. The breakdown of the expenditure returns of the Commission is provided in Table 1.

Table 1: Budget Execution as of September, 2025

Classification	2025 Approved Budget (A)	Releases as at September (B)	Actual Expenditure (C)	Variance 1 (D = A- B)	Variance 2 (E = B – C)
Employee Compensation	9,904,484.01	6,058,820.90	4,025,690.18	3,845,663.11	2,033,130.72
Goods and Services	11,930,300.00	10,379,053.00	9,759,984.44	1,551,247.00	619,068.56
Foreign Loans and Grants (FLG) - Direct Grant	3,260,000.00	5,738,393.76	3,260,000.00	(2,478,393.76)	2,478,393.76
CAPEX - GoG	5,000,000.00	3,500,000.00	-	1,500,000.00	3,500,000.00
TOTAL	**30,094,784.01**	**25,676,267.66**	**17,045,674.62**	**4,418,516.35**	**8,630,593.04**

Outlook for 2026

For the year 2026, the Commission plans to build on the progress achieved in 2025 and advance the implementation of the 2026–2029 Medium-Term objectives. The key priorities for the year will include:

i. Strengthening the effectiveness, accountability and efficiency of public institutions

ii. Improve policy coherence and alignment with national development goals

iii. Improve decentralised planning across MDAs, RCCs, and MMDAs.

iv. Strengthening monitoring and evaluation systems at all levels

v. Mainstream science, technology, research, and innovation (STRI) in all socio-economic activities.

vi. Improve public access to development information

2026 Budget Estimates for the NDPC

For the year 2026, the Commission was allocated a sum of forty-eight million, nine hundred and twenty-nine thousand, seven hundred and forty Ghana Cedis (GH₵48,929,740.00) to implement its stated programmes and activities. The breakdown of the budgetary allocation is presented in table 2 below:

Table 2 Details of the 2026 Budget allocation

	ITEM	2026 Allocation
1.	Employee Compensation	9,378,740.00
2.	Good And Services	10,125,000.00
3.	Capital Expenditure	5,000,000.00
4.	Donor	24,426,000.00
	Total	**48,929,740.00**

General Observations and Recommendations

Increase in Budgetary Allocation

The Committee observed that the total Budgetary allocation of the Commission for 2026 amounted to GH₵48,929,740.00. This was significantly higher by GH₵18,834,956.00 as compared to GH₵30,094,784.00 for the year 2025.

The Committee urged the Commission to utilise the budget to achieve its objectives

Certification of Medium-Term Development Plans

The Committee observed that the Commission has certified only thirty (30) out of three hundred and fifteen (315) Medium-Term Development Plans for 2026-2029 which were expected from Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs), Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies (MMDAs), and Regional Coordinating Councils (RCC). The Commission attributed the weak compliance rate of certification of plans to delays in submission and the limited capacity of some MDAs and MMDAs in formulating their plans.

In addition to prioritising technical support to MMDAs, the Committee urges the Ministry of Finance to collaborate with the Commission to enforce section 5 (a) (ii) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), as amended, which mandates submission and certification of medium-term development plans of MDAs, MMDAs and RCCs as a critical condition for budget allocations to MMDAs.

Utilisation of Foreign Grants

The Committee observed that out of a total amount of GH₵5,738,393.76 obtained from development partners in 2025, the Ministry of Finance only authorised the release of only

GH₵3,260,000.00 to the Commission for its intended activities, representing a utilisation rate of 57 per cent.

The Officials from the Ministry of Finance explained that the current expenditure policy framework associated with the ongoing IMF programme restricts the extent to which MDAs may utilise foreign grants and loans and this has directly limited the Commission's capacity to apply and use the funds.

The Committee however noted that for the year 2026, a total amount of GH₵24,000,000.00 would be obtained from donor partners, representing over 300 per cent increase in donor support. The funds were intended to support the Commission's essential initiatives such as the food systems transformation initiative, nutrition security and integration of climate change into development planning, among others.

The Committee recognised the importance of these initiatives and recommended to the Ministry of Finance to engage the IMF with a view to developing practical arrangements that would allow the Commission to access the full value of the grant needed to support its programme delivery.

Presentation of the President's Coordinated Programme for Economic and Social Development Policies (CPESDPs) to Parliament

The Commission informed the Committee that it is assisting in the development of the President's Coordinated Programme for Economic and Social Development Policies (CPESDPs), as mandated by Article 36 (5) of the 1992 Constitution. It assured the Committee that the CPESDP would soon be presented to Parliament in accordance with the Constitution.

Special activities to be undertaken

The Committee was informed that the Commission will also oversee the 2026 Voluntary National Review (VNR) concerning the execution of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (SDGs) and deliver the nation's progress report to the United Nations General Assembly in July 2026 in New York, USA.

The Commission would also execute other special programmes in compliance with its obligations under the 1992 Constitution and commitments of the Government of Ghana under the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and AU Agenda 2063 at national, sectoral and regional levels.

Renovation of Office Building Complex

The Commission informed the Committee that its Offices Building was significantly challenged and no longer conducive for effective service delivery. In order to address these challenges, the Commission intends to renovate the facility. This intervention is expected to create a more functional and efficient workspace, even as the Commission takes steps toward securing funding for the construction of a new office building.

Inadequate Professional and Technical Staff

The Committee observed that the persistent shortage of professional and technical staff significantly hampers its ability to effectively coordinate, plan, and oversee development interventions across the country. This staffing deficit negatively impacts the quality and timeliness of both national and subnational planning processes, while also limiting the Committee's capacity to provide consistent and comprehensive policy guidance to Ministries, Departments, Agencies, and local assemblies.

The Committee was, however, encouraged to note that provision has been made for the recruitment of twenty-seven (27) technical staff to strengthen the existing workforce in the 2026 financial year. It therefore urges the Ministry of Finance to prioritise the issuance of financial clearance, enabling the Commission to proceed promptly with the recruitment of the additional personnel.

Logistical Challenges

The Committee observed that the Commission's vehicle fleet is both insufficient and ageing, a condition that continues to erode its operational effectiveness. The limited availability of dependable vehicles hampers the Commission's ability to conduct routine field monitoring, provide technical supervision and carry out timely spot checks. Acknowledging adverse implications of the situation on the scope, regularity and overall quality of oversight functions of the Commission, the Committee urges the Ministry of Finance to prioritise the release of budgetary allocations meant for logistical support to the Commission.

Conclusion

The Committee, having conducted a thorough examination of the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the National Development Planning Commission (NDPC), concludes that NPDC programme of activities for 2026 align with the strategic objectives essential for advancing the nation's development.

The Committee accordingly recommends that this House approve the total sum of Forty-Eight Million, Nine Hundred and Twenty-Nine Thousand, Seven Hundred and Forty Ghana Cedis (GH₵48,929,740.00) to finance the implementation of programmes and activities of the NDPC for the 2026 financial year.

Mr Richmond Edem Kofi Kpotosu: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question proposed

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on

Lands and Natural Resources on the allocation of the sum of GH₵2,108,555,490.00 for the services of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 12, the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovation.

The Speaker: Hon Member, the item numbered 12, by the Chairman of the Committee

MINISTRY OF COMMUNICATION, DIGITAL TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATIONS

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Abed-Nego Lamangin Bandim): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Information and Communication on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,255,121,769.00 for the services of the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Speaker, in doing so, I would like to capture the report as read. Thank you.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year was presented to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson, pursuant to article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and in accordance with Order 252 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Pursuant to Orders 195(4) and 244 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the 2026 Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Communications, Digital Technology and Innovations was committed to the Select Committee on Information and Communications for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee met on Wednesday, 3rd and Thursday, 4th December, 2025 with the Hon Minister for Communications, Digital Technology and Innovations, Mr Samuel Nartey George, the Deputy Minister, Hon. Mohammed Adam Sukparu and Officials of the Ministry and its agencies to consider the Budget Estimates. Officials of the Ministry of Finance were also in attendance to assist in the deliberations.

The Committee is grateful to the Hon Minister, Deputy Minister and Officials of the Ministry for attending the meeting to assist in the deliberations of the Committee.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;

iii. Cybersecurity Act, 2020 (Act 1038);

iv. Postal and Courier Services Regulatory Commission Act, 2003 (Act 649);

v. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);

vi. The Ghana Meteorological Agency (Amendment) Act, 2019 (Act 1002)

vii. The 2025 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Communications and Digitalisation;

viii. The Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) of the Ministry of Communications and Digitalisation for 2026 — 2029;

ix. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year; and

x. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.

Vision, Mission and Goal of the Ministry of Communications, Digital Technology and Innovations

Vision of the Ministry

The vision of the Ministry is to ensure that Ghana is a knowledge-based society with a world-class communication infrastructure and services.

Mission of the Ministry

The mission of the Ministry is to ensure the development of a reliable digital infrastructure and services through the initiation, formulation, coordination, monitoring and evaluation of the implementation of globally competitive and innovative policies and programmes to promote national socioeconomic development.

Goal of the Ministry

The goal of the Ministry is to promote the development of Ghana into a knowledge-based society and a smart economy through the use of ICT.

Core Functions of the Ministry

The core functions of the Ministry are as follows:

i. Initiate and formulate ICT policies considering the needs and aspirations of the people;

ii. Coordinate, monitor and evaluate the efficiency and effectiveness of the performance of the communications sector;

iii. Develop appropriate regulations to protect consumers and stimulate competition in the communications sector;

iv. Promote ICT education and digital literacy across all sectors of society, ensuring that citizens have the necessary skills to participate in the digital economy;

v. Ensure the alignment of ICT policies with national development goals including economic growth, digital inclusion and governance;

vi. Support the roll out of emerging technologies such as 5G, Internet of Things (IoT), Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Block Chain;

vii. Ensure the promotion of robust cybersecurity policies and frameworks to protect national ICT infrastructure, data and citizens from cyber threats;

viii. Promote research, innovation and entrepreneurship in the ICT sector including the development of indigenous technology solutions and start-ups; and

ix. Provide quality meteorological data and forecast in support of weather sensitive sections of the economy.

Agencies Under the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations

The following are the Agencies under the Ministry of Communications and Digitalisation:

i. National Communications Authority (NCA);

ii. Cyber Security Authority (CSA);

iii. Postal and Courier Services Regulatory Commission (PCSRC);

iv. National Information Technology Agency (NITA);

v. Ghana Investment Fund for Electronic Communications (GIFEC);

vi. The Ghana-India Kofi Annan Centre of Excellence in ICT (GI-KACE);

vii. Data Protection Commission (DPC);

viii. Ghana Meteorological Agency (GMet);

ix. Ghana Post;

x. Ghana Digital Centre; and

xi. Ghana Domain Name Registry.

Policy Objectives of the Ministry

The policy objectives in line with the Ministry's Medium-Term Development Plan are outlined as follows:

a. Enhance application of ICT in national development;

b. Expand the digital landscape; and

c. Enhance Climate Change Resilience.

Financial Performance of the Ministry in the year 2025

Total Approved Budget for 2025

The sum of eight hundred and thirty-eight million, six hundred and eighty-five thousand, four hundred and twenty-one Ghana cedis (GH₵838,685,421.00) was allocated to the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations for the implementation of its activities for the 2025 financial year. As of November 2025, an amount of GH₵719,623,526.26 was released for the Ministry. The actual expenditure out of the released amount, however, was GH₵697,071,140.97 representing 97 per cent of the releases. The financial breakdown is shown in Table 1 below:

Table 1: Financial Performance of the Ministry of Communications and Digitalisation as at end of November 2025

Economic classification	2025 APPROVED BUDGET(GH₵) (A)	RELEASES (GH₵) (B)	ACTUAL EXPENDITURE (GH₵) (C)	VARIANCE 1 (GH₵) (D=A-B)	VARIANCE 2 (GH₵) (E=B-C)
Compensation	250,971,949.00	228,590,115.07	228,179,499.18	22,381,833.93	410,615.89
GOG	64,113,630.00	42,288,029.57	42,288,029.57	21,825,600.43	0.00
IGF	186,858,319.00	186,302,085.50	185,891,469.61	556,233.50	410,615.89
Goods & Services	199,596,901.00	172,902,906.65	246,121,670.46	26,693,994.35	-73,218,763.81
GOG	80,389,203.00	73,466,365.15	69,609,611.16	6,922,837.85	3,856,753.99
IGF	119,207,698.00	99,436,541.50	176,512,059.30	19,771,156.50	-77,075,517.80
CAPEX	306,616,571.00	256,936,807.94	188,186,536.73	49,679,763.06	68,750,271.21
GOG	220,000,000.00	190,000,000.00	128,262,800.73	30,000,000.00	61,737,199.27
IGF	86,616,571.00	66,936,807.94	59,923,736.00	19,679,763.06	7,013,071.94
Sub-total	757,185,421.00	658,429,829.66	662,487,706.37	98,755,591.34	-4,057,876.71
Dev't Partners	81,500,000.00	61,193,696.60	34,583,434.60	20,306,303.40	26,610,262.00
G&S	16,300,000.00	12,238,739.32	6,916,686.92	4,061,260.68	5,322,052.40
CAPEX	65,200,000.00	48,954,957.28	27,666,747.68	16,245,042.72	21,288,209.60
Grand Total	**838,685,421.00**	**719,623,526.26**	**697,071,140.97**	**119,061,894.74**	**22,552,385.29**

Operational Performance of the Ministry in 2025

The following programmes and activities were implemented in 2025 by the Ministry and its Agencies:

One Million Coders Initiative

In the year under review, the Ministry commenced the pilot phase (Phase One) of the *One Million Coders Initiative*. The Pilot cohort comprises of 859 trainees across Acra, Kumasi, Sunyani, and Bolgatanga. At the time of the launch, an impressive 91,847 applications were received within 48 hours, reflecting overwhelming national interest and demand. The training curriculum consists of 30 comprehensive modules in digital skills, carefully designed to equip participants with practical competencies to thrive in a digital economy.

Phase Two, to include virtual sessions, will commence in December 2025 with an expanded training centres and increased intake of participants.

Girls-In-ICT Initiative (GIICT)

The Ministry, under the Girls-in-ICT initiative, trained 2,000 girls and 200 ICT/STEM teachers in the Volta and Upper West Regions. The best performing girls and 20 outstanding teachers received laptops and certificates, whiles the schools of the top three girls in each region were selected for ICT lab refurbishment. Special recognition was also given to girls with special needs to foster inclusivity.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Ministerial Boot camp

In the year under review, the Ministry in collaboration with the UNDP, facilitated the training of Cabinet Ministers and focal persons from 23 Ministries on Artificial Intelligence (AI) fundamentals. This capacity building initiative aims to strengthen policy development, enhance governance, and ensure national readiness to harness emerging technologies for sustainable growth and digital transformation.

Validation of a National AI Strategy 2025-2035 was completed across the country. A National Steering Committee on the Ethics of AI was also established during the year.

Protection of Critical Information Structure (CII)

Following the publication of Gazette Notice No. 132 in September 2021, institutions across 13 sectors have been identified and designated by the Minister as Critical Information Infrastructure (CII) Owners and Sectors, respectively. In 2025, the Cyber Security Authority launched the Risk Assessment Framework for the Protection of Critical Information Infrastructure Owners to provide CII Owners with a structured approach to identifying and assessing the risks to their critical systems.

Cybercrime/Cybersecurity Incident Reporting Point of Contact Reporting

From January to September 2025, a total of 14,425 contacts were made with

Cyber Security Authority through the Point of Contacts out of which 3,286 (23 per cent) constituted actual cyber related incidents and 11,139 (77 per cent) being direct advisories to the public to help them avoid becoming potential victims of cybercrime. The top 5 incidents recorded during the period are:

- Online Fraud (1,200)
- Cyber bullying (738)
- Online Blackmail (507)
- Unauthorised Access (390)
- Information Disclosure (288)

Total losses to cybercrime between January and September 2025 came to GHS19,313,076.00 with Online Fraud and Impersonation as leading categories with losses of GHS12,870,065 and GHS5,660,700 respectively.

The Cyber Security Authority deployed advanced tools to monitor and mitigate online threats. This effort targets impersonations of Ministers, Members of Parliament, and government officials, leading to the successful takedown of 31 fake social media accounts.

Child Online Protection (COP) Developments

The Cyber Security Authority (CSA) undertook a series of initiatives aimed at promoting the safety and protection of children online. Key among these were:

a. **National Cybersecurity Challenge — Champion of Champions Edition 2025**—An initiative that brought together finalists from senior high schools to compete and showcase their knowledge and innovation in cybersecurity.

b. **Implementation of the National Child Online Protection Framework** —This is build the capacity of key stakeholder groups, including persons with disabilities, industry actors, and organisations addressing online child trafficking. These sessions enhanced stakeholder understanding of their roles in creating a safer digital environment for children and reinforced collaboration for effective implementation of the framework.

c. **Awareness creation for Children on Online Risks and Opportunities**— The Cyber Security Authority conducted targeted awareness sessions for 60,994 children in primary and senior high schools across various regions. The engagements educated children on the risks associated with internet use, such as cyberbullying and online exploitation, while highlighting opportunities for learning, innovation, and safe participation in the digital space.

Rural Telephony and Digital Inclusion Projects (GRT & DIP)

Through the Ghana Investment Fund for Electronic Communications (GIFEC), the Ministry has constructed a total of 1,561 sites, which now serve approximately 1 million Ghanaians as part of the Digitalisation Agenda. These newly constructed sites allow citizens to connect to their preferred mobile networks, through the Local Roaming Initiative.

Establishment of Community Information Centres

GIFEC has established a network of 281 vibrant Community Information ICT Centres (CICs) with continuous support for the existing centres. The Commission has introduced new model with 30 units, of which six new model centres are operational, with 4 already commissioned (Agona Abodom, Kokofu, Tolon and Suhum)

Digital Youth Village

The Ministry commenced construction of a Digital Youth Village at the University of Ghana campus that will serve as a strategic intervention to enhance the application of ICT in national development and expand the digital landscape. In 2025 Project was redesigned and new blueprint developed. The project is at 70 per cent completed.

School Connectivity Programme

The Ministry supported 232 Senior High Schools with 40-seater thin client computer labs in the southern and middle zones to enhance the study of ICT and STEM-related courses. ICT equipment was procured for the National Council on Women and Persons with disabilities.

ECOWAS Roaming Regulation

The National Communications Authority (NCA) successfully implemented the ECOWAS roaming service with The Gambia, enabling seamless communication across borders. Memorandums of Understanding (MOUs) have been signed with Liberia and Sierra Leone to eliminate roaming charges. The Authority is currently developing an MOU with Nigeria to expand. Ghana and Burkina Faso have taken a major step toward easing cross-border communication with a new roaming agreement aimed at lowering call and data costs for travellers.

Launch of the National Privacy Awareness Campaign

The Data Protection Commission on 15th September 2025 launched the One-year-long National Privacy Awareness Campaign targeted at educating the average Ghanaian on their privacy rights and data controllers on their obligations under the Data Protection Act.

Improved Weather Forecast and Prediction

With a network of 21 stations transmitting through MESSIR-COM and 47 Automatic Weather Stations across the country, the Ghana Meteorological Agency (GMet) achieved the following:

- Obtained ISO 9001, 2015 Quality Management System certification for all its services.

- No. of weather forecasts increased to three times daily
- Four Terminal Aerodrome Forecasts per day.
- Two Inland Waters Forecasts daily.
- Issuance of three Marine Weather Advisories,
- Generates Meteorological Aerodrome Report (METARs) every 30 minutes,
- Provided 38 Agrometeorological Bulletins throughout the year.

Passport Delivery

The Ghana Post Company Limited (GPCL) commenced a Passport Delivery Project in May 2025 in collaboration with the Ghana Passport Office. As at the end of August 2025, 61,076 passports had been successfully delivered, marking a significant achievement in service delivery.

Operational volumes during the period exceeded expectations, with Letter Mails achieving a remarkable 279 per cent increase, EMS recording 4 per cent growth, and Parcels rising by 19 per cent.

Outlook for The 2026 Financial Year

The priority areas of the Ministry and its agencies for the year 2026 include the following:

One Million Coders Programme

Train 100,000 citizens during the year.

Support for Fintech Ecosystem

The Ministry will set up a Fintech Growth Fund to promote the growth of Digital Entrepreneurs and support indigenous FinTech companies.

Digital Job Initiative

The Ministry will partner with local tech start-ups and businesses to create job employment opportunities for the youth.

Legislative Review

There will be a review of all sector legislation to make them consistent with recent developments in lCT.

Digital Youth Village

The Ministry intends to complete the Digital Youth Village project. This project is implemented in partnership with the University of Ghana.

Ghana Rural Telephony and Digital Inclusion Project

The Ministry intends to continue with the Ghana Rural Telephony and Digital Inclusion Project to complete the building of remaining sites.

Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry for 2026

The sum of one billion, two hundred and fifty-five million, one hundred and twenty-one thousand, seven hundred and sixty- nine Ghana cedis (GH₵1,255,121,769) has been allocated to the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations for the implementation of its activities for the 2026 financial year. Table 2 provides a breakdown of the 2026 budgetary allocation to the Ministry by economic classificatio

Table 2: Budgetary Allocation by Economic Classification

Expenditure Item	**Sources of Funding**			
	GOG (GH₵)	**IGF (GH₵)**	**DP Funds (GH₵)**	**Total (GH₵)**
Compensation	81,221,438.00	236,238,476.00	-	317,459,914.00
Goods and Services	100,389,203.00	269,860,362.00	27,600,000.00	397,849,565.00
Capital Expenditure	150,000,000.00	279,412,290.00	110,400,000.00	539,812,290.00
Grand Total	**331,610,641.00**	**785,511,128.00**	**138,000,000.00**	**1,255,121,769**

Source: The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2025 Financial Year.

Budgetary Allocation to the Ministry by Programme

Table 3: Budgetary Allocation to the Ministry by Programme

2026 BUDGET PROPOSAL									
PROGRAMME	GOG			SUB-TOTAL	IGF			FL&G	GRAND TOTAL
	COE	G&S	CAPEX		COE	G&S	CAPEX		
Management & Administration	15,867,793	76,155,683	145,800,000	237,823,476	-	59,630,886	139,138,734	138,000,000	574,593,096
ICT Infrastructure, Regulation & Capacity Building	32,843,801	16,963,464	3,200,000	53,007,265	236,238,476	177,425,418	95,276,691		561,947,850
Meterological Services	30,947,566	3,231,136	-	34,178,702		31,084,608	44,996,865	-	110,260,175
Postal & Courier Services	1,562,278	4,038,920	1,000,000	6,601,198		1,719,450	-	-	8,320,648
Total Estimates	81,221,438	100,389,203	150,000,000	331,610,641	236,238,476	269,860,362	279,412,290	138,000,000	1,255,121,769

Source: The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2026 Financial Year.

Observations and Recommendations

The Committee made the following observations during the deliberations:

Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations

The Committee observed that the Ministry has undertaken extensive policy, legislative and programme coordination activities during the year under review, including restructuring of the Ministry's functions, and the initiation of the One Million Coders Programme.

It was noted that the Ministry's mandate has expanded significantly with its new designation which incorporates digital technology and innovation responsibilities. However, the budgetary allocation of the Ministry remains inadequate considering the extent of its mandate and plans for the year under review.

The Committee further observed that several flagship programmes, such as the One Million Coders initiative, digital skills expansion, and sector-wide legislative reforms, are heavily dependent on support from agencies such as NCA and GIFEC, creating compliance and sustainability concerns under the Public Financial Management Act.

The Committee recommends that Ministry minimises the heavy reliance on NCA and GIFEC for flagship programme financing and seek dedicated funding sources for major digital transformation programmes.

The Committee further recommends that the Ministry provide Parliament with comprehensive financial breakdowns for all major initiatives, including unit cost structures for devices supplied under the One Million Coders Programme. The Ministry is encouraged to expedite the ongoing legislative review process and provide quarterly updates to the Committee on progress made.

Additionally, the Committee recommends that the Ministry strengthen its compliance with the reporting requirements of the Public Financial Management Act regarding virements and realignments. Measures should also be taken to ensure adequate staffing support following Ministry restructuring and staff transfers. The Ministry is further encouraged to intensify consumer protection oversight and continue quality-of-service engagements with NCA.

The Committee noted a variance of GH₵1,042,623.47 above the Ministry's approved budget of GH₵9,813,208.00 for Compensation of Employees. It was however explained that this was as a result of the transfer of staff of the erstwhile Ministry of Information to the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations who needed to be remunerated. Similarly, a variance of GH₵73,218,763.81 was identified as an expenditure that exceeded the amount released to the Ministry in respect of Goods and Services. The Minister explained that the excess was internally generated fund that accrued from the sale of broadcast spectrum which Cabinet authorised to be used to support the One Million Coders Programme.

National Information Technology Agency (NITA)

The Committee observed that NITA remains a central institution in the national digital ecosystem, with responsibility for regulating ICT policy implementation, managing government IT infrastructure, and ensuring interoperability and standards compliance across public systems. However, the Committee noted that NITA continues to operate with serious resource limitations, particularly in respect of capital investment, modern ICT tools, and specialised personnel.

It was further observed that despite NITA's pivotal role in government-wide digital transformation—including network infrastructure, cybersecurity collaboration, enterprise architecture, and digital public services—its visibility and operational influence remain constrained. The Committee took notice of the fact that major digital programmes of the Ministry, such as the One Million Coders Programme and the broader digital government initiatives, require NITA's technical oversight, yet the Agency lacks the funding and tools required to undertake these responsibilities effectively.

The Committee noted that NITA manages the call centre operations and the onboarding of Government Agencies, particularly Ministries, Departments and Agencies, onto the ghana.gov platform. The Committee further noted that an agreement was reached with the operators of the ghana.gov (Digital Gov) for the remittance of 7 per cent of their share of the payment for the use of the domain name, although the initial arrangement provided for 12 per cent.

The Committee found that the operators have not made any payment to the Agency, which has contributed significantly to the financial challenges facing the Agency and has weakened its capacity to undertake its statutory functions effectively.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry ensures the enforcement of the revised remittance arrangement and take immediate steps to secure the outstanding payments owed to the Agency. It is further recommended that a comprehensive review of the existing contractual framework be undertaken to provide clarity on obligations and protect public interest.

The Committee further recommends for a dedicated capital funding should be allocated to upgrade government network systems and secure critical digital infrastructure.

The Committee again recommends that the regulatory mandate of NITA be strengthened through the development of a clear framework for ICT standards enforcement, collaboration, and digital systems integration. The Ministry should expedite work on the ongoing policy framework to clarify the role of NITA within the national digital architecture and align it with the emerging mandates of sector agencies.

Additionally, the Committee encourages NITA to establish stronger partnerships with private-sector technology firms and development partners to expand technical capacity.

Cyber Security Authority

The Committee observed that the Cyber Security Authority remains critically underfunded, with minimal allocations for goods and services and no capital expenditure allocation for the upcoming year. The Authority reported high attrition rate arising from uncompetitive remuneration, inadequate tools, and limited recruitment, despite the increasing national cyber threat.

Members also observed the lack of operationalisation of the Cybersecurity Fund provided for under Act 1038, thereby limiting the Authority's ability to generate dedicated resources to sustain its operations.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance significantly increase allocations to the Cyber Security Authority to ensure national resilience against cyber threats. The operationalisation of the Cybersecurity Fund under Act 1038 should be expedited to enable the Authority retain a portion of proceeds arising from cybersecurity operations in accordance with law.

The Committee further recommends that recruitment approvals be expedited as well as improved remuneration structures be considered to address high attrition rates.

Data Protection Agencies

The Committee observed that although the Data Protection Commission carries a statutory mandate to regulate personal data handling across all sectors, the Commission operates with limited resources and staff capacity. Briefings revealed that the Commission has not received predictable funding from its IGF collections, and its operational reach remains far below what is required to enforce data protection compliance nationwide. The Committee noted that the activities of the Commission are increasingly critical given the digital transformation agenda and rising data security concerns, yet its institutional strengthening remains inadequate.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance, in consultation with the sector Ministry, prioritise the operationalisation of the Data Protection Fund to create a more sustainable financing model.

The Committee further recommends periodic reporting on compliance levels to enable parliamentary oversight.

The Ghana-India Kofi Annan Centre of Excellence in ICT

The Committee observed that the Kofi Annan Centre of Excellence in ICT continues to provide technical training and support services, but its operational visibility and national deployment remain limited by funding constraints. Although the Centre plays a strategic role in Ghana's digital skills ecosystem, its ability to deliver cutting-edge ICT training is inhibited by outdated equipment, insufficient capital investment, and limited programme expansion.

The Committee also noted that the potential of the Centre to complement the One Million Coders Programme and other digital literacy initiatives has not been fully leveraged due to resource limitations.

The Committee recommends that the Centre should prioritise procuring adequate resources to modernise its ICT infrastructure and expand its training programmes. The Centre should collaborate more closely with the Ministry to align its curriculum with national digital development priorities. A sustainable funding model, including partnerships with the private sector and development partners, should be explored to broaden programme delivery and national reach.

National Communications Authority

The Committee observed that the National Communications Authority has undertaken critical support functions for several agencies and flagship programmes of the Ministry, including cybersecurity operations, the One Million Coders hardware procurement, and residual obligations relating to DTT infrastructure. It was noted that recent ceilings imposed on IGF of NCA has significantly constrained the Authority's operational flexibility, with implications for agencies dependent on NCA funding.

The Committee further observed that the Authority faces increasing demands, including international regulatory engagements, ITU elections, and hosting responsibilities linked to its 30th anniversary celebration. Members expressed concern that continuing reductions in NCA budget ceilings could jeopardise these obligations as well as national cybersecurity preparedness.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance review the IGF ceiling imposed on NCA to ensure that the Authority remains adequately resourced to perform both its core regulatory functions and its supporting obligations to sector agencies.

The Committee further recommends that responsibilities of NCA towards agencies such as the Cyber Security Authority and the Ghana Domain Name Registry be rationalised and properly provided for under the national budget to prevent over-reliance on the Authority's IGF.

Additionally, the Committee recommends that NCA's international commitments and recurring regulatory duties be reflected in its annual budget ceilings, and that Parliament consider enhanced allocations where necessary to safeguard national infrastructure and regulatory stability.

Ghana Digital Centres Limited

The Committee observed that Ghana Digital Centres Limited (GDCL) achieved only 46 per cent of its Internally Generated Funds target for the 2025 financial year as of September, a development which raises concerns regarding the Centre's financial sustainability. It was further noted that GDCL remains heavily dependent on rental income, yet much of its infrastructure has deteriorated, diminishing its attractiveness to clients and limiting its capacity to raise income.

The Committee also observed that the Centre requires substantial capital investment to rehabilitate its facilities but lacks sufficient internally generated resources to undertake this work.

It was further noted that GDCL occupies PWD properties belonging to the Ministry of Works and Housing, and that the formalisation of this arrangement remains outstanding.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry facilitates access to capital funding to rehabilitate GDCL facilities to restore their competitive value.

The Centre is encouraged to diversify its revenue base by developing additional digital innovation and incubation services.

The Committee further recommends that GDCL finalises the necessary agreements with the Ministry of Works and Housing regarding the occupancy of PWD sites. GDCL is also urged to improve its quarterly reporting to the Committee and to provide detailed strategies for enhancing IGF performance in 2026.

Ghana Post Company Limited

The Committee observed that Ghana Post experienced significant revenue challenges during the year under review, largely attributable to external disruptions, including industrial action by Canada Post and airline decisions that temporarily curtailed parcel movement to the United States under new tariff conditions. Notwithstanding these adverse developments, the Committee noted that Ghana Post has made commendable progress in the nationwide delivery of passports and security documents, although challenges persist in instances where applicants utilise unauthorised intermediaries, thereby preventing successful delivery.

The Committee also observed that customer frustration remains high in respect of Customs duty procedures, which continue to prolong delivery timelines. Additionally, the Committee took notice of Ghana Post's extensive property portfolio, a large portion of which remains underutilised or in need of rehabilitation. It was further observed that the Company continues to experience revenue leakage due to unfavourable arrangements with private courier fronts, despite Ghana Post performing the operational work.

The Committee further noted that Ghana Post has not fully taken advantage of opportunities in payment services, e-commerce logistics, and international parcel flows.

The Committee recommends that Ghana Post establishes a structured collaboration with the GRA to streamline

Customs duty assessment and introduce clearer, customer-friendly processes. Ghana Post should restructure or terminate unfavourable agreements with private courier operators and pursue the necessary regulatory approvals from the Bank of Ghana to operate as a payment service provider.

The Company is further encouraged to undertake a comprehensive audit of its properties and operationalise dormant facilities, particularly in underserved areas. The Committee recommends that Government agencies prioritise Ghana Post for official courier and distribution assignments. Ghana Post is also urged to revise its pricing structure for services and guest houses to reflect market conditions and enhance its IGF. The Company should also diversify its international parcel networks, particularly towards markets such as China, Dubai, India and Turkey.

Postal and Courier Services Regulatory Commission

The Committee observed that the Postal and Courier Services Regulatory Commission (PCRC) plays a regulatory role essential to sanitising the courier and postal delivery landscape, yet the Commission appears under-resourced and overshadowed by operational challenges across the communications sector. During the deliberations, it emerged that the Commission lacks sufficient funding, has limited inspection capabilities, and is challenged in enforcing compliance against unlicensed operators.

The Committee also noted that the PCRC has not been sufficiently integrated into the wider reforms in respect of e-commerce, postal modernization, and last-mile delivery frameworks. The lack of robust enforcement may result in revenue leakages within the courier industry and undermine service standards.

The Committee recommends resourcing of the PCRC to enable comprehensive nationwide inspections and regulatory enforcement. The Commission should be empowered to strengthen licensing procedures, curtail illegal courier operations, and collaborate with Ghana Post and private operators to establish standardised service benchmarks.

Ghana Domain Name Registry

The Committee observed that the Ghana Domain Name Registry (GDNR) operates without an Act of Parliament, a situation which has undermined its ability to receive statutory funding.

The Committee was alarmed to note that staff of the Registry, including the Executive Secretary appointed by the President, have not received salaries for an extended period of approximately eleven months, in clear violation of national labour regulations governing employment. Also, the staff employed are all contract staff.

It was also observed that only one of the four national DNS root servers is currently functional, thereby exposing the country to substantial digital vulnerability should the remaining server fail.

The Committee took notice of the fact that efforts to secure temporary financial support from NCA and GIFEC were unsuccessful due to the absence of a legislative instrument establishing GDNR, and due to audit implications cited by the GIFEC Board. Additionally, negotiations towards the transfer of full management of the *.gh* domain to the Government are yet to be concluded, with concerns relating to institutional support for the Internet Society of Ghana.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry expedites the submission of an establishing legislation for GDNR to regularise its mandate and enable sustainable budgetary support. Financial clearance should be secured urgently to place all GDNR staff on the appropriate government payroll and to clear all outstanding salary arrears without further delay.

The Committee further recommends that priority funding be provided for the replacement of end-of-life DNS infrastructure to safeguard national cybersecurity.

The Ministry is encouraged to conclude negotiations for the transfer of the *.gh* domain using the revised trust-fund model, and to roll out a national sensitisation initiative to promote the adoption of *.gh* and*.com.gh* digital identities. GDNR is further urged to engage the Committee proactively on operational matters requiring Parliamentary attention.

Ghana Meteorological Agency

Members noted during deliberations on Ghana Meteorological Agency (GMet) that the Agency remains constrained by outdated equipment, insufficient forecasting infrastructure, and limited personnel capacity, despite its role in aviation safety, climate monitoring, and national early-warning systems.

The Committee recommends that GMet receive dedicated capital funding for upgrading meteorological equipment, modernising forecasting systems, and enhancing data management infrastructure. The Agency should also be supported to develop strong collaborations with the Cyber Security Authority and NITA to secure meteorological data systems.

The Committee further recommends that the work of GMet be more explicitly incorporated into national digital infrastructure planning, given its importance for agriculture, aviation, disaster management, and climate resilience.

The Committee was alarmed to note that despite provisions of the Ghana Meteorological Agency (Amendment) Act, 2019 (Act 1002), the Ghana Civil Aviation Authority has consistently failed to pay to the Ghana

Meteorological Agency monies due the Agency. The Ghana Airport Company, however, has complied with the said legislation. The Committee recommends for a collaboration between the Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations and the Minister for Transport and itself to ensure compliance by the Ghana Civil Aviation Authority on the matter. The Committee recommends for Mr Speaker and the House to call on GCAA to comply with Act 1002.

Ghana News Agency

The Committee observed that the Ghana News Agency (GNA), despite severe financial constraints, has made commendable strides toward infrastructural improvement, particularly the renovation of its office complex which is reportedly 90per cent complete.

It was noted that GNA continues to play an essential national role in providing credible, non-partisan news content, yet operates with limited equipment and insufficient logistical support. The Minister also drew attention to the progress of GNA with support from development partners and highlighted its potential for expanded national and international relevance.

The Committee recommends that Government provide targeted logistical and financial support to enable GNA to complete its renovation works and operationalise the newly refurbished facilities.

The Committee encourages the GNA to undertake collaborative initiatives with other communications agencies to improve sector-wide content development. The Agency is further encouraged to strengthen partnerships with development organisations to supplement its limited budgetary allocations.

Information Services Department

The Committee observed that the Information Services Department (ISD) has made notable progress in improving its operational visibility following the acquisition of all forty information vans recorded the previous year. The Department is preparing to deploy these vans as part of nationwide public education campaigns, particularly during budget seasons and other national events.

It was noted, however, that ISD continues to experience challenges related to inadequate training, limited digital tools, and insufficient personnel to support modern public communications demands. The presentation highlighted that, although significant funding has been released, critical capacity gaps remain unresolved.

The Committee also observed that multimedia and archival resources require substantial upgrading to meet contemporary standards of public information management and can be also used to attract some IGF.

The Committee recommends that Government continue to prioritise budgetary releases to enable ISD to sustain and expand its public communication activities.

The Department should receive specialised training support to equip staff with modern communication and digital skills. ISD is further encouraged to adopt a structured programme for maintaining and utilising the information vans to ensure maximum national impact.

The Committee urges the Ministry to finalise its plans for a sector-wide restructuring initiative that includes ISD, aimed at enhancing its long-term institutional capacity.

The Committee recommends that ISD should be supported to digitise its archival collections with the aim of creating revenue-generating products, in line with best international practices.

Ghana Broadcasting Corporation

The Committee observed that the Ghana Broadcasting Corporation continues to face significant operational constraints arising from inadequate resources and the absence of modern broadcasting equipment. It was noted with concern that despite the critical national mandate of GBC, resource allocation to the agency remains insufficient, compelling staff to operate under suboptimal conditions.

The Committee further took notice of reports that GBC has made progress in renovating portions of its facilities and has utilised releases under goods and services efficiently, yet the scale of its infrastructural deficit remains substantial. The leadership of the Corporation also highlighted ongoing legacy debts, including high utility arrears that continue to limit its spending flexibility.

The Committee acknowledged that although GBC has demonstrated prudent budget management, its operational environment requires substantial modernisation to meet contemporary broadcasting standards.

The Committee recommends that GBC prioritise capital investment in its infrastructure, including the upgrading of outdated broadcasting equipment and digital transmission systems.

Furthermore, the Committee urges the office of Government Communications to assist GBC in establishing sustainable arrangements to clear outstanding utility obligations in order to stabilise operations.

GBC is encouraged to develop additional revenue strategies, including content monetisation, to strengthen its internally generated funds.

The Minister should also continue its engagements with GBC towards the development of a comprehensive retooling and restructuring programme for presentation to Parliament for further consideration.

Budget Allocations of GBC, GNA, AND ISD

The Minister for Government Communications and officials of Ghana Broadcasting Corporation, Ghana News Agency, and the Information Services Department attended upon the Committee on Information and Communications for deliberations on their budget for the 2026 financial year. It must be noted, however, that the budget allocations for the Ghana Broadcasting Corporation, Ghana News Agency, and the Information Services Department are captured under the budget estimates of the Office of Government Machinery.

Conclusion

The role of the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations is fundamental for the socio-economic transformation of the country. The Committee has critically examined the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry for the 2026 Financial Year, and is of the view that the Estimates are justified.

The Committee accordingly recommends to the House to adopt this Report and approve the sum of one billion, two hundred and fifty-five million, one hundred and twenty-one thousand, seven hundred and sixty-nine Ghana cedis (GH₵1,255,121,769) for the programmes and activities of the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations for the 2026 Financial Year.

Respectfully submitted.

Deputy Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations (Alhaji Mohammed Adams Sukparu) (MP): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Information and Communication on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,255,121,769.00 for the services of the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 11. The allocation for the services of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition for the year ending 31st December 2026.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 11, by the Chairperson of the Committee.

7:47 p.m.

ANNUAL ESTIMATES, 2026

MINISTRY OF ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSITION

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Naser Toure Mahama): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

> That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Energy for the sum of GH₵3,938,542,545.00 on the allocation of the services of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

In doing so, I want the *Hansard* to capture the Report as fully read. Thank you.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year was presented to Parliament by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson, on 13th November, 2025 in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution and Order 252 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Pursuant to Order 195(4) of the Standing Orders, the Annual Budget Estimates for the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition stood committed to the Committee on Energy for consideration and report.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry, met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Energy and Green Transition, Mr Richard Gyan-Mensah, senior officials of the Ministry, and other officials of agencies under the Ministry. Representatives from the Ministry of Finance, together with Mr Kodzo Yaotse of the Africa Centre for Energy Policy (ACEP), were also in attendance to support the deliberations.

The Committee extends its profound appreciation to the Hon Deputy Minister, and all the officials for their attendance and for the valuable clarifications provided in response to the issues raised during the deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana, 2024;

iii. The Civil Service Act, 1993 (PNDCL 327);

iv. The Energy Sector Levies Act, 2015 (Act 899);

v. The Nuclear Regulatory Authority Act, 2015 (Act 895);

vi. The Renewable Energy Act, 2011 (Act 832);

vii. Petroleum Hub Development Corporation Act, 2020 (Act 1053);

viii. Energy Commission Act, 1997 (Act 541);

ix. The Ghana Energy Policy, 2010;

x. The Revised Gas Master Plan; and

xi. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.

Vision, Mission and Core Functions of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition

Vision of the Ministry

To be self-sufficient in the provision of sustainable energy and for export.

Core Functions of the Ministry

The core functions of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition are as follows:

i. Translate Government's energy development agenda and policy directions contained in the national energy policy into strategies and programmes;

ii. Ensure reliable supply of affordable energy services to meet national demand and for export;

iii. Increase access to modern energy forms, especially in the rural areas;

iv. Ensure availability and security of future energy supplies; and

v. Strengthen the capacity of energy sector institutions in the planning and coordination of the sector.

Agencies Under the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition

The Agencies under the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition comprises the following:

i. Petroleum Commission (PC)

ii. National Petroleum Authority (NPA)

iii. Ghana National Petroleum Cooperation (GNPCL)

iv. Ghana National Gas Company Limited (GNGC)

v. Petroleum Hub Development Corporation (PHDC)

vi. Bulk Oil Storage and Transportation Company Limited (BOST)

vii. Tema Oil Refinery (TOR)

viii. Energy Commission (EC)

ix. Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC)

x. Volta River Authority (VRA)

xi. Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG)

xii. Ghana Grid Company Limited (GRIDCO)

xiii. Northern Electricity Distribution Company (NEDCo)

xiv. Bui Power Authority (BPA)

xv. Ghana Cylinder Manufacturing Company Limited (GCMC)

Sector Policy Objectives of the Ministry for the Medium Term

For the Medium Term, the Sector Policy Objectives of the Ministry are, to:

i. Achieve cost-competitive electricity generation;

ii. Develop a grid transmission system that facilitates efficient and cost-competitive power evacuation and transportation;

iii. Accelerate the achievement of universal access to electricity in the country;

iv. Strengthen the electricity distribution system to enhance a competitive electricity retail market and improve revenue collection;

v. Increase the contribution of renewable energy in the overall energy production mix;

vi. Ensure that Ghana's petroleum resources are managed in a transparent and sustainable manner;

vii. Create an environment that will sustain the development and productive utilisation of natural gas;

viii. Ensure an effective and efficient functioning downstream petroleum industry;

ix. Maximise local content and local participation in the energy sector;

x. Protect the health, safety and security of people working in the energy value chain;

xi. Ensure that energy is produced, transported and utilised in an environmentally sustainable manner;

xii. Mainstream gender and persons with disabilities in the energy sector;

xiii. Promote research into energy production, supply and utilisation to ensure sustainable development and use of energy resources;

xiv. Enhance capacity for policy formulation and coordination; and

xv. Ensure effective and efficient government machinery.

2025 Financial Performance of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition

The sum of one billion, two hundred and eighty million, nine hundred and five thousand, three hundred and thirty-five Ghana cedis (GH₵1,280,905,335) was approved for the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition to implement its programmes for the 2025 Financial Year.

The total expenditure of the Ministry as of September 2025 stood at four hundred and fifty-nine million, three hundred and eighty-nine thousand, eighty-one Ghana cedis, twelve pesewas (GH₵459,389,081.12). The details of this expenditure are shown in Table 1.

Table 1: Expenditure of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition as at the end of September 2025

Funding Source	Approved Budget (GH₵) (A)	2025 Releases (End September 2025) (GH₵) (B)	Actual Expenditure (End September 2025) (GH₵) (C)	Variance (GH₵) (B-C)
Compensation (HQTRS, NPG, PHDC)	318,184,467.00	341,068,072.40	330,821,351.28	10,246,721.12
Goods and Services (GoG)	189,415,342.00	236,107,588.87	103,162,043.13	132,945,545.74
Capex	773,305,526.00	338,290,078.19	25,405,686.71	312,884,391.48
Total	**1,280,905,335.00**	**915,465,739.46**	**459,389,081.12**	**456,076,658.34**

Table 2: Classification by Programme of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition as at the end of September 2025

Expenditure Item	2025 Approved Budget (A)	Releases (End Sept 2025) (B)	Actual Expendure (End Sept) (C)	Variance 1 D=A-B	Variance 2 E=B-C
Compensation of Employees	318,184,467.00	341,068,072.40	330,821,351.28	-22,883,605	10,246,721.12
o/w GoG	15,351,908.00	11,767,973.30	10,849,134.18	3,583,934.70	918,839.12
Headquarters	13,593,201.72	11,417,925.30	10,499,086.18	2,175,276.42	918,839.12
Petroleum Hub	1,758,706.28	350,048.00	350,048.00	1,408,658.28	-

IGF	302,832,559.00	329,300,099.10	319,972,217.10	-26,467,540.10	9,327,882.00
Energy Commission	45,748,508.00	36,550,936.00	27,223,054.00	9,197,572.00	9,327,882.00
Petroleum Commission	110,257,436.00	76,969,219.00	76,969,219.00	33,288,217.00	-
National Petroleum Authority	146,826,615.00	215,779,944.10	215,779,944.10	-68,953,329.10	-
Use of Goods & Services	189,415,342.00	236,107,588.87	103,162,043.13	-46,692,246.87	132,945,545.74
o/w GoG	38,671,646.00	13,768,791.68	6,626,579.64	24,902,854.32	7,142,212.04
Rural Electrification	30,000,000.00	10,707,668.24	5,485,812.82	19,292,331.76	5,221,855.42
Petroleum Hub	5,671,646.00	1,995,356.61	75,000.00	3,676,289.39	1,920,356.61
Nuclear Energy	3,000,000.00	1,065,766.82	1,065,766.82	1,934,233.18	-
IGF	150,743,696.00	222,338,797.19	96,535,463.49	-71,595,101.19	125,803,333.70
Energy Commission	26,485,978.00	46,517,038.00	21,396,917.00	-20,031,060.00	25,120,121.00
Petroleum Commission	38,608,859.00	25,262,042.00	25,262,042.00	13,346,817.00	-
National Petroleum Authority	85,648,859.00	150,559,717.19	49,876,504.49	-64,910,858.19	100,683,212.70
Capital Expenditure	773,305,526.00	338,290,078.19	25,405,686.71	435,015,447.81	312,884,391.48
o/w GoG	300,000,000.00	180,000,000.00	-	120,000,000.00	180,000,000.00
Headquaters	184,050,000.00	112,000,000.00	-	72,050,000.00	112,000,000.00
Rural Electrification	100,000,000.00	60,000,000.00	-	40,000,000.00	60,000,000.00
Petroleum Hub	12,950,000.00	5,000,000.00	-	7,950,000.00	5,000,000.00
Nuclear Energy	3,000,000.00	3,000,000.00	-	-	3,000,000.00
IGF	114,245,580.00	158,290,078.19	25,405,686.71	-44,044,498.19	132,884,391.48
Energy Commission	10,835,173.00	5,762,142.00	2,025,253.00	5,073,031.00	3,736,889.00
Petroleum Commission	17,761,548.00	1,968,219.00	1,968,219.00	15,793,329.00	-
National Petroleum Authority	85,648,859.00	150,559,717.19	21,412,214.71	-64,910,858.19	129,147,502.48

Foreign Loans & Grants (FLG)	359,059,946.00	-	-	359,059,946.00	-
Total	**1,280,905,335.00**	**915,465,739.46**	**459,389,081.12**	**365,439,595.54**	**456,076,658.34**

2025 Operational Performance of the Ministry of Energy

The operational performance of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition in 2025 is outlined as follows:

Power Sector Development

Generation and transmission

The Ministry achieved the following under its power generation and transmission programmes during the year under review:

i. Signed the Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) contract for repowering the 132MW Takoradi Thermal Plant (T3).

ii. Successfully on track to commission Phase 1 of the 350 MW Combined Cycle Natural Gas Power Plant by AKSA Energy at Anwomaso, Kumasi, delivering 180 MW of new generation capacity, by the end of 2025.

iii. Under the KfW-funded 330 kV Accra–Kumasi Transmission Line Project, the contract for the Environmental Consultant has been awarded, and the Consultant has commenced work with the preparation of the inception report. The project, when completed, would strengthen the National Grid for domestic use and export.

iv. Successfully signed a Memorandum of Understanding between Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana to advance the implementation of the Ghana Transmission Systems Improvement Projects.

Power distribution

During the year under review, the Ministry achieved the following under its power distribution programmes:

i. Connected 100 communities to the national grid;

ii. Increased the national electricity access rate from 88.75 per cent to 89.03 per cent as of September 2025;

iii. Six Units of the Ameri Plants have been relocated and commissioned;

iv. Continued work on the Emergency Outage Reduction Project to mitigate power outages; and

v. Secured approval from the Public Procurement Authority (PPA) to implement a Nationwide Street Lighting Rehabilitation Project.

This is expected to restore, expand, and ensure the long-term sustainability of streetlights across the country.

Green Energy Transition/Renewable Energy Development

The Ministry achieved the following as part of its programmes under its green energy transition/renewable energy development:

i. Added 50MW solar power capacity to the generation stock, bringing to installed renewable energy capacity to 256MW;

ii. Completed rehabilitation of 5 pilot mini-grids in the islands of Pediatorkope in Ada Municipality, Aglakope in the Krachi West Municipality, Kudorkope in the Krachi East Municipality, Atigagome, and Wayokope in the Sene East District;

iii. Completed the construction of three (3) new mini-grids in Azizakpe, Aflive, and Alorkpem in the Ada Municipality.

iv. Secured approval for the construction of 50MW Sunon Asogli solar power systems and 9MW wind power by Anvoskov-Mikeal Wind;

v. Installed a total of 1,960 (80 per cent) out of the 2,450 solar streetlights in the Ashanti Region;

vi. Distributed a total of 485,000 improved locally manufactured cooking stoves; and

vii. Completed the Design, Engineering, Factory Acceptance Test, training and inauguration for the Dawhenya Irrigation Scheme (DIS).

Nuclear Power Development

The Ministry achieved the following under its Nuclear Power programmes in 2025:

i. Attained significant progress with the installation of a NuScale Power Simulator (E2 Centre) for training and capacity building;

ii. Completed Draft Bill for the establishment of an Owner-Operator Company and ready to be submitted to Parliament; and

iii. Carried out community and stakeholder sensitisation on Nuclear Power.

Petroleum Sub-Sector Development

Upstream activities

The Ministry achieved the following in the petroleum upstream sub-sector in 2025:

i. A total crude oil production from the three producing fields for the period January to September 2025 was 27.92 million barrels which translates to an average daily oil production of 102,058.30 barrels per day;

ii. Total gas production from the three producing fields for the period was 179,542.20 MMSCF at an average daily production rate of 248.95 MMSCF/d;

iii. Exported 79,127.88 MMSCF from the total gas produced to the processing plant at Atuabo and the Onshore Receiving Facility (ORF) at Sanzule; and

iv. Advanced negotiations with Shell Overseas Holdings Limited towards a Petroleum Agreement for the South Deepwater Tano Block, achieving consensus on the majority of key terms.

Downstream activities

The following were achieved by the Ministry in the Downstream in 2024:

i. Conclude the gas agreement of Jubilee Post Foundation to ensure continuous delivery of natural gas from the Jubilee and TEN fields;

ii. Scale up the distribution of LPG cookstoves under the National LPG Promotion Programme (NLPGPP) to benefit 16,000 additional households;

iii. Completed 66.6 per cent of the Front-End Engineering Design (FEED) for the Tema Natural Gas Distribution Pipeline Network Project;

iv. Prepared a new NPA Bill to repeal and re-enact the NPA Act 2005 (Act 691);

v. Worked with relevant stakeholders under the Biofuel Development and Commercialisation Initiative to develop a National Biofuel Action Plan.

Health, Safety, Security and Environment

Implemented climate change interventions through all agencies under the National Climate Change-Smart Energy Action Plan.

Outlook of the Ministry and Agencies for 2026

Power Sector Development

Generation and transmission

In 2026, the Ministry plans to achieve the following under its power generation and transmission programmes:

i. Commission the remaining 50 MW of the Anwomaso Power Plant Phase II;

ii. Commission Phase II (171 MW) of the 350 MW AKSA Plant at Anwomaso by third quarter of 2026;

iii. Operationalise the 132 MW Takoradi Thermal Plant (T3);

iv. Commence WAPP Ghana – Côte D'Ivoire Interconnection Project;

v. Commence the Utility-Scale Solar Auction;

vi. Commission Phase I (110 MW simple cycle) of the 300 MW CENIT Plant at Anwomaso by end of 2026;

vii. Commence the construction of the KFW 330kv project; and

viii. Establish a 1,200MW state-owned thermal Power Plant.

Power distribution

Under the Power Distribution programme of the Ministry, the following activities have been planned for the year 2026:

i. Continue implementation of other Turnkey electrification projects in the Northern; Upper East, Upper West, North East and Savanna Regions;

ii. Connect additional 400 towns under the SHEP-4, SHEP-5, and Turnkey Projects;

iii. Undertake Turnkey Electrification Projects under SHEP-4 in Ashanti, Eastern, Western, Volta, Bono, and Ahafo regions;

iv. Continue the supply and installation of streetlights across the nation; and

v. Committed to the introduction of the Private Sector Participation in the Electricity distribution Sector.

Renewable Energy Development under Green Energy Transition

The Ministry intends to undertake the following under renewable and alternative energy development in 2026:

i. Complete procurement for the supply and installation of 10,000 smart solar streetlights;

ii. Achieve 70 per cent construction progress of 35 SREP Mini grids;

iii. Award contract for the construction of additional 26 mini grids in the Afram Plains;

iv. Complete installation of 2,450 solar streetlights in Ashanti Region;

v. Complete installation of 23,500 solar streetlights;

vi. Commence construction of three-storey (at least 100-seater) Green Building office block annex at MoEn> and

vii. Procurement of 10,000 units of solar rechargeable lanterns and pico systems.

Nuclear Power

The Ministry shall undertake the following in 2026 under their Nuclear Power programmes:

i. Engage with NuScale Power LLC and Regnum Technology Group (RTG) for construction of NuScale VOYGR-12 SMR Nuclear Power

Plant and establishment of industrial enclave as off-takers;

ii. Implement the Framework Agreement between NPG and CNOS of China for the construction of an HPR1000 large-reactor Nuclear Power Plant under a BOOT arrangement;

iii. Commence engagement with GIADEC and Madison Alumina to explore nuclear energy; and

iv. Complete the Bill for the establishment of an Owner-Operator Company, paving the way for its submission to Parliament for consideration and passage into law.

Petroleum Sub-Sector Development

Upstream activities

The Ministry plans to undertake the following upstream during 2026:

i. Facilitate the signing of new Petroleum Agreements;

ii. Increase annual volume of oil production in Jubilee and Greater Jubilee by 27.19 MM;

iii. Increase TEN gas export by 90.88 Bcf; and

iv. Implement Gas Master Plan, evaluate Gas infrastructure and develop LNG infrastructure and fertiliser.

Downstream activities

The Ministry plans to undertake the following activities in the petroleum downstream in 2026:

i. Distribute 457,000 LPG stoves and accessories to households, caterers and schools;

2026 Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry

The sum of three billion, nine hundred and thirty-eight million, five hundred and forty-two thousand, five hundred and forty-five Ghana cedis (GH₵3,938,542,545) has been allocated to the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition for its activities in the 2026 Financial Year. The details are shown in Table 2.

Table 3: Details of the 2026 Annual Budget Estimates of Ministry of Energy and Green Transition

ITEM	HEADQUATERS	PETROLEUM HUB	NUCLEAR POWER GHANA LTD	ENERGY COMMISSION	PETROLEUM COMMISSION	NATIONAL PETROLEUM AUTHORITY
GOG						
Compensation	17,183,960.00	988,665.00	-	-	-	-
Goods and Service	48,671,646.00	5,600,000.00	2,900,000.00	-	-	-
CAPEX	2,020,000,000.00	1,295,000.00	300,000.00	-	-	-
Donor						
Good and Services	144,327,300.00	-	-			
Capex	579,600,000.00	-	-			
IGF						
Compensation	645,510,525.00			71,463,522	114,204,285	459,842,718
Goods and Services	266,512,766.00			61,456,913	60,986,254	144,069,599
Capex	216,736,348.00			25,141,465	27,879,427	163,715,456
Total	**3,938,542,545**	**7,883,665**	**3,200,000**	**158,061,900**	**203,069,966**	**767,627,773**

Observations

The Committee made the following observations during the deliberations:

Rural Electrification Needs Urgent Acceleration

The Committee is concerned that despite ambitious national electrification objectives, delays in procurement, contractor mobilisation, and meter/transformer supply continue to slow progress. This affects service delivery, constituency expectations, and national energy access planning. The Committee notes the Ministry's improved readiness for 2026 but stresses the need for tighter project management.

Decline in Compensation Allocation of Petroleum Hub Development Corporation (PHDC)

The Committee noted a significant reduction in the compensation allocation for the Petroleum Hub Development Corporation (PHDC), which declined from GH₵1,758,706.28 in 2025 to GH₵7,883,665.00 for the 2026 fiscal year.

The Corporation explained that the decrease is primarily attributable to the fact that a substantial number of its personnel are seconded from other public institutions. Consequently, the compensation burden on the PHDC's budget has reduced, reflecting the lower requirement for directly funded staff remuneration.

Concerns over Inadequate Budget Releases

The Committee expressed concern regarding the level of releases to the various agencies, particularly in light of the consistent increases in their approved budget allocations. Despite these upward adjustments, the actual disbursement of funds continues to pose a significant challenge for many of the agencies. The Committee emphasised that the persistent gap between approved budgetary provisions and actual releases hampers effective planning and undermines the ability of the agencies to execute their mandated programmes and activities.

Concerns Over Internally Generated Funds (IGF) Retention Levels

The Committee also expressed its displeasure with the current retention percentages of Internally Generated Funds (IGF) allotted to the various agencies. It was observed that a larger percentage of the internally generated funds are not released to the agencies who worked hard to generate these funds.

The Committee underscored the need for a comprehensive review of these retention levels, noting that several of the agencies perform critical statutory and operational functions that require predictable and adequate resource flows. It was emphasised that allowing such agencies to retain a sufficient proportion of their IGF is essential to ensuring operational continuity, enhancing service delivery, and reducing over-reliance on central budgetary releases.

The Committee therefore recommends an increase in retained Internally Generated Funds (IGF) for the National Petroleum Authority (NPA) to enhance its operational capacity, specifically in the areas of Goods and Services and Capital Expenditure (CAPEX). Additionally, the Committee advises an upward adjustment in the allocation for the NPA to strengthen its activities specifically for managing the Data Centre under Goods and Services, ensuring the effective execution of its mandate.

Urgent Action Needed to Address Upstream Decline

The Committee observed, consistent with the position advanced by Africa Center for Energy Policy (ACEP), that the persistent decline in upstream petroleum production poses a significant risk to national revenue stability. In light of this, the Committee underscores the urgent need for Government to:

- revoke dormant or non-performing upstream licences to free and re-award same to exploration companies who are ready to do business in the country;
- implement targeted incentives to stimulate new exploration activities; and
- expedite ongoing development initiatives, particularly within the Voltaian Basin, to enhance long-term production prospects.

Civil Society Organisation (CSO) Input

ACEP provided an independent technical and policy analysis of the sector. The Committee highlights below the key issues from their intervention:

Significant Improvement in Sector Revenue Transparency

ACEP acknowledged the Ministry's progress in improving visibility within the Cash Waterfall Mechanism. ECG previously retained substantial collections before settlement, but reforms have resulted in ECG remitting significantly more into the waterfall mechanism, causing monthly remittances to rise from GH₵800 million to over GH₵1.6 billion.

The Committee recognises this improvement as an extremely important milestone in ensuring liquidity for natural gas producers, power generators, and bulk transmission service providers.

Renegotiation of Costly Power Purchase Agreements (PPAs)

ACEP applauded the substantial progress made in renegotiating legacy PPAs, noting that government has secured over US$200 million in savings to date.

The Committee concurs with ACEP's analysis that improving the fiscal sustainability of the power sector is an essential condition for ensuring long-term tariff stability, debt reduction, and efficient sector investment.

Persistent Decline in Upstream Petroleum Output

ACEP expressed deep concern that Ghana's crude oil production has been declining year-on-year for more than six years. They attributed part of the problem to non-performing contractors who continue to hold exploration blocks without undertaking any meaningful work.

The Committee shares this concern and calls on the Ministry to reclaim dormant blocks, enforce minimum work obligations, and invite credible operators into the upstream sector.

Concerns about Financing the Second Gas Processing Plant

ACEP noted that although the project is strategically important, no clear financing arrangement has been communicated publicly. ACEP warned that without a transparent and robust financing model, the project risks delays, cost overruns, or fiscal indiscipline.

The Committee therefore expects the Ministry to present a financing strategy detailing:

- whether the project will be funded through borrowing, PPP arrangements, sovereign guarantees, or petroleum funds;
- the expected return on investment; and
- governance and operational accountability structures.

Potential Risks in Relaxing Rules under the Petroleum Revenue Management Act

ACEP analysed proposals to allow petroleum funds to be invested in domestic commercial ventures, including energy infrastructure. While some arguments appear fiscally sound, ACEP insists on strong governance and oversight mechanisms to prevent mismanagement and political capture.

Evaluation of the Proposed 1,200MW Government Power Plant

ACEP cautioned that Government-run power plants historically underperform due to political influence, inefficient management, and poor cost recovery. They advised structuring the new plant through an independent corporate vehicle that adheres to commercial principles.

The Committee acknowledges this advice and intends to request stronger governance guidelines should the project proceed.

Renewable Energy Targets and Mini-Grids

ACEP encouraged the Ministry to accelerate renewables integration and strengthen mini-grid deployment to reach unserved communities, especially islands and remote localities.

The Committee recognises the importance of this and urges the Ministry to revise renewable targets upward.

Conclusion and Recommendation

After a comprehensive review of the Annual Budget Estimates of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition and its agencies for the 2026 financial year, the Committee observed that the budget allocations to the Ministry are well-justified.

In this regard, the Committee recommends to the House to adopt this Report and approve the sum of three billion, nine hundred and thirty-eight million, five hundred and forty-two thousand, five hundred and forty-five Ghana cedis (GH₵3,938,542,545) for the activities of the Ministry of Energy for the 2026 Financial Year.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Energy for the sum of GH₵3,938,542,545.00 on the allocation of the services of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition for the year ending 31st December 2026.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 22. I will move the Motion on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee and then the Minister of State for Government Communications will second the Motion.

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNMENT MACHINERY

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga) *on behalf of* **the Chairperson of the Committee:** Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Public Administration and State Interest on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,454,348,978.00 for the services of the Office of the Government Machinery for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Speaker, in moving the Motion, I wish to present the Report of the Committee and ask that the *Hansard* captures the Report as having been fully read in this House.

Introduction

Following the presentation of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government by the Minister for Finance, Hon Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, for the year ending 31st December, 2026 on 13th November, 2025, the 2026 Budgetary Estimates for the Office of Government Machinery (OGM) was laid in the House and referred to the Committee on Public Administration and State Interest for consideration and report in accordance with Article 179 of the Constitution and the Standing Orders of the House.

The Committee met with the Deputy Chief of Staff, Nana Oye Bampoe Addo, the Chief Director of the Office of Government Machinery, Singbonwura Dr Wayo Abubakari, and a team of officials from the Office of Government Machinery and the Ministry of Finance, to consider the referral. The Committee appreciates their immense contributions.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents in its deliberations:

- The 1992 Constitution;
- The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);
- The Standing Orders of Parliament; and
- The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.

Background

Government Machinery embraces the constitutional view of the Office of the President as the Seat of Government, those Organisations whose operations fall outside traditional areas of sectoral responsibilities, for which the Office of the President (Core Government Machinery) exists to provide administrative, managerial and technical services.

The Office of Government Machinery comprises:

1. Office of the President
2. Sahelian and Accra Initiatives
3. National Centre for Early Warning and Response Mechanism
4. The Black Star Experience
5. The 24-Hour Economy Secretariat
6. IMCC on Decentralisation Secretariat
7. Millennium Development Authority
8. Public Sector Reform
9. Public Enterprises
10. Council of State
11. Office of the Chief of State Protocol
12. Inner City and Zongo Development
13. Zongo Development Fund
14. Ghana Investment Promotion Centre
15. National Population Council
16. Microfinance and Small Loans Centre (MASLOC)
17. Office of the Administrator-General
18. Ghana AIDS Commission
19. Ghana Broadcasting Corporation (GBC)
20. Ghana News Agency (GNA)
21. Information Services Department
22. Northern Development Authority
23. Scholarship Secretariat

Goals and Objectives

The Office of Government Machinery exists to institutionalise open, transparent and accountable governance for the attainment of government's development agenda of improving the quality of life of Ghanaians. The Office of Government Machinery's policy objectives, among others, include:

a) Improving the balance among arms of government, governance institutions and their functions;

b) Ensuring inclusive and equitable political system;

c) Ensuring effective implementation of the decentralisation policy and programme;

d) Ensuring efficient and effective resource mobilisation, internal revenue generation and resource management;

e) Strengthening policy and development planning processes for equitable and balanced spatial and economic development;

f) Rationalising and defining structures, roles and procedures for state institutions;

g) Enhancing supervision and productivity in the public service;

h) Improving the responsiveness of the public service in service delivery; and

i) Mainstreaming development communication across the public-sector policy cycle.

2025 Performance

The under-listed were some of the activities undertaken by the Agencies under the Office of Government Machinery during the year under review:

Office of the President

For the year 2025, the Office of the President undertook the following:

- Organised the Ghana 68th Independence Anniversary Celebration at the forecourt of the Jubilee House and also hosted the 2025 Republic Day Anniversary.

- Undertook maintenance of the Jubilee House, the Osu Castle, Peduase Lodge, etc.

- Hosted Thirty-One (31) Heads of States and other foreign senior government officials.

- received seventeen (17) Letters of Credence to His Excellency the President of the Republic by incoming Ambassadors and High Commissioners. The envoys sessions included Italy, Cuba, Liberia, United Arab Emirates, Iran, Vietnam, Republic of Greece, Jamaica, Tunisia, Burundi and others.

- Produced Ninety-Six (96) Cabinet memos.

- Produced Seventy-Two (72) Cabinet decisions and reports and same were sent to Parliament as at September 2025.

- Organised training and Staff Development programmes for the staff of the office of the President.

- established and operationalized the Inter-Sectoral Implementation Committee (ISIC).

24-Hour Economy Secretariat

For the year 2025, the Commission, among others, undertook the following:

- Delivered the full 24-Hour Programme to the President and launched it nationally, completing the policy, strategy, and operational design work.

- Activated the Secretariat's full delivery architecture — PMU, PMC, sub-programme teams, land and mapping unit, climate desk, investor facilitation desk, and communications unit. The Draft law for the Authority has been gazetted and is ready to be presented to Parliament by the Attorney-General.

- Agreed the 24-Hour Incentives Framework with the Ministry of Finance, pending approval and rollout to support enterprise, manufacturing, and export competitiveness.

- Established the Presidential Advisory Committee on Accelerated Export Development (PCAED) with 19 senior leaders from industry, Cabinet, and trade-facilitation agencies to advise on export policy and the 24-hour economic transition.

- Established a comprehensive pipeline of projects to deliver the 1.7 million jobs by the end of 2028.

- Completed 59 Project Concept Notes Twenty-five (25) of the Concept Notes have been scoped and structured.

- Updated the Existing feasibility studies (Volta Lake Transport, Northern Cargo Handling & Transport, Wungu Pipeline Farm Project, Pwalugu Irrigation Scheme, Tamaligu Irrigation Scheme, Vogu Irrigation Scheme, Bogdoo Irrigation Scheme).

- Pre-Feasibility for Legon Pharmaceutical Innovation Park, Kumasi Machinery and Technology Park, and the Northshore Light Industrial Park, starting in December 2025. There is £200,000 GBP 200K committed by FCDO for pre-feasibility studies.

- Established a coherent funding architecture to support businesses in the 24-Hour programme.

- Incorporated climate finance into the programme a major cultural heritage initiative.

- Integrated the Volta Economic Corridor into Ghana's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC Revision 3.0) as the country's first Net Zero Green Economic Corridor, with a draft Climate Execution Framework completed and engagements underway with the Green Climate Fund (GCF), AfDB Climate Unit, and the Adaptation Fund to secure readiness and project financing.

- Engaged VRA and the Ministry of Transport to actualise the cabinet decision of 10th July 2025 (Volta River System Basin Economic Corridor – A National Economic Corridor for Multimodal Transport, Agro-Industrial Transformation and Cross-Border Trade).

- Positioned the Kwame Nkrumah legacy as a strategic creative-economy value chain, concluding negotiations to clean, restore, and digitise over 300 hours of historic Nkrumah-era film archives that have been at risk for decades and hidden from the world, thereby creating a path for Ghana to reclaim, curate, license, and commercialise this national asset at minimal cost to the State.

State Protocol Department

For the year under review, the Department undertook the following:

- facilitated thirty-one visits by Head of States.

- facilitated the presentation of twenty-seven (27) letters of credence by High Commissioners and Ambassadors to H.E. the President of the Republic.

- thirty-one (31) internal working visits undertaken by the President, and twenty-one (21) external working visits.

- facilitated eleven (11) farewell courtesy calls events for the outgoing Ambassadors.

- facilitated seventeen (17) Swearing-in ceremonies.

- assisted various MDAs and MMDAs in organising forty-two (42) of MDAs events

- trained Forty-five (45) Staff members in various forms.

- The Department also assisted in organising eleven (11) State Funerals and State Assisted Funerals.

- National Population Council (NPC)

- For the period under review, the Council undertook the following:

- Commemorated the 2025 World Population Day and instituted the Media Awards with deserving journalists awarded.

- Led the Country delegation to the 58th Session of the United Nations

Conference on Population & Development (CPD) in New York.

- Participated in Partners in Population & Development (South-South) Board meeting and conferences to reaffirm Ghana's commitment to global population and sustainable development frameworks in Malawi.

- Led the country delegation to participation in the 16th meeting of the Network of African Parliamentary Committee on Health (NEAPACOH) held in Dares Salaam, Tanzania.

- Held engagement with National Council for Curriculum and Assessment (NaCCA) for the approval of the Reproductive Health Education (RHE) Guidelines.

- Held Community Engagement on Gender-based Violence, Harmful Cultural Practices, Family Planning, Teenage Pregnancy and HIV Prevention at the Oguaa Fetu Afahye.

- Paid Courtesy calls on key partners to strengthen partnership.

- Undertook Advocacy programmes in Population & Development at the regional level.

- Engaged inmates at the Senior Correctional Center to promote reproductive health education.

- Was the Implementing partner on UNFPA 8th Country Programme.

Millennium Development Authority

For the period under review, the Authority undertook the following:

- Commenced the cropping of rice on 80 hectares of land leased by ASA Foods at the Kpong Left Bank, and engaged 40 Youth In-Grower Farmers.

- Linked Out-grower farmers to anchor farmer – New Age cropped a total of 3,771.82 hectares and Akuafo Nketewa cropped 1000 hectares.

- Supplied seeds, fertilizer, and crop protection chemicals to 290 in-grower farmers (215 with Argo Kings, 40 with ASA Foods and 35 with African Agribusiness Consortium) to cultivate 490 hectares of rice.

- Supported 2000 out-grower youth farmers of Akufo-Nketewa and 2,240 out-grower youth farmers of New Age with inputs through a cost-sharing collaboration (MiDA 35 per cent, New Age 65 per cent).

- Provided training in good agronomic practices and Agribusiness/Entrepreneurship to 203 youth, including farmers and field officers from ASA Foods, Agrokins, African Agribusiness Consortium and Akuafo Nketewa.

Office of the Administrator-General

For the period under review, the Office undertook the following:

- Implementation of Post-Presidential Transition Activities and Programme;

- Submitted the original copies of the 2024 Handing-Over Notes to the President-elect, Parliament, Chief Justice, The Council of State and the Public Records and Archives Administration Department (PRAAD);

- Completed the Storage of a set of the 2024 Handing-over Notes in the office's documentation centre;

- Reviewed inventory of assets and properties supplied to the Executive, Ministers and Presidential staffers;

- Reviewed the official data on other Official Assets assigned to erstwhile Executives;

- Collaborated with relevant stakeholders to reoccupy official residences allocated to former office holders;

- Organised capacity building programmes for MDAs, RCCs, MMDAs and Independent Constitutional Bodies. The Office has developed a schedule for the capacity building programmes;

- Improved existing records/database for policy formulation on assets management acquisition and disposal;

- Promoted transparency and accountability in the management of official assets of the executives;

- Commenced the Implementation of the Ghana Official Assets Repository Programme (GOARP) by constituting the Technical Committee and initiated procurement processes to engage the Programme Consultant;

- Undertook sensitisation programmes to educate the public on the ethical use and maintenance of state assets;

- Undertook in-house training on performance management for all staff;

- Conducted demonstration workshop with support from the National Information Technology Agency (NITA) on Smart Workplace platform for key staff;

- Development of a revised AG Scheme of Service: AG has drafted the first revised scheme of service for the Office of the Administrator-General (DAG). This updated draft outlines new guidelines, roles, and responsibilities, ensuring that the scheme aligns with current organisational needs and regulatory requirements. The draft is now under review, with the goal of enhancing operational efficiency and providing clear career progression paths for staff within the office;

- Organised a training session on Policy and Legal Framework for Effective Records Management with assistance from PRAAD; and

- Conducted a session for staff on Understanding the Role and Functions of the Records Office with assistance from PRAAD.

Office of the Special Envoy to the Alliance of Sahelian States (AES)

For the year 2025, the Office undertook the following:

- Obtained permission to use the Kpone Unity Terminal as a dedicated terminal for use by the Alliance of Sahelian States (AES) for smooth clearance of imports;

- Facilitated the safe transit with support from the Ghana Armed Forces for the movement of envoys, logistics and other equipment of the AES;

- Facilitate the intake of AES students into Ghana's military training institutions;

- Facilitated the commencement of direct flights, Accra-Ouagadougou-Accra by African World Airlines;

- Signed MoU between Ghana and Burkina Faso on power supply to Burkina Faso;

- Held engagement with the Accra Initiative Member States on the way forward for a new regional counter-terrorism mechanism. (Sahel-Gulf of Guinea States Counter Terrorism Initiative – work in progress); and

- Organised and co-hosted first high-level security dialogue between the AU and the AES.

IMCC on Decentralisation

For the period under review, the office undertook the following:

- Drafted the National Decentralisation Policy and Strategy (NDPS) 2026–2030;

- Held four zonal subnational stakeholder consultation;

- Held one national stakeholder consultation;

- Held one Development Partners engagement on the NDPS 2026-2030;

- Established Legislative Review Committee (LRC) and organised eight (8) meetings;

- Organised (3) Decentralisation Sector Working Group (DSWG) Meetings;

- Paid a working visit to Development Partners and Ministries, Departments & Agencies (MDAs);

- Held a National Dialogue on Decentralisation and Responsive Governance;

- Held an IMCC Technical Committee /IMCC meeting;

- Facilitated high-level Policy Dialogue on Decentralised Budget Support (SECO / GoG);

- Facilitated commemoration of AU Day on Decentralisation; and

- Held a public sensitisation on local governance and decentralisation reforms.

Public Enterprise Secretariat

For the year under review, the Public enterprise Secretariat:

- Held a gender policy sensitisation programme for specified entities to ensure harmonisation following the passage of the Affirmative Action (Gender Equity) Act, 2024 (Act 1121);

- presented advisory papers on the management of the following portfolios;

- Bonsa Tyres Factory

- Northern Star Tomato Factory, Pwalugu

- Daily Graphic and New Times Corporation

- Organised two (2) training programmes in upscaling skills in Digital Technologies, Artificial Intelligence and its applications for selected entities;

- Developed a concept paper for the roll out of a national waste segregation campaign; and

- Developed a Client Service Charter which outlines the standards and expectations for service delivery to stakeholders and the public, to support its implementation, a validation workshop will be organised to sensitise stakeholders. A Client Service Unit has been established to ensure responsive and professional engagement with all clients.

Public Sector Reform Secretariat

For the period under review, the Secretariat undertook the following:

- Led strategic engagements with key public sector organisations (PSC, NIA, BDR, GNPC, Exim Bank, CHRAJ, GRA, SSNIT, IMCCODS) to identify collaboration opportunities and strengthen institutional performance;

- Provided high-level coordination by chairing the OGP National Steering

Committee, NPSRS II Technical Committee, and the Comprehensive Gender Strategy Technical Coordinating Group, offering strategic guidance to advance reform initiatives;

- Took steps to finalise the draft National Public Sector Reform Strategy (NPSRS II) by constituting a Technical Committee with representatives from 22 key Public Service Organisations;

- Inaugurated on 11th June 2025, adopted its Terms of Reference, and reviewed the draft Strategy and lessons from NPSRS 2018–2023;

- Held Five (5) Technical Committee working sessions and multiple bilateral engagements with major Public Service Organisations to gather inputs; and

- Conducted a virtual multi-stakeholder consultation session to present the status of the NPSRS II and solicit their inputs on the proposed programmes and activities in the draft NPSRS II.

Ghana Investment Promotion Centre (GIPC)

For the period under review, the Centre undertook the following:

- Recorded a total investment valued at US$651.72million with the Foreign Direct Investment amounting to US$617.61million;

- Registered forty-six (46) wholly Ghanaian-owned projects with an estimated investments of US$256.54 million;

- Won the award of Best Investment Promotion Agency;

- Encouraged local businesses to access the services of the Centre through the Grow in Ghana, Grow with Ghana initiative;

- Increased its online visibility through social media and other online services;

- Set up an online application system to reduce physical contact with investors; and

- Commenced the review of the GIPC Act, 2013 (Act 865)

Zongo Development Fund

For the period under review, the Zongo Development Fund undertook the following:

- Upgraded the Ansarudeen Islamic Basic School Complex (National Chief Imam's School) at New Fadama;

- Constructed astro turf at Dunkwa-on-Offin for community sports and social activities;

- Participated in the campaign against the use of illicit drugs (opioids) by the youth in zongo communities in collaboration with the Ministry of Interior and other stakeholders;

- Constructed three (3) community mechanised water system at Oyibi, Amanfrom and Adjin Kotoku in the Greater Accra Region for the promotion of clean water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) in Zongo communities;

- Collaborated with the Hausa Youth Ghana in the organisation of lectures and grand durbar in commemoration of the International Hausa Day for the promotion of culture, tourism and tradition;

- Collaborated with Real Emirate Football Club for a gala competition aimed at unearthing talents, creating opportunities and providing avenue for recreation, entertainment and potential professionalism amongst Zongo youth. In all 26 zongo communities participated;

- Collaborated with the Zongo communities towards the 2025 inter-tribal soccer competition aimed at creating social cohesion, harmony, peace and development; and

- Engaged MMDAs to streamline the collection of IGF and maintenance of infrastructure projects in their jurisdiction

Microfinance and Small Loans Centre (MASLOC)

For the period under review, the Centre undertook the following:

- Distributed 381 Leg Sewing Machines amounting to GH₵91,381.00 and 315 Hair Dryers amounting to GH₵67,895.00;

- Distributed 25 tricycles amounting to GH₵356,521 over the reporting period;

- Recovered a total of GH₵9,835,143.85 during the period under review; and

- Undertook monitoring and follow-ups of 3,297 micro credit, 230 small loans and 107 special project clients during the period under review.

Scholarship Secretariat

For the period under review, the Secretariat undertook the following:

- disbursed disability grants to a total of Five Hundred and Sixteen (516) students at a cost of One Million, Six Hundred and Seven Thousand, Three hundred and forty-seven Ghana cedis (GH₵1, 607,347.00)

- disbursed funds for the payment of Thesis and Bursaries for six thousand, six hundred and forty-nine (6,649) postgraduate students from sixteen (16) public tertiary institutions across the country at a cost of three million, one hundred and seventy-two thousand, one hundred and seventy-one Ghana cedis and twenty-five pesewas (GH₵3,172,171.25) for the 2024/2025 academic year;

- expended one hundred and fifty-two million, seven hundred and sixty-seven thousand and twenty-nine Ghana cedis and ninety-sixty pesewas (152,767,029.96) on the foreign tertiary programme;

- Made part payment of an amount of one hundred and fifty-two million, seven hundred and sixty-seven thousand, twenty-nine cedis and ninety-six pesewas (152,767,029.96) for outstanding 2024/2025 stipends, as well as book and medical allowance owned to students under the Bilateral and Non-Bilateral Scholarship programme in various countries, namely Morocco, Algeria, Russia, China, Hungry United Kingdom, the United States, Cuba, and Serbia, among others

- Awarded scholarship to eight hundred and thirty-five (835) students from various universities and colleges of education to participate in the Year Abroad language proficiency programme for the 2024/2025 academic year in Togo, Benin, Tanzania, China and Russia.

Northern Development Fund

For the period under review, the Fund undertook the following:

- Distributed 46 tricycles to some selected youth and women to manage post-harvest losses;

- Held engagements with all the five (5) Regional Ministers within the Northern Development Authority Zone, Major Chiefs, Development Partner and the private sector towards the implementation of a coordination framework;

- organised a Shea Expo 2025 in collaboration with GEPA, PIAA (Presidency) Savannah Golden Tree and others;

- Organized the third (3rd) Northern Trade, Industry and Investment Summit in collaboration with Centre for Policy Development (CPD);

- Collaborated with the Forestry Commission to plant 500 seedlings in selected public institutions and water bodies;

- Supported the organisation of the first Northern Ghana Development Conference by Northern Members of Parliament; and

- Implemented the Clean Water Project in Tamale in collaboration with Clean Commodities Exchange (CCE), Ghana Sankofa Empowerment Outreach, and UDS.

Black Star Experience

During the year under review, the Secretariat undertook the following:

- Participated in Black Star Week following the signing of an MOU with DDM Group, the largest Black-owned media conglomerate in the United States;

- Held meetings with the National Arts Council of South Africa to explore bilateral cultural and creative sector collaboration;

- Participated in the Amapiano Summit held in June 2025 in South Africa;

- Paid a courtesy call on the new South African High Commissioner, H. E. Benjamin Quashie, with GHANAFEST organisers to discuss expanding the festival and introducing a complementary event, the Ghana Arts Week—a broader platform for Ghana's full creative ecosystem;

- Co-created with AfCFTA Secretariat and the Ministry of Trade Agribusiness & Industry; and

- Conducted regional stakeholder roadshows in Nairobi, Tamale, Kumasi, Lagos, scheduled for 31st October, 2025.

Zongo Development Fund

For the period under review, the Fund undertook the following:

- Upgraded the Ansarudeen Islamic basic school complex (National Chief Imam's School) at New Fadama

- Constructed an astro turf at Dunkwa-on-offin for community sports and social activities

- participated in the campaign against the use of illicit drugs (opioids) by the youth in zongo communities in collaboration with the Ministry of Interior and other stakeholders

- Constructed three (3) community mechanized water system at oyibi, amanfrom and Adjin Kotoku in the Greater Accra Region for the promotion of clean water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) in Zongo communities.

- Collaborated with the Hausa Youth Ghana in the organization of lectures and grand durbar in commemoration of the international Hausa day for the promotion of culture, tourism and tradition.

- Engaged with Real Emirate Football Club for a gala competition aimed at unearthing talents, creating opportunities and providing avenue for recreation, entertainment and potential professionalism amongst Zongo youth. In all 26 No zongo communities participated.

- collaborated with the Zongo communities towards the 2025 inter-tribal soccer competition aimed at creating social cohesion, harmony, peace and development.

- Engaged with MMDAs to streamline the collection of IGF and the maintenance of infrastructure projects in their jurisdiction.

Inner City and Zongo Development Secretariat

For the period under review, the Secretariat undertook the following:

- trained 5000 Arabic Instructors and developed nationwide pending payment of stipends

- Collaborated with the Scholarship Secretariat to provide scholarship for 218 needy but brilliant students across various Zongo communities.

- Organised health outreach programmes for 45 beneficiaries in Zongo and Inner-city Communities.

- Supplied relief food items to 500 households in poor Zongo communities

- Constructed boreholes in selected Zongo communities

- Held meeting with opinion leaders to promote peace, harmony and religious dialogue amongst the Zongo and Inner-City Communities

2025 Expenditure Performance Outturn

For the implementation of the various programmes and activities, a total amount of one billion, one hundred and twenty-six million, four hundred and fourteen thousand, and nine Ghana cedis (GH₵1,126,414,009.00) was the budget for the Office of Government Machinery for the 2025 financial year. Out of this amount, only GH₵ 769,072,129.13 was released leaving a variance of GH₵357,341,879.87. The breakdown is shown in Table 1:

Table 1: OGM Budget Outturn for 2025

Item	Budgeted (GH₵) [A]	Releases (GH₵) [B]	Actuals (GH₵) [C]	Variance(GH₵) D=[A-B]	Variance(GH₵) E=[B-C]
Employee Compensation	379,531,179	311,957,965.72	300,713,244.34	67,573,213.28	11,244,721.38
Goods and Services	566,374,141	290,732,165.79	217,076,616.80	275,641,975.21	73,655,548.99
CAPEX	180,508,689	166,381,997.62	66,381,997.62	14,126,691.38	100,000,000.00
Total	1,126,414,009	769,072,129.13	584,171,858.76	357,341,879.87	184,900,270.37

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Outlook for 2026

Office of the President and its Agencies

For the year 2026, the Office of the President and its Agencies will implement a number of activities as follows:

The Ghana AIDS Commission will:

- Develop a new National Strategic Plan 2026 – 2030 and human right strategic plan
- Develop and submit a Cabinet Memo on the National Workplace HIV and Wellness policy
- Develop Corporate Strategy and Operational Plan
- Implement Human Right and Youth HIV Strategies
- Coordinate NACAP and Resource mobilisation activities
- Complete the development of the National HIV Response Sustainability Roadmap
- Engage MDAs, MMDAs, PLHIV Associations.
- Organise the annual Partners Forum & Business Meeting

The Public Sector Reform Secretariat will:

- Finalise and launch the National Public Sector Reform Strategy II
- Sensitize the public sector organisations on the National Public Sector Reform Strategy II for effective implementation.
- Institute a beneficiary feedback mechanism on public sector reforms
- Coordinate the implementation of the National Public Sector Reform Strategy II.
- Coordinate the implementation of the Comprehensive Gender Strategy for the public sector.
- Finalise the One-Stop-Shop Strategic Framework on service delivery Implementation of Open Government Partnership (OGP)
- Undertake a Mid-term review of the 5th Open Government Partnership National Action Plan
- Continue to coordinate the implementation of the 5th Open Government Partnership National Action Plan
- Organise Monitoring and Feedback Sessions with Implementing Agencies
- Print and disseminate copies of the revised OGP 5th National Action Plan

- Participate in international and regional OGP events.
- Organise awareness creation events (media engagements)

The National Population Council will:

- Review the NPC Strategic Plan (2017-2024).
- Commemorate 2026 World Population.
- Organise the 2026 Population Media Awards
- Review the 2015 Population Integration Modules.
- Coordinate Quarterly Meeting of partners on Adolescent SRHR Policy implementation and advocacy.
- Organize national demographic dividend policy dialogue to advocate for increased investments in youth skills, education and sexual and health and rights.
- Organise high-level advocacy meeting to advocate for funding for FD commodities.
- Develop and produce three high-impact advocacy tools on key population and development issues to inform policy dialogue and stakeholder engagement.
- Review the ENGAGE documentary, RAPID 2017 and the NewGEN, investing in young people document.
- Undertake community engagement activities with the aged-population to enhance their welfare.
- Organise one-day seminar on the role of young male adolescents in female's family planning choices in the central region.
- Strengthen advocacy on gender-based violence, harmful cultural practices, family planning, teenage pregnancy and HIV prevention through community durbar in all NPC 10 regional offices.
- Attend the 59th UNCPD Conference in New York.
- The State Protocol Department will
- Host nine (9) State visits
- Receive sixteen (16) Letters Credence expected from Ambassadors and High Commissioners.
- Facilitate ten (10) External visits and fifteen (15) Internal visits to be undertaken by H.E. the President of the Republic
- Assist in the organisations of State anniversaries and commemoration of national events such as

Independence Anniversary and others.

- Arrange six (6) farewell calls for outgoing Ambassadors and High Commissioners

- Organise capacity building workshops and training for thirty-five (35) staff of State Protocol Department to enhance their performance

- Facilitate the organisation of five (5) State and State assisted funerals

- Assist to organise six (6) swearing-in ceremonies

- Assist various MDAs and MMDAs to organize about twenty (20) events.

The Ghana Investment Promotion Council will

- Collaborate with the Ghana Export Promotion Authority to attract investment into priority areas identified in the Export Development Plan

- Collaborate with other investment promotion and implementation agencies to identify and profile specific opportunities for promotion.

- Step up leads with prospective investors through the integrated iron and steel industry along the entire iron and steel value chain.

- Register foreign and local investments

- Digitalise the Centre's processes, procedures and workflow to ensure efficiency.

- Undertake regional sensitisation and monitoring programmes

- Organise in-country investor outreach programmes

- Resource and support the Centre's newly created 24-Hour Economy Desk.

- Review, process and register submitted Technology Transfer Agreements (TTAs) applications.

- Undertake the "Ghana is Open for Business Again" Campaign initiative to promote and attract investments into the country.

The Public Enterprise Secretariat will:

- Organise training in team building as a key component for efficient cooperation.

- Organise training in Rural Enterprises Development for selected entities in rural communities

- Collaborate with stakeholders to organise selected training programmes in export and marketing planning, risk management and feasibility studies

- Organise Policy and Governance Forum in collaboration with SIGA and stakeholders from academia, the private sector and MMDAs.

- Conduct research to ascertain empirical evidence on challenges facing specified entities.

- Undertake working visits to specified entities to ascertain firsthand information on challenges and operational issues for informed decision making

- Interact with the Committee on Public Administration and State Interest of Parliament to enhance scrutiny on specified entities

- Collaborate with SIGA in publication of the Public Enterprises League Table (PELT) and Awards Ceremony

- Organise Business Development forum for managers of specified entities

- Boost visibility of the Secretariat through regular media engagement

- Hold validation workshop and disseminate Secretariat's Client Service Charter to improve client relations

- The Northern Development Authority (NDA) will:

- Procure 715 tricycles under the youth and women in post-harvest losses, management Tricycle Facility Programme for the youth and women;

- Implement the NDA proposed Development Coordination Framework in line with Act 963, focusing on Stakeholder Mapping Exercise, and Formation of stakeholder working groups;

- Undertake monitoring and evaluation of ongoing projects in northern Ghana;

- Organise the fourth (4th) Northern Trade Industry and Investment Summit;

- Organise the 2026 World Shea Expo;

- Implement the Clean Water Project in Tamale and Sagnarigu Districts;

- Establish five Farm Mechanisation Training and Repair Hubs;

- undertake tree planting exercise with the Forestry Commission under the Tree for Life Initiative in selected institutions and water bodies – 5000 trees to be planted;

- Facilitate the development of land banks in support of the 24-hour Economy programme; and

- Renovate the Head Office building in Tamale.

The Council of State will:

- Facilitate the Council's quarterly meetings with H. E. the President;
- Organise weekly meetings;
- Organise monthly plenary sessions for the Council;
- Organise regional interactive sessions for four (4) Regional Representatives;
- Consider nominations for appointments by H. E. the President;
- Organize two (2) Outreach Programmes/ Regional working visits for the Council;
- Organise orientation for members of the Council;
- Organise capacity building programmes for staff;
- Undertake research into issues under consideration by the Council;
- Organise roundtable discussions between the Council and Ministers of State and heads of institutions, and
- Organise sensitisation exercises on the programmes and activities of the Council
- The Office of the Administrator-General will:
- Assist and train sixteen (16) Regional Coordinating Councils, 100 MDAs, 261 MMDAs and 13 Independent Constitutional Bodies in the production and upgrade of their official assets database;
- Improve the existing database/ record for policy formulation on official assets management, acquisition and disposal;
- Safeguard official assets and properties;
- Organise public sensitisation on ethical use and maintenance of executive assets;
- Prepare the national register of official assets; and
- Conduct stock taking exercise of all official assets.
- The Microfinance and Small Loans Centre (MASLOC) will:
- Expand its working capital to SME businesses and start-ups;
- Provide Rickshaw and motor bikes (Okada) with its accessories to the teeming youth on hire purchase for business
- Undertake frantic efforts to recover outstanding loans
- Monitor the Centre's credit to its clients (SMEs, Micro and Assets)
- The Inter Ministering Coordinating Committee on Decentralization will

- Finalise and disseminate National Decentralisation Policy and Strategy (NDPS) [2026-2030].
- Print Ten Thousand (10,000) copies of the NDPS 2026-2030
- Coordinate implementation of National Decentralisation Policy and Strategy (NDPS) [2026-2030].
- Conduct four Technical Committee meetings.
- Conduct Four IMCC meetings.
- Undertake National Dialogue on Decentralisation.
- Facilitate the devolution of the education sector.
- Facilitate the devolution of the health sector.
- Facilitate the devolution of the roads sector.
- Conduct nationwide stakeholder consultations on the draft Local Governance Finances Bill.
- Organise ten (10) meetings of the Legislative Review Committee to develop two Legislative Instruments (L.I.s)
- Organise retreats on Decentralisation for IMCC Ministers, Technical Committees, Decentralisation Focal Persons and other relevant stakeholders.
- Develop the [2026-2030] IGFF in line with NDPS [2026-2030].
- Facilitate sub-national PEFA in collaboration with key stakeholders
- Review, print and disseminate the National Framework for Popular Participation and Practitioners Manual.
- Conduct four study on decentralisation reforms.
- Capacity Development for staff of the IMCC Secretariat.
- Internal Management of the Secretariat.

The 24-Hour Economy will:

- Accelerate the 24H+ Programme, moving from planning to full-scale implementation across key sectors.
- Transition into a statutory Authority, strengthen institutional systems, and align all MDAs through Strategic Priority Initiatives (SPIs).
- Complete major project preparation for flagship initiatives including the Volta Economic Corridor, Wumbei Industrial Parks, Agbledu Agroecological Parks, Tamale Air Cargo Terminal, and the Yapei Inland Port–Volta Lake Transport System.

- Establish Special Purpose Vehicles under GIIF will be to mobilise domestic and international investment while launching investor roadshows to capitalise the 24H+ Sub-Fund.

- Expand enterprise financing through nationwide rollout of the Readiness Programme, operationalisation of the No-Collateral Credit Guarantee Facility, and deployment of SME and Equity Funds.

- Strengthen food security systems via the Warehouse Receipt System, the Food Security and Price Stabilisation Fund, and minimum price-support mechanisms.

- Scale up the Energy & Petroleum Readiness Programme nationwide, including 24-hour depot and retail operations, and feasibility studies for Volta Lake dredging and pipeline extensions.

- Implement the National Shea Strategy, revamping the Buipe Shea Factory and supporting women-led cooperatives across northern Ghana.

- Legislate key policy and legislative reforms to include the 24-Hour Incentives Regime, amendments to the Public Procurement Act, and a new competition law to promote fair markets.

- Expand institutional capacity through office accommodation upgrades, procurement of programme vehicles, and strengthened whole-of-government coordination systems.

- The Sahelian and Accra Initiatives Secretariat will:

- Continue to develop and coordinate the implementation of plans to enhance cooperation between Ghana and the AES countries across sectors;

- Train AES security personnel for the professional protection of mobility corridors, convoys and defensive positions;

- Continue AU/OSEAS co-hosted engagements with AES countries; and

- Develop and implement a counter-terrorism framework for regional; security, with particular focus on preventing a spillover of terrorism from the Sahel into the coastal states.

The Millennium Development will:

- Improve of New Enclave development in Kumawu and Oti/Banda Enclave

- Collaborate with GoG to consider the restoration of stipends and increase accommodation facilities to care for additional youths that has been trained in Youth In-Grower Production.

- The Inner City and Zongo Development Secretariat will:

- Procure new office equipment

- Mobilise donor support

- Project Monitoring and evaluation

- Undertake quarterly, mid-year and annual assessment of programme performance

- Train staff on the scheme of service and competency-based

- Compile data/information on the state of Inner-City communities

The Scholarship Secretariat will:

- Award scholarships to a total of Ten Thousand and Fifty-Six (10,056) students in various tertiary institutions across the country at a cost of Forty-seven million and twenty thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵47,020,000.00).

- Pay an amount of Three Million, Three Hundred and Fifty Thousand Ghana Cedis (GH₵3,350,000,000.00) for payment of thesis and bursaries for Seven Thousand (7000) students in public universities across the country.

- Pay an amount of One Hundred and Ninety-nine Million, Six Hundred and Thirty Thousand, and Forty-seven Ghana Cedis (GH₵199.630.047.00) for part payments of Tuition, monthly allowances, book and medical allowance of students under this category.

- Pay an amount of Forty Million, Eight Hundred and Seventy, and Forty-Eight and Eighty-eight pesewas (GH₵40,870,048.88) to pay for One Thousand, One Hundred and Thirty-Nine (1,139) students. This is anticipated to cover six months stipends, as well as one year's book and medical allowance.

- Pay an amount of One hundred and Twenty-five million, Five Hundred and Sixty-one Thousand, Three Hundred and forty-two Ghana Cedis, Fifty-six pesewas (GH₵ 125,561,342.56) for a total of One Thousand, Three Hundred and Seventy (1,370) non-bilateral students.

- **2026 Budgetary Estimates for the Office of Government Machinery**

- For the implementation of the various programmes and activities for 2026, an amount of one billion, four and fifty-two million, six hundred and ninety-three thousand, three hundred and eleven Ghana cedis (GH₵1,452,693,311.00) has been allocated to the Office of Government Machinery 2026 as shown in Table 2.

- **Table 2 – Summary of Estimates for 2026**

	Compensation of Employees	**Goods and Services**	**CAPEX**	**TOTAL GH₵**
GoG	540,965,872	749,741,049	70,000,000	1,360,706,921.00
IGF	21,372,933	59,534,298	11,079,159	91,986,390.00
Total	562,338,805	809,275,347	81,079,159	1,452,693,311.00

Allocations to the various Agencies under the Office of Government Machinery

Allocations to the Agencies under the Office of Government Machinery are attached in Table 3 below:

Table 3: Allocations to the Agencies under the Office of Government Machinery

NO	AGENCIES/COST CENTRE	GRAND TOTAL
1	Office of the President	737,461,985.00
2	Council of State	17,445,228.00
3	Office of the Chief of State Protocol	8,549,203.00
4	Ghana AIDS Commission	17,534,492.00
5	Scholarship Secretariat	256,746,338.00
6	Office of the Administrator-General	13,296,239.00
7	National Population Council	7,524,535.00
8	Ghana Investment Promotion Centre (GIPC)	59,269,979.00
9	Microfinance and Small Loans Centre (MASLOC)	26,860,400.00
10	Public Sector Reform	5,609,684.00
11	Inner City and Zongo Development	13,275,287.00
12	Northern Development Authority	14,310,000.00
13	Public Enterprise Secretariat	1,127,481.00
14	Ghana Broadcasting Corporation (GBC)	110,522,034.00
15	Information Services Department (ISD)	140,236174.00
16	Ghana News Agency (GNA)	22,924,253.00
	TOTAL	1,452,693,311.00

General Observations

The Committee made the following observations:

Black Star Experience

Inadequate funding for programmes

The Committee was informed that the rationale for establishing the Secretariat of the Black Star Experience was to make Ghana Africa’s foremost Cultural Capital. The aim was to elevate Ghana’s global image as a premier cultural destination, and through cultural driven tourism, events and creative industry make significant contribution to the country’s GDP.

Management informed the Committee that the Black Star Experience was to position the country not only as a hub of creativity but as a global cultural partner, capable of hosting world-class experience that resonate with both local and the diaspora.

To give effect to this, the Secretariat programmed several activities including fashion week events, music carnivals, City Jives, Chieftaincy Awards, Independence explosion, AfCFTA Creative Connect Conference, Ghanafest in South Africa, and Cultural heritage Support Programme. Unfortunately, the amount allocated for the Secretariat was not enough to enable the Secretariat undertake its programme of activities for 2026.

The Secretariat called upon Parliament to urge the Minister for Finance to allocate additional revenue to enable the Secretariat to undertake its activities for 2026

Construction of a national Theatre in Kumasi

The Committee observed that the Secretariat plans to construct a US$90million ultra-modern national theater with a 4,500 capacity in Kumasi.

The Secretariat affirmed the above and indicated that in consultation with the Ashanti Regional Minister and other key stakeholders, a site has been identified and architectural designs were complete. Discussions on funding were ongoing and the intention is to have a PPP arrangement to finance the project. It is expected that in 2026, the President may cut the sod for commencement of the project. If successfully completed, the model would be replicated in all the regional capitals with the intention of promoting creative arts across the country.

Ghana AIDS Commission

Efforts to prevent mother-to-child HIV transmission

In a response to efforts by Government to prevent mother-to-child HIV transmission, the Commission informed the Committee that the Government was on course. Some initiatives are being made to ensure universal HIV testing for pregnant women are carried out. Antiretroviral Therapy (ART) were immediately given to mothers who test positive, as well as prophylaxis for exposed infants, safer infant feeding support, early infant diagnosis, and community engagement. Unfortunately, these efforts are being hampered due to missed testing opportunities and cultural practices. These challenges had left the results at 98.5 per cent. If addressed, the Commission indicated that Ghana could record 100 per cent elimination of mother-to-child HIV transmission. Some efforts were being made to address the challenges.

Advocacy

The Committee expressed concern about recent reports of a rise in HIV infections despite progress made through evidence-based prevention, treatment and care. The Committee noted that the recent generation (Gen Z) were different and recommended to the Commission that there was the need to win the trust of the Gen Z's to get them on board in the fight against HIV.

The Commission agreed with the Committee and indicated that it was partnering with the National Population Council, to get the youth on board. Further, the Commission was also undertaking other measures to reach out to the youth as a priority.

Partnering with Members of Parliament in Advocacy

The Committee noted that unlike the Commission, Members of Parliament had presence in all communities in the country. MPs do advocacy including HIV advocacy and were well placed to support in the fight against the spread of HIV. They, therefore, suggested to the Commission to include MPs and District Health Officers in their advocacy programmes in order to effectively reach out to the target groups.

The Commission accepted the suggestion and indicated that they would partner and include Members of Parliament in their advocacy programmes

Office of the Special Envoy to the Alliance of Sahelian States Rationale for establishing the Office

The Committee was informed that the Office was established to maintain and enhance bilateral relations and cooperation with the Sahelian States. The Office was to pursue mutual interests and promote regional stability with focus on counter-terrorism and prevent violent extremism.

The Office stated that it was also responsible for resolving trade issues, and enhancing security cooperation with the military-led nations in the Sahel. As part of its mandate, the Office was to hold regular meetings with ambassadors of these nations to review human security situations and provide urgent briefs and early warnings to the appropriate authority on developing situations and emerging issues affecting Ghana's interest and regional stability.

Facilitating trade among the Alliance of Sahalian States

The Office informed the Committee that it was to facilitate trade and resolve trade issues and securing trade routes through Ghana's Ports. The Office had facilitated the use of the Tema and Takoradi Ports on concessionary terms by the Alliance of Sahelian counties. It had also liaised with appropriate stakeholders on the creation of safe mobility corridors and supply lines for the enhancement of trade between Ghana and the Alliance of Sahelian States.

The Office stated that these were part of the efforts by Government to make Ghana ports a preferred choice for the Alliance of Sahelian States (AES)

Relationship with the Ministry of Foreign Affairs

The Committee was informed that as part of its mandate, the Office was to keep the Minister for Foreign Affairs fully informed of all plans and activities to ensure effective coordination and proper diplomatic protocol.

Preventing influx of militants

The Committee expressed concern about the influx of alleged terrorist groups into the country and inquired what measures the Office was doing to address that. The Office responded that most of the people in the Sahelian region have links with some ethic groups in Ghana. There was the need to strengthen the borders and increase advocacy to sensitise the citizenry. The Office assured the Committee that Ghana is safe; however, it indicated that issues relating to galamsey and other economic opportunities in the country as well as the ECOWAS protocol on free movement need to be looked at as migrants were being attracted into the country by these conditions. There was the need for more resources to be made available to the security personnel to help provide the needed security for the country

Inadequate Funding

Ghana's Special Envoy to the AES, Col (Rtd) Larry Gbevlo-Lartey, informed the Committee that their mandate cannot be undertaken without appropriate funding. There was the need for a number of special operations, sensitisation and other activities but the allocation for 2026 was woefully inadequate. He called on Parliament to make more allocation to the Office to enable it effectively undertake its mandate.

Scholarship Secretariat

Outstanding Liabilities at Memphis, USA

The Committee observed that outstanding liabilities to Memphis, USA stood at US$2,800,000 and inquired why the choice of the school, which in the opinion of the Committee was expensive.

The Secretariat agreed with the Committee and indicated that there was an existing agreement with the School. However, it is the intention of the Secretariat to review the agreement when it expires. New agreements would reflect new guidelines for award of scholarships to the school.

Microfinance and Small Loans Centre Outstanding Debt

The Committee observed that for the period under review, total recoveries amounted to GH₵13.7 million and enquired about the total debt portfolio

The Centre responded that the total debt stood at GH₵430 million and efforts were underway to recover the debt.

The Chief Executive Officer informed the Committee that the debts were difficult to collect as most clients were under the impression that the moneys given to them were gifts rather than loans. The Centre was intensifying their advocacy and other debt recovery methods to ensure that these funds are recovered by the Centre.

Absence of a legal framework

The Centre informed the Committee that the absence of a legal framework to guide and regulate the operations of the Centre had been a challenge. The Centre had since commenced work to have an established law in place for its operations, among others. The Bill will soon be brought to Parliament for approval and passage

Public Private Partnership

The Centre informed the Committee that it was exploring the option of a Public Private Partnership (PPP) arrangement to enable it meet the demand for its products. The suppliers would be engaged and the terms agreed upon. For 2026, the Centre was holding discussions with a partner on the supply of tricycles.

The Committee recommended that the PPP discussions be looked at properly to ensure that the State will benefit from that arrangement.

24-Hour Economy Secretariat Rationale for the Programme

The Committee observed that 24-hour economy is a major policy initiative aimed at transforming the country into an industrial and export-led economy by encouraging businesses and public services to operate around-the-clock. The policy, is designed to boost productivity, create jobs, and enhance national competitiveness by maximizing the use of infrastructure and human resources.

The Secretariat informed the Committee that the aim is to make Ghana, an economy which is focused on value addition, exports and improving the ease of doing business in Ghana.

Financing arrangements

The Secretariat informed the Committee that availability of credit was very crucial to the success of the Programme. To address that, many banks in the country have committed to syndicate over GH₵3.0 billion loan to the Fund. Besides, Pension Funds would be contributing about GH₵5.0 billion to support the project. The Bank of Ghana had been engaged to support the programme. Other measures were being considered to de-risk lending to critical sectors. These measures would be helpful in long-term lending to critical sectors and businesses to make the programme a success.

Millennium Development Authority (MiDA)

Mandate of MiDA

The Committee observed that since the Compact Agreement came to an end, MiDA was now tasked to implement an agricultural-focused initiative to ensure food security and reduce imports. The project focuses on creating large-scale, commercially viable agricultural zones across Ghana.

The Authority informed the Committee that the project also aims at de-risking acquisition of land for agriculture in the country. It had accordingly obtained large tracts of land and was in the process of preparing same for release to the private sector for farming. The lands acquired were located at Kasunya (1600 acres), Banda (900 acres) and Kumawu (7000 acres).

Expected Agricultural products

The Authority indicated that the Kasunya lands were earmarked for rice cultivation, the Banda and Kumawu lands were for multi-cropping. It indicated that animal husbandry would be included but the Authority needed to identify a potential investor.

Application of modern farming methods

The Authority explained to the Committee that the intention behind the initiative was to promote large scale farming. It is expected that the investors would adopt modern farming practices, apply scientific methods while leveraging on technology. The project would incorporate the banks, CSIR and others. This is to ensure that the country is able to reverse its dependence on import of these crops.

Making agriculture attractive to the youth

The Committee observed that agriculture is not attractive to the youth because of low remuneration and rudimentary tools and technology applied. The Authority informed the Committee that the goal of the project was to ensure that private sector with large capital would be engaged. Supported by good agronomic practices and over 2000 out-grower farmers, returns would be high, which would attract more youth into agriculture.

Public Sector Reform Secretariat

Bill on Misinformation, Disinformation, Hate Speech and Publication of Other Information

The Committee was informed that the Secretariat was currently working on a proposed law specifically titled the Misinformation, Disinformation, Hate Speech and Publication of Other Information (MDHI) Bill, 2025. This

Bill is currently going through consultation and would soon be submitted to Parliament

Conclusion

The Committee, after critically examining the 2026 Budget Estimates of the Office of Government Machinery, recommends that the House approves the sum of one billion, four and fifty-two million, six hundred and ninety-three thousand, three hundred and eleven Ghana cedis (GH₵1,452,693,311.00) for the 2026 financial year.

Respectfully submitted.

Minister of State for Government Communications (Mr Felix Kwakye Ofosu): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Public Administration and State Interest on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,454,348,978.00 for the services of the Office of the Government Machinery for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take item number 32.

The Speaker: Hon Member, item number 32.

OFFICE OF THE ATTORNEY-GENERAL AND MINISTRY OF JUSTICE

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr James Enu) *on behalf of* **the Chairperson of the Committee:** Mr Speaker, I beg to *move:*

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the allocation of the sum of GH₵677,200,937.00 for the services of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Introduction

The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year was presented to Parliament by the Hon Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Forson on Thursday, 13th November, 2025 in accordance with Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution.

In accordance with Orders 195(4) and 238 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Budget Estimates of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice to the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs for consideration and report to the House.

Deliberations

The Committee met on Monday, 1st December, 2025 and considered the 2026 Budget Estimates of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of

Justice. The Hon Deputy Attorney-General and Deputy Minister for Justice, Dr Justice Srem-Sai, the Chief Director and Heads of Agencies and Departments under the office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice, as well as officials from the Ministry of Finance, attended upon the Committee. The Committee extends its gratitude for their submission.

Reference Documents

The Committee had recourse to the under-listed documents.

i. The 1992 Constitution of Ghana;

ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;

iii. The Budget Estimates and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2025 and 2026 Financial years;

iv. The Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice Medium Term Expenditure Framework for 2026-2029;

v. Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the 2025 Budget Estimates of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice; and

vi. The 2026-2029 Budget Hearing Presentation of the Office of the Attorney-General & Ministry of Justice.

Agencies Under the Ministry

The Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice includes the Headquarters and the following agencies:

i. The General Legal Council

ii. The Ghana School of Law

iii. The Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO)

iv. The Registrar-General`s Department (RGD)

v. Office of the Registrar of Companies

vi. The Council for Law Reporting

vii. The Law Reform Commission; and

viii. The Copyright Office.

The Goal of the Office of the Attorney-General and the Ministry of Justice

The Ministry's goal within the medium-term is to “provide quality advice and legal services to the Government and people of Ghana”.

Policy/Strategic Objectives

The strategic policy objectives from the National Medium-Term Development Policy Framework

(NMTDPF) of the Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice are to:

- Promote access and efficiency in delivery of justice;
- Promote the fight against corruption and economic crimes;
- Enhance capacity for policy formulation and coordination;
- Develop a competitive creative arts industry; and
- Ensure improved fiscal performance and sustainability.

2025 Performance Overview

Programme Performance

The 2025 key achievements for the Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice are outlined under five main programmes around which the Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice function. These programmes and activities are geared towards promoting the rule of law and deepening democratic principles in the country. These are:

- Management and Administration;
- Law Administration;
- Management of Economic and Organised Crime;
- Entity Registration Management; and
- Legal Education.

The performance of the various Programmes during the year under review is indicated below:

Management and Administration

i. The Ministry prepares and submitted its 2024 Annual Performance Report to the Office of the Head of the Civil Service (OHCS). This report served as a vital accountable tool which would enable policy makers and stakeholders to measure progress and identify areas that require improvement;

ii. The Ministry published the 2024 research findings on citizens' knowledge and perceptions of the plea-bargaining legal framework in the administration of criminal justice in the Northern Region. This was published on the Ministry's website on 29th July, 2025;

iii. The Ministry conducted a research survey on citizens' knowledge of the jury system and their perspectives on the proposed amendments in the Central and Western Regions. This created a platform for citizen engagement and enable direct contributions to shape the proposed Jury Bill.

iv. The Ministry submitted its 2026-2029 Sector Medium-Term Development Plan (SMTDP) to the National Development Planning

Commission (NDPC) and received certification of approval;

v. The Ministry finalised and submitted its 2024 Annual Progress Report to the National Development Planning Commission (NDPC) and conducted its 2024 End-of-Year Monitoring and Evaluation Exercise to assess the level of implementation of programmes and activities in the 2024 Annual Action Plan (AAP);

vi. The Ministry prepared and submitted its 2024 Annual Budget Performance Report to Parliament and the Ministry of Finance as required by Section 27 (1, 2 & 3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);

vii. The Ministry submitted its 2024 End of Year Report on the National Anti-Corruption Action Plan (NACAP) to the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ);

viii. The Ministry conducted monitoring exercises on the use of the Government Integrated Financial Management Information System (GIFMIS) to promote compliance with financial management procedures and complied and submitted its 2024 Audit Report in March 2025;

ix. The Ministry facilitated training for twenty-three (23) administrative staff at the Civil Service Training Centre (CSTC). The trainings were on Public Financial Management, Policy Development and Analysis, Administrative Instruments amongst others; and

x. The Ministry prepared and submitted its 2024 Consolidated Financial Report of the Sector to the Controller and Accountant General's Department in line with the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921).

Law Administration

i. The Civil Division of the Office of the Attorney-General and the Ministry of Justice successfully represented the State in 249 civil cases brought against the State in various courts, which could have resulted in the State paying huge sums of money to plaintiffs as judgment debts;

ii. The Civil Division also reviewed 20 agreements and contracts as well as 12 Memoranda of Understanding (MoU's) for Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs) as well as MMDAs to ensure value for money;

iii. The Civil Division processed 180 petitions and 188 requests from MDAs and the public as well as provided 15 legal opinions/advice to MDAs;

iv. The Public Prosecution Division received 2,001 dockets, initiated 1,520 prosecutions in the various courts across the country.

v. The Public Prosecution Division and dealt with motions, appeals, petitions, extraditions and mutual legal assistance requests. The Division disposed 1,900 out of the 2,205 motions received and managed 64 appeals;

vi. The Council for Law Reporting made progress in its activities aimed at promoting legal research and the dissemination of legal information in Ghana;

vii. The Council has completed 100 per cent of the editorial work on the manuscripts for the *[2021-2025] Review of Ghana Law and would be* published by the end of 2025;

viii. The Law Reform Commission (LRC) submitted its Report on Unfair Contract Terms from the Expert Roundtable to the Office of the Attorney-General;

ix. The LRC produced a paper on the Law of Trust to offer vital insights to guide future legislative reforms;

x. The Copyright Office registered 893 Copyright Works to protect creative works and encourage innovation;

xi. The Copyright Office in collaboration with the World Intellectual Property Organisation (WIPO) to kick start a project on strategies to address online copyright piracy in Africa's digital market;

xii. The Copyright Office represented Ghana at the ECOWAS Consultative Meeting on Copyright issues in the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) to position the country to benefit from regional integration in creative trade;

xiii. The Registrar-General's Department (RGD) registered 855 Marriages, processed 1,765 Trademark filings and registered 1,034 trademarks to protect marriage unions and intellectual property rights;

xiv. The Department (RGD) also filed 357 Patents, registered 247 and renewed 413 of these patents;

xv. The Department also generated a total amount of fifty-nine million, three hundred and forty-five thousand, seven hundred and five Ghana Cedis, eighteen pesewas (GH₵ 59,345,705.18) in the year under review and processed a total amount of GH₵104,532,551.61 as death gratuities.

Legal Education

i. The General Legal Council (Ghana School of Law) called Nine Hundred and Forty-Seven (947) lawyers to the Bar;

ii. The Council dealt with disciplinary cases against lawyers. Out of 114 complaints received, 80 were resolved;

ii. The Independent Examinations Committee of the General Legal Council conducted an entrance examination for 4,036 applicants, out of which 2,023 students passed and have been admitted into the 2025/2026 academic programme.

Management of Economic and Organised Crime

The Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO) has also advanced in the fight against economic and organised crime by accomplishing the following:

i. Recovering a total amount of GH₵155,669,461.30 made up of GH₵13,001,032.71 as direct recoveries into the consolidated account and GH₵142,668,428.59 as indirect recoveries from other forms of proceeds from crimes;

ii. Investigating a total of 380 cases and out of these, 15 cases are being prosecuted in various courts and have secured no court convictions;

iii. Through joint operations, the Office dismantled organised carjacking syndicates and recovered 29 luxury vehicles; and

iv. The Office sponsored a total of 320 officers to undergo various 302 local and 18 foreign training programmes to equip them with the necessary knowledge and expertise to affectively combat economic and organised crime.

Entity Registration Management

i. The Office of the Registrar of Companies (ORC) generated a total amount of one hundred and fifty-seven million, three hundred and seventy-eight thousand, and sixty Ghana cedis (GH₵157,378,060.00) as at September 2025;

ii. The Office of the Registrar of Companies (ORC) registered a total of 143,099 Businesses/Companies comprising: 493 Corporate Business Names; 5,728 Companies Limited by Guarantee; 194 Partnership; 18,788 Companies Limited by Shares; 117,848 Sole Proprietors and 48 External Companies;

iii. The Office also processed 45,190 Annual Report; 58,713 Annual Renewals; 4,332 Beneficial Ownership updates; 4,994 changes in Business Names; and 16,253 company updates.

iv. The Office (ORC) also published 6 editions of Companies Bulletin to keep the public updated on business registration activities and compliance; and

v. The Office also processed 118 Applications under Dissolution without Full Winding Up. The Office also oversaw 1 merger with 14 Official Liquidation requests underway, completed 18 out of 19 Private Liquidation and processed 22 cessation applications during the period under review.

2025 Financial Performance (As at September 2025)

During the year under review, an amount of four hundred and thirty-six million, seven hundred and fifty-six thousand, nine hundred and seventy-one Ghana cedis (GH₵436,756,971.00) was allocated to the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice for its activities.

An amount of two hundred and seventy-six million, eight hundred and forty-one thousand, two hundred and seventy-five Ghana cedis and twenty-nine pesewas (GH₵276,841,275.29) of the approved budget was expended.

Table 1 below provides the detailed expenditure returns:

Table 1: 2025 Financial Performance by Economic Classification

Expenditure Item	Approved Budget GH₵ (A)	Amount Released GH₵ (B)	Actual Expenditure GH₵ (C)	Variance GH₵ (D=A-B)	% Released (B/A) *100
Compensation	237,520,197.00	196,033,598.42	196,033,598.42	41,486,598.58	82.5
Goods and Services	126,642,216.00	61,227,580.45	59,686,998.99	65,414,635.55	48.3
Capital Expenditure	72,594,558.00	21,120,677.88	21,120,677.88	51,473,880.12	29.1
Grand Total	436,756,971.00	278,381,856.75	276,841,275.29	158,375,114.25	63.7

Source: PBB Estimates of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice

Table 2: 2025 GoG and IGF Budget Expenditure Performance by Economic Items

Classification	**Approved Budget GH₵ (A)**	**Releases Released GH₵ (B)**	**Actual Expenditure GH₵ (C)**	**Variance (D=A-B)**	**% Variance (D=A-B)/A*100**
Compensation of Employees					
GOG	222,008,685.00	183,078,277.42	183,078,277.42	38,930,407.58	17.5
IGF	15,511,512.00	12,955,321.00	12,955,321.00	2,556,191.00	16.5
SUBTOTAL	237,520,197.00	196,033,598.42	196,033,598.42	41,486,598.58	
Goods and Services					
GOG	25,000,000.00	12,146,507.82	10,605,926.36	12,853,492.18	51.4
IGF	101,642,216.00	49,081,072.63	49,081,072.63	52,561,143.37	51.7

SUBTOTAL	126,642,216.00	61,227,580.45	59,686,998.99	65,414,635.55	
Capital Expenditure					
GOG	20,000,000.00	-	-	20,000,000.00	0
IGF	52,594,558.00	21,120,677.88	21,120,677.88	31,473,880.12	59.8
SUBTOTAL	72,594,558.00	21,120,677.88	21,120,677.88	51,473,880.12	
GRAND TOTAL	**436,756,971.00**	**278,381,856.75**	**276,841,275.29**	**158,375,114.25**	**36.3**

Source: PBB Estimates of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice

Outlook for 2026

Programme Outlook

In 2026, the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice intends to achieve the following key targets under its four main programme areas:

Management and Administration

i. Conduct research on policy and socio-economic issues in the legal and justice sector; and

ii. Create awareness on government programmes and policies in the Justice Delivery systems.

Law Administration

i. The Council for Law Reporting envisages the Publication of 700 copies of the [2023-2024] 1 GLR and the [1969-1970] 1 GLR as well as publish 400 copies of [2025] RGL;

ii. The Law Reform Commission would draft a Report on Review of the Passenger Transport Law and that of the Illiterates Protection Act, 1912(Cap 20);

iii. The Copyright Office estimates to register 1,000 copyright-protected works;

iv. The Registrar-General's Department plans to register 1,000 marriages, administer 270 estates, file 1,600 trademarks as well as organise 6 public awareness programmes for educational institutions;

v. The Registrar-General's Department plans to establish 5 technology and innovation support centres as well as develop regulations for Trademark and Patents Acts and review Administration of Estate Act;

Legal Education

i. The General Legal Council (Ghana School of Law) expects to call 1,100 newly qualified lawyers to the Bar; and

ii. Commence pre-construction of a permanent campus for Ghana School of Law in Kumasi; and

iii. Commence First Phase construction of lecture halls together with its associated facilities at the main Campus, Makola.

Management of Economic and Organised Crime

i. EOCO would investigate 450 cases in the year under review;

ii. The Office is set to prosecute 45 cases;

iii. Build capacity of all staff both locally and international; and

iv. Under take 100 public educations on cybercrime; and

v. Undertake 100 sensitisation programmes on organised crime and related crime activities.

Entity Registration Management

i. The Office of the Registrar of Companies (ORC) anticipates registering 180,000 entities and regulate Insolvency Practitioners and Dissolve Companies;

ii. Complete the phase one of the ORC new office;

iii. The ORC would complete Phase I of the new office, establish and operationalise 3 satellite offices and provide a seamless process for the registration of businesses/ Companies thereby improving the online application process for registration of companies;

iv. The ORC would conduct stakeholder engagement forums in Accra and Zonal Offices as well as hold Sensitisation and Outreach Programs; and

v. The ORC would continue the regular maintenance of the E-Registrar/EBRS.

Budgetary Allocation for the 2026 Financial Year

The Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice has been allocated an amount of Six Hundred and Seventy-Seven Million, Two Hundred Thousand, Nine Hundred and Thirty-Six Ghana cedis (GH₵677,200,936.00) to implement its programmes and activities for the year ending 31st December 2026. The breakdown of the spending pattern in terms of economic classification and programme areas, as well as the sources of funding, are provided in Table 3 below:

Table 3: Budgetary Allocation by Economic Classifications for 2026

Expenditure Item	Sources of Funding			Total	Percentage of Allocation (%)
	GOG (GH₵)	IGF (GH₵)	Donors (GH₵)	(GH₵)	
Compensation	294,576,879.00	22,369,150.00	-	316,946,029.00	46.8
Goods and Services	65,000,000.00	171,681,817.00	-	236,681,817.00	34.95
Capital Expenditure	20,000,000.00	103,573,090.00	-	123,573,090.00	18.25
Grand Total	379,576,879.00	297,624,057.00	-	677,200,936.00	100

Source: PBB Estimates of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice

Observations

After careful examination of the Budget Estimates for the Office of the Attorney-General and the Ministry of Justice for the year 2026, the following observations were made by the Committee.

Office of the Attorney-General & Ministry of Justice

Human Resource Constraints

The Committee observed that the Ministry continues to face significant human resource challenges, both at the Ministry itself and across its agencies. This negatively affects their ability to function effectively and deliver on their mandates. The Ministry further indicated that it needs financial clearance to recruit State Attorneys and other essential professional staff to strengthen its human resource capacity.

The Committee, mindful of the critical roles performed by the Ministry and its agencies, recommends that the Ministry of Finance urgently grant the required financial clearance to facilitate the recruitment of State Attorneys and other professional staff to address the existing human resource gaps.

Increase in Goods and Services Allocation

The Committee noted that the Ministry urgently requires increased allocations for Goods and Services and Capital Expenditure (Capex). This is because the current allocations are insufficient to complete key projects such as the Law House and to support other essential operational activities of the Ministry and its agencies.

The Committee further noted the persistent and widespread infrastructural challenges across the sector which is attributed to inadequate funding and delay in releases. These continue to undermine the effectiveness of both the Ministry and its agencies.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance liaise with the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice and its agencies to ensure the necessary upward adjustments in Goods and Services and Capex allocations for the effective running of the sector.

Commitment Authorisation Delays

The Committee identified that, while the new Commitment Authorisation system introduced by the Ministry of Finance is a commendable measure to curb the indiscriminate issuance of contracts and its attendant challenges, several agencies reported delays in fund releases under the new process which adversely affects the timely achievement of key performance indicators.

The Ministry of Finance assured the Committee that steps were being taken to address the challenges and to ensure more timely releases to Ministries, Departments, and Agencies.

The Committee, acknowledged the merits of the initiative, and strongly urged the Ministry of Finance to collaborate closely with the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice to not only avert delays in submission of requests by the Ministry of Justice but also in the process and release of funds by the Ministry of Finance.

Capping of Internally Generated Funds (IGF)

The Committee recognised that challenges associated with the capping of Internally Generated Funds (IGF) persist across agencies under the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice, including the Registrar-General's Department, the Council for Law Reporting, and the Copyright Office. The Committee additionally recognised that this remains a broader systemic concern that continues to impede operational efficiency and limit the capacity of these agencies to effectively deliver on their mandates.

The Committee therefore urges the Ministry of Finance to review upwards the current IGF retention ceilings for these agencies, as enhanced retention is essential to strengthening their financial sustainability and improving their ability to fulfil their statutory mandates efficiently.

Legislative Output & Drafting Capacity Challenges

The Committee observed with concern that current legislative output of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice remains insufficient to meet the country's evolving governance and development needs. Several key legal and policy instruments have experienced prolonged delays, including the Gaming Commission Regulation and Non-Custodial Sentencing Regulation, which have remained pending for multiple years. The Ministry informed the Committee about the significant capacity constraints affecting the legislative drafting process. These include human resource limitations within the Legislative Drafting Division of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice.

The human resource deficit hinders timely preparation of Bills and legislative Instruments. The Committee recommends that urgent measures be taken to accelerate the completion and submission of the outstanding legislative Instruments. The Committee further urges the responsible agencies namely, the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice and the Ministry of Finance to prioritize capacity building within the Legislative Drafting Division, in addition to recruitment.

Legislative Drafting Programme

The Committee mentioned that legislative drafting programme has been expunged from the Ghana School of Law's curriculum. The Committee was of the opinion that it is important for persons to be trained in legislative drafting to augment the work of the Ministry and Parliament. The Ministry of Justice and the Ghana School of Law indicated that efforts are ongoing to reinstate the programme to help rebuild technical capacity.

The Committee prevailed upon the Ghana School of Law to reinstate the legislative drafting programme in its curriculum to ensure a sustainable pipeline of qualified drafters for the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice.

Reformation of Justice System

The Committee noted that the Ministry's key performance indicators should not only be focused on prosecutions but also on reforming the justice system. The Committee appeal to the Ministry to submit a Non-Custodial Sentencing Bill, a Victim Support Code to provide support to victims of crime, as well as a Probation System framework.

The Committee remarked that, there should be a probation system where convictions could be regulated. This system would lessen the burden on the President of the Republic on matters relating to amnesty of inmates.

The Committee urged the Office of the Attorney General to seek non-custodial sentences for less grievous offences. This would decongest the prisons and reform inmates to be better persons.

The Committee similarly recommended that, there must be a system that provides for the welfare of victims. Victims of crime are occasionally left without any remedy from the State. They are requested to cater for their medical Bills themselves, and this sometimes inhibits the assistance and care that they so desperately need.

Second Optional Protocol to ICCPR

The Committee observed that Ghana is yet to sign the Second Optional Protocol to the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR), which relates to the abolition of the death penalty, despite sustained national advocacy for reforms within the criminal justice system.

The Committee recommends that the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice give due consideration to the signing and ratification of the Second Optional Protocol of the ICCPR as part of broader efforts to modernise the criminal justice framework and bring finality to the issue of death penalty.

Ghana School of Law

The Committee noted that the proposed Legal Education Reform Bill seeks to strike a balance between access to professional legal training and protection of quality legal education in the Ghana. It was noted that key enhancing measures include the removal of the entrance examination, the expansion of professional training centers to multiple universities, and the establishment of regional examination centers to reduce geographical barriers to prospective students.

The School informed the Committee that the Legal Education Reform Bill would include strong quality assurance provisions such as stringent accreditation requirements for participating universities, the introduction of a single national bar examination, the requirement for a blend of practitioners and academics in teaching faculties, and requirement for participating universities to have modern infrastructure such as online libraries and moot court facilities.

The School similarly indicated to the Committee that as part of its legal education reform, it intends to transform its campuses into regional examination centres and also invest into computerized examination systems, to reposition the Ghana School of Law into an administrative and training hub.

The Committee expressed its full support for the reforms and urged the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice and the Ghana School of Law to expedite action to present the Bill to Parliament. The Committee also urged the Ministry and the School to develop a clear strategy to address the existing backlog of applicants in order to provide seamless transition to ensure a smooth and effective rollout of the reform.

Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO)

The Committee observed that despite the outstanding performance of the Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO) in the recovery of over three hundred million cedis, EOCO performed with less than half of the required personnel. The Office continues to face significant staffing constraints, EOCO currently has an existing staff strength of 390 against a minimum operational requirement of 850.

The Committee recognised the absence of formal Conditions of Service for staff of EOCO. This has resulted in inadequate remuneration for staff whose duties are high-risk in nature. This gap has contributed to high attrition rate, with skilled officers being poached by other law enforcement agencies with better conditions of service. If the situation is not salvaged, it would thus erode critical institutional memory.

The Committee was informed that the presentation of the Economic and Organised Crime Office Bill to Parliament, which includes provisions for establishing Conditions of Service, remains outstanding. The Committee was of the view that the continued delay in submitting this Bill adversely affects the Office's long-term sustainability and staff motivation. EOCO also indicated to the Committee of its proposal to retain 35 per cent of its recoveries to support its operations.

The Committee recommends that EOCO adopts a revenue retention model similar to the Office of the Special Prosecutor in its Bill which would enable EOCO to retain 35 per cent of its recoveries. Additionally, the Committee recommends that the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice collaborate with EOCO to expedite the presentation of the Bill to Parliament for consideration and passage. This would increase staffing, enhance operational capacity, and ensure the long-term effectiveness of the Office.

Registrar-General's Department

The Committee observed that the Registrar-General's Department is confronted with operational challenges arising from the current capping of its Internally Generated Funds at 18 per cent which restricts the resources available for its activities. The Department informed the Committee that it requires 60 per cent retention of its internally generated funds to effectively operate.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance review the prevailing IGF capping arrangement from 18 per cent to 60 per cent. This is to ensure that the Department retains adequate funds to sustain its operations and continue supporting the broader sector effectively.

Office of the Registrar of Companies

The Committee noted that the Office of the Registrar of Companies still lacks a dedicated office space and is compelled to share premises with the Registrar-General's Department. This arrangement undermines the Office's visibility, independence and operational efficiency. The absence of a permanent office continues to hinder the Office's ability to fully discharge its mandate and deliver optimal services to the public.

The Committee urged the Ministry of Finance, in collaboration with the Ministry of Justice, to prioritise the allocation of resources to support the establishment of a permanent office for the Registrar of Companies.

Law Reform Commission

The Committee observed the shortage of essential office equipment, including printers, which significantly impedes the efficient execution of the Legal Reform Commission's day-to-day functions. This undermines the Commission's capacity to perform its mandate effectively and hinders the timely delivery of its services.

The Committee recommends that the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice expedite action for the provision of these critical equipment to the Commission to enhance its operational efficiency and general productivity.

Copyright Office

The Copyright Office informed the Committee that it has already submitted a letter to the Minister of Finance seeking relief from the current capping arrangement and response is pending. The Office seeks a 100 per cent retention of its Internally Generated Funds to effectively support its activities.

The Committee also observed that the Copyright Office remains significantly understaffed, this continues to impede its ability to effectively discharge its mandate. It was further noted that the Copyright office operates in Accra and Kumasi only, despite its national mandate to serve rights holders across the entire country. This limited geographical presence hinders public access to copyright services and undermines efforts to promote and protect intellectual property rights nationwide.

The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance expedite its review of the Office's request. Broader policy considerations be undertaken to address recurring IGF capping constraints across affected agencies. The Committee recommends that the Ministry of Finance liaise with Office of the Attorney-General and the Ministry of Justice to allocate the necessary resources to strengthen the institutional capacity of the Copyright Office. This should include increment in staffing and expansion of its regional presence to ensure effective nationwide service delivery.

Council for Law Reporting

The Committee tasked the Council to maintain an active social media presence to bring awareness to the citizenry. It was noted that the Council successfully executed initiatives such as registration on the Ghana.gov platform for electronic payments, an agreement with Graphic Corporation for nationwide deliveries, and the recruitment of National Service personnel to strengthen digital marketing.

The Committee also noted that the Council's Internally Generated Fund (IGF) retention, capped at 66 per cent, restrains operational capacity and affects the execution of core mandates such as printing, which operations depends heavily on retained revenue. The Committee also observed that a single marketing officer is insufficient for contemporary digital communication and outreach demands.

Accordingly, the Committee urges the Council to fully leverage and enhance its existing initiatives such as social media presence to improve public engagement and service delivery. It further recommends that the Ministry of Finance review the IGF retention threshold from 66 per cent to 100 per cent to sustain the Council's operations.

Similarly, the Committee recommends that additional marketing personnel be recruited to strengthen the Council's visibility, service delivery, and competitiveness in the digital age.

Conclusion and Recommendation

The Committee accordingly recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the sum of six hundred and seventy-seven million, two hundred thousand, nine hundred and thirty-six Ghana cedis (GH₵677,200,936.00) for the programmes and activities of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved.

That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the allocation of the sum of GH₵677,200,937.00 for the services of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we will take the item numbered 33. The Attorney-General and Minister for Justice is not here so, I plead that the Minister for Sports and Recreation to move the Motion on his behalf.

Thank you.

The Speaker: The Motion numbered 33.

JUDICIARY AND JUDICIAL SERVICE

Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams) *on behalf of* **Attorney-General and Minister for Justice:** Mr Speaker, I rise to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Judiciary on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,098,136,900.00 for the services of the Judiciary and Judicial Service for the year ending 31st December, 2026.

The Speaker: Any seconder?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion that this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Judiciary on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,098,136,900.00 for the services of the Judiciary and Judicial Service for the year ending 31st December, 2026. And in doing so, Mr Speaker, I wish to present the Report of your Committee. I want *Hansard* to capture the report as having been duly read.

Introduction

Pursuant to Article 179 of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana and Section 21(3) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921), the Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, presented the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year to Parliament on Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

In accordance with Standing Orders 195(4) and 256, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Annual Budget Estimates of the Judiciary and Judicial Service to the Committee on Judiciary for consideration and report.

On Tuesday, 2nd December, 2025, the Committee on Judiciary met with the Judiciary and the Judicial Service to consider the referral. Present at the meeting was the Judicial Secretary, His Lordship Justice Musah Ahmed. Also present at the meeting were other Senior Officials from the Judiciary and the Judicial Service, as well as representatives of the Ministry of Finance.

The Committee is grateful to the Judicial Secretary, the technical team from the Judicial Service, and officials from the Ministry of Finance for assisting the Committee in deliberating the Budget Estimates.

Reference Documents

The underlisted documents were considered during the Committee's deliberations:

i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;

ii. The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana;

iii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year;

iv. The Programme Based Budget Estimates of the Judiciary and Judicial Service for the year 2026;

v. The Annual Budget Estimates of the Judiciary for the 2025 Financial Year;

vi. The Judiciary and Judicial Service Medium Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) for 2025 to 2028;

vii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year;

viii. The Report of the Judiciary Committee on the Annual Budget Estimates of the Judiciary and

Judicial Service for the 2025 Financial Year.

Vision of the Service

The vision of the Judicial Service is to ensure "Equal access to quality justice."

Mission of the Service

The Mission of the Judiciary and Judicial Service is to be an independent arm of the state created to resolve legal conflicts according to law, impartially and efficiently, to all persons without fear or favour, affection or ill-will.

Core Functions

The core functions of the Judiciary and Judicial Service are to:

i. Ensure efficient and speedy disposal of cases at all courts;

ii. Ensure efficiency and speedy delivery of justice;

iii. Strengthen the capacity of its human resources and improve the conditions of service for all staff;

iv. Change the poor public perception of the Judiciary and build public confidence in the delivery of justice;

v. Improve infrastructural capacity to enhance service delivery

Strategic Policy Objectives

The Judicial Service has the following strategies in line with the Medium-Term Policy Objectives.

- Enhance the judicial processes and procedures to improve access and justice;
- Develop both Human and Material Capacity of the Judiciary and the Judicial Service of Ghana to deliver on its mandate;
- Optimise the use of Technology to ensure speedy resolution of cases and efficient service; and
- Enhance public understanding, trust, and confidence through open and transparent engagement.

Performance for Year 2025

The budget allocation to the Judiciary and Judicial Service for the implementation of its programmes and activities for the 2025 Fiscal Year was one billion, eighteen million, six hundred and eleven thousand, two hundred and seventy-three Ghana cedis, (GH₵1,018,611,273.00). Table 1 details the Budgetary Allocation by Sources of Funding and Economic Classification

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Table 1: Breakdown of approved budgetary allocation for the 2025 Fiscal Year					
ECONOMIC CLASSIFICATION	SOURCES OF FUNDING				
	GoG	IGF	Donor	Total	%
	(GH₵)	(GH₵)	(GH₵)	(GH₵)	
Compensation	676,560,833.00	20,034,161.00		696,594,994.00	69
Goods and Services	155,018,329.00	22,896,184.00		177,914,513.00	17
Capital Expenditure	129,791,651.00	14,310,115.00		144,101,766.00	14
TOTAL	961,370,813.00	57,240,460.00		1,018,611,273.00	100

Source: Ministry of Finance

Performance for the Year 2025

During the year under review, the Judicial Service executed the following programmes and activities:

Management and Administration

During the 2025 budget year, the Judicial Service made notable progress in strengthening justice delivery and institutional performance. A key achievement was the publication of a joint Judicial Service–UNICEF research study titled "Assessment of Sexual Abuse Cases before the Gender-Based Violence Courts and Other Circuit Courts in Ghana." The study provides essential insights to guide policy reforms and improve the handling of sexual abuse cases across the justice system.

Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR

Under the Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) programme, the Judicial Service intensified public sensitisation and case-resolution activities across the country. Key engagements, including radio and television panel discussions, were organised to deepen public awareness of ADR processes and encourage greater utilisation of mediation services. During the ADR Week celebrations, 608 cases were referred to the ADR courts, out of which 192 were successfully settled, representing a 31 per cent settlement rate. Additionally, between January and June 2025, a total of 4,030 cases were referred by the courts for mediation, with 1,168 cases settled, reflecting an overall settlement rate of 29 per cent. These interventions contributed to decongesting the courts and promoting timely, cost-effective dispute resolution. This clearly shows that we must encourage and support the use of ADR in the resolution of disputes.

Infrastructure Development

The Judicial Service continued its efforts to expand access to justice. Three new court, the AMA District Court, the Kpone District Court, and the Winneba High Court, were commissioned to improve justice delivery in their respective jurisdictions.

Also, the Wa Court and Administration Complex, which had been abandoned for over a decade, was re-awarded, and work commenced on 30th September 2024. The project has since advanced steadily and is now nearing completion, promising to enhance judicial service delivery in the Upper West Region upon commissioning. Additionally, construction of the three-storey Office and Documentation Block at the Judicial Service Head Office, which began in 2024, has reached an advanced stage of completion. These infrastructural developments demonstrate the Service's commitment to expanding and modernising its facilities to support efficient justice administration.

E-Justice and Digital Court Automation

The E-Justice Programme also progressed significantly, reaching 80 percent completion under phase one. Phase two of the programme is scheduled to go live in 2026 and will focus on digitising processes at the Supreme Court and Court of Appeal to enhance efficiency and reduce manual paperwork.

The Service made substantial progress in digital transformation, with over 18 million legal records digitised and 110 additional transcription systems installed across the country to improve court proceedings and records management. The Judicial Service will further introduce an e-Appeal Records System to streamline appeal processes, reduce delays, and enhance the overall administration of justice.

Budgetary Allocation for Year 2026

The Judiciary and Judicial Service have been allocated a total amount of one billion, ninety-eight million, one hundred and thirty-six thousand, nine hundred Ghana cedis (GH₵1,098,136,900.00), for the effective implementation of its programmes and activities.

Table 2 below details the Budgetary Allocation by Sources of Funding and Economic Classification.

BREAKDOWN OF BUDGETARY ALLOCATION FOR THE 2026 FINANCIAL YEAR					
	SOURCES OF FUNDING				
ECONOMIC CLASSIFI CATION	GoG	IGF	Total	%	
	(GH₵)	(GH₵)	(GH₵)		
Compensation	778,044,958.00	15,167,271.00	793,212,229.00	72.23	
Goods and Services	155,018,329.00	18,768,652.00	173,786,981.00	15.83	
Capital Expenditure	120,000,000.00	11,137,690.00	131,137,690.00	11.94	
TOTAL	1,053,063,287.00	45,073,613.00	1,098,136,900.00		
%	95.90	4.10		100.00	

Table 2 shows the economic classification of resources and sources of funding allocated to the Judiciary and Judicial Service for the 2026 financial year. Out of the total allocation of GH₵1,098,136,900.00, GH₵1053,063,287.00 representing 95.90 per cent is funded from GoG sources. Internally Generated Fund (IGF) contributes 4.10 per cent to the total allocation. The CAPEX allocation constitutes 11.94 per cent. This amount is inadequate, having regard to the needs o the Judiciary and Judicial Service.

Outlook for 2026

In the 2026 fiscal year, the Judiciary and Judicial Service would apply its Budget allocation to the following projects:

Key Construction and Infrastructure Projects

In the year 2026, the Judiciary would commence some projects and see to the completion of on-going construction works. Below are the highlights:

i. Complete the Wa Court and Administration Complex projects;

ii. Commence the construction of the Office Block for Court of Appeal Judges (Phase 1);

iii. Commence the construction of one (1) Regional Administration Office at Western North Region;

iv. Installation of two (2) lifts at the Supreme Court Building;

v. Provision of one (1) lift for the Kumasi Court of Appeal;

vi. Provision of two (2) generators (250 KVA and 400 KVA) for the Kumasi Court of Appeal and High Court;

vii. Replacement of air conditioners at the Law Court Complex (Phase 1);

viii. Provision of mechanised boreholes with a treatment plant for Law Court; and

ix. Purchase of 40 Money Safes for some Court at the Complex

Digitisation and ICT Infrastructure Projects

In 2026, the Judicial Service will prioritise the procurement of some essential office equipment to support the e-justice project, automation of court services, and digitisation equipment to enhance operational efficiency across all courts. These procurements will include desktop computers, laptops, UPS units, photocopier machines, printers, software solutions, microphones, cameras, and related ICT tools required to support digital court processes.

The Service will also pursue ISO certification to strengthen institutional standards and improve service quality. Additionally, the expansion of the Data Center storage capacity by 900TB will be undertaken to accommodate the growing volume of digital records and ensure secure, reliable data management across the justice sector.

Observations

Large Backlog of Cases

The Committee was informed that as of the end of the 2025 legal year, a total of one hundred and thirty-three thousand, four hundred twenty-two (133,422) cases were pending and yet to be resolved at the superior and lower courts. This comprises three hundred and eighty-two (382) at the Supreme Court, three thousand, two hundred and eighty-three (3,283) at the Court of Appeal. The High Court recorded twenty-eight thousand, nine hundred and seventy-four (28,974) outstanding, Circuit Court, twenty-seven thousand, nine hundred and twenty-five (27,925), and seventy-one thousand, eight hundred and fifty-eight (71,858) at the District Court.

The Committee expressed concern about the alarming number of outstanding caseloads. It was observed that the challenge of slow judicial processes, which could be partly attributed to adjournments, staff shortages, and technological limitations, has contributed to the situation. Currently, fifty-two (52) of the one hundred and twenty-eight (128) High Courts have been digitised, all other courts continue to operate manually. This heavy reliance on manual processes contributes to significant case backlogs and operational overload within the judicial system.

The Committee was informed that although digitising alone would not unlock the full potential of the judiciary's service delivery, plans are far ahead to digitise all the records of appeal at the Court of Appeal and the Supreme Court to reduce the turnaround time and backlog of cases.

The Committee recommends that the Judiciary pursue vigorously all the plans to digitise the court processes, including those at the lower courts, to ensure speedy delivery of justice for all.

Delay in Project Completion

The Committee was informed of the Wa Court Complex project, which was originally commenced in 2005, but stalled and was re-awarded in 2024. The Committee was not happy with the delay in the completion of the project, which was as a result of the late release of funds. The delay is also partly attributed to the inadequate provision for washrooms and other minor works, which were not part of the initial plan.

The Committee is, however, pleased to note that an amount of GH₵7 million has been released by the Controller and Accountant-General's Department for that purpose. Additionally, the GH₵5 million earmarked in the 2026 Budget, when released, would complete the project.

The Committee noted that although this is a legacy project, it was expected that the Service would have been more proactive in addressing the anomalies identified. It expressed concern about the renegotiation of contract sums, which comes at an expense to the government, hence the need to carry out the requisite assessment of all projects before commencement. The Committee was, however, assured that the project would be completed in March 2026.

The Committee therefore urges the Judicial Service to expedite action on the outstanding works to ensure the timely completion and full functionality of the project, as any further delay will adversely affect the effective delivery of justice. The Committee also recommends that the Ministry of Finance ensure the timely release of funds to prevent further delay.

Priority Projects

The Committee noted that an amount of GH₵80,137,514.83 has been allocated to ongoing priority projects of the Judiciary. This amount represents 61 per cent of the total capital expenditure allocation of GH₵131,137,690.00 for the 2026 financial year. The Committee inquired into the nature of these projects and requested justification for the associated allocations.

In response, the Judicial Service informed the Committee that the bulk of the allocation is for the provision of an Electronic Document Management and Upload Solution for the scanning of court processes, and the Electronic Case Management System (ECMS) for the Supreme Court and Court of Appeal (E-Justice). The total allocation for these projects amounts to GH₵69,264,614.90. These initiatives form part of the broader E-Justice Project, which seeks to address the predominantly manual court operations.

The Committee acknowledges the urgent need for the completion of these projects to address the critical challenges affecting legal and judicial processes and urges the Service to ensure early completion of these ongoing projects.

Budgetary Allocation and Resource Adequacy

For the 2025 financial year, the Judiciary and the Judicial Service were allocated a total budget of GH₵1,018,611,273.00. The projected allocation for the 2026 financial year is GH₵1,098,136,900.00. This shows a marginal increase of 7.2 per cent as compared to 2025.

While the Committee acknowledges this 7.2 per cent increase, it expresses concern that the amount remains inadequate, particularly the allocation for capital expenditure in the face of challenges bedeviling the judicial system. The Judicial Service proposed to procure one (1) station wagon (4x4) for the Supreme Court, a high-spec saloon vehicle for the Chief Justice, eleven (11) diesel station wagons for the Court of Appeal, thirty (30) SUVs for the High Court, twenty-two (22) saloon vehicles for Circuit Courts, and forty (40) saloon vehicles for District Courts. However, due to budgetary constraints, sixteen (16) vehicles have been approved for procurement.

The Committee observed that a number of court infrastructure projects across the country remain uncompleted due to budgetary constraints. Additionally, persistent challenges relating to the conditions of service for judges require urgent attention.

The Committee recommends that the Judiciary is the bedrock of the country's democracy, and the Judicial Service serves as its operational machinery. It is therefore imperative that both institutions are adequately resourced to effectively execute their mandate. The Committee also recommends that the Ministry of Finance consider an upward adjustment of the CAPEX allocation to the Judiciary during the Mid-year Budget Review.

Conclusion and Recommendation

The role of the Judiciary in shaping Ghana's legal jurisprudence is paramount. As the guardian of justice, the institution must be adequately equipped and resourced to effectively execute its mandate. Strengthening its capacity is essential to improving judicial processes and procedures, ensuring continuous enhancement in access to justice, and promoting the timely delivery of justice across the country.

The Judicial Service, as the administrative arm of the Judiciary, plays a pivotal role in the effective management and operationalisation of the judicial system. Its functions are essential to enhancing access to justice and ensuring that justice is delivered speedily. Consequently, the activities of both the Judiciary and the Judicial Service must be adequately funded to support the effective execution of their mandate.

In this regard, the Committee respectfully recommends to the House to adopt this Report and approve the sum of one billion, ninety-eight million, one hundred and thirty-six thousand, nine hundred Ghana Cedis (GH₵1,098,136,900.00) for the activities of the Judiciary and the Judicial Service of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.

Respectfully submitted.

Question proposed.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

> That this honourable House adopted the Report of the Committee on Judiciary on the allocation of the sum of GH₵1,098,136,900.00 for the services of the Judiciary and Judicial Service for the year ending 31st December 2026.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, if we can go back to the item numbered 9(d) and lay some Papers.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we are back to item numbered 9, Presentation of Papers, 9(d), by the Chairman of the Committee.

PAPER

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong) on behalf of the Chairperson—

> Report of the Finance Committee on the Indicative Debt Treatment Menus between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Finance) and individual commercial lenders for the restructuring of the outstanding Commercial Debt of two billion, seven hundred million United States Dollars (US$2,700,000,000.00)

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Report of the Finance Committee has been accordingly presented to the House.

7:57 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let me use this opportunity to thank my Friends in the Minority. Their action has enabled a very speedy approval of the estimates of the various agencies and their Reports. We thank them very much for their non-involvement. It has enabled us to move with dispatch and to approve all our estimates.

Mr Speaker, we have concluded Business for the day and given that we have exceeded five hours, I want to thank you very much. I want to thank you very much for the manner in which you have steered affairs in this House today in spite of the effort to undermine the execution of Government Business. You kept the ship moving, and we have been able to successfully approve all the estimates that we scheduled to approve today.

Mr Speaker, I want to assure the general public and the Ghanaian population that this Side of the House, the NDC side, will continue to uphold the tenets of democracy. We have the numbers. We could have done certain things, but we know that this 4th Republican Constitution is a product of the National Democratic Congress (NDC). *[Hear! Hear!]* Mr Speaker, no Constitution in the history of Ghana has lasted and endured the way that this 4th Republican Constitution has endured. *[Hear! Hear!]* Mr Speaker, the fight between the Minority and Majority can be likened to a fight between David and Goliath. David succeeded because Goliath allowed him to lure Goliath into using the tools David was more adept at.

Mr Speaker, I could have used my numbers to vanquish this small Minority *[Hear! Hear!]*, but if I had fallen into their trap, I would not have succeeded in approving the Estimates. So, I refused to use their tools; I applied wisdom, and that is why I can now confidently say that the NDC has been successful today. Mr Speaker, the target date for the passage of the Appropriation will be met by this House. We will pass the Appropriation on the date we have determined.

Mr Speaker, I want to assure my Friends on the other Side that we understand their issue: they are protesting the letter from the Clerk to the Electoral Commission. We will all await your ruling on this matter. I believe, as you have always done, that your ruling will be fair and it will be based on the law, and whoever is right in this matter, you will accordingly pronounce.

Mr Speaker, thank you for your leadership today. I ordinarily would not thank citizens who are sitting in the Public Gallery and observing us, but when our forces in the Chamber are confronted with a battle, they need their general, and our general is here. I commend the National Chairman of the party, General Aseidu Nketia, who is here to give this Side of the House the moral support and encouragement to execute the task of the House.

Mr Speaker, I thank you very much.

[Members of the Majority sang their party anthem]

The Speaker: I will proceed to adjourn the House to tomorrow. I take it that the House will prefer that we resume sitting at 12 noon. At what time?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, 12 noon.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 8:06 p.m. till 10th December, 2025 at 12 noon.

Editor’s Note
This Official Report was corrected by the House on 19th December, 2025.